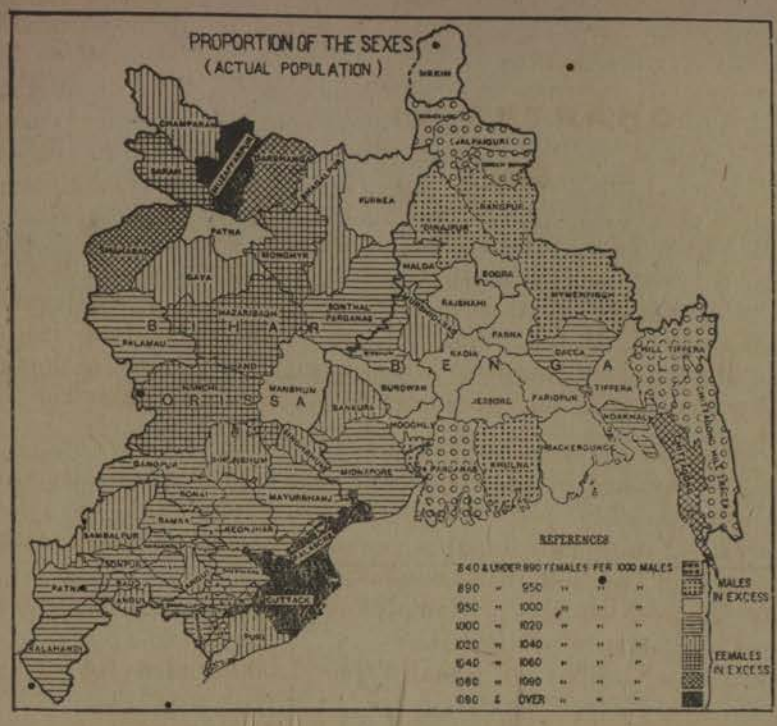
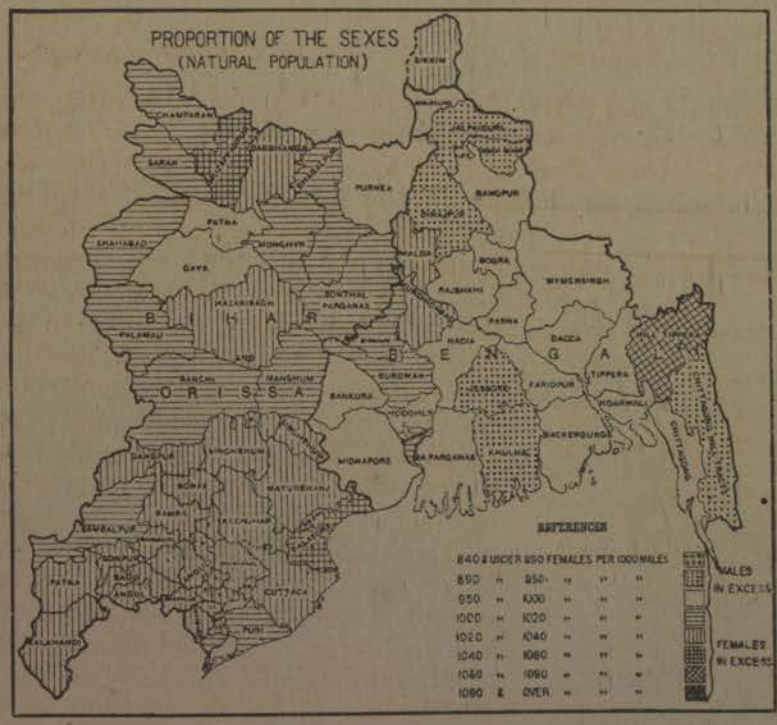
in every district of Bengal, except Birbhum, Bankura, Midnapore, Murshidabad, Malda, Dacca, Noakhali and Chittagong; in the latter eight districts the proportion of females to 1,000 males varies from 1,000 in Midnapore to 1,087 in Chittagong. In Bihar and Orissa females are in marked excess in every district except Purnea (957), Patna (988) and Manbhum (963). To a small extent the difference between the two provinces is due to the large number of immigrants that pour into Bengal from Bihar and Orissa, the United Provinces and elsewhere. The actual number of immigrants enumerated in Bengal is nearly 2 millions, among whom there is, roughly, only one female to every two males. In the actual population, therefore, the real proportion of the sexes is partially obscured by migration. The effect of migration on any tract may, however, be eliminated, if we exclude the immigrants from outside and include those who have emigrated, so as to get what is known as the natural population, *i.e.*, the population born in that tract, regardless of the place of enumeration.





613. The proportion of the sexes in the actual and natural population of each district and natural division is shown in Subsidiary Table I, from which it will be seen that the volume of migration is not sufficient to change the excess of females into a defect, or conversely, except in the marginally-noted districts. The net gain of males or loss of females on the census day turned the balance in the actual population in favour of males only in the colliery districts of Burdwan and Manbhum, and in the State of Hill Tippera. In the natural population of Bengal females are in excess only in the border districts of Burdwan,

District.	Number of females per 1,000 males.	
	Actual population.	Natural population.
Burdwan ...	997	1,018
Bankura ...	1,024	935
Midnapore ...	1,000	996
Dacca	1,003	979
Noakhali ...	1,016	985
Chittagong ...	1,087	984
Hill Tippera ...	885	1,081
Gaya	1,035	992
Manbhum ...	963	1,010

Birbhum, Murshidabad and Malda on the east, in the frontier State of Hill Tippera in the extreme south-east, and in Howrah in the south. Elsewhere males preponderate. The proportion of females is highest in the more distinctively Hindu localities, viz., West Bengal (994) and Central Bengal (972). It is lowest in the divisions which have a majority of Musalmans, viz., East Bengal (965) and North Bengal (965). In Bihar and Orissa also the proportion of females is highest in the most purely Hindu tracts, *i. e.*, Orissa (1,028) and North Bihar (1,019). The latter is closely followed by Chota Nagpur (1,018), which has a large Animist population. South Bihar has the smallest proportion of females, viz., 991 per 1,000 males. Females predominate in the natural population of every district, except the border district of Purnea, the inhabitants of which have many affinities to the Bengalis, and in Patna and Gaya. The deficiency in these latter two districts is to be attributed partly to plague, to which females are more liable than males.

SEX PROPORTION BY RELIGION.

614. In Bengal, Bihar and Orissa as a whole the proportion of females in the actual population has been higher amongst Hindus than amongst Muhammadans at each of the last three censuses, but the Muhammadans have a higher, and not a lower, proportion of females than the Hindus in each province separately. This latter feature is common to all the natural divisions of both provinces, except the Chota Nagpur Plateau, and to more than half the districts. In the two provinces as a whole, and in the Chota Nagpur Plateau in particular, the Animists have a larger proportion of women than either Hindus or Muhammadans. It seems probable, therefore, that in Chota Nagpur the greater excess of females amongst Hindus is due mainly to the fact that they are mostly of aboriginal stock. Statistics for natural population by religion are not available, but we have already seen that migration is not so extensive as to turn the balance of the sex proportions. It is also clear that, if the effects of migration be eliminated, the difference between the figures for Hindus and Musalmans would be greater still in all parts of Bihar and Orissa except the Chota Nagpur Plateau, as Hindu males form the majority of the emigrants.

PROVINCE.	NUMBER (000's OMITTED) OF—				NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES.	
	HINDUS.		MUSALMANS.		HINDUS.	MUSALMANS.
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.		
Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.	26,413	26,281	14,153	13,766	995	973
Bengal	10,848	10,097	12,377	11,860	931	958
Bihar and Orissa ...	15,565	16,184	1,776	1 908	1,040	1,074

DIVISION.	NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES IN 1911.		NUMBER OF DISTRICTS IN WHICH THE EXCESS OF FEMALES IS GREATEST AMONG.—	
	Hindus	Musalmans.	Hindus.	Musalmans.
Bengal ...	**931**	**958**	**12**	**18**
West Bengal ...	986	992	3	3
Central ,, ...	852	906	2	3
North ,, ...	881	955	1	8
East ,, ...	960	973	6	4
Bihar and Orissa.	**1,040**	**1,074**	**11**	**12**
North Bihar ...	1,057	1,066	...	6
South ,, ...	1,020	1,177	...	4
Orissa	1,080	1,118	1	2
Chota Nagpur Plateau.	1,016	975	10	...

SEX PROPORTION BY CASTE.

615. There is a general deficiency of females amongst all the Bengali Hindu castes, except Bagdi (1,010), Baishnab (1,205), Bauri (1,035), Bhumij (1,078), Chasi Kaibartta (1,001), Sudra (1106) and Tiyar (1,074), all, be it noted, low classes. A few other castes or tribes, which are of Mongoloid origin (and cannot be called purely Bengali) also have a slight excess of females, viz., Khambu and Jimdar (1,012), Kuki (1,001), Magh (1,040) and Mech (1,101), and also the Dravidian Oraon (1,055). In Bihar and Orissa nearly every caste has a preponderance of females, the exceptions being the three high castes of Babhan (967), Brahman (1,000) and Rajput (995), the ubiquitous Baniya (995) and the Animist Bhumij (986). Statistics of emigration by caste not being available, it is impossible to say how far the varying paucity of males in the different castes of Bihar and Orissa is attributable to the exodus of their males; but it is noticeable that there is no striking deficiency among the Animist

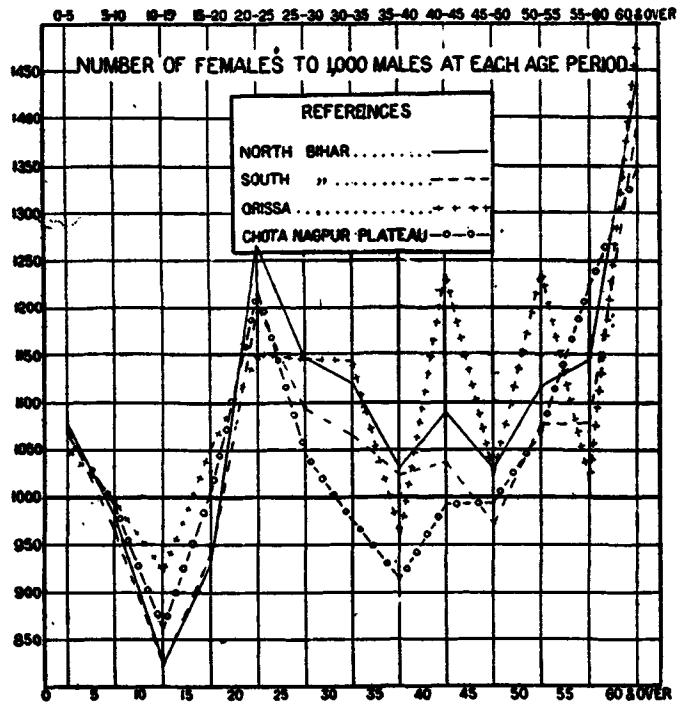
Santals and Oraons, who are pioneer races furnishing a large proportion of emigrants.

No correlation between social status and the proportion of the sexes can be traced, for in Bengal the Subarnabaniks (815) have the lowest proportion of females, and then come in order Goala, Muchi, Brahman, Tanti and Bhuiya, the ratio among whom varies from 819 to 924. In Bihar and Orissa, after the five castes mentioned above (Babhan, Brahman, Rajput, Baniya and Bhumij) the lowest proportion is found among the Doms, Goalas and Kayasths, varying only from 1,002 to 1,004.

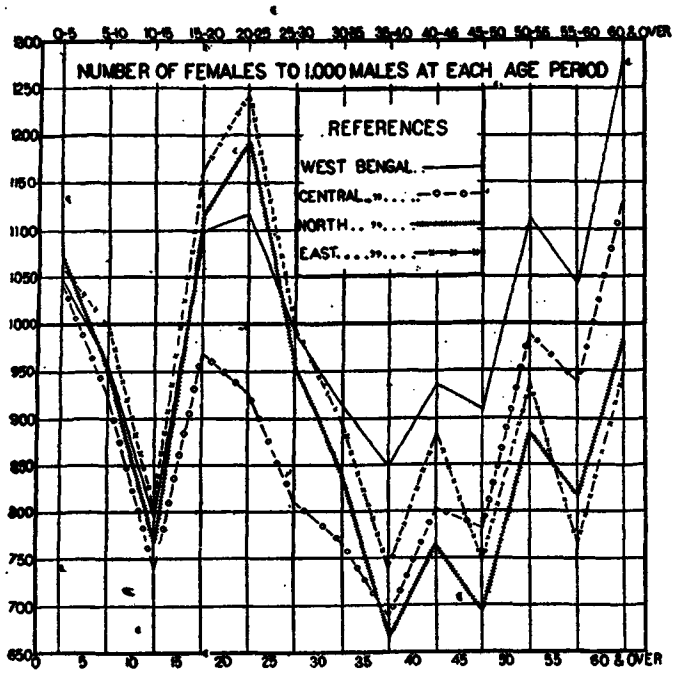
Two features in the returns are noticeable. First, there is a relatively small number of women among the Brahmans and Kayasths in both provinces, a feature which is not noticed in other castes that have representatives both in Bengal and in Bihar and Orissa. Secondly, females are generally in excess amongst the Munda and Dravidian tribes of Chota Nagpur, *e.g.*, Munda, Oraon, Santal, etc., but are in marked defect among certain tribes and race castes of East and North Bengal, *e.g.*, Chakma (891), Tipara (966), Koch (934), etc., which have a strong Mongoloid element. On the other hand, certain other Mongoloid races have, as already shown, an excess of females.

SEX PROPORTION BY AGE.

616. The inaccuracy of the age statistics, especially for females, is so great, that it is difficult for a conscientious statistician to place much reliance on the proportion of females to males at each age period, and it is therefore not proposed to discuss the figures in details. The following more salient and general features may, however, be noticed. As shown in Subsidiary Table III and illustrated graphically in the marginal diagram, there is a deficiency of females in each natural division of Bengal at the age period 10—15. It changes into an excess at the next age periods 15—20 and 20—25, after which the deficiency re-appears and goes on increasing till it reaches the maximum at the age period 35—40. After this, the proportion of females to males increases, with the usual sharp rises at ages which are multiples of 10.



The marked deficiency of females at the age period 10—15 seems due to —(*i*) a higher mortality at the time of puberty, when there is a general functional derangement, the effects of which are often intensified by premature cohabitation and parturition; and (*ii*) the understatement of their age, if still unmarried, and to the exaggeration of it, if they are married and especially if they have become mothers. It might be suggested that the deficiency is due to the fact that many females at this age period are omitted from the returns owing to the reluctance of their parents or guardians to give information about their women-folk. If this theory were tenable, we should also find a deficiency of females at the next age period 15—20, and also to a certain extent at 20—25, whereas there is actually an excess of females at those age periods. This hypothesis cannot therefore be accepted. It is more probable that the relative paucity of girls aged 10—15 is simply due to a large proportion being returned as older than they really are. The marked fall at the age period 35—40 may be attributed partly to the higher mortality of females at the previous age periods consequent on child-bearing in insanitary surroundings and with unskilful midwifery, and partly to the under-statement of their ages by women who are still capable of bearing children. The alternate rises and falls in the proportion of females at the subsequent



age periods illustrate the special predilection of women for multiples of 10 in stating their age, while the steady increase in their relative number is due in part to their greater longevity, to which reference has been made in the last chapter.

The figures and graphs showing the proportions of females to males in Bihar and Orissa have a general resemblance to those for Bengal. But, owing to the general excess of females throughout the new province, the graphs for its natural divisions are mostly above the line of equality, whereas the general preponderance of males in the Presidency causes the graphs for Bengal to be below that line at most of the age periods.

VARIATIONS IN SEX PROPORTION.

617. Since 1881 the proportion of females to males in the actual population has steadily declined throughout Bengal. This is due partly to the increasing number of immigrants from other provinces, who are mostly males, and partly to the actual decrease in the relative number of females. That there has been such a decrease is apparent from the returns of natural population, the proportion of females in which has also been decreasing during the last thirty years in all the districts of Bengal except Dinajpur, Jalpaiguri, Bogra, Cooch Behar, Backergunge, Noakhali and Hill Tippera. In respect of the actual population, only six out of thirty districts and States, viz., Bogra, Khulna, Tippera, Noakhali, the Chittagong Hill Tracts and Hill Tippera, show an increase in the relative strength of the female population. The decline is further apparent in the returns for individual Hindu castes, but not among the aboriginal castes. It is natural that in these circumstances the price of brides should go up, but it is not so easy to understand why, when males are becoming proportionately more numerous, the price of bridegrooms should be rising among so many castes.

CASTES OF BENGAL.	NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES.	
	1911.	1901.
HINDU.		
Baidya	1,007	1,012
Barui	964	1,014
Bhuinmali ...	943	979
Brahman ...	953	987
Chamar and Muchi	1,006	1,024
Dhoba	1,003	1,011
Dom	1,004	1,019
Gandhabanik ...	1,001	1,007
Goala	971	979
Hajjam and Napit	994	1,005
Jogi	976	991
Kamar and Lohar	997	1,009
Kayasth ...	952	1,003
Kumhar... ...	980	1,009
Mayra	906	894
Namasudra ...	974	989
Pod	957	981
Rajbansi ...	930	936
Sadgop	975	1,004
Subarnabanik ...	965	969
Sutradhar ...	937	952
Tanti	1,032	1,000
Teli and Tili ...	1,008	1,024
HINDU AND ANIMIST.		
Garo	982	981
Munda	1,022	1,005
Oraon	1,023	1,003
Santal	1,019	1,008
Tippera	964	931

Bihar and Orissa, on the other hand, most of the districts of North Bihar, Orissa and Chota Nagpur show a steady increase in the proportion of females during the last three decades, for which the increasing number of male emigrants seems to be largely responsible. For, in the natural population, the proportion of females, which grew from 1881 to 1901, has fallen during the last decade, when emigration was greatly quickened. The districts of South Bihar, however, show a decline in the relative number of women since 1881, which may be attributed in part to plague, to which, as already stated, females succumb more than males. The decline in the proportion of females is also noticeable in the figures for each age period given in Subsidiary Table II, and to a greater or less extent in the number speaking the native language of each locality, viz., Bengali

PROPORTION OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES SPEAKING THE LANGUAGE OF THE LOCALITY.		
	1901.	1911.
West Bengal ...	1,038	1,016
Central ,, ...	974	958
North ,, ...	960	957
East ,, ...	985	980
North Bihar ...	1,064	1,064
South ,, ...	1,032	1,035
Orissa	1,056	1,043

throughout Bengal, Hindi in Bihar and Oriya in Orissa, as shown in the marginal statement. The Chota Nagpur Plateau is omitted from this statement, as there is no language common to its congeries of tribes and castes. It may be added that the vital statistics in Subsidiary Table V-A show that the natural growth of females relatively to males has declined in the ratio of 158 to 132 in Bengal and of 158 to 105 in Bihar and Orissa.

THEORY OF INCOMPLETE ENUMERATION.

618. We may now turn to a discussion of the hypothesis advanced by German critics, that the deficiency of females in the population is due to the omission of females from the census record. This theory rests on the following grounds, which will be briefly discussed :—

(1) It affords a ready explanation of the disproportion of sexes which is suspected to be unreal.

If the deficiency itself be taken as a proof of omission, then the enumeration of females must be incomplete everywhere in the world, except in Europe (excluding the countries to the south-east). If, moreover, we refer to the figures for small local areas, we find that in both provinces there are numerous contiguous thanas (with a population of 60,000 to 300,000) one of which shows a deficiency of females, while the other shows an excess, though there is no reason why females should be omitted from the record in one of them rather than in the other.*

(2) The omission of females is *a priori* probable, in view of the zenana system, which is largely in vogue in this country, and the strictness with which females are kept in privacy.

On this ground, omissions would be most likely to occur amongst the Muhammadans, but, as already shown, they have nearly always a higher proportion of females than the Hindus. Further, the low Hindus castes, whose women do not observe the *pardah* system and move about freely, also have a paucity of females.

(3) Each successive enumeration is likely to be more complete than the previous one, and each shows a rise in the proportion of females.

This argument does not hold good in the case of either Bengal or Bihar and Orissa, where, as already shown, the proportion of females is falling. It may be added that the decrease in the proportion of females in the actual population during the last decade is noticeable almost throughout India.

(4) The paucity of females is greatest at the age period 10—15, when omissions would be most likely to occur.

The statistics however show an excess of females at the next age period 15—20, which the theory of incomplete enumeration does not account for. It is possible of course that Hindu parents may wilfully omit to have marriageable daughters aged 10—15 entered in the returns, but it is more likely that their ages are misstated.

(5) The last argument that might be advanced in favour of the theory that the relative paucity of females is due to incomplete enumeration is that the vital statistics, as well as the conclusions drawn by Mr. Hardy from the age returns of the last census, show that the mortality of females is lower than that of males. As regards this argument, the marginal statement sufficiently shows that the proportion of females as ascertained at the census is generally higher than at birth. The fact is that more males are born, but their higher mortality reduces their proportionate strength and raises that of females in Bengal. This feature is common to Bengal, which gains, and to Bihar and Orissa, which loses, by the migration of males, and cannot, therefore, be connected with the

	Number of females per 1,000 males.	
	At birth.	At census.
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	**947**	**988**
Bengal	**941**	**945**
West Bengal	940	987
Central ,, ...	934	876
North ,, ...	950	925
East ,, ...	938	969
Bihar and Orissa	**955**	**1,043**
North Bihar	952	1,058
South ,, ...	954	1,034
Orissa	951	1,061
Chota Nagpur Plateau	962	1,019

* The exigencies of space prohibit the publication of the figures for these thanas. The statement can easily be verified by a reference to Provincial Table I.

movements of the people. In Bihar and Orissa, however, there is an excess of females in the actual population as in Europe, whereas in Bengal they are in defect, the effect of their lower mortality not being sufficient to bring their numbers up to, much less above, that of the males.

EFFECTS OF PLAGUE.

619. In some districts of Bihar the ravages of plague are reducing the proportion of females considerably. Its effect may be realized from the marginal table, in which figures are given for Patna, Shahabad and Saran, which have suffered more than any other districts during the last decade, the total plague mortality representing a death-rate on 2·3 and 8 per cent. respectively on the population of 1901. In order to discount the effects of migration, figures are given for natural as well as for actual population. Migration should help to increase the proportion of women in the actual population because it has grown greatly in volume and the majority of the emigrants are males. Not only is the reverse the case, but the decline in the number of males is even greater in the natural population than in the actual population. Plague must be held largely, though not entirely, responsible for the change which has taken place in the sex proportion. Women are far more exposed to its attacks than men, owing to their living much more inside the house, and to their going about with bare feet, which are liable to be bitten by the plague-rat flea. Moreover when plague breaks out, though the villagers leave their homes and encamp out in temporary huts, women will persist in returning either for the worship of the household god or to obtain food from the household store. The incidence of mortality among them is, in fact, more than half as great as among males, the plague death-rate for females in Bihar and Orissa during the five years 1905-10 being 11·7 per mille, while it was only 7·5 per mille among males.

DISTRICT.	NUMBER OF FEMALES TO 1,000 MALES.			
	Actual population.		Natural population.	
	1901.	1911.	1901.	1911.
Patna	1,020	988	991	951
Shahabad ...	1,096	1,062	1,054	1,010
Saran	1,200	1,151	1,074	1,012

COMPARISON WITH OTHER COUNTRIES.

620. A question which naturally arises is why the lower mortality of females in Bengal does not turn the balance of the sex proportion in their favour, as it does in European countries and also in Bihar and Orissa. In Bengal, however, the number of females brought into the world is, relatively to males, fewer than in Europe or Bihar and Orissa, so that, *ceteris paribus*, the proportion of females must naturally be lower. Further the conditions of female life in Bengal are far less favourable to their chances of survival than in Europe. The principal factors in question are briefly as follows :—

COUNTRY.	NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000* MALES.		
	At census.	Births.	Deaths.
Europe (average) ...	***1,038***	***948***	***946***
England	1,068	964	936
Scotland	1,057	955	997
Germany	1,032	948	922
France	1,032	961	930
Ireland	1,027	944	1,016
Bengal	***945***	***941***	***895***
Bihar and Orissa ...	***1,043***	***955***	***940***

* The figures for European countries are for 1900.

(1) The first, and not the least important, is the neglect of females from an early age. As is well known male children are ardently desired, and the birth of a girl is generally unwelcome. This is especially the case among castes where the father has to pay heavily for a bridegroom and has already had several girls. As a natural consequence, girls receive less attention than boys, and, though constitutionally stronger, their natural advantage in this respect is minimized.

(2) The second factor is early marriage and premature sexual intercourse and child-bearing. In Bengal girls are generally married at a tender age and are usually allowed to cohabit with their husbands as soon as they attain puberty: they often menstruate in the 12th year, and conceive in the thirteenth. In fact, wives aged 15 or 16 are either mothers of children (living or dead), or are suspected of being barren. Early coition and premature maternity very often do irreparable injury to the young wife's constitution, and naturally raise their death-rate at this period of life.

(3) To some extent, also, infantile mortality is indirectly the cause of mortality among mothers. An abnormally large proportion of infants die

either within the first month or first year of life. Their deaths, by shortening the period of suckling, diminish the interval of child-bearing and thus help to keep up a high birth-rate, while conceptions following in quick succession naturally tell upon the health of the mothers.

(4) The conditions attending child-birth further increase the dangers of a woman's life. The account given in the next chapter may so far be anticipated by saying that the methods of midwifery are crude and the surroundings of the young mother generally insanitary.

(5) Lastly, reference may be made to the practice of abortion by females who stray from the path of virtue—generally, young widows who have succumbed to the temptations of the seducer. The dangers of this practice in undermining the health or even causing premature death are too well known to require mention.

621. On all these accounts, it might reasonably be expected that, relatively to males, more females should die in Bengal than in Europe. The proportion (895) of female deaths to male deaths, however, does not, at first sight, show that this is the case, for it is lower than the average for Europe (946). The explanation of this apparent anomaly appears to be as follows: Both male and female births depend on the same cause, viz., the number of married females of reproductive age, whereas male and female deaths depend on two distinctly different things, namely, the numerical strength of the male and female population. Hence, in drawing any inferences from their mutual proportion, we must take into account the relative strength of the male and female members of the community. In Europe females outnumber males, while in Bengal they form a minority. It is only natural, therefore, that the proportion of female deaths to male deaths should be higher in Europe than in Bengal. If we examine the actual death-rates, we find that the percentage of the female death-rate to the male death-rate is higher in Bengal than in Europe. We thus see that, relatively to males, fewer females are born, but more die, in Bengal than in Europe. In addition to this, if we bear in mind the fact that it is probably the deaths of neglected females, pregnant widows, etc., that form the majority of the unreported deaths, we have a full explanation of the deficiency of females in Bengal without presuming their omission from the census record. It is also clear why the province of Bihar and Orissa, like Europe and unlike Bengal, has an excess of females, for, relatively to males, more females are born, but less die, in Bihar and Orissa than in Bengal or even in Europe.

Country.	Death rate.*		Percentage of female death-rate to male death-rate.
	Male.	Female.	
Europe (average) ...	***21·1***	***19·1***	***90·5***
England	18·2	15·8	86·8
Germany	22·1	19·6	88·7
France	21·6	19·3	89·4
Bengal	***34***	***31***	***91·2***
Bihar and Orissa ...	***37***	***33***	***89·2***

Country.	Number of females per 1,000 males at—		Percentage of female death-rate to male death-rate.
	Census.	Birth.	
Europe (average) ...	***1,038***	***943***	***90·5***
Bengal	945	941	91·2
Bihar and Orissa ...	1,043	956	89·2

622. Since the time of Aristotle, various conflicting theories have been put forward regarding the causation of sex, but no statisfactory conclusion has yet been arrived at. An account of such theories is given in Westermarck's *History of Human Marriage* and in Geddes and Thomson's *Evolution of Sex*, as also in some of the previous Census Reports. The limits of space forbid a discussion of these theories with reference to the sex statistics of Bengal and Bihar and Orissa, but the following may be very briefly noticed :—

CAUSES INFLUENCING SEX.

(1) The offspring has a tendency to be of the same sex as the elder parent, and the tendency varies with the difference in the relative ages of

* The figures for European countries are taken from an article, "The Recent Growth of Population in Western Europe" by Sir J. A. Baines, KT., C.S.I., published in the *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society*, December 1909.

the parents. This theory is consonant with the fact that in Bengal, where husbands are, with very few exceptions, considerably older than their wives, the proportion of male births is greater than in Bihar and Chota Nagpur, where they are more equal in age.

(2) An intense desire of the parents may have some effect on the sex of the child. In India the universal desire of parents is to have male children, and various expedients, *e.g.*, charms and amulets given by *sadhus*, *fakirs*, etc., offerings to gods and goddesses, etc., are resorted to in order to obtain its fulfilment. Among the Hindus there are special religious ceremonies like *Punsavan* (male-making), a brief account of which is given in the next chapter. Needless to say, universal as is the desire for male children, the proportion of male births varies greatly in different parts of the country.

(3) In mountainous countries more boys are born than girls.* This theory receives some confirmation from the figures for Darjeeling and the Chittagong Hill Tracts, where females are in a minority, but not from the sex statistics of Chota Nagpur, where females are in marked excess. In the plains of Bengal, moreover, females are in defect.

(4) Differences in sex proportions are due to race rather than locality or climate.† The Dravidian races to which the people of Chota Nagpur belong have an excess of females, while the Mongoloid tribes of East and North Bengal have a paucity of women. In fact, the proportion of females to males is, as shown in the margin, generally lowest in the tracts where the Mongoloid element in the population is strongest.

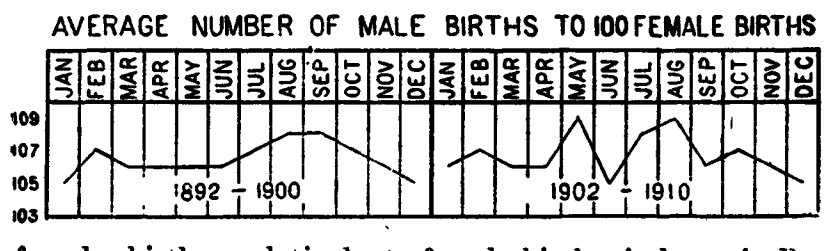
Tracts.	Actual population.	Natural population.
Bengal	**945**	**970**
Jalpaiguri	841	900
Chittagong Hill Tracts	860	900
Cooch Behar	873	917
Dinajpur	897	938

(5) Consanguineous marriages produce a considerable excess of male births. This theory is not consistent with the fact that the Muhammadans, who allow cousins to marry, have a lower proportion of males than the Hindus, who do not.

A short account of the popular ideas regarding the causation of sex, together with a description of the ceremonies performed in order (*a*) to make a woman conceive and (*b*) to secure male offspring, is given in the next chapter.

623. Before bringing this chapter to a close, one interesting fact may be briefly noticed, viz., that the proportion of the sexes at birth is not uniform throughout the year. Statistics of average monthly births by sex from 1902 to 1909 have been compiled for Bengal and are illustrated in the marginal diagram, in which the corresponding figures for 1892—1900‡ are also exhibited. It will be seen from this diagram that in Bengal the number of male births, relatively to female births, is least in December and January and greatest in August. Except for this, no general correlation is traceable between the season of gestation and the sex of the child.

SEASON OF GESTATION AND SEX AT BIRTH.



* Westermarck's *Human Marriage*.
† Bengal Census Report for 1891.
‡ Appendix IV, p. XXII, Bengal Census Report of 1901.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—General Proportions of the Sexes by Natural Divisions and Districts.

District and Natural Division.	Number of Females to 1,000 Males.								
	1911.		1901.		1891.		1881.		1872.
	Actual population.	Natural population.	Actual population.	Natural population.	Actual population.	Natural population.	Actual population.	Natural population.	Actual population.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**988**	**991**	**999**	**1,005**	**1,004**	**1,012**	**1,008**	**1,016**	**1,006**
Bengal	**945**	**970**	**960**	**982**	**973**	**995**	**994**	**1,013**	**992**
WEST BENGAL	**987**	**994**	**1,001**	**1,015**	**1,023**	**1,019**	**1,050**	**1,045**	**1,041**
Burdwan	997	1,018	1,004	1,028	1,038	1,026	1.083	1,081	1.044
Birbhum	1.017	1,018	1,029	1,028	1,048	1,049	1.082	1.094	1,090
Bankura	1,024	965	1,032	1,012	1,034	1,011	1,054	1,030	1,016
Midnapore	1,000	996	1,006	1,003	1.012	1.011	1.023	1,018	1,021
Hooghly	961	965	986	998	1,031	1,004	1.071	1,041	1.069
Howrah	892	1,000	935	1,030	984	1.044	1,011	1,056	1,038
CENTRAL BENGAL	**876**	**972**	**911**	**982**	**944**	**1,010**	**971**	**1,037**	**972**
24-Parganas	864	970	902	970	913	958	942	...	969
Calcutta	475	669	507	828	526	9[illegible]	556	1,018	552
Nadia	991	978	1.015	994	1.030	1.021	1,054	...	1,058
Murshidabad	1,023	1,031	1,041	1,044	1,065	1,085	1,092	1,098	1.093
Jessore	951	945	984	970	1.007	981	1,022	...	1,027
NORTH BENGAL	**925**	**965**	**938**	**969**	**955**	**985**	**973**	**995**	**973**
Rajshahi	961	983	972	990	1.001	1.031	1,026	1.043	1,014
Dinajpur	897	933	902	932	915	936	933	934	931
Jalpaiguri	841	900	862	894	868	933	904	934	930
Darjeeling	869	964	873	1,011	815	923	742	815	786
Rangpur	901	954	915	959	945	970	965	988	964
Bogra	957	980	954	967	952	999	961	1.003	981
Pabna	974	988	1,002	1,008	1,010	1,015	1,023	1,023	1,011
Malda	1,014	1,036	1,020	1,054	1,038	1,075	1,047	1,090	1,043
Cooch Behar	873	917	881	911	914	930	933	947	912
EAST BENGAL	**969**	**965**	**976**	**974**	**975**	**983**	**990**	**999**	**988**
Khulna	926	935	918	945	906	940	900	...	867
Dacca	1,003	979	1,019	994	1,017	1,003	1,048	1,018	1,047
Mymensingh	935	954	943	962	941	965	965	979	978
Faridpur	974	968	997	984	1,012	384	1.024	993	1,038
Backergunge	951	967	949	976	950	972	952	975	965
Tippera	935	951	950	961	955	968	970	976	959
Noakhali	1,016	935	1,007	979	945	965	977	967	973
Chittagong	1 047	994	1,110	1,011	1,095	1,011	1,130	1,124	1,103
Chittagong Hill Tracts ...	860	900	828	901	801	896	796	...	703
Hill Tippera	885	1,031	874	913	920	988	859	...	931
Bihar and Orissa ...	**1,043**	**1,014**	**1,047**	**1,027**	**1,040**	**1,032**	**1,024**	**1,018**	**1,009**
NORTH BIHAR	**1,058**	**1,019**	**1,064**	**1,038**	**1,049**	**1,030**	**1,026**	**1,015**	**999**
Saran	1,151	1,012	1,200	1,074	1,176	1,077	1,105	1,022	1,070
Champaran	1,026	1,002	1,022	1,030	986	1,023	977	999	954
Muzaffarpur	1,092	1,046	1,089	1,055	1,077	1,025	1,040	1,023	1,028
Darbhanga	1,074	1,029	1,056	1,035	1,044	1,034	1,032	1,029	972
Bhagalpur	1,022	1,016	1,033	1,033	1,023	1,021	1,008	1,013	991
Purnea	957	990	956	983	958	978	973	987	957
SOUTH BIHAR	**1,034**	**991**	**1,050**	**1,020**	**1,059**	**1,041**	**1,045**	**1,027**	**1,043**
Patna	988	951	1,020	991	1,043	1,015	1,045	1,029	1,047
Gaya	1,035	992	1,037	1,009	1,046	1,026	1,036	1,026	1,043
Shahabad	1,062	1,010	1,096	1,034	1,082	1,126	1,068	1,023	1,064
Monghyr	1,044	1,005	1,045	1,024	1,063	1,023	1,032	1,028	1,021
ORISSA	**1,081**	**1,028**	**1,055**	**1,020**	**1,044**	**1,031**	**1,032**	**1,018**	**1,031**
Cuttack	1,107	1,027	1,072	1,015	1,060	1,034	1,045	1,014	1,056
Balasore	1,092	1,045	1,070	1,050	1,065	1,054	1,048	1,042	1,032
Puri	1,020	1,011	1,007	996	991	990	989	1,001	976
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.	**1,019**	**1,018**	**1,022**	**1,020**	**1,012**	**1,025**	**999**	**1,012**	**981**
Hazaribagh	1,048	1,031	1,066	1,028	1,053	1,003	1,027	1,026	944
Ranchi	1,050	1,024	1,058	1,036	1,045	1,049	1,022	1,018	994
Palamau	1,012	1,016	1,028	1,036	1,028	1,055	1,016		984
Manbhum	963	1,010	992	1,020	1.012	1,012	1,014	1,020	985
Singhbhum	1,035	1,024	1,029	1,033	1,010	1,008	1,002	996	998
Sonthal Parganas	1,017	1,003	1,019	1,006	1,015	1,010	997	995	1,000
Angul	1,028	1,028	1,000	990	983	...	965	...	970
Sambalpur	1,036	1,015	1,036	1,043	1,005	...	1,003	...	984
Orissa Feudatory States ...	1,011	1,022	1,008	1,009	944	...	967	...	972
Chota Nagpur States ...	1.049	1,045	1,027	1,032	1.007	...	993	...	990
SIKKIM	**951**	**1,033**	**916**	**956**	**935**	...	...	...	...

NOTE.—The expression "actual population" means the population actually present at the time of the census, irrespective of birth-place. "Natural population" means the population born in the district, etc., irrespective of the place of enumeration.
The natural population of 1872 cannot be ascertained.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.

PART I.—NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES AT DIFFERENT AGE-PERIODS BY RELIGIONS AT EACH OF THE LAST THREE CENSUSES.

AGE.	ALL RELIGIONS.			HINDU.			MUSALMAN.			ANIMIST.		
	1891.	1901.	1911.	1891.	1901.	1911.	1891.	1901.	1911.	1891.	1901.	1911.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.												
0—1	1,058	1,020	1,020	1,054	1,024	1,023	1,065	1,011	459	1,051	1,039	1,025
1—2	1,076	1,092	1,065	1,075	1,096	1,067	1,082	1,090	1,064	1,067	1,081	1,064
2—3	1,109	1,101	1,086	1,122	1,104	1,083	1,090	1,097	1,092	1,109	1,111	1,085
3—4	1,121	1,115	1,112	1,134	1,118	1,118	1,098	1,106	1,106	1,133	1,153	1,117
4—5	1,041	1,042	1,032	1,044	1,043	1,032	1,033	1,037	1,033	1,072	1,070	1,052
Total 0—5	***1,082***	***1,073***	***1,063***	***1,087***	***1,076***	***1,063***	***1,073***	***1,066***	***1,062***	***1,091***	***1,097***	***1,070***
5—10	952	978	974	961	982	976	937	970	969	953	984	989
10—15	803	813	813	813	820	819	776	791	790	857	875	893
15—20	1,029	1,045	1,048	985	1,005	1,001	1,115	1,126	1,133	1,074	1,071	1,090
20—25	1,184	1,173	1,176	1,126	1,121	1,130	1,311	1,231	1,263	1,233	1,272	1,283
25—30	1,070	1,006	1,014	1,059	996	1,008	1 088	1,022	1,014	1,122	1,068	1,082
Total 0—30	***1,002***	***1,001***	***1,001***	***994***	***992***	***991***	***1,015***	***1,014***	***1,014***	***1,021***	***1,033***	***1,041***
30—40	958	935	902	984	962	939	895	872	846	1,045	1,019	960
40—50	939	940	917	963	969	950	884	874	848	941	974	920
50—60	1,035	1,023	1,016	1,053	1,051	1,054	995	966	938	1,003	981	998
60 and over...	1,305	1,263	1,213	1,376	1,344	1,305	1,165	1,102	1,029	1,198	1,226	1,191
Total 30 and over ...	***1,011***	***994***	***964***	***1,042***	***1,030***	***1,003***	***944***	***918***	***884***	***1,030***	***1,027***	***984***
Total all ages (actual population)	***1,004***	***999***	***988***	***1,011***	***1,005***	***995***	***992***	***983***	***973***	***1,023***	***1,031***	***1,024***
Total all ages (natural population)	***1,012***	***1,005***	***991***	Not available.			Not available.			Not available.		

PART II.—NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES AT DIFFERENT AGE-PERIODS BY RELIGIONS (CENSUS OF 1911).

AGE.	ALL RELIGIONS.		HINDU.		MUSALMAN.		ANIMIST.	
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
0— 1	1,017	1,022	1,025	1,021	1,012	1,030	1,002	1,030
1— 2	1,075	1,051	1,086	1,054	1,069	1,024	1,089	1,057
2— 3	1,083	1,090	1,074	1,088	1,091	1,107	1,077	1,088
3— 4	1,098	1,298	1,101	1,128	1,097	1,166	1,117	1,117
4— 5	1,023	1,044	1,014	1,042	1,028	1,058	1,061	1,050
Total 0— 5	***1,058***	***1,069***	***1,057***	***1,067***	***1,059***	***1,083***	***1,070***	***1,070***
5—10	969	981	968	981	968	972	988	990
10—15	783	848	776	846	785	822	870	898
15—20	1,102	972	1,049	963	1,153	979	1,204	1,063
20—25	1,141	1,223	1,034	1,207	1,251	1,331	1,347	1,266
25—30	949	1,121	900	1,091	994	1,229	1,064	1,086
Total 0—30	***989***	***1,016***	***961***	***1,011***	***1,011***	***1,038***	***1,056***	***1,037***
30—40	800	1,030	793	1,024	807	1,112	827	1,003
40—50	818	1,041	827	1,041	812	1,074	692	997
50—60	937	1,110	976	1,108	903	1,151	754	1,071
60 and over	1,054	1,407	1,144	1,421	967	1,381	942	1,272
Total 30 and over	***859***	***1,095***	***877***	***1094***	***844***	***1,147***	***792***	***1,046***
Total all ages (actual population) ...	***945***	***1,043***	***931***	***1,040***	***958***	***1,074***	***967***	***1,040***
Total all ages (natural population)...	***971***	***1,013***	Not available.					

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—Number of Females per 1,000 Males at different age-periods by Religions and Natural Divisions (Census of 1911).

BENGAL.

Age.	West Bengal.			Central Bengal.			North Bengal.			East Bengal.		
	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
0—1	1,036	1,035	1,047	1,021	1,031	1,013	1,004	1,005	1,005	1,015	1,025	1,012
1—2	1,061	1,059	1,060	1,066	1,078	1,059	1,097	1,129	1,062	1,072	1,088	1,066
2—3	1,058	1,056	1,070	1,068	1,072	1,063	1,107	1,087	1,119	1,084	1,085	1,085
3—4	1,097	1,093	1,113	1,083	1,092	1,074	1,120	1,123	1,121	1,091	1,098	1,091
4—5	999	993	1,010	983	983	981	1,039	1,042	1,037	1,035	1,035	1,036
Total 0—5	*1,049*	*1,046*	*1,060*	*1,041*	*1,048*	*1,036*	*1,071*	*1,071*	*1,073*	*1,059*	*1,064*	*1,059*
5—10	957	958	946	922	936	909	951	964	943	999	1,002	999
10—15	795	797	780	733	733	739	766	764	760	805	788	810
15—20	1,098	1,088	1,145	968	935	1,005	1,116	1,011	1,184	1,161	1,110	1,187
20—25	1,116	1,096	1,198	926	836	1,054	1,192	1,086	1,306	1,248	1,130	1,300
25—30	990	988	987	810	743	900	956	872	1,015	998	953	1,018
Total 0—30	*990*	*986*	*1,000*	*900*	*872*	*931*	*993*	*953*	*1,016*	*1,023*	*1,000*	*1,033*
30—40	884	885	880	732	694	780	758	719	786	824	825	822
40—50	925	927	958	793	777	817	735	617	773	828	846	817
50—60	1,086	1,092	1,087	971	970	982	865	822	912	885	943	852
60 and over	1,284	1,304	1,188	1,130	1,164	1,094	985	968	1,011	951	1,073	884
Total 30 and over ...	*981*	*986*	*977*	*834*	*817*	*857*	*794*	*733*	*827*	*852*	*886*	*834*
Total all ages (actual population).	*987*	*986*	*992*	*876*	*852*	*906*	*925*	*881*	*955*	*969*	*960*	*973*
Total all ages (natural population).	*994*	Not available		*972*	Not available		*965*	Not available		*965*	Not available.	

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

Age.	North Bihar.			South Bihar.			Orissa.			Chota Na pur Plateau.				
	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.	All religions.	Hindu.	Muslman.	Christian.	Animist.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
0—1	1,016	1,018	1,027	1,024	1,022	1,046	1,010	1,010	984	1,032	1,034	1,033	997	1,029
1—2	1,069	1,072	1,036	1,062	1,069	1,001	1,043	1,047	950	1,037	1,036	965	1,023	1,055
2—3	1,099	1,093	1,122	1,112	1,115	1,087	1,048	1,048	1,064	1,081	1,081	1,078	1,093	1,082
3—4	1,140	1,130	1,186	1,139	1,138	1,147	1,135	1,136	1,115	1,114	1,116	1,121	1,052	1,114
4—5	1,063	1,061	1,071	1,024	1,026	1,002	1,016	1,016	1,012	1,044	1,041	1,084	1,016	1,047
Total 0—5 ...	*1,077*	*1,073*	*1,097*	*1,072*	*1,073*	*1,063*	*1,049*	*1,049*	*1,034*	*1,064*	*1,064*	*1,065*	*1,035*	*1,067*
5—10	979	979	974	963	961	980	995	996	940	990	991	959	1,022	911
10—15	835	830	799	824	816	907	922	924	863	861	852	803	865	899
15—20	930	922	936	940	924	1,129	1,053	1,049	1,190	1,007	992	957	1,008	1,064
20—25	1,266	1,252	1,343	1,202	1,175	1,534	1,151	1,146	1,360	1,219	1,209	1,169	1,247	1,265
25—30	1,148	1,133	1,232	1,094	1,069	1,416	1,146	1,143	1,256	1,045	1,036	1,013	1,056	1,085
Total 0—30 ...	*1,017*	*1,014*	*1,030*	*1,003*	*992*	*1,109*	*1,038*	*1,037*	*1,055*	*1,015*	*1,010*	*982*	*1,016*	*1,026*
30—40	1,080	1,076	1,107	1,046	1,025	1,317	1,064	1,064	1,119	949	938	898	976	1,006
40—50	1,064	1,067	1,036	1,010	992	1,211	1,161	1,160	1,241	993	994	928	1,007	1,004
50—60	1,127	1,127	1,132	1,078	1,061	1,254	1,473	1,170	1,327	1,085	1,092	1,034	1,043	1,076
60 and over ...	1,438	1,451	1,381	1,389	1,381	1,461	1,479	1,476	1,617	1,346	1,379	1,176	1,275	1,280
Total 30 and over	*1,132*	*1,133*	*1,135*	*1,038*	*1,069*	*1,301*	*1,164*	*1,163*	*1,257*	*1,029*	*1,027*	*962*	*1,031*	*1,051*
Total all ages (actual population).	*1,058*	*1,057*	*1,066*	*1,034*	*1,020*	*1,177*	*1,081*	*1,080*	*1,118*	*1,019*	*1,016*	*975*	*1,020*	*1,041*
Total all ages (natural population).	*1,018*	Not available.		*990*	Not available.		*1,027*	Not available.		*1,017*	Not available.			

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Number of Females per 1,000 Males for certain selected Castes.

Caste.	Locality.	Number of Females per 1,000 Males.						
		All ages.	0—5	5—12	12—15	15—20	20—40	40 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
AGARWALA (Hindu)	Bengal	569	813	738	627	663	486	552
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,029	882	926	654	1,047	1,255	1,014
AJLAF (Musalman)	Bengal	906	1,084	849	743	1,208	884	813
ANGLO-INDIAN (Christian) ...	Bengal	996	1,072	944	833	866	1,020	1,093
	Bihar and Orissa ...	928	1,136	809	783	1,224	856	903
BABHAN (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	967	1,105	891	659	785	976	1,151
BAGDI (Hindu)	Bengal	1,010	1,053	920	846	1,103	1,023	1,053
BAIDYA (Hindu)	Bengal	983	1,037	1,000	726	935	969	1,075
BAISNAB (Hindu)	Bengal	1,205	1,076	945	876	1,175	1,271	1,443
BANIYA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	995	1,081	900	769	929	1,009	1,120
BARAI (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,047	975	985	886	902	1,093	1,209
BARHI (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,084	1,074	965	892	1,007	1,194	1,160
BARUI (Hindu)	Bengal	950	1,041	927	797	1,120	946	891
BAURI (Hindu)	Bengal	1,035	1,116	919	703	1,045	1,096	1,212
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,019	1,092	934	990	1,169	1,041	956
BHOTIA (Buddhist)	Bengal	1,064	1,108	1,116	1,051	1,573	992	976
BHUIYA (Hindu)	Bengal	924	1,146	967	892	1,101	874	782
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,071	1,121	933	1,016	1,246	1,100	1,093
BHUINMALI (Hindu)	Bengal	967	1,069	946	795	1,220	944	913
BHUMIJ (Hindu)	Bengal	1,078	1,356	952	942	1,091	1,047	1,128
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,062	1,314	977	937	874	990	1,316
BHUMIJ (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa ...	986	1,057	903	627	962	1,036	1,037
BRAHMAN (Hindu)	Bengal	878	1,020	941	788	966	769	914
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,000	1,050	930	787	881	1,005	114
BRAHMO (Brahmo)	Bengal	975	910	122	1,740	128	842	699
CHAKMA (Hindu)	Bengal	891	945	952	866	968	970	647
CHAMAR (Hindu)	Bengal	544	886	739	499	633	457	460
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,153	1,124	985	892	1,080	1,309	1,270
CHASA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1 042	1,071	1,016	860	945	1,060	1,145
CHINESE (Confucian)	Bengal	157	1,200	1.706	...	176	109	100
CHINESE (Buddhist)	Bengal	198	808	645	438	245	134	249
DHANUK (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,095	1,067	942	898	1,041	1,188	1,213
DHOBA (Hindu)	Bengal	932	1,056	953	739	1,055	902	899
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,063	1,048	961	923	1,030	1,126	1,150
DHUNIA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,141	1,100	975	874	1,086	1,292	1,269
DOM (Hindu)	Bengal	967	1,041	922	924	1,133	922	969
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,002	1,027	981	842	1,015	1,005	1,077
DOSADH (Hindu)	Bengal	360	615	526	422	332	287	391
EURO EANS AND ALLIED RACES (Christian).	Bengal	519	909	836	756	720	389	561
	Bihar and Orissa ...	607	884	953	1,153	943	469	582
GANDHABANIK (Hindu) ...	Bengal	938	1,124	979	876	1,223	883	870
GARO (Hindu)	Bengal	976	878	1,050	1.071	1,949	1,042	641

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Number of Females per 1,000 Males for certain selected Castes—*continued.*

Caste.	Locality.	Number of Females per 1,000 Males.						
		All ages.	0—5	5—12	12—15	5—20	20—40	40 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
GARO (Animist)	Bengal	960	1,056	929	920	1,301	1,065	618
GAURA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,099	1,033	977	875	1,010	1,153	1,321
GOALA (Ahir) (Hindu)	Bengal	819	1,022	893	795	912	695	848
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,003	1,058	921	866	932	1,037	1,078
GOND (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,014	1,062	966	695	926	1,058	1,150
GURUNG (Hindu)	Bengal	986	1,036	951	925	1,073	926	1,076
HAJJAM (Napit) (Hindu) ...	Bengal	948	1,050	945	808	1,059	901	959
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,071	1,048	937	868	950	1,178	1,205
HAJJAM (Mussalman)	Bengal	961	845	828	874	1,500	913	964
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,111	1,052	982	876	1,063	1,284	1,138
HARI (Hindu)	Bengal	982	1,105	909	815	1,203	977	944
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,032	1,188	1,012	797	1,093	1,079	927
INDIAN CHRISTIAN	Bengal	935	1,022	1,029	667	1,092	915	880
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,028	1,033	948	968	1,018	1,078	1,093
JOGI (Hindu)	Bengal	977	1,053	965	766	1,122	935	987
JOLAHA (Mussalman)	Bengal	863	1,002	852	760	1,010	805	856
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,123	1,054	962	888	1,015	1,323	1,233
KAHAR (Hindu)	Bengal	243	697	420	391	216	181	249
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,149	1,064	925	824	1,042	1,276	1,412
KAIBARTTA (Unspecified) (Hindu)	Bengal	955	828	1,346	778	1,113	791	1,025
KAIBARTTA CHASI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	1,001	1,051	968	816	1,138	980	1,032
KAIBARTTA JALIA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	959	1,094	940	810	1,215	917	903
KALWAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,046	1,070	900	818	904	1,110	1,217
KAMAR (Hindu)	Bengal	948	1,076	947	831	1,089	868	945
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,021	1,001	986	850	1,022	1,040	1,098
KANDH (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,057	1,117	990	846	1,070	1,079	1,115
KANDH (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,040	1,069	984	932	1,182	1,047	1,039
KANDU (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,082	1,090	919	780	915	1,181	1,274
KAORA (Hindu)	Bengal	944	935	746	1,025	797	1,001	1,008
KAPALI (Hindu)	Bengal	986	1,006	957	820	1,011	1,001	1,023
KARAN (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,075	1,030	1,030	876	975	1,041	1,289
KAYASTH (Hindu)	Bengal	954	1,015	974	716	981	904	1,052
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,004	1,032	988	748	797	1,035	1,110
KEWAT (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,063	1,040	1,034	890	1,008	1,074	1,182
KHAMBU AND JIMDAR (Hindu)	Bengal	1,012	1,185	1,107	875	1,019	983	919
KHANDAIT (Hindu)	Bengal	30	80	51	29	21	24	37
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,104	1,052	992	889	1,006	1,143	1,333
KHARIA (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,181	1,141	1,098	845	1,037	1,362	1,369
KHAS OR CHETTRI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	841	932	893	936	789	789	809
KHATRI (Hindu)	Bengal	332	549	600	677	469	193	410
KOCH (Hindu)	Bengal	934	1,253	851	889	1,121	902	782
KOIRI (Hindu)	Bengal	168	356	401	263	178	122	180
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,021	1,075	962	820	950	1,063	1,068

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Number of Females per 1,000 Males for certain selected Castes—*continued.*

Caste.	Locality.	Number of Females per 1,000 Males.						
		All ages.	0—5	5—12	12—15	15—20	20—40	40 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
KUKI (Hindu)	Bengal	1,001	969	964	844	1,140	1,073	933
KULU (Musalman)	Bengal	931	1,043	827	855	1,148	991	797
KUMHAR (Hindu)	Bengal	947	1,073	921	776	1,038	920	950
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,012	1,064	967	985	981	657	1 005
KUNJRA (Musalman)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,105	1,021	939	992	1,114	1.261	1,182
KURMI (Hindu)	Bengal	909	1,019	974	753	1,007	867	861
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,027	1,082	1,056	852	896	1,074	1,047
LEPCHA (Buddhist)	Bengal	997	1,072	892	863	848	1,028	1,076
LEPCHA (Christian)	Bengal	997	1,165	925	1,217	929	885	1,128
LOHAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,071	1,073	944	749	961	1,197	1,208
MAGH (Buddhist)	Bengal	1,040	971	944	912	1,125	1,153	1,047
MALLAH (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,307	1,136	1.000	845	1,245	1,622	1,533
MALO (Hindu)	Bengal	971	1,093	942	864	1,105	954	930
MAL PAHARIA (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,019	1,000	982	784	960	1,126	1,078
MAYRA (Hindu)	Bengal	442	1,005	709	684	496	309	415
MECH (Hindu)	Bengal	1,101	1 533	1,238	608	1.057	1,207	817
MECH (Animist)	Bengal	547	900	592	1,261	915	362	185
MOGHAL (Musalman)	Bengal	414	703	550	277	403	348	488
MUCHI (Hindu)	Bengal	875	1,028	880	845	1 069	817	799
MUNDA (Hindu)	Bengal	960	1,069	1,175	692	1,811	925	554
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,048	913	1,083	987	1,107	1,033	1,145
MUNDA (Animist)	Bengal	969	1,196	971	1,011	1.300	1,000	583
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,029	996	1,015	910	891	1,035	1,213
MURMI (Buddhist)	Bengal	984	938	930	997	952	920	1,157
MUSAHAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,020	1,123	962	811	1.045	1,127	921
NAMASUDRA (Hindu)	Bengal	973	1,046	939	794	1,235	972	903
NUNIYA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,144	1,119	962	745	954	1,339	1,323
ORAON (Hindu)	Bengal	1,055	1,213	1,115	1,233	1,843	1,013	646
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,021	1,099	940	928	938	1,092	1,015
ORAON (Animist)	Bengal	944	976	1,024	1,003	1,363	1,038	547
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,145	992	999	873	878	1,106	1,932
PAN (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,056	1,096	986	824	1,050	1,112	1,130
PAN (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,000	1,100	988	739	1,050	1,020	981
PATHAN (Musalman)	Bengal	773	1,021	847	628	835	703	728
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,087	1,069	913	818	1,005	1,194	1,255
PATNI (Hindu)	Bengal	959	1,045	906	821	1,122	943	955
POD (Hindu)	Bengal	961	1,074	912	868	1,202	956	852
RAJBANSI (Hindu)	Bengal	942	1,130	945	738	1,040	971	793
RAJPUT (Hindu)	Bengal	656	901	947	789	698	492	651
	Bihar and Orissa ...	995	1,031	906	658	727	1,022	1,226
RAJWAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,115	1,126	952	977	1,097	1,308	1,082

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES FOR CERTAIN SELECTED CASTES- *concluded.*

CASTE.	Locality.	NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES.						
		All ages.	0—5	5—12	12—15	15—20	20—40	40 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
RAUNIAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,018	1,143	959	839	956	937	1,207
SADGOP (Hindu)	Bengal	990	1,034	953	848	992	969	1,080
SAIYAD (Musalman)	Bengal	856	946	907	765	925	800	849
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,054	1,043	922	828	1,087	1,155	1,119
SANTAL (Hindu)	Bengal	970	1,060	938	897	1,231	1,016	786
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,146	1,013	1,183	1,398	1,360	1,166	941
SANTAL (Animist)	Bengal	984	1,068	935	848	116	1,051	850
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,008	1,006	914	1,147	1,035	1,015	1,045
SONAR (Hindu)	Bengal	571	533	614	392	996	552	502
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,028	1,046	926	795	929	1,103	1,124
SUBARNABANIK (Hindu) ...	Bengal	815	842	872	922	872	745	827
SUDRA (Hindu)	Bengal	1,106	1,029	967	804	1,166	1,240	1,203
SUNRI (Hindu)	Bengal	960	1,118	1,013	828	1,010	970	942
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,069	1,023	950	910	1,136	1,130	1,172
SUTRADHAR (Hindu)	Bengal	944	1,067	928	869	999	940	897
TANTI AND TATWA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	912	990	962	811	1,014	827	955
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,113	1,015	961	906	1,048	1,253	1,239
TELI AND TILI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	936	1,005	916	785	987	877	1,032
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,040	1,041	945	883	975	1,064	1,156
TIPARA (Hindu)	Bengal	966	1,087	914	1,068	1,303	952	778
TIPARA (Animist)	Bengal	948	987	975	1,031	1,234	939	752
TLAYR (Hindu)	Bengal	1,074	1,321	1,030	1,049	1,402	1,037	861
	Bihar and Orissa ...	1,107	1,225	994	927	1,123	1,203	1,072

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V. PART I.—ACTUAL NUMBER OF BIRTHS AND DEATHS REPORTED FOR EACH SEX DURING THE DECADES 1891—1900 AND 1901—1910.

YEAR.	NUMBER OF BIRTHS.			NUMBER OF DEATHS.			Excess (+) or deficit (-) of female births over male births.	Excess (+) or deficit (-) of female deaths over male deaths.	Excess (+) or deficit (-) of births over deaths.	Number of female births per 1,000 male births.	Number of female deaths per 1,000 male deaths
	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.					
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Bengal.											
1891*	724,981	678,836	1,403,817	573,414	515,397	1,088,811	- 46,145	- 58,017	+ 315,006	936	899
1892	549,941	505,874	1,055,815	625,971	549,581	1,175,552	- 44,067	- 76,390	- 119,737	920	878
1893	754,389	699,300	1,453,689	622,340	555,851	1,178,191	- 55,089	- 66,489	+ 275,498	927	893
1894	649,572	609,340	1,258,912	636,372	563,334	1,199,706	- 40,232	- 73,038	+ 59,206	938	885
1895	705,891	661,555	1,367,446	688,275	604,839	1,293,114	- 44,336	- 83,436	+ 74,332	937	879
1896	761,853	717,010	1,478,863	704,510	606,466	1,310,976	- 44,843	- 98,044	+ 167,887	941	861
1897	758,179	708,576	1,466,755	687,241	582,820	1,270,061	- 49,603	- 104,421	+ 196,694	935	848
1898	738,688	693,453	1,432,141	604,631	519,311	1,123,942	- 45,235	- 85,320	+ 308,199	939	859
1899	821,769	775,822	1,597,591	702,788	617,413	1,320,201	- 45,947	- 85,375	+ 277,390	944	879
1900	784,545	738,597	1,523,142	767,121	663,780	1,430,901	- 45,948	- 103,341	+ 92,241	941	865
Total 1891—1900 ...	*7,249,808*	*6,788,363*	*14,038,171*	*6,612,663*	*5,775,792*	*12,391,455*	- *461,445*	- *833,871*	+ *1,646,716*	*936*	*874*
1901	806,527	761,058	1,567,585	674,637	586,765	1,261,402	- 45,469	- 87,872	+ 306,183	944	870
1902	839,706	792,427	1,632,133	779,387	687,269	1,466,656	- 47,279	- 92,118	+ 165,477	944	882
1903	787,868	741,401	1,529,269	710,264	635,973	1,346,237	- 46,467	- 74,291	+ 183,032	941	895
1904	877,116	827,682	1,704,798	726 990	657,167	1,384,157	- 49,434	- 69,823	+ 320.641	944	904
1905	810,318	764,617	1,574,935	798,743	725,269	1,534,012	- 45,701	- 73,474	+ 50,923	944	908
1906	764,143	714,493	1,478,636	733,002	656,914	1,389,916	- 49,650	- 76,088	+ 88,720	935	896
1907	771,220	729,764	1,500,984	737,786	666,477	1,404,263	- 41,456	- 71,309	+ 96,721	946	903
1908	819,474	767,337	1,586,811	706,296	624,825	1,331,121	- 52,137	- 81,471	+ 255,690	936	885
1909	849,575	796,814	1,646,389	690,156	616,217	1,306.373	- 52,761	- 73,939	+ 340.016	938	893
1910	813,978	761,826	1,575,804	688,930	625,229	1,314,159	- 52,152	- 63,701	+ 261,645	936	908
Total 1901—1910 ...	*8,139,925*	*7,657,419*	*15,797,544*	*7,246,191*	*6,482,105*	*13,728 296*	- *482,506*	- *764,086*	+ *2,069,043*	*941*	*886*

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V. PART I.—ACTUAL NUMBER OF BIRTHS AND DEATHS REPORTED FOR EACH SEX DURING THE DECADES 1891—1900 AND 1901—1910.—*concluded.*

YEAR.	NUMBER OF BIRTHS.			NUMBER OF DEATHS.			Excess (+) or deficit (−) of female births over male births.	Excess (+) or deficit (−) of female deaths over male deaths.	Excess (+) or deficit (−) of births over deaths.	Number of female births per 1,000 male births.	Number of female deaths per 1,000 male deaths.
	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.					
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Bihar and Orissa.											
1891*	592,225	557,678	1,149,903	429,128	378,327	807,450	— 34,547	— 50,796	+ 342,453	942	882
1892	482,961	443,184	926,145	568,503	503,220	1,071,723	— 39,777	— 65,283	— 145,578	918	885
1893	560,070	521,100	1,081,170	437,198	390,074	827,272	— 38,970	— 47,124	+ 253,898	930	892
1894	552,750	520,585	1,073,335	679,879	599,511	1,279,390	— 32,165	— 80,368	— 206,055	942	882
1895	562,065	529,112	1,091,177	507,719	430,625	938,344	— 32,953	— 77,094	+ 152,833	941	848
1896	630,732	593,891	1,224,623	606,445	512,409	1,117,854	— 36,841	— 93,036	+ 106,769	942	846
1897	596,318	562,771	1,159,089	583,456	488,115	1,071,571	— 33,547	— 95,341	+ 87,518	944	837
1898	572,764	538,796	1,111,560	413,777	350,749	764,526	— 33,968	— 63,028	+ 347,034	941	848
1899	744,488	711,099	1,455,587	477,982	420,110	898,042	— 33,389	— 57,872	+ 557,545	955	879
1900	627,677	593,563	1,226,440	617,652	555,183	1,172,835	— 29,314	— 62,469	+ 53,605	953	899
Total 1891-1900 ...	*5,922,250*	*5,576,779*	*11,499,029*	*5,320,684*	*4,628,323*	*9,949,007*	— *345,471*	— *692,361*	+ *1,550,029*	*942*	*870*
1901	678,550	643,954	1,322,504	546,880	514,900	1,061,780	— 34,596	— 31,980	+ 260,724	942	942
1902	706,724	676,756	1,383,480	543,616	491,559	1,035,175	— 31,968	— 52,057	+ 350,305	955	904
1903	715,739	684,733	1 400 462	594,263	553,450	1,147,713	— 30,996	— 40,813	+ 252,749	957	931
1904	764,078	731,830	1 495.908	537,372	508,165	1,045.537	— 32,248	— 29,207	+ 450,371	958	946
1905	705,287	674,287	1,379.574	660,603	633,154	1,293.662	— 31,000	— 27,354	+ 85,912	956	959
1906	683,570	653.945	1,337.515	628,909	587,210	1,216.119	— 29.625	— 41,699	+ 121.396	957	934
1907	674,894	644,360	1,319.254	629,117	611,540	1,240 657	— 30.534	— 17,577	+ 78,597	955	972
1908	646,203	614,565	1,260.768	697,551	650,496	1,348.047	— 31,638	— 47,055	— 87,279	951	933
1909	636,301	625,692	1.781.993	551,407	522,769	1,074.176	— 30,609	— 28,638	+ 207,817	953	948
1910	701,283	669,352	1,370.640	612,200	569,960	1,182.160	— 31,936	— 42,240	+ 188.480	954	931
Total 1901-1910 ...	*6,934,624*	*6,619,474*	*13,554,098*	*6,001,823*	*5,643,203*	*11.645,026*	— *315,150*	— *358,690*	+ *1,909,072*	*955*	*940*

* As births were not registered in rural areas in 1891, the figures in columns 2, 3 and 4 of that year have been obtained by taking one-ninth of the totals of the years 1892—1900.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V. PART II.—NUMBER OF BIRTHS AND DEATHS REPORTED FOR EACH SEX IN EACH NATURAL DIVISION DURING THE DECADE 1901—1910.

NATURAL DIVISION.	NUMBER OF BIRTHS.			NUMBER OF DEATHS.			Excess (+) or deficit (−) of female births over male births.	Excess (+) or deficit (−) of female deaths over male deaths.	Excess (+) or deficit (−) of births over deaths.	Number of female births per 1,000 male births.	Number of female deaths per 1,000 male deaths.
	Male	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female	Total.					
	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Bengal ...	*8,135,925*	*7,657,419*	*15,737,344*	*7,946,191*	*6,492,105*	*13,728,296*	— *452,506*	— *764,086*	+*2,009,048*	*941*	*896*
West Bengal ...	1,421,976	1,336,671	2,758,647	1,405,575	1,260,245	2,665,820	— 85,305	— 145,330	+ 92,827	940	897
Central Bengal ...	1,352,036	1,263,286	2,615,322	1,410,741	1,241,680	2,652,421	— 88,750	— 169,061	— 37,099	934	880
North Bengal ...	1,943,458	1,845,878	3,789,336	1,799,544	1,597,089	3,396,633	— 97,580	— 202.465	+ 392,703	950	887
East Bengal ...	3,422,455	3,211,584	6,634,039	2,330,331	2,393,091	5,013,422	— 210,871	— 247,240	+1,620,617	938	906
Bihar and Orissa	*6,934,624*	*6,619,474*	*13,554,098*	*6,001,823*	*5,643,203*	*11,645,026*	— *315,150*	— *358,690*	+*1,909,072*	*955*	*940*
North Bihar ...	2,865,778	2,727,137	5,592.915	2,542,942	2,349,127	4,892,069	— 138,641	— 193,815	+ 700,846	952	924
South Bihar ...	1,685,028	1,607,677	3,292,705	1,595,950	1,581,580	3,177,530	— 77,351	— 14,370	+ 115,175	954	991
Orissa	832,657	791,791	1,624,448	770,630	745,242	1,515,872	— 40,866	— 25,388	+ 108,576	951	967
Chota Nagpur Plateau	1,551,161	1,492,869	3,044,030	1,092,301	967,254	2,059,555	— 58,292	— 125,047	+ 984,475	962	886

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V-A—Excess (+) or deficiency (—) of Births over Deaths during the decades 1891—1901 and 1901—1911.

	Excess of Births over Deaths.				Percentage of Female excess to Male excess.	
	1891—1901.		1901—1911.			
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	1891—1901.	1901—1911.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	***+1,238,711***	***+1,958,027***	***+1,826,535***	***+2,151,585***	***+ 158***	***+ 118***
Bengal	***+ 637,145***	***+1,009,571***	***+ 893,734***	***+1,175,314***	***+ 158***	***+ 132***
West Bengal	+ 139,611	+ 198,899	+ 16,401	+ 76,426	+ 142	+ 466
Central Bengal	- 23,103	+ 47,433	- 58,705	+ 21,606	- 205	- 37
North Bengal	- 23,887	+ 84,032	+ 143,914	+ 248,789	- 352	+ 173
East Bengal	+ 544,524	+ 679,237	+ 792,124	+ 828,493	+ 125	+ 105
Bihar and Orissa ...	***+ 601,566***	***+ 948,456***	***+ 932,801***	***+ 976,271***	***+ 158***	***+ 105***
North Bihar	+ 98,596	+ 336,480	+ 322,836	+ 378,010	+ 341	+ 117
South Bihar	+ 105,444	+ 143,476	+ 89,078	+ 26,037	+ 167	+ 29
Orissa	+ 121,062	+ 119,835	+ 62,027	+ 46,549	+ 99	+ 75
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	+ 277,464	+ 348,665	+ 458,860	+ 525,615	+ 126	+ 115

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—Number of Deaths of each sex at different ages.

Age.	1905.		1906.		1907.		1908.		1909.		Total.		Average number of female deaths per 1,000 male deaths.
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	
Bengal Total	***798,743***	***725,269***	***733,002***	***656,914***	***737,786***	***666,477***	***706,296***	***624,825***	***690,156***	***616,217***	***3,665,983***	***3,289,702***	***897***
0— 1 ...	182,082	157,482	167,043	142,352	154,917	133,746	165,330	138,488	166,262	140,966	835,634	713,034	852
1— 5 ...	122,289	114,812	104,166	96,108	97,024	92,677	89,025	83,756	94,517	89,089	507,001	476,442	940
5—10 ...	73,679	56,342	61,317	47,716	63,966	50,753	54,925	43,177	55,413	43,008	309,200	241,085	780
10—15 ...	40,641	29,421	33,498	23,980	35,554	25,242	31,270	22,278	29,163	21,329	170,126	122,250	719
15—20 ...	39,768	47,629	33,477	41,566	36,293	42,824	33,017	33,379	31,358	39,617	172,913	210,015	1,215
20—30 ...	76,254	89,401	71,225	84,101	74,396	86,067	68,606	78,978	66,753	79,732	357,234	418,279	1,171
30—40 ...	74,147	63,349	72,221	59,989	75,554	64,253	72,883	60,462	68,690	57,733	363,495	305,786	841
40—50 ...	60,868	47,562	59,590	44,755	62,801	48,264	60,426	45,774	56,417	42,040	300,102	228,395	761
50—60 ...	50,124	45,473	50,022	43,352	52,974	46,258	52,266	44,954	47,420	39,946	252,806	219,983	870
60 and over ...	79,911	73,798	80,443	72,995	84,307	76,393	78,648	68,579	74,163	62,647	397,472	354,412	892
Bihar and Orissa Total	***660,509***	***633,154***	***628,909***	***587,210***	***629,117***	***611,540***	***697,551***	***650,496***	***551,407***	***522,769***	***3,167,492***	***3,005,169***	***949***
0— 1 ...	146,331	129,490	140,117	124,295	132,448	119,929	148,734	135,099	123,057	109,761	690,687	618,574	896
1— 5 ...	113,048	108,799	104,722	100,085	98,489	96,957	116,568	112,606	88,300	87,043	520,127	505,490	972
5—10 ...	56,429	48,647	52,225	43,452	53,497	47,165	57,271	46,618	43,066	36,341	262,488	222,203	847
10—15 ...	37,727	29,314	33,862	24,886	35,282	27,359	34,212	25,034	25,866	18,934	166,949	125,527	752
15—20 ...	25,207	22,404	24,018	21,003	24,254	22,608	25,510	22,421	18,086	15,629	117,075	104,069	889
20—30 ...	59,036	61,346	57,342	57,342	57,307	60,470	62,142	61,392	45,240	44,162	281,067	284,712	1,013
30—40 ...	56,092	53,944	55,343	50,120	56,691	53,360	62,835	55,587	47,327	41,140	278,288	254,151	913
40—50 ...	49,629	43,873	48,441	40,317	50,167	45,422	56,490	44,781	44,007	36,099	248,734	208,492	838
50—60 ...	45,261	46,676	44,164	44,248	47,025	48,107	54,326	52,513	43,274	43,753	234,050	235,297	1,005
60 and over ...	72,748	88,657	68,675	81,482	73,957	92,163	79,463	94,445	73,184	89,907	368,027	446,654	1,214

The figures shown against Bihar and Orissa for the year 1905 are exclusive of Sambalpur, for which figures are not available.

CHAPTER VII.

CIVIL CONDITION.

INTRODUCTORY.

624. Civil condition is a term applied to domestic status. The statistics relating to it are contained in Imperial Tables VII and XIV, which show the number of persons of each sex who are either unmarried or married or widowed. In Part I of the former table statistics are given for the total population of each province, and for each religion by different age periods. In Part II similar information is furnished for each of the main religions in every district. Table XIV contains statistics for selected castes and tribes, the arrangement being the same as in Table VII, except that the age periods 5—12 and 12—15 are substituted for 5—10 and 10—15 respectively. At the end of this chapter five subsidiary tables will be found, viz.—

Subsidiary Table I.—Distribution by civil condition of 1,000 of each sex, religion and main age period at each of the last four censuses.

Subsidiary Table II.—Distribution by civil condition of 1,000 of each sex at certain ages in each religion and natural division.

Subsidiary Table III.—Distribution by main age periods of 10,000 of each sex and religion.

Subsidiary Table IV.—Proportion of the sexes by civil condition at certain ages for religions and natural divisions.

Subsidiary Table V.—Distribution by civil condition of 1,000 of each sex at certain ages for selected castes.

The instructions regarding the entry of civil condition at this census were the same as in 1901, viz., that persons were to be shown as unmarried, married or widowed. Divorced persons were to be entered as widowed, and a woman who had never been married was to be shown as unmarried even though she was a prostitute or concubine. Persons who were recognized by custom as married were to be entered as such, even though they had not gone through the full ceremony, *e.g.*, widows who had taken a second husband.

Before proceeding to discuss the statistics, a short review will be given of the customs by which marriage is regulated, to which will also be added, under the instructions of the Census Commissioner, an account of certain customs connected with pregnancy and birth, and of relationships and their restrictions. The chapter will therefore be divided into two parts, viz., (1) General and (2) Statistical.

PART I.—GENERAL.

MARRIAGE CUSTOMS.

PREMARITAL INTERCOURSE.

625. Sexual intercourse between members of the same tribe is tolerated by some of the aboriginal tribes, provided either that the parties are not closely related or that they are not members of the same sept. Such intercourse frequently takes place at annual festivals, when considerable license prevails. Among the Kharias a marriage, as well as a festival, is an occasion for an orgy, in which the village youths and girls come together without a word of protest. The system of dormitories, in which the boys and girls sleep away from their parents, also facilitates the indulgence of youthful passions. The Oraons, for instance, have a common dormitory, known as *dhumkuria*, in which the boys sleep together, while the girls all sleep in the house of some old woman, who is supposed to look after them. She often winks, however, at their delinquencies, and pretends not to see a girl slip away to the boys' dormitory. In some villages, moreover, there is not this separation of the sexes, and both boys and girls sleep together in one dormitory. If a girl becomes pregnant, the putative father is expected to marry her, and he generally does so:

otherwise he is punished by the Panchayat. Among the Santals, if the young lover belongs to the same sept and therefore cannot marry the girl, he is bound to provide her with a husband called *kiring-jawae*, *i.e.*, a bought husband, because he is paid by the girl's lover or by her father for consenting to take her as his wife.

Premarital intercourse is also recognized by the Rajbansis in Purnea, among whom it is due to the expenses attending the marriage ceremony. A feast to the caste brethren is an essential feature of marriage. Unless and until such a feast is given, the marriage ceremony is void. If the man who wishes to marry has not been able to save enough money to provide a feast, he simply sprinkles water on the girl, and they are thereby united. They may live together and have children, but are not regarded as being properly married. The formal marriage may take place at any subsequent time, when the husband has got together the money required for the feast. As soon as the feast is given, the marriage becomes valid with retrospective effect.

MARRIAGE BY CAPTURE.

626. Marriage by capture is still commonly practised by some of the aboriginal tribes of the Chota Nagpur Plateau. Among the Bhuiyas of the Orissa States, if a young man is in love with a girl, and either she or her parents will not consent to a marriage, he gathers together a band of his friends, and, when he gets an opportunity, carries her off, his companions guarding the flight. This method of obtaining a bride often leads to sanguinary conflicts, owing to the girl's friends attempting to prevent the abduction or to rescue her. A survival of marriage by capture is seen in another form of marriage among the Bhuiyas, which is effected with the consent of the girl. Her would-be husband takes her away from a group of Bhuiya girls in the forest. Her companions return to the village, where they report that she has been carried off by a tiger and urge the villagers to go in pursuit. A search party is organized, which, after going to the spot, returns to the house of the parents of the lover and demands the blood of the lad. His parents offer to pay blood money and to stand a village feast, and the wedding is then celebrated. In both these cases the abduction has to be regularized by the marriage ceremony and by feasting the community when it takes place.*

The Hos also practise marriage by capture, the young man carrying off the girl from some dance or market in spite of any resistance, real or feigned, that she may make. In this case the bride-price is settled afterwards. Traces of marriage by capture are also seen in the marriage ceremonies of many low classes, of which a regular feature is a mimic conflict between the *barat* (*i.e.*, the procession of the bridegroom's friends) and the friends of the bride, which ends in the victory of the former.

MARRIAGE BY SERVICE.

627. Marriage by service is common among the Santals, Mundas and Oraons, and is also found among the Rajbansis and the Haris. The young man in this case wins his bride by service, working in the house of her parents for a certain period of years, after which she is given to him as his wife, in the same way that Leah and Rachel were given to Jacob. Among the Santals this form of marriage is usual when a girl is deformed or ugly, and is also resorted to by parents who have only daughters or have grown-up daughters and infant sons. The *ghardi-jawae*, as the man is called, is generally a poor man who has not enough to satisfy the father's demand for his daughter. He therefore, pays by his labour, living with and working for his future father-in-law without wages for five years. He then gets two buffaloes, some rice and some agricultural implements, and sets up house for himself and his wife. If his wife has no brothers, and he stays on in the house and works for his father-in-law till he dies, he inherits all the immovable property and half the movable property, the other half going to the relatives of the deceased. Should the *ghardi-jawae* have a child, the names of the maternal grand-mother and grand-father are given first, instead of the name of paternal grand-parents, as is the usual practice. This may possibly be a trace of matriarchy.

Among the Mundas the "service son-in-law," who is known as *gharjawain* or *ghardamad*, stays in the house of his father-in-law and works for three years. He then takes his wife away to his own home, receiving a present of

* L. E. B. Cobden Ramsay, *Orissa States Gazetteer*, pp. 48, 49.

some land, two bullocks, and 12 maunds of rice. If, after his marriage, he remains with his father-in-law or mother-in-law, and takes care of them till their death, he inherits the whole property. There are three kinds of "service sons-in-law" among the Oraons, all of whom are called *erpajeon khaddi* (Hindi, *ghardamad* or *ghardi-jawai*). Some are practically servants, who receive food, clothing and wages, besides a yearly bonus, during their period of service, and when it is over, have to leave the house. The second kind may, after marriage, either stay in the house or set up a separate establishment. In addition to their pay, board and lodging, the yearly bonus, and the wife, they receive, on departure, a pair of bullocks and a plough, tools and various household articles. Lastly, a man, who is afraid that he may die without male issue, may adopt one or more young men, conferring upon them all the rights of inheritance due to a son or sons. The only conditions are that the young men must marry his daughters and work for him until his death. They get no pay, but the same treatment as a son. A widow may adopt a son on the same conditions, and on her death he will succeed to her husband's property.

MARRIAGE BY PURCHASE.

628. The almost universal form of marriage at the present time is marriage by purchase, *i.e.*, either the bride or the bridegroom is paid for. Generally, the higher castes pay for the bridegroom, the payment being called *tilak* or *dahej*, while the lower castes pay a bride-price. The amount varies with the wealth and position of the parties. Naturally, a poor man is not expected to pay as much as a rich man, but, on the other hand, a man must pay more if he seeks a matrimonial alliance with a family having a better social position or greater wealth. Hypergamy also necessitates the payment of high fees, as the field of choice is limited. Educational qualifications put up the price of a bridegroom, not so much because of any belief in education as an advantage *per se*, but because the bridegroom is more likely to get remunerative employment. It is its potential, and, in some cases, its actual, value that makes a University degree a good asset. Unless it were thought that the bridegroom is, or is likely to be, in a position to maintain a family, he would stand a poor chance in the marriage market. In spite of the growing number of bridegrooms with University qualifications, their price is still very high. A Kayasth, for instance, in Champaran obtained Rs. 700 for a son who had passed the Entrance examination, whereas he would otherwise have received only Rs. 300. This, however, was an unusually cheap match for a Kayasth. Another youth in the same fortunate position secured Rs. 2,500, and the price of a Bihari B.A. husband has been known to run up to Rs. 3,500. In the richer province of Bengal the price of a Kayasth matriculate or graduate usually varies from Rs. 500 to Rs. 3,000, but there are instances of Rs. 10,000 being demanded and paid.

The possession of a degree may even change the whole situation and cause a bridegroom-price to be paid instead of a bride-price. It is reported from Bankura that the bride-price system prevails among the Sadgops, but if the bridegroom has a University degree, his father, so far from paying anything for the bride, has a handsome sum paid to him. Generally, however, though a certain amount of education is appreciated in a Sadgop bridegroom, the possession of landed property is more valued than the possession of a degree. A bride's father will pay as much as Rs. 300 for a boy with some landed property and a fair education, whereas he would otherwise receive Rs. 100 to Rs. 500 for giving his daughter in marriage. Among the Babhans and Rajputs landed property is sought after rather than educational proficiency. Rupees 15,000 have before now been paid for an uneducated Babhan zamindar with a big rent-roll. It should be added that it is not uncommon for a girl's father to undertake to pay for the cost of the bridegroom's education. The payment is thus spread over several years, and there is the prospect of a good investment if the boy has ability.

629. Age affects the price considerably. Where brides are bought, a girl who is getting on in years will not command so high a price as one who is younger. Where bridegrooms are bought, it is more difficult and expensive to find a husband for a girl who has attained puberty than for one who is still immature. Among the higher castes who take a price for bridegrooms, it is considered a disgraceful thing to take anything for girls. Only those who are poor will do so. The bridegroom in such cases is nearly always suffering from some infirmity or is an old man who would find it difficult to obtain a bride

otherwise. Occasionally, however, a man of high caste will pay for a bride when he really wants a wife to look after his house.

630. The following statement shows the prices generally paid for brides and bridegrooms, and the age at which marriage takes place, among different castes. Where there is no entry of a bride-price, it means that the bridegroom is paid for, and *vice versâ*.

Caste.	Locality.	Sums paid for—		Age of—	
		Bride.	Bridegroom.	Bride.	Bridegroom.
		Rs.	Rs.		
AGURI	Burdwan	...	200—5,000	5—13	12—25
BABHAN	Bihar	...	20—2,000	10—12	12—20
BAGDI	Bengal	7—64	...	3—14	7—26
BAIDYA	Bengal	...	500—3,000	10—14	20—25
BAURI	Bengal	4 as. to Rs. 10	...	5—16	8—20
	Orissa	10—20	...	11—22	20—30
BHOTIA	Darjeeling	25 and upwards	...	16—17	20—25
BHUIYA	Chota Nagpur	2—7	...	7—12	10—14
BHUMIJ	Chota Nagpur	2	...	7—18	12—25
BINJHAL	Orissa	40	...	12	13—15
BRAHMAN	Bengal	...	500—5,000	8—14	17—20
	Bihar	...	10—3,000	7—15	12—20
	Orissa	...	100—200	7—11	12—20
CHASA	Orissa	10—100	...	11—22	20—30
CHERO	Palamau	5—10	...	8—10	12—13
DHANUK	Bihar	100	...	3—10	4—10
GANDHABANIK	Burdwan	...	50—300	9—12	16—20
GAURA	Orissa	10—40	...	10—12	12—25
GOALA	Bengal	100—400	...	5—10	11—20
	Bihar	5—100	...	1—8	2—16
GURIA	Orissa	2—40	...	5—10	5—10
JIMDAR	Darjeeling	15 and upwards	...	18 and over	18 and over
KAHAR	Bihar	50—100	...	8—14	8—14
KAIBARTTA	West Bengal	25—100	...	7—11	15—25
KANDH (Phond)	Orissa	20—60	...	16—30	16—40
KAORA	24-Parganas	15—50	...	5—9	10—25
KARAN	Orissa	...	100—3,000	11—22	18—30
KAYASTH	Bengal	...	200—5,000	9—14	16—25
	Bihar	...	50—1,000	7—15	11—25
KEWAT	Purnea	10—50	...	2—8	4—12
KHAIRA	Bankura	5—10	...	7—9	11—16
KHANDAIT	Orissa	30—100	...	9—20	14—25
KHARIA	Ranchi	In kind	...	12—20	12—20
KHARWAR	Palamau	7	...	11—12	12—13
KORI	Bihar	50—100	...	8—14	8—14
KORA	Manbhum	2	...	7—12	12—20
KURMI	Bihar	2—100	...	8—14	8—14
LEPCHA	Darjeeling	100	...	16 and over	20 and over.
LIMBU	Darjeeling	40—60	...	16 and over	20 and over.
MANGAR	Darjeeling	60	...	14	18
MUNDA	Ranchi	5—80	...	12—20	15—20
MURMI	Darjeeling	25 and upwards	...	17	18
NAMASUDRA	Central Bengal	20—100	...	4—10	12—18
ORAON	Ranchi	10	...	12—20	12—20
PAN	Orissa	10—30	...	6—20	10—30
POD	24-Parganas	15—50	...	5—9	10—25
RAJBANSI	Cooch Behar	80—100	...	10—11	20—23
RAJPUT	Bihar	...	10—5,000	8—20	10—25
SADGOP	Bengal	30—500	...	7—13	9—22
SAHAR	Orissa	15—17	...	10—20	10—30
SANTAL	Southal Parganas	13	...	14—18	18—22
SAURIA PAHARIA (Maler)	Southal Parganas	13	...	16—17	18—20
SUBARNABANIK	Howrah	...	500—3,000	9—12	18—20
SUKLI	Midnapore	50—200	...	8—9	16—20
TELI	Bihar	100	...	5—10	5—16
TIYAR	24-Parganas	15—50	...	5—9	10—25

631. The price is generally settled by the parents, either directly or through intermediaries, but in some castes it is settled by the caste Panchayat and is not left to mutual agreement. The horoscopes of the boy and girl have to be carefully compared to see if the stars, under which they were born, harmonize, *i.e.*, whether the marriage is auspicious or not. It has been suggested that the object of consulting horoscopes is to see whether in a former life they have been members of different castes, which would of course preclude any alliance, but this is not the idea of the people themselves. The marriages of the Maithil Brahmans are carefully regulated by a record called the Panj, which dates back many hundred years—it is said that it is at least a thousand years old, and the fact that it is written on palm-leaves attests its antiquity. No Brahman can marry any woman whose birth has not been entered in the Panj. It is kept up by genealogists called Panjiaras, who go on annual tours, entering the names of the Brahmans born in each village during the year. The office is hereditary, but, before practising, the candidate must obtain the permission of the Maharaja of Darbhanga. The parties, who wish to arrange a marriage between their sons and daughters, employ Ghataks or marriage-brokers, and, after coming to an agreement, go to the Panjiara. The latter refers to the Panj and, if it shows that there is no bar to the marriage, grants them a certificate to that effect.

PRICES OF BRIDE AND BRIDEGROOM.

632. There is a general consensus of opinion that the prices to be paid for both brides and bridegrooms have risen of late years. In Cooch Behar, for instance, the average amount paid for a Rajbansi bride used to be Rs. 40 to Rs. 50, but is now Rs. 80 to Rs. 100. The cause of enhancement seems to be very largely the increased cost of living. It is partly also the result of greater facilities of intercommunication consequent on the extension of railways. The field of selection larger, but competitive prices have set in. The members of a caste in one place now have means of knowing that high prices are paid in another, and it is naturally considered necessary to demand no less. Apart from mercenary considerations, a high price argues a high position. Lastly, prices have been enhanced by new standards. It is no longer a question of a good family record and a fair amount of land. Educational qualifications are sought after, and the possession of them raises the price. Special circumstances may also come into play. In Hazaribagh, for example, a Bhuiya bridegroom, who a few years ago paid Rs. 3 for a wife, now has to pay Rs. 4. The increase is due to the number of men who have migrated to Burma or elsewhere, and, coming home with pockets full, are ready to pay a rupee more for a handsome bride. In Bihar, the increase is attributed by one correspondent to families ceasing to employ Brahmans to arrange marriages for them in consequence of the frauds that have been detected. The families themselves, it is said, are far more exacting than the Brahman. A further cause of the enhancement of prices seems to be that in this, as in other respects, the low imitate the high castes, and there is a general levelling up.

633. It must not be imagined that bargains are always made. The amount is still often determined by custom, and this is generally the case where it is paid in kind. The idea of a price is obscured, and it is merely a customary obligation for the bridegroom to provide so many articles—ornaments, clothes, etc.—and to receive certain presents himself. The payment may be entirely or only partially in kind. The following schedule of the articles made over by a Sahar bridegroom in Orissa to his father-in-law is a relic of the days when barter was in vogue :—240 seers of paddy, 2 *saris*, a goat, 20 seers of common rice, four seers of fine rice, a seer of oil and ½ seer of turmeric, besides Re. 1-4 in cash : the total value of these miscellaneous articles is Rs. 15. It should be added that the amount to be paid is frequently enhanced by the necessity of having to provide a caste feast.

634. Hindu custom makes it necessary that girls should be married before they attain puberty. A *sloka* of Parashar fixes their marriageable age at 8 to 10 years, while a *sloka* attributed to Manu extends it to 12 years, for it is laid down that a bridegroom of 24 should marry a girl of 8, and a man of 30 a girl of 12. In Bengal, these rules are observed by the lower castes, but among the higher castes the age of marriage is higher, and is steadily rising, so that the old rules have frequently to be broken. This is due, in a small

AGES OF BRIDE AND BRIDEGROOM.

degree, to the more enlightened views that are coming into favour, but mainly to the high price commanded by bridegrooms. The expenditure necessary to secure a suitable bridegroom is becoming so heavy, that many fathers find it beyond their means to arrange marriages while their daughters are at an early age, and have reluctantly to wait till they have saved enough to meet it without ruining themselves. The attitude of the average father who has to defer his daughter's marriage is, in fact, that of Shakespeare's Apothecary—"My poverty but not my will consents." Kulinism is also partly responsible for the extension of the age-limit. Cases are common of Kulin girls being married at an advanced age, and some are condemned to a life of celibacy owing to the impossibility of getting a bridegroom from a family of equal status.

635. As is well known, the more enlightened Hindus have for some time past attempted to fix a reasonable amount as the price to be paid for bride or bridegroom: and to raise the age of marriage. The higher castes have protested at any monetary demand as not being enjoined by the Sastras, and have endeavoured to limit the price of bridegrooms, maxima such as Rs. 51 being fixed. These attempts have hitherto borne but little fruit. A society, called the Hindu Marriage Reform League, has also been started by Hindu gentlemen in Calcutta with the object of raising the age, at which girls can be given in marriage, to 16 years. Till recently such attempts have been made only by the higher castes, but the movement is spreading downwards. A general conference of the Namasudras held in 1908 resolved that any one marrying a son under 20 or a daughter under 10 years of age should be excommunicated. This resolution has had some effect, for it is reported that, in the Narail subdivision of Jessore, the age of a bride varies from 8 to 11 and that of a bridegroom from 16 to 20. In this subdivision it has further been determined that no Namasudra parent shall take more than Rs. 30 for a daughter and, if he is in affluent circumstances, nothing at all.

636. Orissa furnishes an exception to the rule that the low castes marry earlier than the high castes, for there both high and low castes marry their girls after as well as before puberty. Child marriage is the custom among the Brahman, Baniya and Jyotish castes, as well as among immigrant Kayasths, but other castes commonly marry their girls after puberty. Among the Brahmans, the usual age for the marriage of a girl is 7 to 11 years and for a boy 12 to 20, but, among other castes, it varies from 11 to 22 years, while men commonly marry as late as 20 to 30. Even the Karan women marry late, many not being wedded till after 20 years of age, and the same is the case with the Khandaits. Among the Brahmans, on the other hand, it is very uncommon for females to be spinsters at 20 or even at 16. Unlike Bengal, there is no difficulty in securing a husband, but it is no easy matter to obtain a suitable bride. The bride price is, in fact, so large, that many Brahman men have to remain unmarried till they are advanced in years.

637. It is a general rule that the bridegroom must be a few years older than the bride. Sometimes, among the illiterate classes, the parents do not know their children's age and have to go by their heights. The Goalas and Dhanuks use a measuring rope, and all is well if the boy is 2 or 3 inches taller than the girl. Some apparently regard the question of height as more important than that of age, *i.e.*, the essential point is that the bridegroom should be taller than the bride. The Sunris of Bihar and Chota Nagpur, when negotiating for the marriage of their children, state their height in *girahs*, and it is the right thing for a girl to be married when she is from 12 to 14 *girahs* high and a boy when he is from 12 to 16 *girahs*. The Kewats of Bihar are so strict on this point, that if the boy is shorter than the girl, or if his height is exactly the same as hers, it is believed that the union of the two will bring ill-luck, and the match is at once broken off*.

There is rarely any great difference of age when a boy is married for the first time, but, when a man contracts a second, third or fourth marriage, the disparity is often remarkable. Well-to-do widowers of 50 and over commonly marry girls of 12 years of age. One exceptional case reported

* I have not first-hand knowledge and merely quote from reports.

from Saran is that of a Kurmi man aged 36 who married an infant of 6 months. It is very rare for the bride to be older than the bridegroom, but in the same district a Rajput boy of 10 was married to a woman of 25 and a Goala boy of the same age to a woman of 24.

638. Among the Nepalese castes or tribes, adult marriages are the general rule. They are almost universal among the aboriginal tribes, to whom the idea of an early marriage, to be consummated when the bride attains puberty, is foreign. Marriage among them is based on the practical consideration that a wife must be old and strong enough for house and other work. The influence of Hinduization is, however, making itself felt, and marriages are beginning to take place at an earlier age. The age for marriage among Santals used to be 25 for men and 20 for women. Now a youth marries at 18 to 22, and a girl at 14 to 18 years of age, while cases of child marriage, though still comparatively few, are on the increase.

INFANT MARRIAGE.

639. Infant marriages are almost confined to the lower Hindu castes and are most frequent in Bihar. They are specially common among the Bihari Goalas, whose children are generally married in the first three years of life. It is rare for a Goala bride to be older than 8 years, or for a bridegoom to be older than 10. To be a spinster or a bachelor after those ages is regarded as disreputable or argues some physical defect. Infant marriages among the higher castes are exceptional, but fathers who have lost children in infancy sometimes marry their daughters when they are only two or three years old, in the belief that their lives will be saved by being made members of another family. Some fifty years ago there was a practice called *Bagdan* among the Vaidik Brahmans of Bengal by which parents made agreements that if one had a son and the other a daughter, they should be married, but this practice has fallen into desuetude, presumably because the field of selection is larger. It still prevails, however, among the Goalas of Bihar.

THE MARRIAGE CEREMONY.

640. *Sindurdan*, or smearing vermilion on the bride's forehead or on the parting of her hair, is generally regarded as the essential feature of the marriage ceremony. This is carried so far, that some castes consider it sufficient for a would-be bridegroom to smear some red paint on the forehead of the girl with whom he is in love. Even among the Musalmans of Purnea, if a man can manage to put vermilion on a woman's head, she is regarded as having been thereby married to him : the practice is, however, confined to the lower uneducated classes. Among the Santals this device is regarded as a regular form of marriage, though it is attended with some risk to the young lover. If he is caught in the act, he is soundly thrashed by the girl's relations. Otherwise, they go to his house, and if they find him, tie him up and beat him till he is half dead : cases have been known of youths being killed on such occasions. They also smash all the earthenware pots, break up the fireplace, and kill a couple of goats or pigs. They end by taking away some bullocks or buffaloes as a kind of bail, till the case is decided by the headman, who orders compensation to be paid to the girl's father. The two families then eat the bullocks or buffaloes and a goat contributed by the girl's family. A young Santal will sometimes smear vermilion on the forehead of a girl against whom he has some grudge, in order that he may divorce her and prevent her being married like other young girls.

Another essential feature of the marriage ceremony is that the bride and bridegoom eat together, thereby showing that she has been transferred to his family, but before the stage of *Sindurdan* and the common meal is reached, various formalities have to be gone through, which are so numerous and varied, that space forbids their mention.

The application of vermilion is probably a survival of a blood covenant between husband and wife. This is still actually observed by some castes, such as the Haris of Bengal, among whom a bride and bridegroom are smeared with each other's blood, which is extracted with a thorn from their fingers. It is reported that among the Dharhis and Dosadhs of Monghyr the fingers are lanced by a barber, and the blood is soaked in red cotton wool, which is enclosed in *pan*. The bride chews the *pan* containing the

bridegroom's blood, and the bridegroom that containing the bride's blood. A similar custom prevails among the Gulgulias; only in their case the wool which absorbs the blood is used to dye the feet of the bridegroom and the bride. This is the last act in the marriage ceremony, after which she is taken away to his house.

MARRIAGE OF WIDOWS.

641. The marriage of widows is opposed to the sacramental theory of marriage held by orthodox Hindus, but is commonly practised by the low castes. Even among them, however, the tendency is to give up the custom, its abandonment being regarded as a a hall-mark of respectability. Some sub-castes, called Biahut in Bihar, claim a superior status because they do not allow widows to re-marry, while ambitious castes, such as the Kurmis of Bihar and the Chasas of Orissa, among whom the custom used to prevail, are discontinuing it in their desire to obtain a higher status. It is sometimes said that a re-married widow is regarded as a kind of concubine, but this appears to be too sweeping a statement. The distinction between widow marriage and concubinage is well defined and clearly recognized. In the first place a widow marriage can take place only between members of the same caste, while the only restriction on the choice of a concubine is that she must belong to a caste from which water may be taken. In the second place the consent of the castemen has frequently to be obtained before a widow is married, whereas no one would dream of consulting them before taking a concubine. Lastly, widow marriage is accompanied by a ceremony, though it is far less formal than at the marriage of a virgin bride. It usually consists merely of applying vermilion to the woman's forehead and putting bracelets on her wrists. If a bride-price is paid for a widow, it is small in amount and far less than is paid for a virgin bride: commonly nothing is paid at all. The Dhanuks and Chamars of Patna are, however, reported to prefer widows and to pay a higher price for them. The cause of this unusual custom is perhaps that their marriages are celebrated at an early age, and that a girl bride has to be supported for many years before she is able to add to the income of the family or be of any assistance to it.

642. At the same time, some castes hold a re-married widow in such low esteem, that her actual position is little better than that of a concubine. This is the case among the Santals, who believe that a woman is the property of her first husband and will rejoin him in the next world. In fact, they say that the second husband merely "hires" the widow for this life. The ceremony also shows the low estimation in which they hold the woman, for instead of smearing *sindur* on her forehead, the bridegroom smears it on a flower, which he thereupon places in her hair with his left (or impure) hand. Among the Kurmis of Manbhum a widow has to undergo the indignity of receiving *sindur* from the bridegroom's great toe. Among the Rajbansis a *dangua*, *i.e.*, a man who marries a widow and is kept by her, is regarded with particular contempt: the woman can even turn him out of her house whenever she likes. So great is the disgust which he inspires, that it is said that if a cow dies, and a *dangua* removes its carcase from the cowshed, even the keen-eyed vultures will not eat it. Another story is that those sagacious animals—the elephants—will refuse to eat rice which has been tied up in grass and offered to them by a *dangua*.*

In Orissa the name *thainani*, which is applied to a re-married widow, is a term of contempt. She never has the privileges of a virgin wife; she cannot prepare or touch *sraddha* offerings and she cannot join *sadhabas*, or women married for the first time, in the performance of ceremonies. She is formally repudiated by the family of her deceased husband. When she expresses a desire to marry again, the leading men of the village are called together and the ornaments given her at marriage are taken from her. Any children the women may have born to her first husband are also taken away, though she is allowed to retain a child at the breast till it is of marriageable age. This practice is also usual in Bihar. A solemn declaration is finally made that neither she nor her husband's family have claims on one another. This formal renunciation is called *elakabujhineba* or cessation of claims.

* Jalpaiguri District Gazetteer, p. 35.

643. Widow marriage (*dwitya* or *sanga* or *thain*) is very common in Orissa, and presents some peculiar features which may be mentioned here. It obtains among almost all castes, except the Bengali settlers, the Brahmans, the Karans and the Mahanaik section of the Khandaits, who are gradually working up to a higher standard of orthodoxy. The ceremony is generally of a simple character. Some ornaments and cloth are given to the bride, and the caste people have a feast. The particular ornament the presentation of which by the bridegroom to the bride appears to be indispensable, is a *bala* or bangle, so that widow marriage is sometimes called *Baladewa* (giving a *bala*). An odd number is very unlucky. A man may therefore marry a widow without danger if it is his second or fourth marriage, but not if he is a bachelor marrying his first or a widower marrying a third wife. When a bachelor takes a widow wife, he first goes through a form of marriage to a *sahara* tree. One of the branches of the tree is lowered and placed in his hand and a garland is tied round his wrist, as is generally done in the case of marriage with a woman. Then the widow is brought before the bridegroom, garlands are exchanged, and the bridegroom presents a *bala* to the bride and makes her wear it. If a widower marries for a third time, he also marries a *sahara* tree before he takes the widow as his bride, so that the tree becomes his third wife and the widow the fourth wife. The idea is simply superstitious. The Koltas say that if a bachelor marries a widow, he will become an evil spirit after death; he therefore goes through a mock marriage with a flower before the real marriage with the widow. There is a similar custom among the Halwais of Bihar. When a Halwai bachelor marries a widow, the ceremony takes place, as is the usual practice, in the widow's house, but before going there the bridegroom is formally married in his own house to a sword or a piece of iron, which he bedaubs with vermilion as if it were his bride.

THE BRAHMO MARRIAGE ACT.

644. The provisions of the Brahmo Marriage Act (III of 1872) do not appear to be utilized to any great extent for the re-marriage of widows. The total number of marriages celebrated under it in Bengal during the decade 1901-10 was only 335 (of which two-thirds took place in Calcutta), and in 34 cases only were the brides widows.

LEVIRATE.

645. A special form of widow marriage, which is common among aboriginals and low Hindu castes in Chota Nagpur and Orissa, and is also practised to a certain extent in Bihar, is that which is sometimes called the levirate. Levirate is the designation of the Jewish custom by which a dead man's brother had to marry his widow, in order that he might continue his line—raise up seed to him, as it is commonly called.* The first son begotten by him succeeded to the dead man's property. This is a misnomer as applied to the Hindu custom by which a widow may be married to one of her husband's younger brothers. It must be a younger brother, and there is no idea that such a marriage is necessary in order that he may act as a kind of substitute for the dead man and produce offspring. In fact, he may marry the widow even though she already has sons, and he need not necessarily be a bachelor or a widower. The idea is that the woman belongs to the husband's family because they have paid the bride-price, and that her property must remain in the family. This idea is translated into practice by some castes and races. Among the Santals a younger brother who takes the widow as his wife (or co-wife if he has already been married), does not go through any marriage ceremony and no bride-price is paid, as they say they have already paid for her and she belongs to the family. Among the Hos and other castes, if either the younger brother or

* *Cf.* Deuteronomy, XXV, 5—10: "If brethren dwell together, and one of them die, and have no child, the wife of the dead shall not marry without unto a stranger: her husband's brother shall go in unto her, and take her to him to wife, and perform the duty of an husband's brother unto her. And it shall be, that the firstborn which she beareth shall succeed in the name of his brother which is dead, that his name be not put out of Israel. And if the man like not to take his brother's wife, then let his brother's wife go up to the gate unto the elders and say, My husband's brother refuseth to raise up unto his brother a name in Israel; he will not perform the duty of my husband's brother. Then the elders of his city shall call him, and speak unto him: and if he stand to it, and say, I like not to take her, then shall his brother's wife come unto him in the presence of the elders, and loose his shoe from off his foot, and spit in his face, and shall answer and say, So shall it be done unto that man that will not build up his brother's house. And his name shall be called in Israel, the house of him that hath his shoe loosed."

the widow refuse to marry, and she marries some one else, her husband has to refund the bride price originally paid for her. Among the Gandas, the second husband of the woman is outcasted, if he fails to pay. Among the Binjhals the second husband has ordinarily to pay Rs. 5, five *kulas* of rice (a *kula* is a basket, which holds about ten seers) and five goats as a fine to the caste people, which are utilized for a feast. If a Binjhal marries the widow with the consent of the *debar* (husband's younger brother), he has to give a feast on a much smaller scale, one *kula* of rice and one goat being considered sufficient.

The marriage between the widow and her husband's younger brother is in any case not obligatory as among the Jews. Either may refuse the marriage, though among castes with whom the practice is in vogue it is generally recognized that it is the proper thing for her to consent. Still it is not absolutely incumbent on her: the caste people will not force such a marriage on her, though they will try their best to obtain her consent. If she does marry him, she retains the privilege of preparing offerings of milk, cakes, etc., for the gods and the ancestors, and of participating in other ceremonies, which she loses if she marries out of the family. Should both parties consent, the ceremony is of the same simple nature as at an ordinary widow marriage. In Orissa if the younger brother is a bachelor, he is first married to a flower before the ceremony is performed, just as he would in the case of any other widow.

646. The only locality where the Jewish conception of the levirate appears to be implicitly understood is Orissa, where the practice is known as *Devarinasutoputti*, *i.e.*, begetting a son through the husband's younger brother. This idea perhaps accounts for a curious modification of the custom which prevailed in Orissa over a century ago, by which a man could marry his brother's wife during a prolonged absence. Mr. Motte, in describing his journey through Balasore in 1766, wrote :—

"From this part of Orissa come all that people improperly called by the English Balasore bearers—a circumstance which contributes in some measure to the depopulation of the country. Seven thousand of the stoutest young fellows go into Bengal, and are employed as chairmen, leaving their families behind. These people stretch the Levitical law so, that a brother not only raises up seed to another after his decease, but even during his absence on service, so that no married woman lies fallow."[3]

At the present time, if a husband has gone to Bengal or elsewhere for work and has been absent for two or three years, his wife can re-marry, and her choice is not confined to her brother-in-law. She is married as a widow, the bridegroom presenting her with some ornaments, including the indispensable *bala* or bracelet. Sometimes also a feast is given to a limited number of the castemen. Strictly speaking, the woman commits bigamy, but though she is looked down upon by the society to which she belongs, the union is generally recognized as a marriage. Another instance of the demoralizing effect of emigration is seen in Saran, where illegitimate births and the abandonment of illegitimate children are far more common than elsewhere. This seems to be a direct result of the absence of the husband or head of the family.

MOCK MARRIAGES.

647. A mock marriage is the preliminary to the real marriage among the Bagdis. Early on the wedding morning, before the bridegroom starts in procession for the bride's house, he goes through a mock marriage to a *mahua* tree. He embraces the tree and bedaubs it with vermilion ; his right wrist is bound to it with thread, and, after he is released from the tree, this same thread is used to attach a bunch of a *mahua* leaves to his wrist. Among the Kharwars not only the bridegroom but also the bride goes through the form of marriage to a mango tree, or at least to a branch of the tree, as a preliminary to marriage. The Kurmis of Chota Nagpur make the parties marry different trees, each separately in their houses on the wedding morning. The bride marries

[3] T. Motte, *Narrative of a Journey to the Diamond Mines at Sumbhulpoor*, Asiatic Annual Register, 1799.

a *mahua* and the bridegroom a mango. The bride wears on her right wrist a bracelet of the leaves of the *mahua*, walks round the tree seven times, has her right hand and right ear tied to the tree with thread, and is made to chew *mahua* leaves. The same ritual is performed by the bridegroom, with the difference that in his case the tree is a mango, and is circled nine times instead of seven. The same practice of marrying the bride to a *mahua* and bridegroom to a mango tree before the marriage procession starts prevails among the Mahilis. In Nepal Newar girls are married when children to a *bel* fruit, which is thrown into some sacred river after the ceremony: they are afterwards married to husbands when puberty is attained. In all these cases the marriage to a tree merely precedes the real marriage and is symbolical. It is a survival of a more primitive type of society, and its *raison d'etre* is probably the belief that all possible misfortunes in married life are transferred to the tree, which acts as a kind of scapegoat.

648. A different motive inspires the mock marriage of girls who otherwise would have the stigma of attaining puberty without being wed. To avoid this, the Gonr sub-caste of Kandus in Bihar marry to a sword any girl who is unlikely to find a husband by reason of physical defects. The full marriage ceremony is performed, the caste Brahman officiates as priest, and red lead is smeared on the girl's forehead with the point of the sword. A girl so married wears ornaments, bedaubs the parting of her hair with red lead, and in every respect demeans herself as a married woman, though living in her father's house. In the event of her afterwards procuring a husband, the entire ceremony is performed afresh.* Such marriages are especially common in Orissa, where the girl is married to a flower or an arrow or a tree, if she is on the point of attaining puberty and a husband can be got for her. Among some castes, such as the Sahars, if a girl has through some mischance attained maturity before being married to an arrow, she is tied to a tree in a jungle. It is uncertain whether the idea underlying this is that she is married to the tree or that she is exposed to wild beasts or left as a prize for the first-comer. Sometimes the family avoid the shame of having an adult spinster in the house by giving her in marriage to an old man, who acts as husband *pro formâ*. His claim to keep her as a wife is not recognized, and if a chance of marrying her comes, she is married as if she was a widow. The following account of the ceremony among the Chasas may be taken as typical. The priest binds the girl's hand to the arrow with some *kush* grass. The girl venerates the arrow during her lifetime and never mentions it, just as she would never mention the name of a real husband. If a suitor presents himself afterwards, her marriage is *dwitva*, the same name as is given to the re-marriage of a real widow. The marriage is, moreover, like that of an ordinary widow, for the bridegroom need not attend the marriage, but may send his younger brother, who puts a bangle on the bride's wrist. A third class of mock marriage is performed when a bachelor marries a widow, of which an account has already been given.

649. The performance of a marriage ceremony is recognized as a necessary rite even by prostitutes whose life is the negation of marriage. In Bengal a girl who is intended for a life of shame goes through a form of marriage before or as soon as she reaches puberty. She is married either to a man, or to a plant, or to a sword or a knife. The man is generally an imbecile, but sometimes a Baishnab is hired to act as a bridegroom, or a prostitute's son takes the part. In any case, he is a husband *pro formâ* only and goes away after the marriage. A regular marriage ceremony is, however, performed by a low Brahman, if, as sometimes happens, one can be secured, or by a Baishnab priest, while a Mullah officiates among Musalmans. The ceremony is also performed if the girl is married to a plant (*e.g.*, a jasmine or rose), or a plantain tree, or a sword or a knife—a sword or knife is invariably selected by Muhammadan prostitutes, while a plant is preferred by Hindus. The symbolism is carried so far that the plant is carefully watered and the sword is kept locked up in a box, in the belief that if the one dies or the other is lost

MARRIAGE AMONG PROSTITUTES.

* Tribes and Castes of Bengal, Vol. I, p. 415.

the girl becomes a widow. In fact, when the plant dies, she wipes off the vermilion smeared on her head and removes the iron bangle from her wrist just as if she was a widow. One correspondent reports that a prostitute was married to a cat "with great *eclat*" at Chinsura about 40 years ago, but no other instance of prostitutes marrying animals has been traced, and this appears to have been an exceptional case. Sometimes, it is said, the bridegroom is represented by the image of a man made of *sola* pith. No such ceremonies appear to be in vogue in Bihar, where what is called the *nathuni*, or nose-ring ceremony, merely means a feast and the handing over of the girl to some lover, who pays a high price for robbing her of her virginity. In Orissa, as soon as a young prostitute attains puberty, she goes through a rite of which the essential feature appears to be the worship of the sun. The girl holds up a handful of mustard seed and invokes the sun to grant her as many lovers as the seeds she has in her hands. The accounts of this rite vary. One correspondent reports that the worship of the sun is followed by a ceremony in which the girl is formally married to an arrow; another that a Brahman officiates during the sun worship, after which he performs *homa*. This being concluded, the girl is taken to the nearest temple for worship. In the evening other prostitutes come to her house, give her presents, put vermilion on her forehead, etc., and a feast takes place. Whatever the ceremony, the underlying idea is that a form of marriage is essential to remove the shame of remaining unwed when puberty is once attained.

DIVORCE.

650. Divorce is allowed for adultery or misconduct, and sometimes also for barrenness and incurable diseases; it is generally symbolized by breaking the iron bangle which is the insignia of a married woman or by tearing some leaves in pieces. Among some castes the consent of the Panchayat is necessary before a divorce can be effected; and among the Gandas of Sambalpur the consent of the Sethia or headman used to be necessary before a divorced woman was remarried. Fees were paid to him for his consent, and he was practically the owner of the women, selling them to their suitors and pocketing the proceeds.

It is rarely that a woman has the right to divorce her husband, but this privilege is enjoyed by the Newar women in Nepal. According to Colonel KIRKPATRICK, a century ago Newar women were at liberty to divorce one man after another on the slightest pretence; and they still leave their husbands and marry again if their marriage proves uncongenial. The only intimation necessary before the woman leaves the house is that she should place two betel nuts in her bed. She is then free to choose another husband. At the same time, provided that she only cohabits with a man of her own or of a higher caste, she can, whenever she pleases, return to the house of her first husband and resume charge of his family.* This practice of divorcing husbands is said to be falling into desuetude among the Newars of Darjeeling. Among the Musalmans of the Purnea district the marriage tie appears not to be so binding as elsewhere. If a woman is discontented with her husband, she can go to the *hat* or village market and pick out a man that she wants to marry—naturally, he is a man with whom she had already been on terms of intimacy. All that she has to do is to throw some *murki* (fried paddy mixed with molasses) on him. Thereby she divorces her husband and is lawfully married to the man of her choice. Among the Santals also a woman can demand a divorce if her husband takes a second wife without her consent.

CONCUBINAGE.

651. In Orissa concubinage prevails to such an extent, that it is a recognized institution to which little or no discredit attaches. Formerly it was so widely prevalent, especially among the Karans, that it has given rise to a caste, known as Shagirdpesha, numbering over 46,000. It has long been the practice among the Chiefs, Rajas and large zamindars for the bridegroom to receive a number of maid servants, who are young unmarried girls, as presents from his father-in-law at the time of marriage. The number is often very great, running up to 50 or 60, while one Raja had 100 concubines. These girls have a recognized position in the household. A

* Imperial Gazetteer, Article on Nepal.

separate room is allotted to each, and they are given a daily allowance of food from the zamindar's store-room, which they cook themselves. A few only, who are favourites of the Rani, are allowed to take their food from her kitchen. "Almost all the Rajas and big zamindars", writes one correspondent, "insist on having and get young unmarried girls as presents when they marry. The greater the number, the greater the *eclat* of the occasion. These girls are maids of all work, and the more handsome among them share the beds of their mistresses' husbands. This practice goes further in some cases, and it is not uncommon that, at the time of marriage, one or more of these girls are honoured with a garland and the girl so honoured is called Phul Bai and receives treatment almost on a par with that of the Pat Rani or principal wife." The custom is falling into desuetude with the advance of education and the raising of ethical standards. The example set by that enlightened ruler, the late Maharaja of Mayurbhunj, has had not a little to do with the result, for he would not allow any such presents to be given at his marriage and was the first to protest against the practice.

POLYANDRY.

652. Polyandry may be of two kinds, viz., matriarchal, where a woman marries several men who are not related to each other, and fraternal, where brothers have a common wife. Fraternal polyandry only is found in this part of India, where it is practised by the Bhotias, and, in a modified form, by the Santals. Property among both races descends through the male and not through the female, as is the custom where maternal polyandry is in vogue. The rules regulating cousin marriage among the Bhotias of Sikkim are probably connected with the institution of fraternal polyandry. There it is not considered right that a man should marry his cousin on his father's side, though recently there have been a few cases where a man has married his father's sister's daughter. He may marry his cousin on his mother's side, whether the daughter of his mother's brother or of his mother's sister. The reason given is that the bone descends from the father's side and the flesh from the mother's. Should cousins on the paternal side marry, it is said that the bone is pierced, resulting in course of time in various infirmities. The Santals so far practise fraternal polyandry that a man's younger brothers have a recognized right to intercourse with his wife; they must, however, observe a certain amount of decency and not make too open a display of their relations. According to the Rev. L. O. Skrefsrud, the younger brothers formerly enjoyed this privilege even after they were married, but at present the wife is usually common property only while they are unmarried.

POLYGAMY.

653. Polygamy is recognized as admissible, but is generally prohibited by its expense or inconvenience, for few men can afford more than one wife or bear the domestic discord that the presence of two or more wives entails. Marrying more than one wife is, moreover, regarded by the better classes of Hindus as disreputable, unless a man's wife is barren, or has not borne him a son who will secure his salvation after death, or suffers from some incurable disease. Among the Sauria Paharias, or Maler, of the Sonthal Parganas polygamy is not only a recognized institution, but is regulated by definite rules. A man may marry five or six wives, and may even marry five or six sisters, provided he marries the eldest sister first and she consents to his marrying the others. He must marry the sisters in order of age, and, if already married to a younger sister, may not take an elder sister to wife. The first wife is the chief wife, and all others are her subordinates. The wives live in the same house. At night the husband sleeps in the centre, and the wives occupy beds on either side. In case of his having intercourse with a younger wife without the consent of the elder wife, he is liable to punishment by the Panchayat. For the first offence he is let off with a warning, but if he persists, he is fined.* The Santal's relations with his wife's younger sisters are probably a survival of the same kind of polygamy. He commonly enjoys their favours, and if one of them becomes pregnant, he must make her his wife. Such intimacy is not resented by his wife. On the contrary, she countenances and sometimes encourages it, though Santal wives are usually

* R. B. Bainbridge, *The Saorias of the Rajmahal Hills*, Memoirs of the Asiatic Society of Bengal, Vol. II, No. 4, 1907.

extremely jealous. A Santal uncle also commonly has sexual intercourse with his wife's nieces, this being a recognized privilege of his.

654. As is well known, polygamy was formerly common among the Kulin Brahmans. Vidyasagar mentions five men, resident in the same village, of ages varying from 20 to 70, who had an aggregate of 230 wives ; the minimum number was 16, the husband in this case being only 20 years old, and the maximum was 62. The practice is dying out and the Kulins are becoming monogamous with the spread of education and a higher ethical standard. It is not yet, however, extinct : a Bengali gentleman informs me of three cases within his own knowledge in which 60, 8 and 4 wives have been married. The first two cases occurred in the last generation, while the third occurred in this generation, the gentleman concerned being a M. A. and B. L. Polygamy is also practised by the Maithil Brahmans, though it is falling into disfavour. It has given rise to a class called Bikauwas or vendors, who derive their name from the practice of selling themselves, or their minor sons, to girls belonging to lower groups. Some have as many as 40 or 50 wives, who live with their parents and are visited at intervals by their husbands. This form of polygamy is due to hypergamy, *i.e.*, the practice by which a man marries his daughter to a member of a higher group in the caste.

PECULIAR CUSTOMS.

655. It is the usual custom for a Hindu bride to be married in her parent's house and to stay there till the marriage is consummated, when she finally goes to her husband's house. Among the Rajbansis, however, the bride goes to the bridegroom's house to be married. Until very recently it was the custom for the bride to be carried to the bridegroom's house on the back of her sister's husband ; but they have now given up this custom as degrading. Another curious custom among them is that when a marriage takes place the bridegroom's sister's husband has the privilege of sitting near the altar and of erecting plantain trees round it. Among the Bediyas in Jessore a girl when married does not go to live in her husband's family. A separate loft (*tong*) in the compound of the bride's father's house is allotted to the couple, or the bride's father gives them a boat to live in, if the family live on the waters.

The Koltas of Orissa have a unique custom, viz., that when the marriage of an eldest son or eldest girl is celebrated, the parents themselves have to go through a ceremony of remarriage (called *sup-bibaha*), which the child is not allowed to see. Possibly this is an expedient to ward off any insinuations as to the illegitimacy of their first child, or it may be a relic of a time when the couple began to live together informally, the ceremony being performed subsequently in order to legitimize their offspring. Among the Binjhals a man takes a wife when he succeeds to a zamindari, even though he may be married already. The new wife is the Pat Rani or principal wife.

In Sambalpur one peculiar ceremony is performed at the time of marriage by all classes. Before it takes place, some married women of the bridegroom's household go out at night to a river or tank and fill a *lota* with water. They take it to seven other households and ask them to give some water in exchange for some of that in the *lota*. By the time they get back, the water has become a mixture of water from seven houses. With this the bridegroom is bathed on the day of marriage, and is thereby purged of his unmarried state. A similar ceremony is performed in the house of the bride. With this may be compared the practice of Pokhra Khandai, which is observed by the Tharus and Tikulihars of Champaran. Formerly rich men celebrated their daughters' marriages by having tanks dug, water from which was used in the ceremony. The bride's father took water and grain in his hand and gave them to the bridegroom, saying "I give these to you with my daughter." The only survival of this practice now consists in the bride's and bridegroom's sisters' husbands having to dig earth. They also have to fry grain, this custom being called Lawa Bhunjai. It is said that formerly the celebration of marriages, and other religious and social ceremonies, began with the offering of sacrifices to fire, the oblations consisting of grain. The grain, after being parched by the bride's and the bridegroom's sisters' husbands, is mixed together, and the bride and bridegroom both eat it. Another curious ceremony is found among

the Mundas. When the bridegroom's procession arrives near the house or village of the bride, it is met by a procession from the bride's house. When the two processions meet, the mothers or the aunts (either paternal or maternal) of the bride and bridegroom advance with pitchers of water in their hands. Then they sprinkle water on one another with mango leaves, and, after washing one another's feet, embrace.

BIRTH CUSTOMS.

656. THE treatment of women and children at child-birth in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa is generally regulated by the Sasthi system, which is so called because the worship of Sasthi, the tutelary goddess of young children and of women at child-birth, is an essential feature in it.

TREATMENT AT CHILD-BIRTH. SASTHI SYSTEM.

The expectant mother is taken to a lying-in room (*sutika ghar*) shortly before delivery. The character of the room depends on the means and enlightenment of the family, but generally it is one of the worst rooms in the house, or a shed is erected outside in the compound. Among the poorer classes, the woman's accommodation is wretched. A portion of one of the living rooms may be screened off, or she may have to use the verandah; some doctors even state that the cowshed or kitchen is occasionally used. As a rule, when a separate room is assigned, it is small, dark and ill-ventilated. Bad as the ventilation would naturally be, the perflation of air is often absolutely impossible owing to windows and apertures being closed with mud or stuffed with rags; this is done in order to prevent the mother and child catching cold, or because of a superstitious belief that it is necessary to keep out evil spirits. The outside shed, moreover, is often damp, and no attempt is made to admit the sunshine. Among the better castes, the mother is regarded as impure, after giving birth to a child, for 30 days, if it is a girl, and 21 days if it is a boy, and among some of the lower castes for 6 or 12 days. It would therefore be out of the question to furnish the room, and her bedding is poor and meagre. She generally has some straw or an old torn mat to lie on, though sometimes a charpoy or *taktaposh* is allowed. A quilt made of dirty old rags serves as a coverlet, while her head rests on a dirty pillow or even a brick. However hot the weather, a fire is kept burning in the room day and night for at least five and, sometimes, as long as 21 days. The belief is that, unless the room is kept at a high temperature, the child will be an invalid or liable to catch cold all his or her life, while the mother will get pneumonia or typhoid. The more ignorant believe that the fire has magic power to save mother and child from the influence of evil spirits. Sometimes, however, the child is suffocated by the acrid fumes: all the same, its death is put down to malevolent demons. For the first five days at least, the mother is at the mercy of a low-caste midwife, who is called *agani* in some parts of Bengal, as it is her duty to keep up the fire (*agni*). No male may enter the room and the women of her family may not touch her: if they do, they have to be purified by a bath before resuming their household duties. No doctor can attend on her because of her impure state—this of course is not the case with the educated classes. In Orissa, should it be necessary to seek medical advice, a drop or two of oil that the young mother has touched is put into water, and the *kabiraj* or doctor makes his diagnosis from the way it floats and prescribes accordingly.

Heat is believed to be necessary for a speedy recovery. In addition to the warmth of the fire, the mother and child have hot dry fomentations, and the child after being rubbed with mustard oil is laid out in the sun for hours at a time: this is believed in some places to strengthen the cranial bones. Cold drinks are prohibited, as it is thought that they may bring on suppuration of the womb. Water is either not given at all or very sparingly for the first few days: in any case it is warm or tepid. To keep up her strength, the mother is given a concoction of which the main ingredients are hot spices, such as pepper and ginger, and warm *ghi*; when she can digest solid food, she eats fried rice (*chura*) and fried garlic.

On the fifth or sixth day the woman and child have a bath, and she is sometimes allowed to change her room. In any case the lying-in room is cleaned—not too soon, as in many parts the ashes of the fire are allowed to remain as they are till this day, while the sweepings of the floor and the dirty foul-smelling clothes are kept in a corner. The practice in this respect is not uniform, for the room is very often carefully cleaned soon after delivery. In Midnapore, it is reported that, after a child is born, the mother has to pass her hands and feet over some burning straw: the ashes of the straw, her soiled clothes and other refuse, a comb with a few strands of her hair, and a little turmeric, which has been rubbed on her left arm, are put into a pot, which is kept in a corner of the room and serves as a receptacle for refuse till this day.*

657. The sixth day is a very important one, as it is the day of the worship of Sasthi, which means "the goddess of the sixth." In the evening, a representation of the goddess is made with cowdung (or in some places, of earth), in which some cowries are stuck. This is placed on the wall of the lying-in room, with a pot of water and some mango-leaves before it, and worshipped by the family. On the night of this day, it is believed, the Creator writes the destiny of the child on its forehead in indelible characters. An inkpot and pen are therefore placed ready for use at the door of the room. The antiquity of the practice is evident from the fact that an iron stylus and palm-leaves are frequently provided. When the sixth day is over, there is rejoicing, as the first six days are a critical period for tetanus—that common cause of death among infants, the umbilical cord being generally cut with dirty instruments (*e.g.*, a split bamboo or a conch-shell) and cowdung ashes applied to the freshly-cut end. It is believed to be caused by evil spirits, who are specially apt to attack both mother and child during her confinement. To protect them, various devices are adopted. The skull of a cow smeared with vermilion, with cowries stuck in the sockets of the eyes and, in some places, with a red rag across the horns, is frequently, but not invariably, placed on the outside wall of the room to drive them away. Iron is also commonly employed to ward off their attacks. In some places, an iron sickle or sword is placed under the mother's bed,† or a sword, spear or other iron weapon is stuck up at the door, or several iron articles are hung up over it, *e.g.*, an iron spade, hoe, harrow and axe. Old shoes and bits of old net, or thorny twigs, are also suspended over the door, and sometimes the father fires off a gun in the belief that the noise will scare away the evil spirits.

The ceremonies observed by Maithil Brahmans in the Sonthal Parganas have several peculiar features. As soon as a child is born, straight lines about five inches long are drawn on the walls of the room, five for a daughter and ten for a son. On the sixth day, milk is sprinkled upon the head of the mother and the new-born babe. This must be done by the sister-in-law of the woman: ethnologists may be able to account for the choice of the latter. In the evening, the worship of Sasthi takes place. A square is painted on the walls, in the centre of which is a figure of Sasthi. To this figure the family make obeisance, and a feast is held to which friends are invited. The figure remains on the wall for six months, after which it is washed out with cow's milk

KRISHNA SYSTEM OR HARILOT.

658. Another method of treatment is known as the Krishna or Satya-narayan system, or as Harilot. It is mostly followed by Vaishnava families, though not confined to them, *e.g.*, it is resorted to when women have had still-births. It is a more rational method, and is accompanied by fewer restrictions about food and drink. No fire is kept burning in the room; no *jhal* or concoctions of spices are administered. The woman is allowed cooling drinks, and given ordinary food. She is not regarded as unclean, and need not therefore be banished to an outhouse and left to the midwife's mercies, but is attended

* This is not a universal practice; in some households the pot is thrown away at once.

† A cure for cramp is said to consist in placing a common iron key at the foot of a bed [Chapman's Biochemistry, p. 98].

by women of the household during the period of her confinement. She and the child are also bathed in cold or tepid water soon after delivery. This system is so called, because the regime is determined by resignation to the will of God, and because Hari (Vishnu) is worshipped by the mother a few days after the birth of her child. She makes obeisance to the *tulsi* plant, takes a little holy earth from the place where it grows, and presents sweetmeats to the god with prayer. Sweetmeats are also distributed to children. This system is rarely followed, but is gaining popularity among the more enlightened Bengalis.

REINCARNATION IN THE SAME FAMILY.

659. The Hindus believe that, when a man dies, his spirit hovers as a *preta* in the sky for one year, during which it is provided with food and drink every month in what is called the *Masika Sraddha*. At the end of the year, *Sraddha* is performed, the effect of which is that the spirit joins the spirits of his ancestors in the *Pitriloka*, or heaven of the *Pitris*, and there becomes a participator in the *Sraddha* offerings, more particularly of the funeral cakes (*pinda*). This belief precludes the idea that the spirits of the departed are reborn in the same family. If, however, an infant is born within one year of the death of a member of the family, it is generally thought that the spirit of the departed has come back. Sometimes also, if a child shows extraordinary precocity, he or she is regarded as a reincarnation of an ancestor. A correspondent inform me that a daughter of his, aged only 4 years old, when on the point of death, begged that she might be taken to the bank of the Ganges. Her last request was granted and she died on the riverside crying "Ma Ganga," "Ma Ganga." This knowledge of the Hindu religion by a child of such tender years was so extraordinary, that all the villagers were convinced that the spirit of the child was that of her grandmother, who had died ten years before.

660. There appears to be an express or implicit belief among some aboriginal tribes that souls return to animate human beings in the same family. It is a general belief among the Khonds that the souls of deceased persons (*pidari*) return to animate human bodies, but such persons must have been married, or at least have had sexual intercourse, during their lifetime. The souls of unmarried persons cannot enter the circle of family spirits, but are malevolent spirits, causing fever, ague, apoplexy, etc. Those of married people animate the fœtus as soon as it is fully formed. The souls of old people are believed to possess similar powers even before their death. It is also said that if an expectant mother sees one of the ancestors in her dreams, the fœtus is then endued with life, and begins to move in the womb. The soul of a dead man may animate two or more persons at the same time or in different generations.

In a report by Captain MacPherson, dated the 10th July 1844, regarding the practice of female infanticide amongst the Khonds, it is stated—"The Khonds believe that souls almost invariably return to animate human forms in the families in which they have been first born and received. But the reception of the soul of an infant into a family is completed only on the performance of the ceremony of naming upon the seventh day after its birth. The death of a female infant, therefore, before that ceremonial of reception is believed to exclude its soul from the circle of family spirits, diminishing by one the chance of future female births in the family. And, as the first aspiration of every Khond is to have male children, this belief is a powerful incentive to infanticide." Inquiry shows that there is no belief among the Khonds at the present time that the ceremony of receiving a child into the family on the seventh day after birth confers the privilege of re-entering the family at some future time. This power is acquired only when the child has become an adult and been married. The explanation is probably that, as it would be improper to destroy a child after it had been given a welcome in the family circle, it became the practice to destroy female children before the ceremony was performed.

661. Among the Chakmas and Maghs, when a child is born, its body is carefully examined to see if it has any red or black spot. If such a spot is found and it corresponds with the mark made with sandal-wood paste on the dead body of a relation, it is thought that that relation has been reincarnate

in the child. Further, if a dead man appears in a dream, and a son is born shortly afterwards, he is considered to be a reincarnation of the dead man. The Gonds also believe that a man can be born again in his family. His soul is brought back to the house on the fifth day after death. His relations go to the side of a river or stream and call him by name, after which they catch a fish or an insect and take it home. There they either place it in a room reserved for the spirits of dead ancestors or eat it in the belief that the dead man will again be born in the family.

662. The practice of naming children after ancestors also seems to point to a belief in the conservation of spirits in the same family. This is clearly expressed in the ceremony attending the naming of children among the Khonds. A Guru is called on the seventh day after its birth to discover by divination which of the ancestors has animated the new-born child. To make sure that the Guru has made no mistake, the child is placed on a new piece of cloth after having been bathed and fed. Should it fall asleep, it is a sign that the correct name has been discovered. If there has been a mistake, the ancestral spirit will show its disapproval by keeping the child awake and causing it to cry; the Guru is thereupon required to make another attempt at divination. The Santals also name their children after ancestors. The eldest son takes the name of his paternal grandfather, a second son that of his maternal grandfather, a third son that of the paternal grandfather's brother, the fourth son that of the maternal grandfather's brother, etc. A similar custom is observed in the case of girls, the names of relations on the female side being taken in the same order. Among the Bhuiyas the name of the grandfather is given to the eldest son, that of the great-grandfather to the second son, and then the names of collateral relatives according to seniority. A similar custom of naming children after ancestors prevails among the Hos, who have a method of divination like that of the Khonds to ascertain which name should be given. They repeat the name of the ancestors in turn and as each is mentioned, drop a grain of pulse (*urid*) in water; if the grain sinks, it shows that the proper name has been selected, if it floats, they go on till the right name is found.

The Hos have no idea of reincarnation, though it is believed that the spirits of the dead return to the house. Seven days after death the spirit is solemnly recalled. Ashes are spread on the floor of the house and four women sit at the corners, while the family and their guests sit near the door outside and invoke the spirit. Two go out and call to the *bongas* or evil spirits, praying that if any have taken the deceased, they will allow him to come back. The house is kept dark, and suddenly the women cry out "The spirit has come." They then light a lamp and look for the marks the spirit has left on the ashes. Some spirits leave the footprints of birds, some of snakes, others of cats, others of dogs. These footmarks show whether the spirit is happy or not. The greatest happiness is indicated by the footprints of birds, then of cats and then of dogs. The mark of a snake, however, shows that the spirit is in great misery. After this, the spirit is supposed to remain in an invisible form in the house, and a space is set aside for him in the inner room (*adina*), which no one but members of the family may enter.

NAMING OF CHILDREN.

663. Among Hindus every child has generally two names. One is the ordinary name by which the child is known to the outside world. The other is the *rashi nam*, *i.e.*, a name containing the first letter of the *rashi* or sign (division of the zodiac) under which the child was born. This name, which is given at the *annaprasan* ceremony about six months after birth, is known only to the nearest relations and is used only in religious ceremonies. It is sedulously kept secret from the public on account of a superstitious belief that mischief can be done to the child through it. Many also have a third name, which is only used in the family or among relations and friends. The *rashi* name is frequently chosen by a species of divination. Two or more names are written out, and each is placed before a lamp; the name before the lamp that burns brightest is chosen. The upper classes frequently name children after gods or goddesses and mythological heroes, the idea being that the children will be protected by the deities, or will grow up to be great or famous like the heroes or heroines

whose names they bear. There is also an idea that virtue is acquired by mentioning the name of a god or goddess in addressing a child. Now-a-days such names are not so frequently given, but melodious or poetical names, *e.g.*, Jyothsna (moonshine) for a girl.

Among the low castes names are selected more or less at random. A child may be named after the day of the week on which it was born, *e.g.*, Sombari (born on Monday), or the name may mark some physical peculiarity, or it may even be the designation of some common article.

Among the Bhuiyas of the Orissa States the name of the grandfather is generally given to the eldest son, that of the great-grandfather to the second son, and then the names of collataral relatives according to seniority; but it is not unusual to give a name that commemorates some incident or event that happened on the day of the child birth. Thus, if the child is born on the anniversary of a festival, he may be called after it, *e.g.*, as Dasahara. If a European happens to pass through the village on the day of a child's birth, the child will be named Saheb or Gora (white man), while, if it is visited by a Musalman, a dealer, a peon or a constable, the child's name wil lbe Pathan, Mahajan, Chaprasi or Sipahi (sepoy) as the case may be*.

664. If women have failed to bear children before, or if their children have been still-born or have died shortly after birth, opprobrious names are given in the belief that this will avert the evil eye or fail to attract the god of death. Such names as Tinkauri and Panchkauri are supposed to mean that the child is worth not more than three or five cowries. Similar names are Sachunia (the broomstick), Kangalia (the poor), Haran (the lost one) and the like. A boy needing special divine protection is often named Haribola. Superstitious parents will not disclose the names to outsiders and use such terms as Meghar Bap (father of Megha), Tukir Ma (mother of Tuki), etc. In Orissa there are often fictitious sales of children in order to save them from a premature death. The parents sell them at a small price to women belonging to such low castes as Dhoba, Hari, Dom or Ghasi, and repurchase them at a higher price. There is an actual, though momentary, transfer, for the children are handed over to the low caste woman, who gives them back to the parents after anointing them with turmeric powder mixed with water and oil. Similar sham sales are effected at the shrines of gods and goddesses, the priests in this case being the buyers. Among the middle and low classes children are named after the caste of the women to whom they are sold, so that a boy may be called Dhobai, Hari, Pan, Ghasia or Dom, and a girl Dhobani, Hariani, etc. Such names are often given too by parents without any fictitious sale. The belief underlying these transactions is that the parents have committed some sin which can only be expiated by the death of the child and that the low caste woman takes the place of the parents and acts as a scapegoat.

DEATHS IN PREGNANCY.

665. If a pregnant woman dies before delivery, her womb is ripped open and the fœtus extracted. This gruesome task is performed by the husband himself at the burning ghat. The *raison d'etre* of the practice is said to be the hope of saving the life of the unborn child, but as it is postponed till the body is about to be cremated, this hope must be rarely, if ever, fulfilled. It is noticeable too that the fœtus is buried while the woman is burnt, and it is probable that the origin of the practice was to prevent the woman becoming an evil spirit and injuring the family. The Bhuiyas of the Orissa States burn the embryo and the corpse on opposite banks of a stream, the idea being that as no spirit can cross a stream, the mother is unable to become a witch without union with her child. In all other cases the Bhuiyas bury their dead. When a pregnant Oraon woman dies, her ankles are broken and her feet wrenched backward to prevent her spirit walking; a bundle of thorns and a heavy stone are also placed over her grave to prevent the spirit getting out.

RITES OF PREGNANCY.

666. As is well known, it is the duty of Hindus to observe twelve purificatory rites, called *Sanskaras*, beginning with conception and ending with marriage, which are

* L. E. B. Cobden-Ramsay, *Orissa States Gazetteer*, pp. 49, 50.

intended to purify a man from the taint transmitted through his parents. Three of these are rites of pregnancy, viz., *Garbhadhan*, *Punsavan* and *Simantonnayan*. *Garbhadhan* is a ceremony which should be observed at the first appearance of the menses and be followed by cohabitation. It is intended to consecrate impregnation, the idea being as stated by Monier Williams, that a husband, before approaching his wife, should secure the solemn imprimatur of religion on an act which may lead to the introduction of another human being into the world.* This ceremony is now rarely observed except by the thoroughly orthodox. Even those families who recognize it as obligatory consider that their duty is discharged by a symbolical performance, a gold ring being passed under the bride's clothes. *Punsavan* is a ceremony which should be observed three months after conception, and before the period of quickening, with the object of securing male offspring. *Homa* is performed, the sacred fire being kindled and libations made of *ghi*, rice, plantains, etc. The husband touches the navel of his wife with a piece of gold and utters certain *mantras* at the dictation of a priest, by which the blessings of the gods of fire, water, and air are invoked. This ceremony also is almost obsolete. *Simantonnayan* is a ceremony designed for the purification of the womb and the unborn child, which may be observed in the 4th, 6th or 8th month of pregnancy. The main feature of the ceremony is that the husband parts the hair of the head of his wife with certain articles sanctified according to Vedic rites. This is done only in the case of a first pregnancy, and has fallen into desuetude except in very orthodox families.

Certain other rites which are not *Sanskaras* are observed far more commonly. The first of these is *Panchamrita*, which takes place in the fifth month. A mixture is made of five *amritas*, viz., milk, curd, *ghi*, sugar and honey, which are purified with *mantras* by the priest and given to the pregnant woman to drink in order that the child may be born with a pure spirit and a healthy constitution. Female friends and neighbours are invited to be present, and are given a feast. In Eastern Bengal a similar ceremony, called *Saptamrita*, is held in the seventh month, and sometimes also in the ninth month, when it is called *Nabamrita*. A woman who is expecting her first child is also given a series of entertainments in order that she may keep up her spirits and that her child may have a happy disposition. The first of these is called *Kancha Sadh*; *sadh* means the desire or craving of a pregnant woman. It takes place in the fifth month when the fact of pregnancy is clear. She is given various articles of food to eat, such as sweetmeats, fruits, etc., on an auspicious day; there is general rejoicing in the family circle, and a feast is held to which friends are invited. From the seventh month till delivery, more entertainments are given which are called *Pakka Sadh*, or *Sadh-bhakshan*. The nearest female relatives are expected to entertain her in turn and present her with a new *sari*. She has to put this on before eating, and is given various dainties to eat. Children are invited to sit with her and to help her in doing justice to the good fare. A little boy (never a girl) first of all hands her a morsel of food in order that she may give birth to a male child. The object of these entertainments is to keep her bright and cheerful: incidentally she secures a good stock of *saris*, a new one being given to her on each occasion.

CAUSATION AND DETERMINATION OF SEX.

667. The desire of Hindu parents is naturally to have male children, and there are various beliefs regarding the measures necessary to obtain male offspring. The general idea is that the male element must be able to prevail over the female element, in other words, that there must be an abundance of semen. It is also believed that the male principle is strong on even and the female on odd days: consequently, intercourse on even days (from the 4th to the 16th day after the commencement of menstruation) will produce a male child, and on odd days a female child. Various devices are adopted in order to ascertain the sex of the child before birth. Sometimes a *ganak* or astrologer foretells it by drawing figures with a piece of chalk; to make his calculations, he must know the numbers of letters in the

* *Religious Life and Thought in India*, p. 355.

names of the wife and husband. and the month in which the pregnancy commenced. Another common method of divination is as follows. A stone pestle and an earthen plate or lamp are covered with two cane baskets. A small boy is asked to uncover one of the two. If the basket over the pestle is taken off, it is believed the child will be a male; otherwise, it will be a girl. Occasionally offerings are made under a banyan tree on the day before the *Simantonnayan* ceremony, and the husband takes a leaf off the tree. The edge of this is steeped in the juice of a plant called *kantikari* and held to the nose of the wife. If she sneezes, it is believed there is a male child in the womb and. if not, a female child. There are also, of course, ideas, which are common to women in many countries, that the sex of the child can be known from the position of the womb and the colour of the nipples, that if the expectant mother looks dark and thin during her pregnancy, the child will be a male, etc. Some women also think that if conception takes place in the bright half of the lunar month, it will result in the birth of a male child. and, if it occurs in the dark half. in the birth of a female.

RELATIONSHIP.

TERMS OF RELATIONSHIP.

668. Hindu females are debarred by custom from mentioning the names of their husbands and of their husbands' superior relatives, such as his father, his mother and his elder brother. Males do not, as a rule, mention the names of their daughters-in-law or of the wives of their brothers' or sisters' sons, but there is no strict rule on the subject as there is in the case of women. Orthodox women generally refer to their husbands' elder brothers and other superior relatives of their husbands by mentioning them as the "father of so and so." A husband, however, is usually called by his wife not the father of her son, but the son of her son, there being some superstitious objection to the use of the term "father" in connection with one's own husband. This, though the old custom, is not the universal practice, for in Calcutta and its neighbourhood women who have been educated not only call their husbands their son's fathers, but sometimes go further and actually call them by their names. Orthodox old-fashioned Hindu women not only never mention the names of their husbands and his near relatives, but also refrain from using words which are the same as or similar to those names. In order to avoid the difficulty arising out of this practice, curious devices are resorted to. Thus a woman, whose husband's name happens to be Madhu will, when speaking of honey (of which the word *madhu* is a Bengali equivalent), either refer to it in a round-about way by calling it *chakbhanga* (that which is taken out of the beehive) or transform it arbitrarily into Kadhu. Similarly, if the name of a husband's elder brother happens to be Panchu, the woman. in counting, will avoid the word *vanch* (five) because it bears a similarity to the name, and call it *nach* (a dance).

RESTRICTIONS.

669. Great respect is paid by Hindu women to their husbands' elder brothers, whom they may not even speak to. Among the Santals there are special restrictions on the relations between an elder brother and his younger brother's wife. They must not touch one another; they cannot enter the same room, or remain together in the courtyard, unless others are present. Should she come in from work in the fields, and find the elder brother sitting alone in the courtyard, she must remain in the village street, or in another verandah of the house, till some other people enter the house. As a rule, too, she must not sit down in his presence: should it be really necessary for her to do so, she must sit on a low stool.

A similar rule is observed by the Mundas. among whom the younger brother's wife is forbidden to mention the name of the elder brother, or to sit in his presence, or touch him. The husband is similarly forbidden to mention the name of his wife's elder sister or to touch her. *Baynal* is the name given by Oraons to relations subject to such restrictions. The Revd.

A. Grignard, S.J., of Tongo, in Ranchi, writes :—"A man is *baynalas*, and a woman is *baynali*, to his and her younger brother's wives : and the latter are *baynali* to them. Again, a woman is *baynali* to her younger sister's husband, and he is *baynalas* to her. Between persons of different sexes, this relationship imports that they must never remain alone together, never touch each other's things, never walk in one another's shadow. Except in cases of absolute necessity, they are not allowed to, and will not, speak to each other. If two married brothers have separate houses, and the elder of the two calls at the younger's but does not find him at home, he may, if pressed by hunger, ask his sister-in-law for a little rice, but he must do so from the door-step. She will listen with her back turned towards him, and the rice will be put out on the threshold. If the younger brother is at home, his sister-in-law will leave the place directly the elder brother enters. This family bar lasts as long as life ; and it will be upheld even with respect to, and by, a widow or widower rendered perfectly helpless by loneliness and malady. The relations of a man with his wife's younger sister, and of a woman with her husband's younger brother, are perfectly free from trammels and restraints. Between two females (*e.g.*, a woman and the younger brother's wife) the *baynal* relationship imports nothing beyond an exaggerated respect on the one side, and motherly love on the other."

Among Oriya castes, such as Sahars and Gandas, a woman will step aside and leave the road, out of respect, for her husband's elder brother, her husband's maternal uncle and her younger sister's husband, but not for her elder sister's husband. If a Gond woman and her husband's elder or younger brother's son sit together at a meal, she cannot leave her seat first, even if she has finished her meal, but must wait till the nephew rises.

THE MATERNAL UNCLE.

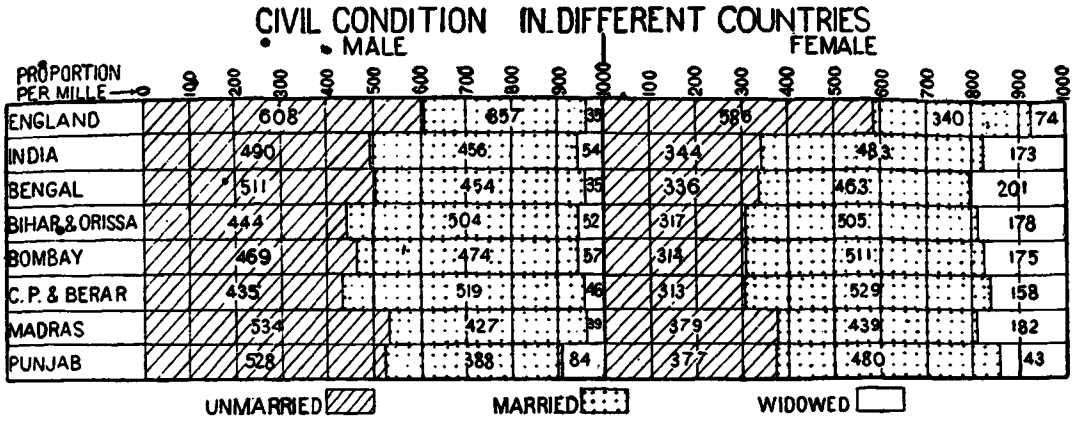
670. The maternal uncle plays an important part in the family life of many castes and tribes. At the time of *annaprasan*, which is an essential rite for Hindu children, he has the privilege of putting rice first into the child's mouth. At weddings many castes pay particular honour to the bride's maternal uncle, who receives special presents, this custom being known as *matul bidaya* or *matul byabahar*. Among the Oraons he cuts off the hair on a newly born babe's head. This must be done shortly after birth ; otherwise, the child would be boycotted for life. Young children are subject to fleshy excrescences of the scalp, which multiply and spread, developing into sores. Any such growth should be burnt, as soon as it appears, with a piece of heated turmeric ; but the operation cannot be a success unless performed by the child's maternal uncle. On the other hand, among the Gonds and Gandas of Orissa a curious respect is paid to sister's children (*bhania* and *bhani*) by the maternal uncle and his wife, who will even take the dust of their feet, in spite of the difference of age. The nephew and niece may not take any food left by the uncle and aunt, and the latter take care to sit at some distance from them while eating, for fear that there might be even accidental touching of the food or the plate. A maternal uncle will also give his daughter in marriage to his sister's son. Such a marriage (called *bhaniadan*) is looked upon as the most honourable form of marriage. The maternal uncle not only gives away his daughter, but also bears all the expenses of the marriage, provides the caste-feast, etc., and will not take anything from the bridegroom. Though *bhanjadan* is allowed, the reverse, *i.e.*, the marriage of a man's son with his sister's daughter, is not permissible.

PART II—STATISTICAL.*

UNIVERSALITY OF MARRIAGE.

671. As pointed out in 1901, the most striking fact brought out by the statistics of marriage is the universality of the institution, especially among females. The number of persons other than those suffering from some bodily or mental affliction, who go through life unmarried, is extremely small. In England over 60 per cent. of the males and 58 per cent. of the females, but in Bengal only 51 per cent. of the former and 34 per cent. of the latter are unmarried. In Bihar and Orissa

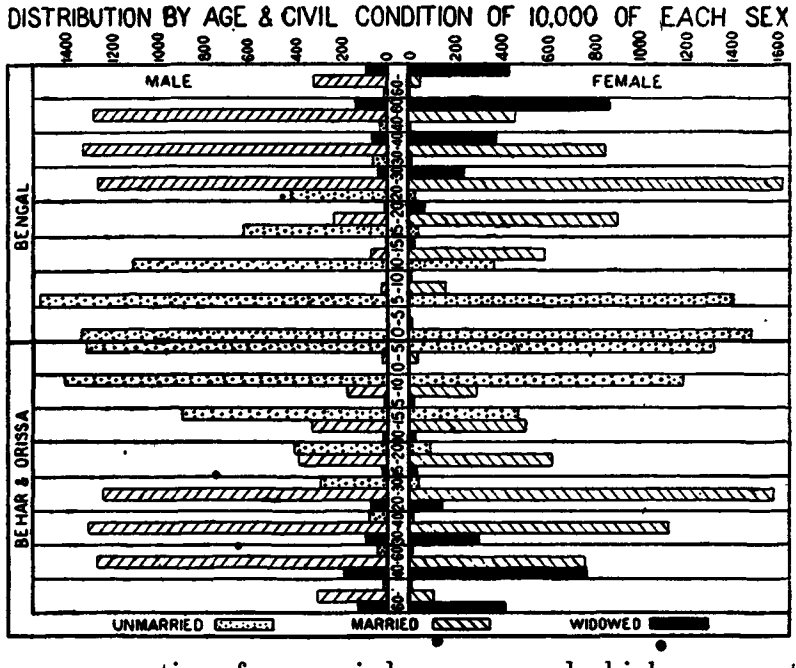
* This part has been written in collaboration with my Personal Assistant, Babu Naba Gauranga Basak, M.A., Deputy Magistrate and Deputy Collector.



the percentage is lower still, viz., 44 amongst males and 32 amongst females. In this latter province Hindus are in a strong majority, representing over four-fifths of the population, and, as is well known, it is a religious obligation for a Hindu to marry and beget a son, and also to get his daughters married before they attain puberty: the very name of son (*putra*) is due to the fact that he is the means of saving his father's soul from the hell called *put*. The universal prevalence of marriage among Hindus has had its effect on other sections of the community, for many have the same blood in their veins, being converts from Hinduism or the descendants of converts, while those who are on the border-line of Hinduism, and aspire to acknowledgement as Hindus, naturally emulate the example of orthodox Hindus. The prevalence of marriage is also, to a large extent, due to the fact that the prudential considerations of more advanced communities are not entertained. Apart from the price of a bride, it is no great expense for a man to take a wife, especially if he belongs to a joint family. Among the lower classes he has all the greater inducement to do so, because a wife is not only a domestic necessity but also a valuable helpmate, for she supplements the husband's income by work in the fields, etc.

CIVIL CONDITION BY AGE AND SEX.

672. The more prominent features of the statistics for age and sex are exhibited in Subsidiary Table I at the end of this chapter, and it is not proposed to mention in detail what can be more readily gathered from the tabular statement and the marginal diagram. Briefly, 45 per cent. of the males in Bengal and 50 per cent. in Bihar and Orissa are married, the corresponding ratio for females being 46 and 50½ respectively. The proportion of married persons is higher among females than among males up to the age period 20—30, and after that the reverse is the case. In all age periods females have a lower proportion of unmarried persons, and a higher proportion of widowed, than the male sex. It is further noticeable that females are in a strong majority among those who have contracted a marriage below the age of 20, and among the widowed at all ages. The cause is briefly that (1) husbands are generally older than their wives, the disparity of age being often considerable, (2) elderly men commonly marry, but rarely old spinsters, and (3) widowers re-marry more than widows: in a large section of the community widow re-marriage is strictly prohibited, but there is no bar on widowers marrying a second or even a third or fourth time.

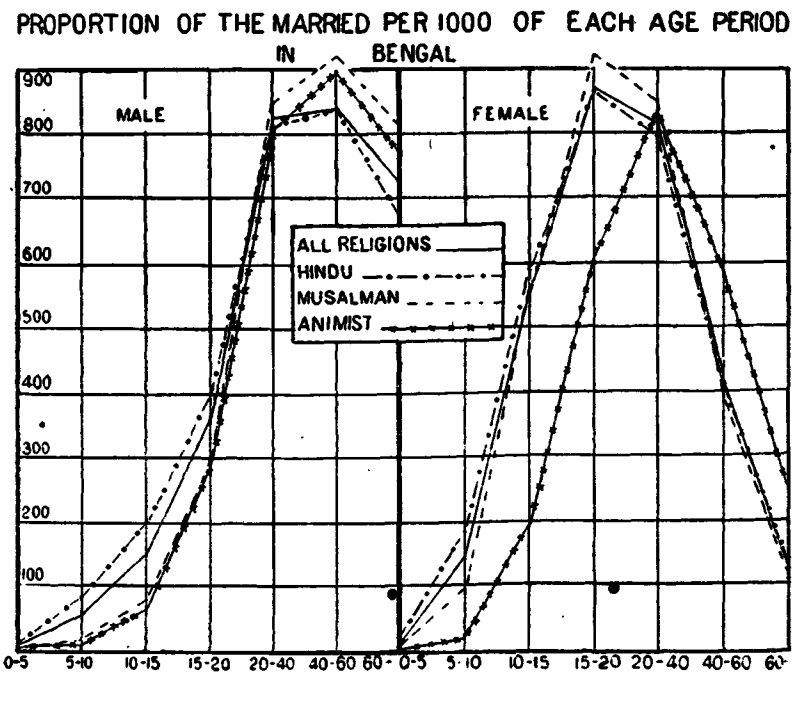


673. In Bengal only 2½ per cent. of the females and 22 per cent. of the males are unmarried after they are 15 years of age. In Bihar and Orissa the proportion is 6 and 18 per cent. respectively. In the former province there are two unmarried youths aged 10 to 15 to every unmarried girl of the same age : in the latter the proportion is 4 to 3. After 20 years of age only one woman in 83 remains unmarried in Bengal, and one in 40 in Bihar and Orissa. The unmarried females consist of the following :—(1) Genuine spinsters, who are found amongst aboriginal and semi-Hinduized races, and also in some sections of the higher Hindu castes, such as Kulin Brahmans in Bengal, Karans and Khandaits in Orissa, and Rajputs, Brahmans and Babhans in Bihar. Among these castes hypergamy and the high price of bridegrooms often make it impossible for marriageable girls to be married till they are advanced in years. (2) Females suffering from infirmities like leprosy, blindness, etc., who cannot therefore get husbands. (3) Concubines, who are often kept ostensibly as maid servants, as in Orissa. (4) Prostitutes, who are not recognized as married, though they often go through a mock ceremony of marriage. Some idea of the proportion of prostitutes in the unmarried female population may be gathered from special statistics compiled for prostitutes in Calcutta. Here one-fourth of the prostitutes aged 20 and over returned themselves as unmarried ; they represent half the total number of unmarried females of that age who were enumerated in Calcutta, and 4 per cent. of the total number enumerated in Bengal. As it is only reasonable to suppose that a large proportion of the prostitutes outside Calcutta are also unmarried, it may fairly be assumed that fallen women account for a considerable number of the unmarried females who are beyond the teens.

AGE PERIOD.	NUMBER PER 1,000 UNMARRIED.			
	BENGAL.		BIHAR AND ORISSA.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
0—5	262†	445	297[9]	419
5—10	297	420	318	375
10—15	218	110	202	150
15—20	122	13	90	31
20—30	82	8	65	14
30—40	12	2	16	5
40—60	6	1·3	9	4
60 and over	1	·3	3	2

MARRIAGE BY RELIGION.

674. The percentage of married males is higher among Hindus than among Musalmans in every natural division of the two provinces, except West Bengal, North Bengal and the Chota Nagpur Plateau. The proportion of married females, however, is higher amongst Muhammadans in all parts of Bengal, and lower in all parts of Bihar and Orissa except Chota Nagpur. As regards different age periods, the proportion of married persons in the male population of Bengal is higher among Hindus than among Muhammadans or Animists up to 20—40, but lower in the subsequent years. The same phenomenon is

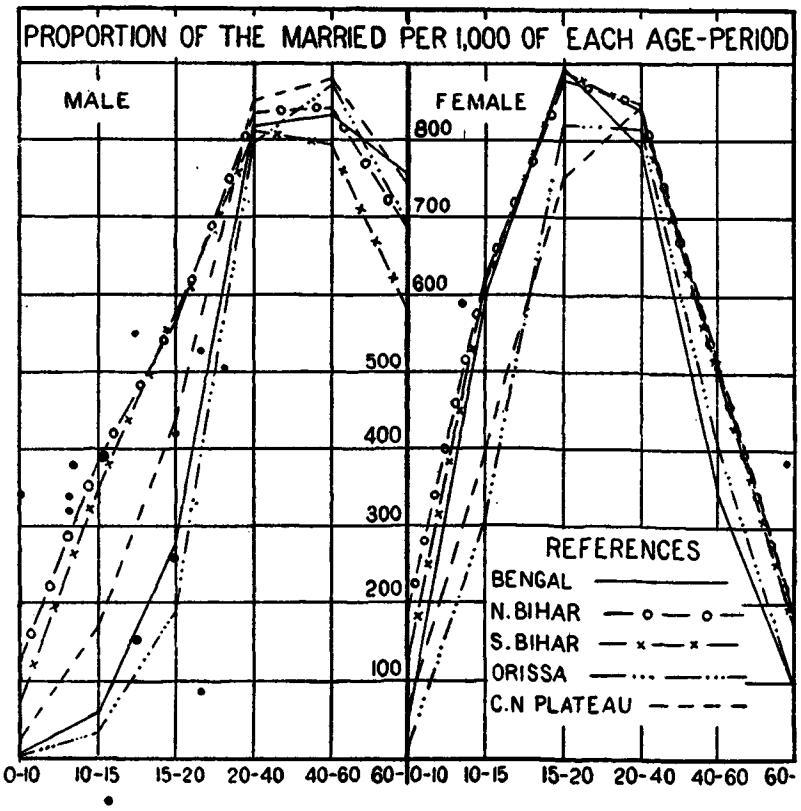


[9] The fact that the proportion of married males is lower at 0—5 than at 5—10 seems due to the fondness for the number 5 in the returns and the consequent exaggeration of the age of infants who are under 5.

observable in the female population. Between 5 and 10 years of age one out of every eight Hindu girls in Bengal has gone through the marraiage ceremnony, and over two-thirds of those aged 10 to 15, whereas the proportion in the Muhammadan community is 9 and 56 per cent. respectively. The marginal diagram illustrates graphically the prevalence of early marriage and the prohibition of widow re-marriage amongst the Hindus of Bengal.

MARRIAGE BY LOCALITY.

675. Bengal being a homogeneous province, there is not so much difference between the proportion of the married in different localities as there is in Bihar and Orissa with its four natural divisions having divergent characteristics. In the accompanying diagram, therefore, showing the proportions at each age period, Bengal has been treated as a whole, but each division of the other province has been plotted separately. Marriage appears to be a more universal institution, both among Hindus and Musalmans, in Bihar and Orissa than in Bengal. In the general population (including both Hindus and Musalmans) the proportion of married persons of both sexes is highest in North Bihar and lowest in Orissa: in the former 545 per mille, and in the latter 439 per mille, are married. Among the Hindus the proportion of married women is lowest in North Bengal (427 per mille).



EARLY MARRIAGE.

676. The next point to notice is the prevalence of early marriage and of its extreme form, viz., infant marriage, which exists in Bihar and Orissa, but is comparatively rare in Bengal. In the latter province 20,333 infants under five are married and 1,978 are widowed, whereas no less than 127,984 are married and 8,064 are widowed in Bihar and Orissa, though it has a smaller population. In Bihar and Orissa, too, as many as 2,030 infants under one year of age have gone through the marriage ceremony, while 553 are widowed. The corresponding figures for Bengal are only 187 and 12 respectively. In both provinces the majority of these infants are Hindus, but Musalmans Animists, Buddhists and Christians are also represented, though sparingly among them.

INFANTS UNDER 1 YEAR OF AGE—

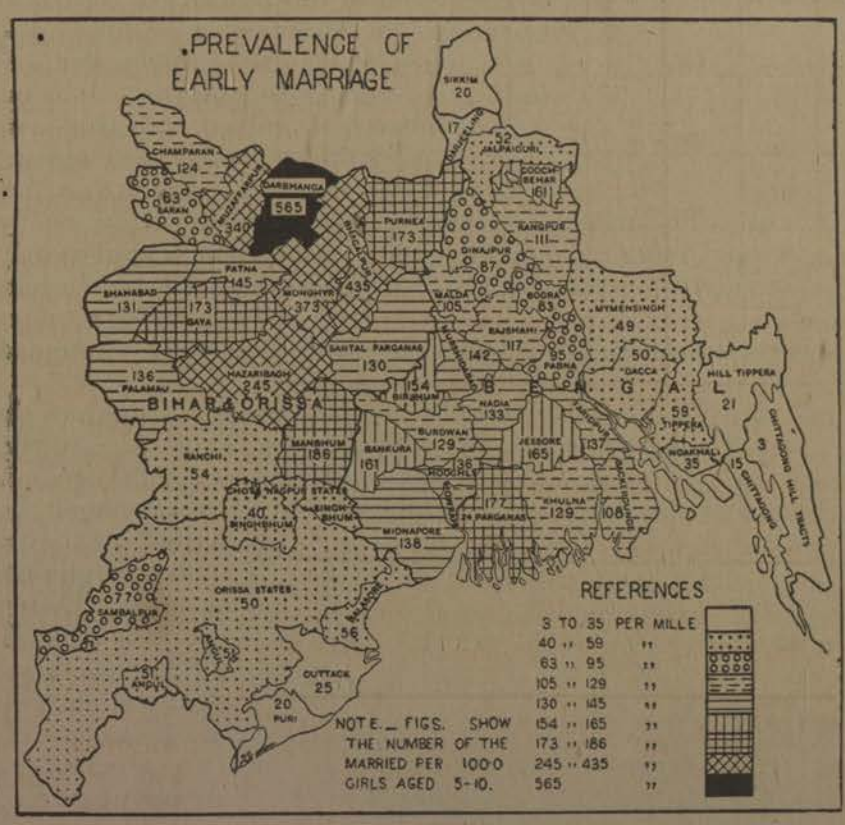
RELIGION.	MARRIED.				WIDOWED.			
	BENGAL.		BIHAR AND ORISSA.		BENGAL.		BIHAR AND ORISSA.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
All religions ...	***61***	***126***	***1,253***	***1,277***	***4***	***8***	***96***	***157***
Hindu	32	82	1,088	1,565	1	5	89	388
Muhammadan ...	23	36	103	165	3	3	6	67
Animist	...	4	56	47	...	...	1	2
Buddhist ...	4	3	...	...	...	...	...	...
Christian ...	2	1	6	...	...	...	...	...

677. The proportion of the married per 1,000 children of either sex aged 5 furnishes a fair index of the prevalence of early marriage in different localities and amongst different communities. The figures for females are, however, sufficient for a consideration of the question, as those for males correspond to them; the chief difference is that the proportion is less in the case of males owing to the higher age at which men marry. Early marriage is most prevalent in North Bihar, where three out of every 10 girls are married between the ages of 5 and 10. Next, in order, come South Bihar (217 per mille), Central Bengal (151), West Bengal (140), the Chota Nagpur Plateau (106), North Bengal (98) and East Bengal (68). Orissa stands on a plane by itself, only one in every 33 girls at this age having contracted a marriage. In no district is early marriage so common as in Darbhanga. Here three-fifths of the Hindu girls between 5 and 10 are married, while the proportion among Musalman girls, though far lower, viz., 22 per cent., is higher than in any other part of the two provinces ---a fact which may fairly be taken to indicate the adoption or imitation of Hindu practices.

BY LOCALITY.

MARRIED PER 1,000 AGED 5—10.

PROVINCE AND DIVISION.	ALL RELIGIONS.		HINDU.		MUHAMMADAN.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
Bengal	***11***	***99***	***11***	***120***	***12***	***87***
West Bengal ...	9	140	9	153	12	106
Central Bengal ...	19	151	12	151	26	154
North Bengal ...	12	98	18	90	9	108
East Bengal ...	9	68	7	88	10	61
Bihar and Orissa	***110***	***194***	***126***	***219***	***65***	***147***
North Bihar ...	198	308	228	345	62	142
Darbhanga ...	*434*	*565*	*481*	*617*	*129*	*223*
South Bihar ...	118	217	124	227	62	127
Orissa	4	32	4	33	3	13
Chota Nagpur Plateau	40	106	46	130	93	219



678. Infant marriage, *i.e.*, marriage of children under one year of age, is also far more common in North Bihar, and in Darbhanga in particular, than elsewhere. This is ascribed in the last Census Report (page 259, paragraph 441) to the teaching and influence of the Maithil or Tirhutia Brahmans, to whom the celebration of the marriage ceremony is a source of profit. For a discussion of this and the other causes suggested for early marriage, the last Census Reports for Bengal and India may be referred to.

MARRIED FEMALES PER 1,000 UNDER 5.

LOCALITY.	All Religions.	Hindu.	Muhammadan.
Bengal	5	5	4
Bihar and Orissa	32	36	20
North Bihar	59	68	21
Darbhanga	141	156	40

679. The marginal table given in paragraph 677 sufficiently shows that early marriage is distinctively a Hindu institution. As is well known, the Hindus look upon

BY RELIGION.

marriage as a religious sacrament, essential and irrevocable. "The act itself, when completed, is best viewed in the light of a sacrament; the steps leading up to it are best viewed in the light of a contract"* Their *Sastras* enjoin the marriage of girls before puberty. Infant marriage is not contemplated, but the nubile age is fixed at 8 to 10 or 12 at the latest. A contributory factor is the number of restrictions imposed by the rules relating, to consanguinity, endogamy (*i.e.*, marriage within a certain circle), exogamy, (*i.e.* marriage outside a certain circle) and hypergamy (*i.e.*, marriage in a circle of higher social status). The effect of these rules is naturally to make parents anxious to get their daughters safely married before they attain an age when the sway of the passions may lead to irregular attachments and frustrate their observance. Among the Muhammadans not only has early marriage no religious sanction, but marriage is a civil contract, which admits of dissolution during the life-time of the parties; in fact, it may even be entered into temporarily for a short period. Strictly, therefore, a Muhammadan girl should be old enough to be an intelligent party to the contract, and to give her free consent. In spite of this, early marriages are commonly celebrated, though not to the same extent as in the Hindu community.

680. The usual practice of the Animists is to marry only girls who are old and strong enough to be real helpmates. The same principle is observed by the Himalayan races, who form a large section of the Buddhists. Proportionately, the number of children who are married while still of tender years is far higher among the Aryas. It must be remembered, however, that the Arya movement in Bihar—it has not spread to Bengal—is of recent origin and has not yet had time to produce its full effects, while those hitherto attracted by it have been, to a large extent, members of low castes that practise early marriage. The figures for Christians do not distinguish between Indian and other Christians, and the presence of married children among them must be attributed to converts whose children were married before they embraced Christianity.

NUMBER OF MARRIED PER 1,000 AGED 5—10.

Religion.	Province.	Male.	Female.
Animist	Bihar and Orissa	10	19
Arya	Ditto ...	37	90
Brahmo	Bengal ...	6	9
Buddhist	Do.	4	7
Christian	Do.	6	7

681. It is unnecessary to discuss in detail the returns for the numerous castes dealt with in Subsidiary Table V, but the following salient features may be briefly noticed. (1) Early marriage is more common amongst the lower castes than amongst the higher, as shown in the margin. (2) Amongst castes common to both provinces, those who are natives of Bihar and Orissa marry at an early age far more commonly than those who are indigenous to Bengal. (3) Early marriage is comparatively rare amongst Himalayan castes and tribes, and also amongst aboriginal castes and tribes of Mongolian or Dravidian origin. (4) Early marriage is generally more common amongst Hinduized than amongst non-Hinduized members of aboriginal races. This, again, illustrates the influence of the Hindus upon their Animist neighbours.

BY CASTE.

NUMBER OF MARRIED GIRLS PER 1,000 AGED—

Castes.	0—5	5—12
Bengal.		
Bagdi	9	244
Baidya	2	48
Brahman	3	154
Chamar	7	209
Dom	13	267
Kayasth	2	83
Bihar and Orissa.		
Barhi	58	390
Brahman	12	178
Chamar	63	368
Dom	23	240
Kalwar	35	277
Kayasth	8	60
Mongoloid races.		
Bhotia	2	13
Gurung	5	12
Khambu (Jimdar) ...	5	25
Lepcha	5	10
Murmi	4	16
Chakma	0	4
Kuki	0	23

Castes.	0—5.		5—12.	
	Hindu.	Animist.	Hindu.	Animist.
Bengal.				
Garo	...	4	121	90
Tipara	2	...	15	10
Bihar and Orissa.				
Bhumij	30	...	83	29
Munda	10	3	67	31
Oraon	11	9	62	21
Santal	19	5	158	26

Ashutosh Mukerji, *The Position of Women in Bengali Society.*

682. Three causes might naturally be expected to operate against the practice of early marriage, or at least against its gaining greater vogue. These are (1) the wider diffusion of education, and incidentally, to a small extent, greater familiarity with a higher ethical standard, (2) the increase in the cost of living and (3) its consequence, or concomitant, viz., the rise in the price of brides and bridegrooms. There are grounds for the belief that these three factors are producing some result, for, as shown in the margin, early marriages decreased to a small extent between 1891 and 1901, and to a greater extent in the subsequent decade, when the factors in question came more fully into play. The decrease is common not only to all the main religions, but also to all the natural divisions except the Chota Nagpur Plateau, where early marriages appear to be on the increase, presumably as a result of the progressive Hinduization of its aboriginal population.

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

	MARRIED GIRLS PER 1,000 AGED—					
	0—5.			5—10.		
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1911.	1901.	1891.
All Religions	**17**	**22**	**16**	**142**	**156**	**167**
Hindu	24	30	21	182	197	201
Muhammadan	6	12	11	95	108	124
Christian ...	2	4	4	7	7	20
Animist ...	3	6	4	20	21	9

683. Some idea of the varying extent to which the marriage of widows prevails in different localities and among different communities may be gathered from the figures showing the number of widows among females aged 15—40, as this period includes women of marriageable age, who are not so old as to be barren or to have lost their personal attractions, and to be debarred thereby from marrying again.

WIDOW MARRIAGE.

684. In North Bihar, though early marriage is more common than elsewhere, the proportion of widows of the reproductive age is lower than in any other natural division. As a low age of marriage must naturally result in a high proportion of widows, this phenomenon is only explicable by the greater frequency of widow remarriage. There is a comparative paucity of widows in Orissa and the Chota Nagpur Plateau, which seems to be due partly to the higher age at which marriages are contracted and partly to the practice of widow remarriage. This latter practice appears to be least in vogue in the more distinctively Hindu centres of Bengal, viz., West Bengal and Central Bengal.

BY LOCALITY.

Number of widows per 1,000 females aged 15—40.

NATURAL DIVISION.	All Religions.	Hindu.	Muhammadan.
BENGAL	**164**	**224**	**113**
West Bengal	212	229	140
Central ,, ...	197	244	152
North ,, ...	151	210	120
East ,, ...	134	216	96
BIHAR AND ORISSA ...	**122**	**125**	**123**
North Bihar	125	125	127
South ,, ...	134	134	127
Orissa	145	146	126
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	102	109	98

685. The marginal statement illustrates the well known fact that widow marriage is much more frequent amongst Muhammadans than amongst Hindus. It also shows that, next to the Hindus, the Musalmans have more widows than other communities, such as Animists and Buddhists, who marry at an adult age and allow their widows to remarry. The difference in this respect between the Brahmos, who allow widow remarriage, and the Hindus, many of whom do not, is noticeable, but what is even more striking is that among those who have become adherents of the Arya Samaj, women are more generally relegated to widowhood than even among the general Hindu community.

BY RELIGION.

Number of widows per 1,000 females aged—

RELIGION.	15—20.		20—40.	
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.
ALL RELIGIONS	**61**	**42**	**197**	**140**
Hindu	93	45	266	144
Muhammadan ...	35	37	139	141
Christian ...	21	45	96	144
Animist	...*	27	...*	99
Buddhist ...	28	...*	92	...*
Brahmo	26	...*	128	...*
Arya	...*	82	...*	193

* Not compiled, the actual figures being very small.

686. The figures for castes given in Subsidiary Table V establish the following facts. (1) The proportion of widows (per 1,000 females aged 20—40) is very small amongst the Himalayan tribes and castes, *e.g.*, Bhotia (67), Gurung (54), Lepcha (33), Khambu and Jimdar (73) and Murmi (53). (2) It is generally higher amongst the Hinduized members of aboriginal tribes than amongst the non-Hinduized : as already stated, the former practise early marriage more than the latter. (3) It is generally high amongst Baidyas (191), Brahmans (258), Kayasths (276), Rajputs (283) and other castes forming the upper strata of Hindu society. The proportion is higher still amongst Goalas (323), Chasi Kaibarttas (302), Kumhars (307), Namasudras (304), Sadgops (326), Sutradhars (285), Telis and Tilis (313), etc. All of these are castes ranking low in the social scale, who look upon the prohibition of widow remarriage as a visible sign of respectability and good status. (4) Widows are comparatively few amonst the low castes, like Chamars (140) Doms (197), Muchis (181), etc.. who allow widow marriage freely, especially in Bihar and Orissa.

BY CASTE.

Number of widows per 1,000 females, aged 20—40.

	Hindu.	Animist.
BENGAL.		
Garo	90	87
Munda	88	64
Oraon	136	87
Santal	115	122
Tippera	43	34
BIHAR AND ORISSA.		
Bhumij	134	...
Munda	134	111
Oraon	104	138
Pan	125	91
Santal	188	86

687. Widows are relatively more numerous than widowers at all ages and in all religions. Even in the Muhammadan community, where the remarriage of widows is not only countenanced, but even enjoined by Muhammadan law, widowers remarry far less frequently than widows. The disparity of the number of widowers and widows is even more pronounced in the case of the Hindus, who allow men to marry as often as they please, but, to a large extent, lay a ban on widows taking a second husband. The restrictions on marriage already referred to are, however, effectual in making the number of men who have the courage to contract a second marriage less than in the case of either Musalmans or Animists.

BY SEX.

Proportion of the widowed per mille of each sex in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.

AGE.	ALL RELIGIONS.		HINDU.		MUSALMAN.		ANIMIST.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
ALL AGES ...	**43**	**190**	**53**	**212**	**26**	**160**	**30**	**114**
0— 5	...	1	1	2	...	1	0·1	1
5—10	2	7	4	10	...	4	0·3	2
10—15	6	24	9	30	2	17	1	7
15—20	18	54	17	67	7	35	8	30
20—40	41	170	48	190	29	139	36	100
40—60	133	573	138	575	68	596	85	394
60 and over ...	256	858	296	857	178	879	210	737

688. Both in Bengal and in Bihar and Orissa there has been a steady decline during the last three decades in the proportion of widows at almost all age periods. This seems to be due to the gradual rise in the age of marriage, and partly perhaps, in a small degree, to the greater prevalence of widow marriage. Amongst the educated members of some of the higher Hindu castes of Bengal, there is, as is well known, a movement in favour of the marriage of young widows, and a few such marriages have actually taken place among Hindu families of high social status. The proportion of widowers at different age periods has increased during the decennium amongst the Hindus and Animists, as well as in the general population of the two provinces, but has decreased among the Muhammadans.

VARIATION SINCE 1891.

689. The early marriage of girls is often associated with widow marriage, *e.g.*, in North Bihar both early marriage and widow marriage are more prevalent than elsewhere. Castes which get their children married

RELATION BETWEEN EARLY MARRIAGE AND WIDOW MARRIAGE.

at a tender age often allow widows to take a second husband, as will be seen from the marginal table. The first group consists of castes with a low proportion of widows of the reproductive age and a high proportion of married girls of 5—10. The second group consists of castes in which the converse is the case. To this rule, however, there are many exceptions in the case of Hindu castes in Bengal, like those shown in the third group, which look upon the prohibition of widow marriage as a token of respectability, but at the same time generally marry at an early age. It must be remembered, moreover, that widow marriage is not inconsistent with the absence of early marriage, for there are many communities, *e.g.*, Christians, Brahmos, aboriginal tribes, etc., which marry when they are adults and allow their widows to resume the married state if they desire to do so.

Caste.	Locality.	Number of married girls per 1,000 aged 5-10.	Number of widows per 1,000 females aged 20-40.
I.—Dhanuk ...	Bihar ...	630	132
Goala	Do. ...	436	125
Koiri	Do. ...	370	131
Teli	Do. ...	409	125
II.—Babhan ...	Bihar ...	113	228
Gaura	Orissa ...	96	148
Karan	Do. ...	17	192
Kayasth ...	Bengal ...	83	276
Kayasth ...	Bihar ...	60	217
Khandait ...	Orissa ...	42	194
III.—Bagdi	Bengal ...	244	278
Gandhabanik ...	Do. ...	156	244
Goala	Do. ...	313	322
Kaibartta ...	Do. ...	210	380
Sadgop ...	Do. ...	218	326

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—PART I.—DISTRIBUTION BY CIVIL CONDITION OF 1,000 OF EACH SEX, RELIGION AND MAIN AGE PERIOD AT EACH OF THE LAST FOUR CENSUSES.

BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.

RELIGION, SEX AND AGE.	UNMARRIED.				MARRIED.				WIDOWED.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
ALL RELIGIONS.												
MALES	***481***	***477***	***478***	***467***	***476***	***482***	***480***	***493***	***43***	***41***	***42***	***40***
0—5	991	990	993	960	9	10	6	39	...	...	1	1
5—10	942	941	945		56	57	53		2	2	2	
10—15	842	837	826	809	152	158	168	185	6	5	6	6
15—20	626	608	594	572	361	380	394	414	13	12	12	14
20—40	136	134	132	133	823	826	830	829	41	37	38	38
40—60	28	26	21	21	839	868	872	882	133	106	107	97
60 and over	21	21	14	19	723	739	741	750	256	240	245	231
FEMALES	***327***	***318***	***315***	***297***	***483***	***483***	***481***	***490***	***190***	***199***	***204***	***213***
0—5	982	977	983	884	17	22	16	111	1	1	1	5
5—10	851	836	827		142	156	167		7	8	6	
10—15	422	402	372	313	554	572	604	637	24	26	24	30
15—20	77	77	64	50	869	868	882	885	54	55	54	65
20—40	15	16	10	9	815	808	809	802	170	176	181	189
40—60	7	7	4	4	420	415	416	428	573	578	580	568
60 and over	6	6	3	6	136	131	117	136	858	863	880	858
HINDU.												
MALES	***453***	***450***	***454***	***445***	***494***	***501***	***496***	***508***	***53***	***49***	***50***	***47***
0—5	987	985	990	945	12	15	9	54	1	...	1	1
5—10	913	912	922		83	85	75		4	3	3	
10—15	790	789	777	758	201	204	215	234	9	7	8	8
15—20	582	567	556	537	401	418	429	447	17	15	15	16
20—40	139	141	140	136	813	817	817	819	48	42	43	46
40—60	29	33	28	26	838	844	846	861	133	123	126	113
60 and over	26	25	18	22	678	701	701	714	296	274	281	264
FEMALES	***297***	***290***	***291***	***278***	***491***	***492***	***487***	***495***	***212***	***218***	***222***	***227***
0—5	974	968	978	861	24	30	21	133	2	2	1	6
5—10	808	793	791		182	197	201		10	10	8	
10—15	383	370	350	300	587	600	621	666	30	30	29	34
15—20	72	75	59	50	861	859	876	871	67	66	65	79
20—40	13	14	8	9	797	792	793	786	190	194	199	205
40—60	6	7	4	3	419	416	418	431	575	577	578	566
60 and over	6	5	3	5	137	132	117	138	857	863	880	857
MUSALMAN.												
MALES	***524***	***516***	***513***	***504***	***450***	***457***	***460***	***469***	***26***	***27***	***27***	***27***
0—5	998	996	997	988	2	4	3	12	...	...	...	...
5—10	981	980	982		19	19	18		...	1	...	
10—15	920	912	904	898	78	86	93	99	2	2	3	3
15—20	696	675	657	642	297	317	335	349	7	8	8	9
20—40	125	116	111	119	846	855	861	853	29	29	28	28
40—60	12	11	8	9	920	919	924	927	68	70	68	64
60 and over	11	10	4	11	811	814	820	821	178	176	176	168
FEMALES	***362***	***351***	***341***	***322***	***478***	***478***	***479***	***485***	***160***	***171***	***180***	***193***
0—5	993	987	988	918	6	12	11	79	1	1	1	3
5—10	901	887	872		95	108	124		4	5	4	
10—15	426	402	346	292	557	578	636	686	17	20	18	22
15—20	44	44	33	29	921	917	930	929	35	39	37	42
20—40	11	11	7	7	850	842	841	830	139	147	152	163
40—60	4	6	4	4	400	391	385	404	596	603	611	592
60 and over	4	4	3	6	117	112	101	121	879	884	896	873
CHRISTIAN.												
MALES	***588***	***594***	***599***	***597***	***385***	***374***	***375***	***377***	***27***	***32***	***26***	***26***
0—5	998	997	994	994	2	3	6	6	...	...	...	...
5—10	999	994	988		6	6	11		...	...	1	
10—15	969	970	965	957	30	29	34	42	1	1	1	1
15—20	813	812	780	822	181	184	214	174	6	4	6	4
20—40	266	305	302	380	708	663	673	598	26	32	25	22
40—60	54	59	74	83	868	842	847	837	78	99	79	80
60 and over	41	39	37	69	748	745	779	747	211	216	184	184
FEMALES	***497***	***492***	***492***	***467***	***395***	***387***	***389***	***401***	***108***	***121***	***119***	***132***
0—5	998	996	996	989	2	4	4	10	...	...	...	1
5—10	992	992	988		7	7	9		1	1	3	
10—15	893	872	859	847	104	123	141	149	3	5	4	4
15—20	415	430	380	383	567	551	598	597	18	19	22	20
20—40	89	93	89	83	824	796	810	804	87	111	101	113
40—60	42	32	34	32	581	557	548	532	377	411	418	436
60 and over	31	29	23	38	226	207	207	185	743	764	770	777

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—PART I.—DISTRIBUTION BY CIVIL CONDITION OF 1,000 OF EACH SEX, RELIGION AND MAIN AGE PERIOD AT EACH OF THE LAST FOUR CENSUSES—*concluded.*

BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA—*concluded.*

RELIGION, SEX AND AGE.	UNMARRIED.				MARRIED.				WIDOWED.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
ANIMIST.												
MALES	*558*	*575*	*582*	*550*	*412*	*399*	*393*	*431*	*30*	*26*	*25*	*19*
0— 5	996	997	997	988	4	3	3	12	1	...	...	...
5—10	990	985	993		10	11	7		3	4	...	
10—15	937	935	931	904	62	64	67	95	1	1	2	1
15—20	699	702	686	638	293	291	306	354	8	7	8	8
20—40	154	166	160	122	810	804	810	856	36	30	30	22
40—60	21	21	18	12	894	902	911	935	85	77	71	53
60 and over	16	17	11	18	774	800	817	831	210	183	172	151
FEMALES	*476*	*485*	*496*	*459*	*410*	*400*	*396*	*434*	*114*	*115*	*103*	*107*
0— 5	996	993	996	977	3	6	4	22	1	1	...	1
5—10	978	977	979		20	21	20		2	2	1	
10—15	800	798	802	731	193	194	191	261	7	8	7	8
15—20	362	376	340	285	608	593	594	707	30	31	26	28
20—40	65	71	68	30	835	827	837	885	100	102	93	85
40—60	23	24	21	8	583	576	619	626	394	400	360	366
60 and over	18	17	15	15	245	235	259	258	737	748	726	727

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—PART II—DISTRIBUTION BY CIVIL CONDITION OF 1,000 OF EACH SEX, RELIGION AND MAIN AGE PERIOD IN 1911.

RELIGION, SEX AND AGE.	BENGAL.			BIHAR AND ORISSA.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
ALL RELIGIONS.						
MALES	*511*	*454*	*35*	*444*	*504*	*52*
0— 5	999	1	...	982	17	1
5—10	988	11	1	885	110	5
10—15	940	59	1	724	264	12
15—20	720	274	6	498	479	23
20—40	151	817	32	117	830	53
40—60	30	833	137	27	845	128
60 and over	18	752	230	25	688	287
FEMALES	*336*	*463*	*201*	*317*	*505*	*178*
0— 5	995	5	...	966	32	2
5—10	897	99	4	795	194	11
10—15	577	599	24	472	503	25
15—20	43	896	61	130	828	42
20—40	11	792	197	19	841	140
40—60	4	346	650	9	494	497
60 and over	4	93	903	8	175	817
HINDU.						
MALES	*487*	*464*	*49*	*429*	*516*	*55*
0— 5	998	2	...	980	19	1
5—10	989	11	...	868	126	6
10—15	938	60	2	696	290	14
15—20	721	273	6	474	501	25
20—40	174	789	37	114	831	55
40—60	32	836	132	28	839	133
60 and over	25	679	296	32	836	132
FEMALES	*292*	*451*	*257*	*300*	*516*	*184*
0— 5	994	5	1	962	36	2
5—10	874	120	6	769	219	12
10—15	295	671	34	434	539	27
15—20	33	874	93	104	851	45
20—40	10	724	266	15	841	144
40—60	4	301	695	7	490	503
60 and over	3	80	917	7	171	822

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—PART II.—DISTRIBUTION BY CIVIL CONDITION OF 1,000 OF EACH SEX, RELIGION AND MAIN AGE PERIOD IN 1911 —*concluded.*

RELIGION, SEX AND AGE.	BENGAL.			BIHAR AND ORISSA.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
MUSALMAN.						
MALES	*531*	*445*	*24*	*474*	*481*	*45*
0— 5	999	1	...	988	12	·1
5—10	988	12	...	933	65	2
10—15	940	58	2	776	217	7
15—20	716	278	6	540	443	17
20—40	126	848	26	114	838	48
40—60	11	927	61	18	874	108
60 and over	10	826	164	17	725	258
FEMALES	*368*	*475*	*157*	*328*	*491*	*181*
0— 5	995	4	1	979	19	2
5—10	909	87	4	847	147	6
10—15	419	564	17	469	512	19
15—20	39	926	35	91	872	37
20—40	10	851	139	15	844	141
40—60	3	383	614	8	479	513
60 and over	3	103	894	7	171	822
CHRISTIAN.						
MALES	*592*	*379*	*29*	*587*	*388*	*25*
0— 5	998	2	...	997	3	·1
5—10	996	4	...	994	6	·2
10—15	965	35	...	971	28	1
15—20	924	74	2	754	238	8
20—40	415	563	22	156	815	29
40—60	95	825	80	29	894	77
60 and over	64	714	222	26	769	205
FEMALES	*472*	*404*	*124*	*503*	*392*	*100*
0— 5	998	2	...	998	2	·1
5—10	991	8	1	992	7	1
10—15	892	106	2	893	104	3
15—20	405	574	21	104	851	45
20—40	141	763	96	15	841	144
40—60	79	508	413	7	490	503
60 and over	54	172	774	7	171	822
	BUDDHIST.			**ANIMIST.**		
MALES	*570*	*398*	*32*	*567*	*403*	*30*
0— 5	999	1	...	996	4	·1
5—10	996	4	·1	990	10	·3
10—15	995	15	·3	933	66	1
15—20	884	113	3	689	302	9
20—40	211	758	31	158	806	36
40—60	28	892	80	23	888	89
60 and over	35	728	237	18	766	216
FEMALES	*459*	*421*	*120*	*482*	*403*	*115*
0— 5	999	1	...	995	4	1
5—10	992	7	1	979	19	2
10—15	886	111	3	808	185	7
15—20	437	535	28	393	580	27
20—40	54	854	92	74	827	99
40—60	9	607	384	26	580	394
60 and over	10	244	746	21	250	729
	BRAHMO.			**ARYA.**		
MALES	*615*	*345*	*40*	*398*	*492*	*110*
0— 5	1,000	...	...	978	22	...
5—10	994	6	...	959	37	4
10—15	995	5	...	750	236	14
15—20	958	42	...	440	520	40
20—40	456	513	31	127	776	97
40—60	54	825	121	42	742	216
60 and over	70	719	211	24	389	587
FEMALES	*549*	*336*	*115*	*290*	*483*	*227*
0— 5	994	6	...	987	13	...
5—10	991	9	...	908	90	7
10—15	957	29	14	523	448	29
15—20	691	283	26	96	822	82
20—40	190	682	128	17	90	193
40—60	12	629	359	6	498	496
60 and over	...	152	848	...	155	845

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—Distribution by Civil Condition of 1,000 of each sex at certain ages in the main Religions and in each Natural Division.

Religion and Natural Division.	Males.																		Females.															
	All ages.			0—5.			5—10.			10—15.			15—40.			40 and over.			All ages.			0—5.			5—10.			10—15.			15—40.			40 and over.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37
BENGAL—																																				
All religions	511	454	35	999	1	·01	988	11	1	940	59	1	273	701	26	20	852	128	336	463	201	995	5	·5	897	99	4	377	599	24	19	817	164	4	279	717
Hindu	487	464	49	998	2	·05	989	11	·4	935	60	2	249	680	31	30	801	169	292	451	257	994	5	1	874	120	6	295	671	34	16	760	224	4	240	756
Musalman	531	445	24	999	1	·03	985	12	·3	940	58	2	255	723	22	10	904	86	368	475	157	995	4	1	909	87	4	419	564	17	18	869	113	3	312	685
WEST BENGAL—																																				
All religions	479	475	46	998	2	·06	991	9	·3	923	70	2	261	717	22	26	806	168	271	473	256	993	6	1	854	140	6	271	693	36	16	772	212	3	258	739
Hindu	477	473	50	998	2	·05	991	9	·3	927	71	2	264	707	29	29	790	181	260	470	270	992	7	1	840	153	7	230	730	40	13	758	229	4	244	752
Musalman	476	493	31	998	2	·1	988	12	·4	920	79	1	262	716	22	13	881	106	295	497	208	995	5	·3	889	106	5	358	623	19	13	847	140	4	300	696
CENTRAL BENGAL—																																				
All religions	470	493	37	997	3	·07	980	19	1	931	67	2	264	712	24	22	846	132	282	476	242	990	9	1	843	151	6	235	733	32	15	788	197	6	252	742
Hindu	454	499	47	997	3	·09	987	12	1	930	68	2	276	696	28	30	809	161	265	456	279	991	8	1	842	151	7	212	748	40	12	744	244	6	231	763
Musalman	484	489	27	997	3	·06	974	26	·4	932	67	1	243	737	20	11	891	98	295	498	207	989	10	1	841	154	5	240	735	25	13	835	152	4	272	724
NORTH BENGAL—																																				
All religions	515	448	37	999	1	·02	988	12	·4	932	66	2	266	699	35	21	855	124	357	458	185	997	3	·3	897	98	5	365	610	25	24	825	151	4	276	720
Hindu	499	448	53	999	1	·04	982	18	·5	934	64	2	310	647	43	35	798	167	344	427	229	997	3	·4	904	90	6	422	549	29	27	763	210	4	247	749
Musalman	524	449	27	999	1	·02	991	9	·3	929	69	2	233	738	29	10	893	92	359	478	163	997	3	·3	888	108	4	304	673	23	17	863	120	3	283	714
EAST BENGAL—																																				
All religions	542	430	28	999	1	·02	991	9	·3	952	47	1	288	690	22	16	876	108	379	457	163	996	4	·4	929	68	3	478	506	16	19	847	134	3	306	691
Hindu	515	440	45	999	1	·05	993	7	·3	958	41	1	254	716	30	28	809	163	316	441	243	995	4	1	907	88	5	353	621	26	14	770	216	3	238	759
Musalman	554	426	20	999	1	·01	990	10	·3	970	49	1	272	709	19	10	914	76	400	465	135	996	4	·3	936	61	3	520	468	12	19	885	96	3	343	654

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—Distribution by Civil condition of 1,000 of each Sex at certain ages in the Main Religions and in each Natural Division.

Religion and Natural Division.	Males.																		Females.																	
	All ages.			0—5.			5—10.			10—15.			15—40.			40 and over.			All ages.			0—5.			5—10.			10—15.			15—40.			40 and over.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37
BIHAR AND ORISSA—																																				
All Religion	444	504	52	982	17	1	885	110	5	724	264	12	196	757	47	26	803	165	317	505	178	966	32	2	795	194	11	472	503	25	40	838	122	9	405	586
Hindu	429	516	55	980	19	1	868	126	6	696	290	14	188	763	49	27	802	171	300	516	184	961	36	3	769	219	12	434	539	27	32	843	125	8	400	592
Musalman	474	481	45	988	12	·5	933	65	2	776	217	7	203	755	42	18	837	145	328	491	181	978	20	2	847	147	6	469	512	19	28	849	123	8	388	604
NORTH BIHAR—																																				
All Religion	394	546	60	966	32	2	793	198	9	598	381	21	165	779	56	33	799	168	267	545	188	937	59	4	674	308	18	343	620	37	23	852	125	7	413	580
Hindu	376	561	63	961	37	2	761	228	11	557	419	24	153	789	58	29	788	183	253	558	189	928	68	4	634	345	21	313	647	40	21	854	123	7	418	575
Musalman	482	473	45	990	10	·5	936	62	2	790	203	7	223	735	42	18	842	140	331	486	183	977	21	2	882	142	6	484	495	21	30	843	127	8	381	611
SOUTH BIHAR—																																				
All Religion	408	520	72	982	17	1	877	118	5	637	348	15	168	765	67	39	754	207	280	527	193	968	30	2	772	217	11	354	617	29	19	848	133	7	407	586
Hindu	402	524	74	982	17	1	871	124	5	622	362	16	165	767	68	41	750	209	277	531	192	966	32	2	761	227	12	340	630	30	18	848	134	7	418	585
Musalman	462	478	60	932	17	1	936	62	2	782	212	6	182	766	52	17	797	186	308	494	198	985	14	1	866	127	7	472	510	18	28	845	127	8	393	599
ORISSA—																																				
All Religion	525	435	40	1,000	·3	Nil	996	4	·06	969	31	·4	372	618	10	18	854	128	343	443	214	999	1	·0004	967	32	1	683	305	12	31	850	119	6	410	584
Hindu	523	437	40	1,000	·3	,,	996	4	·07	968	32	·4	314	663	23	17	828	155	341	444	215	999	1	·01	966	33	1	678	310	12	38	816	146	5	323	672
Musalman	579	398	23	999	1	,,	997	3	·1	985	15	·4	334	648	18	16	884	100	384	418	198	999	1	Nil	986	13	1	824	175	3	41	833	126	4	329	667
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU—																																				
All Religion	495	469	36	994	6	·2	959	40	1	826	170	4	208	759	33	20	849	131	390	465	145	985	14	1	889	106	5	591	395	14	34	859	107	14	427	559
Hindu	476	486	38	993	7	·3	952	46	2	798	197	5	192	774	34	19	845	136	363	481	156	983	16	1	865	130	5	524	459	17	49	850	101	11	407	582
Musalman	433	534	33	986	13	1	905	93	2	660	331	9	122	846	32	18	867	115	328	532	140	970	28	2	774	219	7	319	662	19	21	881	98	9	441	550

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—Distribution by main Age periods and Civil condition of 10,000 of each Sex and Religion, 1911.

Religion and Age.	Male.			Female.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
BENGAL.						
ALL RELIGIONS	*5,113*	*4,535*	*352*	*3,359*	*4,633*	*2,008*
0—10	2,858	19	1	2,905	162	8
10—15	1,112	69	2	369	588	24
15—40	1,104	2,834	107	78	3,378	676
40 and upwards	39	1,613	242	7	505	1,300
HINDU	*4,872*	*4,643*	*485*	*2,923*	*4,510*	*2,567*
0—10	2,526	17	1	2,572	176	10
10—15	1,049	68	2	276	626	32
15—40	1,235	2,903	132	67	3,207	948
40 and upwards	62	1,655	350	8	501	1,577
MUSALMAN	*5,308*	*4,454*	*238*	*3 678*	*4,750*	*1,572*
0—10	3,143	22	1	3,176	156	7
10—15	1,167	72	2	426	573	17
15—40	981	2,786	85	71	3,527	460
40 and upwards	17	1,574	150	5	494	1,088
BIHAR AND ORISSA.						
ALL RELIGIONS	*4,439*	*5,036*	*525*	*3,173*	*5,046*	*1,781*
0—10	2,728	198	9	2,520	335	19
10—15	899	327	15	476	508	25
15—40	761	2,935	181	159	3,338	484
40 and upwards	51	1,576	320	18	865	1253
HINDU	*4,287*	*5,157*	*556*	*3,004*	*5,158*	*1,838*
0—10	2,641	223	10	2,427	372	21
10—15	855	356	17	434	538	27
15—40	737	2,994	192	127	3,376	501
40 and upwards	54	1,584	337	16	872	1,289
MUSALMAN	*4.740*	*4,810*	*450*	*3,277*	*4,915*	*1,808*
0—10	2,989	128	4	2,699	256	13
10—15	973	273	9	450	491	19
15—40	743	2,766	152	112	3,386	483
40 and upwards	35	1,643	285	16	832	1,293

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Proportion of the sexes by Civil condition at certain ages for the main Religions and Natural Divisions.

Number of Females per 1,000 Males.

Natural Division and Religion.	All ages.			0—10.			10—15.			15—40.			40 and over.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
BENGAL.															
All religions	621	965	5,402	961	7,897	11,638	314	8.006	11,926	67	1,127	5,981	173	296	5,080
Hindu	558	904	4,929	948	9,889	12,892	245	8,601	15,080	50	1,028	6,664	123	282	4,200
Musalman	664	1,022	6,363	968	6,817	10,750	350	7,609	9,153	69	1,213	5,208	287	301	6,963
WEST BENGAL.															
All religions	559	982	5,462	925	13,092	16,046	232	7,841	15,868	62	1,087	7,687	157	336	4,631
Hindu	536	980	5,344	918	15.383	19,274	197	8,237	16,403	50	1,069	7,992	133	326	4,405
Musalman	614	1,001	6,696	944	8,200	7,980	304	6,122	12,000	57	1,164	6,179	318	357	6,885

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Proportion of the sexes by Civil condition at certain Ages for the main Religions and Natural Divisions—*concluded.*

Natural Division and Religion.	All ages.			0--10.			10—16.			16—40.			40 and over.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	11	12	14	15	16
CENTRAL BENGAL.															
All religions ...	526	846	5,698	908	6,787	10,304	187	8,095	13,515	48	927	6,873	237	272	5,153
Hindu ...	496	779	5,033	915	10,028	9,262	167	8,059	15,336	35	837	6,826	176	261	4,339
Musalman ...	552	924	6,942	900	5,309	12,196	190	8,154	11,514	48	1,028	7,081	356	282	6,814
NORTH BENGAL.															
All religions ...	642	946	4,579	958	7,508	11,261	300	7,033	9,684	85	1,126	4,165	144	266	4,760
Hindu ...	607	840	3,816	972	4,710	9,356	345	6,553	10,318	75	1,025	4,259	94	244	3,527
Musalman ...	654	1,017	5,706	948	10,838	13,762	248	7,445	9,596	73	1,186	4,210	261	271	6,668
EAST BENGAL.															
All religions ...	671	1,030	5,817	994	6,985	10,861	405	8,748	10,360	68	1,252	6,172	165	305	5,609
Hindu ...	589	961	5,205	985	11,046	14,756	291	11,862	17,427	43	1,145	7,618	92	273	4,321
Musalman ...	703	1,062	6,520	998	5,873	9,008	444	7,688	7,798	74	1,300	5,206	268	317	7,226
BIHAR AND ORISSA.															
All religions ...	745	1,045	3,535	963	1,763	2,274	552	1,619	1,732	218	1,186	2,785	372	573	4,076
Hindu ...	728	1,040	3,442	955	1,739	2,196	528	1,571	1,671	179	1,172	2,716	313	572	3,981
Musalman ...	743	1,098	4,314	970	2,146	3,235	497	1,933	2,359	162	1,296	3,410	497	544	4,870
NORTH BIHAR.															
All religions ...	716	1,057	3,296	937	1,572	2,050	473	1,343	1,430	153	1,201	2,462	258	601	4,010
Hindu ...	711	1,051	3,147	926	1,534	1,992	466	1,246	1,370	151	1,182	2,334	250	617	3,860
Musalman ...	732	1,093	4,401	976	2,222	3,384	489	1,954	2,502	151	1,309	3,406	466	524	5,041
SOUTH BIHAR.															
All religions ...	710	1,048	2,750	949	1,782	2,221	459	1,460	1,575	122	1,181	2,133	191	603	3,174
Hindu ...	702	1,034	2,663	945	1,782	2,187	447	1,417	1,535	118	1,156	2,059	172	599	3,086
Musalman ...	785	1,216	3,886	984	1,772	2,926	548	2,183	2,611	209	1,481	3,309	595	637	4,166
ORISSA.															
All religions ...	706	1,101	5,784	1,004	7,494	17,750	650	9,099	23,717	135	1,352	6,910	417	481	5,408
Hindu ...	705	1,099	5,727	1,005	7,639	18,211	647	9,110	24,171	132	1,347	6,883	413	481	5,343
Musalman ...	741	1,175	9,487	977	3,125	8,000	722	9,928	6,000	149	1,561	8,698	354	479	9,800
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.															
All religions ...	803	1,010	4,150	983	2,606	3,848	616	2,002	2,843	365	1,123	3,248	754	550	4,696
Hindu ...	774	1,005	4,197	978	2,732	3,699	560	1,983	2,836	285	1,106	3,308	626	530	4,741
Musalman ...	740	973	4,054	929	2,254	3,016	389	1,606	1,681	173	1,023	3,058	519	517	4,833
Christian ...	887	1,026	4,103	1,028	1,037	4,222	792	3,308	4,455	519	1,190	2,861	768	652	4,771
Animist ...	886	1,039	3,982	1,020	1,670	7,096	780	2,517	4,431	571	1,214	3,068	1,211	622	4,481

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V—Distribution by Civil Condition of 1,000 of each Sex at certain Ages for Selected Castes.

Caste.	Locality.	Distribution of 1,000 Males of each age by Civil Condition.																			Distribution of 1,000 Females of each age by Civil Condition.														
		All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.			All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.		
		Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38
AGARWALA (Hindu)...	Bengal ...	287	664	49	1,000	...	...	936	64	...	510	481	9	120	840	40	25	843	132	218	616	166	1,000	...	...	843	153	4	128	784	88	13	894	93	10	458	532
	Bihar and Orissa ...	423	480	97	1,000	...	...	936	54	10	525	457	18	129	785	86	62	676	262	267	447	286	992	8	...	884	116	...	92	844	64	17	704	279	3	293	704
AJLAF (Musalman) ...	Bengal ...	474	502	24	997	3	...	981	18	1	705	291	4	63	917	20	8	902	90	301	543	156	980	20	·3	686	306	8	25	947	28	8	865	127	6	339	655
ANGLO-INDIAN (Christian).	Bengal ...	642	300	58	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	937	63	·5	427	509	64	166	639	195	549	320	131	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	870	115	15	248	640	112	145	424	431
	Bihar and Orissa ...	647	320	33	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	766	234	...	489	479	32	153	708	139	550	360	90	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	667	330	3	242	693	65	92	466	442
BABHAN (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	492	431	77	989	10	1	952	45	3	668	320	12	263	671	66	91	677	232	292	446	262	985	13	2	879	113	8	211	733	56	10	762	228	6	340	654
BAGDI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	471	478	51	998	2	...	978	22	·2	732	260	8	122	838	40	19	800	181	264	474	262	991	9	·5	746	244	10	61	843	96	9	713	278	5	277	718
BAIDYA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	561	407	32	998	2	...	995	5	...	905	91	4	206	767	27	32	848	120	361	433	206	998	2	...	949	48	3	178	785	37	9	800	191	2	325	673
BAISHNAB (Hindu) ...	Bengal	451	470	79	997	3	·1	978	21	1	735	254	11	155	781	64	68	709	223	209	409	382	990	9	1	746	241	13	87	802	111	14	606	380	6	214	780
BANIYA (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	395	530	75	980	19	1	812	174	14	489	480	31	99	825	76	29	760	211	244	497	259	944	53	3	575	406	19	55	870	75	16	738	246	8	267	725
BARAI (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	339	582	79	957	39	4	625	360	15	304	655	41	75	836	89	22	772	206	233	581	186	924	74	2	466	506	28	119	838	43	11	849	140	5	455	540
BARHI (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	382	559	59	989	30	1	727	263	10	421	545	34	67	874	59	17	814	169	270	570	160	938	58	4	590	390	20	131	831	38	12	877	111	10	458	532
BARUI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	507	442	51	998	2	...	991	9	·1	792	198	10	153	805	42	31	795	174	306	462	232	996	2	2	809	185	6	59	877	64	4	732	264	5	274	721
BAURI (Hindu) ..	Bengal	478	474	48	999	1	...	958	42	·2	596	388	16	60	879	61	22	815	163	326	499	175	996	4	·1	845	150	5	137	812	51	9	800	191	5	446	549
	Bihar and Orissa ...	493	457	50	999	1	·5	971	27	2	688	284	28	125	821	54	14	839	147	379	462	159	938	62	·3	925	73	2	322	641	37	28	849	153	10	403	587
BHOTIA (Buddhist) ...	Bengal	501	460	39	1,000	...	...	988	12	...	887	108	5	297	686	17	63	812	125	424	478	98	998	2	...	987	13	...	650	335	15	120	813	67	30	664	306
BHUIYA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	430	529	41	1,000	·4	...	968	32	·3	690	304	6	93	864	41	16	862	122	347	472	181	997	3	...	852	145	3	190	768	42	14	784	202	5	389	606
	Bihar and Orissa ...	484	467	49	983	16	1	943	55	2	596	369	35	95	850	55	26	819	155	387	475	138	972	25	3	864	126	10	302	646	52	34	841	125	32	468	500
BHUNMALI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	498	445	57	998	2	...	984	15	1	818	178	4	191	763	46	27	782	191	300	447	253	997	3	·2	821	170	9	70	859	71	6	726	268	2	231	767
BHUMIJ (Hindu) ..	Bengal	481	471	48	998	1	1	949	11	·1	709	263	28	111	841	48	18	833	149	370	448	182	996	4	·3	905	91	4	274	684	42	21	798	181	6	390	604
	Bihar and Orissa ...	497	430	73	989	11	...	945	44	11	599	325	76	181	741	78	34	786	180	404	426	170	963	30	7	881	83	36	380	497	123	77	759	164	50	513	437
BHUMIJ (Animist) ...	Bihar and Orissa ..	589	387	24	1,000	...	...	994	5	1	894	106	...	187	794	19	29	856	115	466	397	137	1,000	...	...	970	29	1	569	424	7	50	824	126	28	397	575
BRAHMAN (Hindu) ...	Bengal	485	464	51	998	2	·01	936	14	·4	788	203	9	199	762	39	57	776	167	297	462	251	996	3	1	840	154	6	100	829	71	8	734	258	3	291	706
	Bihar and Orissa ...	471	456	73	993	6	1	959	39	2	672	310	18	187	753	60	61	711	228	281	459	260	987	12	1	812	178	10	142	789	69	10	744	246	7	327	666
BRAHMO (Hindu) ...	Bengal	627	336	37	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	957	43	...	565	408	27	60	813	127	547	321	132	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	795	170	35	244	622	134	9	474	517
CHAKMA (Buddhist) ...	Bengal	574	393	33	1,000	...	...	995	5	...	916	83	1	165	807	28	16	854	130	519	429	52	1,000	...	...	995	4	1	642	356	2	30	950	20	9	662	329
CHAMAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	309	647	44	993	7	...	933	65	2	500	482	18	90	864	46	21	881	98	277	555	168	993	7	·2	785	209	6	97	859	44	11	849	140	4	408	588
	Bihar and Orissa ...	379	571	50	964	34	2	717	273	10	378	587	35	48	900	52	16	839	145	280	567	153	934	63	3	612	368	20	151	809	40	13	877	110	8	464	528
CHASA (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	532	434	34	1,000	·2	...	991	9	·1	894	105	1	189	785	26	10	863	127	376	443	181	1,000	·2	·1	956	43	1	393	591	16	12	860	128	5	365	630
CHINESE (Confucian)	Bengal	237	751	12	1,000	...	...	941	59	...	780	220	...	227	773	...	65	887	48	343	593	64	1,000	...	...	897	103	...	667	333	...	...	984	16	...	652	348
CHINESE (Buddhist) ...	Bengal	407	591	2	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	839	161	...	367	633	...	148	837	15	360	570	70	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	594	406	...	145	845	10	135	577	288
DHANUK (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	283	650	67	948	50	2	560	419	21	192	753	55	24	906	70	13	836	161	185	625	190	893	102	5	334	630	36	42	907	51	8	860	132	4	425	571

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V—Distribution by Civil Condition of 1,000 of each Sex at certain ages for Selected Castes—*continued.*

Caste.	Locality.	Distribution of 1,000 Males of each age by Civil Condition.																			Distribution of 1,000 Females of each age by Civil Condition.														
		All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.				All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.		
		Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.		Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20		21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38
DHOBA (Hindu) ...	Bengal ...	487	458	55	998	2	...	982	17	1	770	221	9	164	788	48	26	790	184		301	458	241	993	6	1	809	185	6	81	844	75	11	719	270	3	270	727
	Bihar and Orissa ...	415	531	54	978	21	1	806	187	7	546	430	24	84	863	53	17	815	168		305	527	168	956	40	4	710	277	13	235	724	41	16	859	125	18	417	565
DHUNIA (Musalman) ..	Bihar and Orissa ...	397	554	49	976	23	1	773	221	6	373	602	25	46	895	59	14	844	142		272	568	160	960	38	2	561	424	15	114	832	54	13	874	113	6	461	533
DOM (Hindu) ...	Bengal	424	517	59	996	4	...	964	36	·2	597	387	16	91	848	61	29	799	172		263	528	209	986	13	1	725	267	8	107	820	63	8	795	197	5	354	641
	Bihar and Orissa ...	435	516	49	980	19	1	891	103	6	457	499	44	55	896	49	28	826	146		354	517	129	977	23	·2	749	240	11	193	756	51	46	833	121	55	497	448
DOSADH (Hindu) ...	Bengal	222	720	58	980	20	...	825	173	2	483	495	22	72	872	56	16	872	112		217	570	213	1,000	...	...	785	215	...	185	784	31	22	815	163	6	460	534
EUROPEANS AND ALLIED RACES (Christian).	Bengal	649	321	30	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	979	20	1	671	312	17	237	669	94		514	406	80	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	911	88	1	311	643	46	213	526	261
	Bihar and Orissa ...	591	354	55	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	960	40	...	575	385	40	225	633	142		503	431	66	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	854	146	...	273	692	35	189	579	232
GANDHABANIK (Hindu).	Bengal	456	493	51	995	5	...	987	13	·5	771	221	8	156	803	41	29	814	157		295	462	243	997	3	...	837	156	7	64	833	103	13	748	244	4	282	714
GARO (Hindu) ...	Bengal	487	501	12	1,000	...	...	983	17	...	822	178	...	149	837	14	9	957	34		362	534	104	1,000	...	...	874	121	5	169	762	69	18	897	90	...	601	399
GARO (Animist ...	Bengal	535	444	21	999	1	...	978	22	·4	748	241	11	121	851	28	10	926	64		435	485	80	995	4	1	905	90	5	266	703	31	18	895	87	8	585	407
GAURA (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	501	460	39	1,000	·2	...	977	23	·3	779	218	3	134	831	35	10	845	145		327	469	204	1,000	·4	...	902	96	2	280	695	25	10	842	148	4	339	657
GOALA (Ahir) (Hindu)	Bengal	434	503	63	996	4	·1	978	21	1	739	250	11	166	785	49	37	770	193		247	457	296	992	7	1	673	313	14	62	824	114	10	667	323	4	247	749
	Bihar and Orissa ...	345	578	77	954	44	2	884	100	16	363	594	43	69	848	83	19	778	203		253	579	168	923	72	5	538	436	26	141	807	52	12	863	125	9	457	534
GOND (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	517	456	27	1,000	·1	...	972	28	·1	697	293	5	98	868	34	12	885	103		407	449	144	1,000	·3	...	884	114	2	343	638	19	25	866	109	11	371	618
GURUNG	Bengal	542	433	25	999	1	...	990	10	...	839	159	2	192	790	18	77	818	105		468	452	80	993	·5	...	988	12	...	670	327	3	88	858	54	18	660	322
HAJJAM AND NAPIT (Hindu).	Bengal	487	454	59	999	1	...	985	14	1	775	216	9	165	787	48	28	771	201		285	443	266	992	7	1	775	215	10	72	838	90	7	695	298	4	248	748
	Bihar and Orissa ...	378	557	65	966	28	6	760	228	12	357	600	43	62	868	70	28	796	176		268	561	171	948	49	3	597	382	21	130	807	63	18	858	124	14	439	547
HAJJAM (Musalman)	Bengal	452	507	41	983	17	...	951	44	5	557	416	27	91	872	37	47	829	124		283	455	262	990	10	...	625	339	36	180	730	90	85	621	294	38	156	806
	Bihar and Orissa ...	439	486	75	996	4	·3	926	73	1	522	458	20	80	838	82	15	764	221		317	509	174	982	18	·4	810	186	4	190	780	30	17	855	128	4	435	561
HARI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	455	486	59	993	2	...	980	19	1	672	307	21	103	835	62	23	801	174		299	501	200	992	6	·2	786	207	7	111	832	57	10	801	189	12	334	654
	Bihar and Orissa ...	532	421	47	1,000	...	...	989	11	...	893	103	5	120	831	49	12	818	170		454	427	119	1,000	...	...	978	22	...	501	485	14	29	887	84	7	449	544
INDIAN CHRISTIAN (Christian).	Bengal	559	405	36	997	3	...	994	6	·3	917	79	4	217	743	40	45	831	124		445	424	131	998	2	·1	982	18	·3	459	521	20	67	808	125	34	457	509
	Bihar and Orissa ...	586	390	24	997	3	·1	993	7	·2	874	122	4	125	847	28	17	881	102		508	391	101	998	2	·3	987	12	1	673	318	9	54	862	83	18	523	459
JOGI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	512	442	46	999	1	·1	987	13	·2	820	175	5	176	790	34	38	793	169		296	459	245	996	4	·3	794	199	7	52	882	66	13	727	260	3	239	758
JOLAHA (Musalman)	Bengal	445	517	38	998	2	·1	962	37	1	650	341	9	88	872	40	23	856	121		298	523	179	989	11	·4	733	270	7	104	862	34	12	839	149	4	252	664
	Bihar and Orissa ...	427	517	56	983	16	1	826	168	6	400	565	35	59	881	60	17	811	172		305	546	149	967	31	2	685	306	9	139	826	35	15	880	105	12	465	523
KAHAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	212	736	52	993	7	...	940	60	...	432	560	8	103	846	51	21	875	104		237	570	193	997	3	...	782	216	2	244	705	51	68	772	160	6	490	504
	Bihar and Orissa ...	410	525	65	988	12	·2	875	120	5	450	521	29	59	862	79	16	803	181		271	529	200	978	20	2	729	258	13	123	838	39	12	850	138	7	390	603
KAIBARTTA (unspecified) (Hindu).	Bengal	374	517	109	1,000	...	...	957	35	8	456	511	33	115	764	121	27	681	292		253	454	293	1,000	...	...	781	210	9	110	820	70	7	613	380	2	272	726
KAIBARTTA JALIA (Hindu).	Bengal	497	450	53	999	1	·1	988	11	1	787	206	7	182	774	44	29	788	183		310	449	241	993	6	1	817	177	6	118	803	79	14	720	266	4	257	739
KAIBARTTA CHASI (Hindu).	Bengal	494	451	55	995	5	·1	983	16	1	753	234	13	155	793	49	27	786	187		279	458	263	988	11	1	741	247	12	76	815	109	12	686	302	7	272	721
KALWAR (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	409	523	68	985	14	1	840	154	6	472	495	33	89	836	75	22	785	193		281	529	190	962	35	3	711	277	12	141	824	35	11	854	135	7	407	586
KAMAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	471	467	62	998	2	·1	932	17	1	755	231	14	158	788	54	32	775	193		281	464	255	993	6	1	767	223	10	90	818	92	11	716	273	4	283	713

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—Distribution by Civil Condition of 1,000 of each sex at certain ages for Selected Castes—*continued.*

Caste.	Locality.	Distribution of 1,000 Males of each age by Civil Condition.																			Distribution of 1,000 Females of each age by Civil Condition.														
		All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.			All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.		
		Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38
KAMAR (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	408	451	41	1,000	...	...	989	11	...	851	146	3	147	823	30	13	835	152	326	479	195	999	1	...	910	89	1	246	728	26	12	850	138	9	332	659
KANDH (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	544	425	31	1,000	·2	...	990	10	·1	892	105	3	196	770	34	27	863	110	438	407	155	1,000	·2	...	976	23	1	629	359	12	44	839	117	15	375	610
KANDH (Animist) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	568	402	30	1,000	·1	...	993	7	·1	893	98	4	221	745	34	27	858	115	471	392	137	1,000	·3	...	988	11	1	643	322	35	65	828	107	18	359	623
KANDU (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	403	528	69	982	18	·4	825	168	7	446	522	32	76	844	80	17	790	193	284	530	186	969	29	2	708	280	12	143	818	39	12	856	132	7	413	580
KAORA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	358	577	65	982	18	...	980	20	...	653	357	10	93	833	68	25	809	166	200	550	250	1,000	...	...	827	168	5	144	766	90	30	740	230	35	379	586
KAPALI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	526	430	44	999	1	...	988	12	...	781	213	6	171	793	36	27	803	170	312	434	254	994	5	1	755	237	8	45	880	75	26	689	285	2	222	776
KARAN (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	551	406	43	1,000	·4	...	995	5	...	953	46	1	304	671	25	32	814	154	384	389	247	999	1	...	982	17	1	593	590	17	14	794	192	5	307	688
KAYASTH (Hindu) ...	Bengal	527	428	45	999	1	·01	988	12	·3	860	128	12	226	731	43	42	805	153	313	417	270	997	2	1	912	83	5	122	809	69	9	715	276	3	248	749
	Bihar and Orissa ...	459	426	85	993	6	1	963	34	3	745	236	19	234	693	73	72	684	244	323	425	252	991	8	1	934	60	6	330	626	44	12	771	217	7	3.3	660
KEWAT (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	479	485	36	999	1	...	975	25	·1	738	259	3	115	854	31	9	858	133	349	474	177	999	1	·1	899	99	2	302	679	19	12	862	126	5	572	623
KHAMBU AND JIMDAR (Hindu).	Bengal	493	473	34	996	4	...	980	20	·4	846	152	2	170	802	28	21	863	116	483	426	91	995	5	...	975	25	·1	752	240	8	102	825	73	16	630	354
KHANDAIT (Hindu) ...	Bengal	246	708	46	994	6	...	943	57	...	407	559	34	193	775	30	23	877	100	297	448	255	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	415	463	122	111	633	256	141	412	447
	Bihar and Orissa ...	551	412	37	1,000	·2	...	992	8	·1	906	92	2	216	758	26	13	837	150	359	416	225	1,000	·1	...	956	42	2	429	545	26	10	796	194	4	314	682
KHARIA (Animist) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	569	398	33	997	3	·3	960	40	...	680	316	4	141	822	37	21	825	154	481	382	137	996	3	1	971	27	2	544	426	30	48	824	128	14	442	544
KHAS (Hindu) ...	Bengal	524	454	22	996	4	...	976	24	...	777	221	2	201	770	29	37	892	71	459	472	69	995	5	...	949	51	·5	539	455	6	79	871	50	15	667	318
KHATRI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	338	568	94	993	7	...	945	55	...	664	323	18	255	644	101	40	791	169	209	583	206	1,000	...	...	899	81	20	88	878	34	21	761	218	7	542	451
KOCH (Hindu) ...	Bengal	509	457	34	999	1	·3	990	10	...	644	332	24	152	815	33	19	876	105	373	462	165	998	2	·2	877	119	4	138	741	121	7	821	172	·2	418	582
KOIRI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	232	720	48	931	19	...	973	27	...	463	520	17	127	834	39	33	836	111	301	510	189	1,000	...	...	915	85	...	282	624	94	159	691	170	15	581	404
	Bihar and Orissa ...	367	557	76	973	25	2	757	233	10	405	564	31	84	837	79	21	766	213	237	560	173	954	41	5	611	370	19	128	828	44	12	857	131	7	449	544
KUKI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	551	409	40	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	941	59	...	137	802	61	5	871	124	485	404	131	1,000	...	...	977	23	...	593	384	23	73	797	130	6	464	530
KULU ((Musalman) ...	Bengal	500	471	29	999	1	...	952	47	1	690	302	8	93	872	35	28	876	96	338	508	154	995	5	...	806	188	6	56	912	32	21	858	121	2	292	706
KUMHAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	481	457	62	999	1	...	984	15	1	750	237	13	160	790	50	36	759	205	276	453	271	993	7	·3	734	258	8	67	832	101	7	686	307	4	259	737
	Bihar and Orissa ...	385	561	54	965	34	1	745	245	10	448	518	34	68	877	55	18	831	151	297	543	154	921	77	2	600	383	17	213	728	59	23	856	121	19	449	532
KUNJRA (Musalman)	Bihar and Orissa ...	357	590	53	969	30	1	668	320	12	263	708	29	36	907	57	17	828	155	246	597	157	929	67	4	476	505	19	58	874	38	12	880	108	10	457	533
KURMI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	412	544	44	999	1	...	969	31	·3	513	465	22	57	894	49	14	861	125	293	531	176	992	8	...	693	301	6	93	849	58	15	825	160	3	369	628
	Bihar and Orissa ...	384	513	103	973	25	2	812	180	8	457	503	40	92	771	137	29	794	247	289	519	192	947	47	6	680	297	23	214	697	89	21	806	173	13	443	544
LEPCHA (Christian) ...	Bengal	607	372	21	1,000	...	...	992	8	...	961	39	...	249	732	19	46	849	105	569	352	79	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	815	185	...	173	784	43	31	546	423
LEPCHA (Buddhist) ...	Bengal	437	501	32	998	2	...	990	9	1	858	142	...	217	767	16	31	870	99	397	512	91	995	5	...	990	10	...	786	214	...	125	842	33	15	704	281
LOHAR (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	445	503	52	988	12	·4	868	127	5	507	469	24	87	853	60	27	812	161	330	513	157	969	27	4	776	211	13	236	728	46	24	862	114	13	454	533
MAGH (Buddhist) ...	Bengal	584	382	34	1,000	·1	...	996	4	...	950	48	2	202	760	38	24	859	117	428	412	160	1,000	...	...	977	22	1	517	452	31	34	828	138	7	420	573
MALLAH (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	460	463	57	989	11	·3	906	91	3	563	414	23	72	871	57	19	809	181	311	500	189	978	20	2	816	175	9	232	731	37	25	846	129	16	409	575
MALO (Hindu) ...	Bengal	500	438	62	999	1	·1	991	9	·3	816	172	12	228	722	50	29	776	195	292	431	277	998	2	·2	819	174	7	97	809	94	12	689	299	2	239	759
MAL PAHARIA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	540	426	34	993	7	...	952	45	3	734	233	33	105	848	47	43	870	87	418	464	118	993	7	·3	912	84	4	350	603	47	28	866	114	11	562	427

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—Distribution by Civil Condition of 1,000 of each Sex at certain Ages for Selected Castes—*continued.*

Caste.	Locality.	Distribution of 1,000 Males of each age by Civil Condition.																		Distribution of 1,000 Females of each age by Civil Condition.															
		All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.			All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.		
		Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38
MAYRA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	287	652	61	1,000	...	...	975	25	...	575	394	31	141	822	37	13	831	156	272	473	255	982	18	...	844	156	...	146	775	79	49	666	285	16	357	627
MECH (Hindu) ...	Bengal	518	437	45	1,000	...	...	994	6	...	857	135	8	251	712	37	84	781	135	374	554	72	1,000	..	...	796	204	...	364	627	9	40	926	34	4	665	331
MECH (Animist) ..	Bengal	533	430	37	996	4	...	976	22	2	805	189	6	210	747	43	34	859	107	499	437	64	766	214	20	944	42	14	304	635	61	14	916	70	24	630	346
MOGHAL (Musalman)	Bengal	377	547	76	1,000	...	...	1,000	...	...	580	412	8	279	642	79	24	795	181	321	486	193	1,000	...	...	864	136	...	357	619	24	124	618	258	129	516	355
MUCHI (Hindu) ..	Bengal	431	529	40	998	2	...	968	31	1	633	350	17	81	882	37	16	859	125	292	517	191	990	9	1	708	283	9	95	844	61	8	811	181	4	329	667
MUNDA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	502	439	59	998	2	...	949	44	7	708	271	21	167	737	96	98	783	121	455	461	84	1,000	4	...	935	42	3	299	674	27	53	859	88	1	538	461
	Bihar and Orissa ...	526	436	38	994	4	2	980	18	2	754	238	8	161	799	40	50	825	125	416	422	162	986	10	4	923	67	10	440	517	43	70	796	134	25	436	539
MUNDA (Animist) ...	Bengal	508	448	44	998	2	...	987	13	...	849	141	10	192	760	48	23	839	138	455	475	70	999	1	...	966	34	...	492	497	11	42	893	64	...	596	404
	Bihar and Orissa ...	550	410	40	995	4	1	982	16	2	716	277	7	138	803	59	39	827	134	478	395	127	996	3	1	965	31	4	569	400	31	60	829	111	35	499	466
MURMI (Buddhist) ...	Bengal	546	420	34	997	3	...	995	5	·2	837	163	...	196	772	32	23	841	136	497	425	78	996	4	...	984	16	...	820	180	...	95	852	53	14	676	310
MUSAHAR (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	370	578	52	968	30	2	760	230	10	347	618	35	30	913	57	18	848	139	304	579	117	946	51	3	632	352	16	130	830	40	13	891	96	8	563	429
NAMASUDRA (Hindu)	Bengal	509	437	54	998	2	·1	977	22	1	780	203	17	167	786	47	30	786	184	304	438	258	993	6	1	778	211	11	68	779	153	6	690	304	4	266	730
NUNIYA (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	397	546	57	968	30	2	755	232	13	438	513	49	64	883	53	18	821	161	287	547	166	950	48	2	667	316	17	184	770	46	15	870	115	8	458	534
ORAON (Hindu) ...	Bengal	479	458	63	998	1	1	981	13	6	697	274	29	138	775	87	98	763	139	437	459	104	999	1	...	949	49	2	382	591	27	40	824	136	15	541	444
	Bihar and Orissa ...	494	470	36	988	11	1	954	45	1	559	418	23	52	899	49	18	872	110	439	440	121	987	11	2	922	62	16	344	632	24	20	876	104	33	472	495
ORAON (Animist) ..	Bengal	491	463	46	998	2	...	989	11	·5	814	182	4	126	818	56	14	850	136	449	467	84	1,000	...	·2	967	32	1	455	530	25	35	878	87	4	577	419
	Bihar and Orissa ...	509	456	35	996	4	·2	980	19	1	580	410	10	38	919	43	12	843	145	393	447	160	990	9	1	972	21	7	348	607	45	18	844	138	7	585	458
PAN (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	560	412	28	1,000	·1	...	988	12	·1	893	105	2	151	821	28	14	869	117	435	417	148	1,000	·4	·1	972	27	1	496	489	15	23	852	125	8	385	607
PAN (Animist) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	543	430	27	1,000	...	...	974	26	...	829	164	7	147	817	36	22	879	99	465	421	114	1,000	...	...	955	45	...	558	416	26	47	862	91	16	422	562
PATHAN (Musalman)	Bengal	450	507	43	997	3	·2	977	21	2	706	279	15	151	805	44	29	851	120	323	489	188	993	4	1	839	155	6	141	807	52	15	811	174	17	345	638
	Bihar and Orissa ...	510	443	47	993	7	·2	973	25	2	785	200	17	151	803	46	23	829	148	341	451	208	987	12	1	902	91	7	282	677	41	20	814	166	11	369	620
PATNI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	536	400	64	998	2	...	995	5	...	898	95	7	335	615	50	49	746	205	269	403	328	999	1	...	850	144	6	76	851	73	7	633	360	2	186	862
POD (Hindu) ...	Bengal	485	480	34	997	3	·2	968	31	1	665	329	6	80	894	26	12	855	133	298	498	204	956	43	1	642	347	10	42	876	82	8	742	250	6	305	689
RAJBANSI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	535	407	58	999	1	·04	991	8	1	799	196	5	244	700	56	31	777	192	346	422	232	996	4	·5	848	145	7	102	835	63	9	718	273	4	229	767
RAJPUT (Hindu) ...	Bengal	417	516	67	997	3	...	973	27	...	672	305	23	214	722	64	58	763	169	278	471	251	989	9	2	755	236	9	158	749	93	15	702	283	3	327	670
	Bihar and Orissa ...	528	399	73	993	6	1	966	31	3	728	258	14	299	635	66	99	677	224	305	425	270	979	19	2	896	105	9	277	661	62	14	742	244	7	324	669
RAJWAR (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	388	548	64	995	5	...	796	199	5	358	619	23	58	882	60	21	774	205	302	537	161	988	12	·2	732	260	8	160	799	41	11	864	125	5	442	553
RAUNIAR (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	359	582	59	959	40	1	700	288	12	341	636	23	67	864	69	29	806	165	276	555	169	945	54	1	559	424	17	81	851	68	7	846	147	14	481	505
SADGOP (Hindu) ...	Bengal	476	445	79	999	1	·03	979	20	1	724	258	18	195	743	62	46	708	246	239	454	307	991	8	1	707	281	12	63	830	107	5	669	326	4	244	752
SAIYAD (Musalman) ...	Bengal	487	473	40	997	3	...	983	16	1	732	256	12	204	759	37	26	851	123	328	475	197	989	10	1	861	133	6	184	774	42	18	802	180	10	335	655
	Bihar and Orissa ...	512	436	52	990	8	2	974	24	2	810	169	21	160	792	48	32	812	156	360	435	205	990	7	3	922	69	9	353	602	45	23	812	165	13	371	616
SANTAL (Hindu) ...	Bengal	514	450	36	998	2	·1	989	11	·1	744	247	9	138	822	40	15	868	117	427	462	111	998	2	...	952	44	3	370	595	35	24	861	115	8	556	436
	Bihar and Orissa ...	468	461	71	997	3	·2	889	97	14	533	412	55	108	797	95	46	790	164	381	468	151	979	19	2	831	158	11	318	592	95	26	786	188	14	517	469

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—Distribution by Civil Condition of 1,000 of each sex at certain ages for Selected Castes—*concluded.*

Caste.	Locality.	Distribution of 1,000 Males of each age by Civil Condition.																		
		All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.			
		Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	
SANTAL (Animist) ...	Bengal	544	420	36	993	2	·1	985	14	1	789	198	13	147	813	40	16	863	121	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	568	403	29	996	4	·02	990	10	·1	693	294	8	119	843	38	17	858	125	
SONAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	375	539	86	1,000	...	...	937	13	...	633	312	55	184	730	86	26	808	166	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	429	498	73	985	12	3	877	118	5	520	441	39	103	825	72	28	759	213	
SUBARNABANIK (Hindu).	Bengal	421	531	48	999	1	...	932	17	1	751	239	10	162	801	37	98	772	130	
SUDRA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	532	400	68	1,000	·4	·1	985	14	1	776	217	7	183	760	57	24	727	249	
SUNRI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	470	454	76	997	3	...	951	38	1	643	337	20	192	738	70	45	738	217	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	341	583	73	940	58	2	650	333	17	318	632	50	49	871	80	9	798	193	
SUTRADHAR (Hindu)	Bengal	495	448	57	999	1	...	990	10	·1	789	201	10	174	777	49	24	783	189	
TANTI AND TATWA (Hindu).	Bengal	448	494	58	998	1	1	982	17	1	723	261	16	138	808	54	33	791	171	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	361	582	57	948	49	3	656	325	19	433	524	43	68	880	52	15	835	150	
TELI AND TILI (Hindu).	Bengal	457	476	67	999	1	...	978	22	·3	693	292	15	158	787	55	40	745	215	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	384	570	66	960	36	4	730	267	13	377	583	40	61	820	69	20	799	181	
TIPARA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	544	419	37	987	13	...	994	6	...	853	144	3	101	860	39	8	847	145	
TIPARA (Animist) ...	Bengal	531	433	36	1,000	...	...	997	2	1	891	108	1	123	836	41	13	865	122	
TIYAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	523	413	64	1,000	·4	...	976	24	·3	716	267	17	193	740	67	88	714	198	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	401	552	47	979	21	·3	808	187	5	444	536	20	62	888	50	10	849	141	

Caste.	Locality.	Distribution of 1,000 Females of each age by Civil Condition.																		
		All ages.			0—5			5—12			12—20			20—40			40 and over.			
		Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	
1	2	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	
SANTAL (Animist) ...	Bengal	450	426	124	998	2	·1	963	35	2	412	552	36	32	846	122	12	483	505	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	485	425	90	994	5	1	973	26	1	458	522	20	46	868	86	12	545	443	
SONAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	264	503	233	1,000	...	...	947	53	...	287	634	79	21	692	287	...	523	477	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	301	509	190	974	24	2	755	233	12	160	787	53	12	833	155	8	411	581	
SUBARNABANIK (Hindu).	Bengal	250	510	240	934	16	...	889	108	3	188	757	55	17	732	251	8	428	564	
SUDRA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	339	425	235	999	1	·3	899	93	3	198	751	51	46	917	237	21	288	691	
SUNRI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	284	448	268	992	7	1	718	274	8	115	788	97	13	663	324	4	306	690	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	254	564	182	930	66	4	497	476	27	132	794	74	18	830	152	26	430	544	
SUTRADHAR (Hindu)	Bengal	300	445	255	997	3	·2	814	179	7	104	815	81	8	707	285	4	251	745	
TANTI AND TATWA (Hindu).	Bengal	273	471	256	993	7	·4	741	251	8	121	791	88	11	711	278	8	314	678	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	237	580	183	913	84	3	517	455	28	155	797	48	11	858	131	6	421	563	
TELI AND TILI (Hindu).	Bengal	243	454	290	991	8	1	678	309	13	87	808	105	11	676	313	3	271	726	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	263	566	171	939	58	3	570	409	21	132	813	55	12	863	125	10	434	557	
TIPARA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	496	435	69	1,000	·2	...	935	15	·1	488	502	10	20	937	43	7	596	396	
TIPARA (Animist) ...	Bengal	476	458	66	1,000	...	...	988	10	2	533	458	9	30	936	34	14	635	351	
TIYAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	334	426	240	999	1	...	780	214	6	115	775	110	9	680	311	5	228	769	
	Bihar and Orissa ...	288	531	181	952	46	2	597	388	15	103	850	47	7	834	159	4	366	630	

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CHAPTER VIII.

EDUCATION.

INTRODUCTORY.

690. The returns on which the discussion in this chapter is based will be found in Imperial Tables VIII and IX, in which the number of persons who are literate or illiterate is shown by age periods. In Table VIII statistics of literacy are given for the province as a whole, and for each religion returned, and also for the main religions in each district and city. The figures in Table IX deal with the literacy of individual castes, tribes and races grouped together for homogeneous localities. Further statistics, mainly proportional, are given in the following Subsidiary Tables at the end of this chapter :—

Subsidiary Table	*I.*—Education by age, sex and religion.
Ditto	*II.*—Education by age, sex and locality.
Ditto	*III.*—Education by religion, sex and locality.
Ditto	*IV.*—English education by age, sex and locality.
Ditto	*V.*—Progress of education since 1881.
Ditto	*VI.*—Education by caste.
Ditto	*VII.*—Number of educational institutions and pupils.
Ditto	*VIII.*—Main results of University examinations.
Ditto	*IX.*—Number and circulation of newspapers, etc.
Ditto	*X.*—Number of books published in each language.

INSTRUCTIONS TO ENUMERATORS.

691. At each of the last three censuses different instructions have been given regarding the entries relating to education to be made in the schedules In 1891 the same classification was adopted as in 1881, the population being divided into three classes, viz., "Learning," "Literate" and "Illiterate." Those who were under instruction, either at home or at school or college, were entered as "Learning." Those who were not under instruction, but able both to read and write, were recorded as "Literate," and the remainder of the population as "Illiterate." It was found, however, that the return of the "Learning," *i.e.*, children under instruction, was vitiated by the omission of children who had not long been at school, as they were entered as "Illiterate," and also of more advanced students, who were classed as "Literate." There were thus great discrepancies between the census returns of the number of "Learning," and the corresponding statistics of the Education Department. It was therefore decided in 1901 to confine the entry in the enumeration schedules to the two main categories of "Literate" and "Illiterate," the former being those who were able both to read and write, and the latter those who did not satisfy this standard. No other criterion, however, was laid down, and the standard to be adopted, in deciding whether a person could read or write, was left indeterminate. At this census a further condition was imposed, viz., that a person was to be recorded as literate only if he could write a letter to a friend and read the answer to it. The standard was therefore higher than that hitherto prescribed.

692. The new condition, if strictly applied, should have led to the exclusion of a number of persons who have hitherto been entered as literate, such as boys at school who can read and write a little, but are unable to write a letter, and also that large body of persons who can read but have not got further with their writing than signing their names or keeping accounts. In some cases the instructions were strictly followed, the result being a large diminution in the number of literates at early ages. In Nadia, for instance,

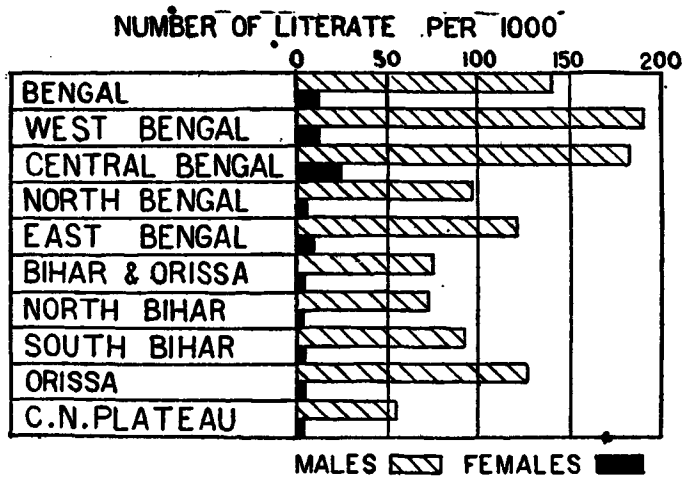
where the census was very carefully conducted, the number of literate persons under 10 years of age decreased by 47 per cent., and there was a decrease of 16 per cent. among those aged 10—15. On the other hand there was a small increase of 1½ per cent. at the age period 15—20, and then an increase of 5 per cent. among those aged 20 and over. Elsewhere, the same exactitude was not shewn, especially in the case of persons able to read and write English. Still, the change in the instructions has affected the returns very materially, as may be realized from the marginal table, which shows that the proportion of literate males under 10 years of age has risen only in one division, is stationary in two and has fallen in five. It is perhaps superfluous to add that owing to the wider diffusion of primary education, and the natural growth of the population, since 1901, children under 10 would have shewn a large increase of literates had the definition remained the same.

Division.	No. of literate males per mille aged 0—10.	
	1901.	1911.
West Bengal ...	49	36
Central ,, ...	37	34
North ,, ...	14	14
East ,, ...	17	16
North Bihar ...	9	10
South ,, ...	11	11
Orissa	25	12
Chota Nagpur plateau	8	6

BENGAL.

693. Taking the population as a whole, the total number of persons in Bengal who are literate is 3,575,231, or 7·7 per cent. of the population. Of these, 3,323,195 are males, and a little over a quarter of a million (252,036) are females: in other words, for every female who is able to read and write, there are 13 males. Considered in their proportion to the total male and female population, we find that one male in every seven and one female in every 99 is literate. This does not argue any very wide diffusion of education, but it must be remembered that a large proportion of the population consists of children who are either too young to learn or have only recently begun their studies. Excluding those aged under 10, the proportion of literates among males is approximately one in five, and among females one in sixty-eight.

Extent of literacy.



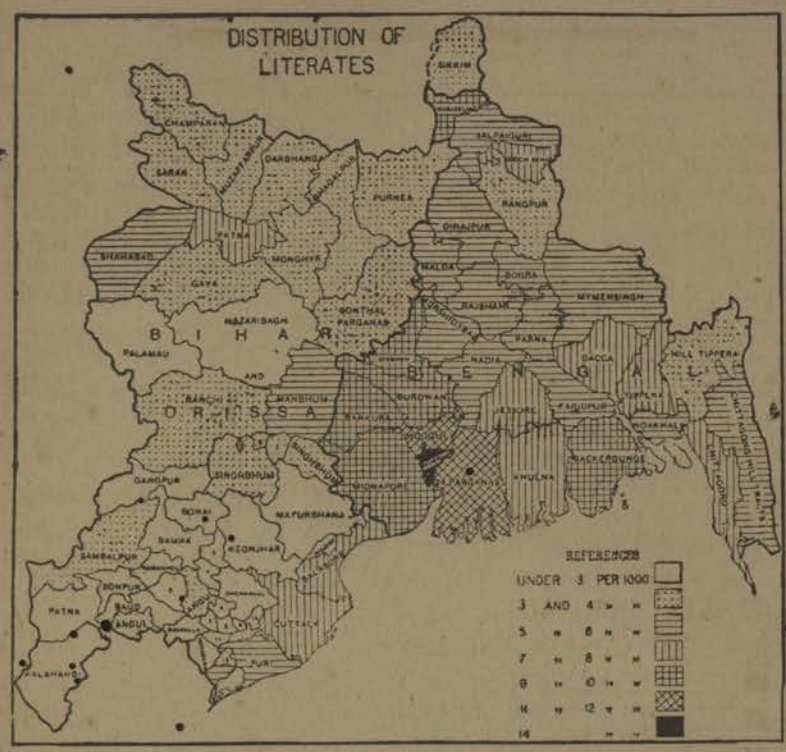
There is a steady rise in the relative strength of male literates as they advance in years, the percentage being 14 per cent. between the ages of 10 and 15, and rising to 19 per cent. between 15 and 20, while at 20 and over it is 20 per cent. There is no such progressive advance in the case of females, for the ratio at the first two age periods is 18 and 19 per mille, respectively, and then falls (*i.e.*, among those aged 20 and over) to 13 per mille. The explanation of this apparent anomaly is that, the education of women being a development of comparatively recent times, the number of those who have received instruction is naturally greater among the younger generation. A secondary cause is that the education of a girl is rarely continued after she has left her home for her husband's house and undertaken the duties of married life.

694. Central Bengal is the most advanced part of the province from an educational point of view, 11 per cent. of the inhabitants fulfilling the standard of literacy. This position it owes mainly to the city of Calcutta with its large population of educated Europeans, Bengalis and others in professional, commercial and

Distribution by locality.

clerical employment. West Bengal, with a proportion of 10 per cent., comes next on the list, and there is a marked decline in the other two divisions with their large Musalman communities. In East Bengal only one in 15 has even the rudiments of learning, and the nadir of ignorance is reached in North Bengal, only one out of every nineteen of its inhabitants being able to read and write.

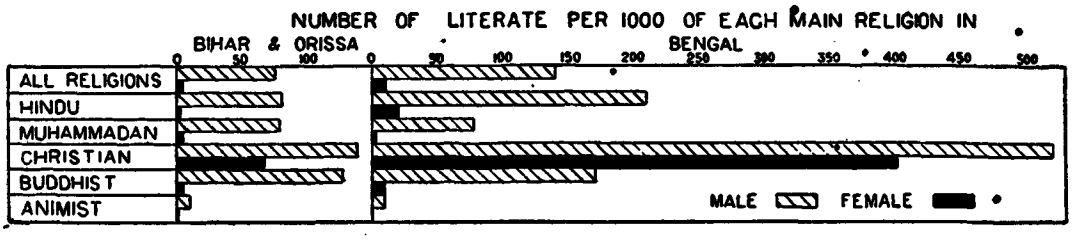
As regards individual districts, Calcutta is *facile princeps*, one out of every three of its inhabitants having sufficient knowledge to pass the census test: this figure is surprisingly high considering how largely immigrants drawn from a low strata of society bulk in its population. There are four districts in which 10 per cent. or more of the people are literate, viz., Howrah (14), the 24-Parganas (12), Hooghly (11) and Burdwan (10). The district last named is closely followed by Darjeeling (9·9 per cent.), which has a considerable Europeon community; in only two other districts, viz., Midnapore and Bankura, does the literate population reach 9 per cent. At the bottom of the list come four districts and one State in which the ratio is under 5 per cent, viz., Mymensingh, Rajshahi, Rangpur, Malda and Hill Tippera. The State of Cooch Behar holds a comparatively high place, 7·4 per cent. of its population being literate. It is superior in this respect to no less than 16 of the Bengal districts, and is nearly on the same level as Dacca (7·5 per cent.), which is famous for the high standard attained by the people of the Bikrampur *pargana*. Education is, as might be expected, far more widely disseminated in the urban than among the rural population, more than one-third of the males and nearly one-seventh of the females resident in the towns or cities of Bengal being so far advanced as to come within the category of "Literate."



695. Though the Hindus constitute a little less than one half of the total population of Bengal, they contribute seven-tenths of the number of literates, and the Musalmans, who represent 52 per cent., barely three-tenths. The total number of Hindu literates is nearly 2½ millions and of Musalmans one million, so that approximately there are only two Musalmans to every five Hindus who can read and write. Christians alone account for 60,000 literates, of whom one-third are Indian converts, and Buddhists for 22,000. Excluding Europeans, the Brahmos have by far the highest proportion of literates, three-fourths of them being able both to read and write: among Brahmo children under 10 one out of every three is literate, which argues either great precocity or an inattention to the instructions that only those who could write a letter to a friend and read the answer to it were to be entered as literates. The proportion among other Indian communities is less than one-third of that among the Brahmos. The most advanced are the Indian Christians, of whom one-fourth are literate. Next come the Hindus with 12 per cent., and the Buddhists with 9 per cent. The backwardness of the Musalmans is apparent from the fact that only 4 per cent. can read and write. At the bottom of the list come the

DISTRIBUTION BY RELIGION.

aboriginal races with an Animistic religion, who have a strength of nearly three-quarters of a million, but contribute less than 4,000 to the number of literates.



696. Education among the Hindus is most widely diffused in districts where they are least numerous. In East Bengal, where they are largely outnumbered by the Musalmans, out of every four Hindus is literate. In West Bengal, where the Hindus form a large majority, the proportion is only one in five. Of individual districts Backergunge contains more Hindu literates in proportion to its Hindu population than any other: then come, in order, Chittagong, Howrah, Tippera, Dacca and the 24-Parganas. The Hindus of Rangpur, Dinajpur, Jalpaiguri and Hill Tippera are the most backward, less than 11 per cent. of them being included in the returns for literates.

In the case of Musalmans the same phenomenon is noticeable, viz., that the degree of literacy varies inversely with their strength. The highest place is held by the Musalmans of West Bengal, where they form a small minority, and the proportion of literates falls steadily as the community rises in numerical strength. In North Bengal only 8 per cent. of the Musalman males are literate, and the minimum is reached in East Bengal, where they are most numerous. In the division last named only one in every 15 Musalman males can read and write, whereas in West Bengal one in seven can do so. The districts in which the greatest ignorance appears to prevail among the adherents of Islam are Nadia, Mymensingh and Faridpur, where less than 5 per mille of the males are literate. The ratio is over 13 per cent. in all the districts of West Bengal; outside this area it is over 10 per cent. only in the 24-Parganas, Cooch Behar, the Chittagong Hill Tracts, Dinajpur, Jalpaiguri and Darjeeling. In the last three districts only is education more general among Musalmans than Hindus, the explanation probably being that Jalpaiguri and Dinajpur include a large number of semi-Hinduized aboriginals from the Chota Nagpur Plateau, while the Musalmans of Darjeeling include immigrants from more advanced tracts.

LITERACY BY RACE AND CASTE.

697. European and other cognate races, such as Australians and Americans, naturally head the list of literate races, but the extent of literacy among the Anglo-Indians is very nearly as great, 84 per cent. (or only 4 per cent. less) being able to read and write. The Brahmos come next with a ratio of 78. Among the Indian castes six stand in a class by themselves, viz., Baidya (53), Subarnabanik (45), Agarwala (42), Brahman (40), Kayasth (35) and Gandhabanik (31): the percentage of literates is shown in each case after the name. Three of these are trading castes, viz., Agarwala, Subarnabanik and Gandhabanik, with whom a knowledge of reading and writing is necessary to the transaction of business. Very different figures are returned for the males and females, as the latter take no active part in business and it is not therefore considered worth while educating them. The Subarnabaniks are the most liberal-minded, for among them 16 per cent. of the women can read and write, but only 4 per cent. and 5 per cent. respectively among the other two. It is noticeable that not only do the Baidyas come first in general literacy, but that their women are far more generally educated than those of any other caste. No less than 35 per cent. of the Baidya women are literate, and they leave the Brahman and Kayasth women far behind, the proportion in their cases being only 11 and 13 per cent. respectively. It may be added that the position of the Kayasth in the list, which is *primâ facie* low, may be ascribed to a large number of Sudras, a low caste of Eastern Bengal, passing themselves off as Kayasths.

As regards other castes, it is noticeable that two of the ambitious castes that are endeavouring to raise their social status, viz., the Chasi

Kaibarttas and Pods, have reached a very fair average of literacy. There is, however, a fall in the proportion of Chasi Kaibarttas compared with 1901, which is due to a number of Jaliya Kaibarttas returning themselves as Chasi: the number of educated persons among the Chasis is relatively 2½ times as great as among the Jaliyas. The Pods, on the other hand, have made great strides, the proportion of literates having been nearly doubled. Considerable advance has also been made by the Namasudras and Rajbansis, but in spite of this only one in every 20 can read and write, whereas among the Chasi Kaibarttas one in nine, and among the Pods one in seven, can do so. The Maghs are the most advanced among the Buddhists, the proportion being the same as among the Chasi Kaibarttas. Of the Nepalese races, the Newars, who are nearly on the same level as the latter, come first, and then the Gurungs and Jimdars. Of the Bhotias only 6, and of the Lepchas only 3 per cent. can read and write. Among the Musalman classes the proportion of literates is very low, except among Saiyads, of whom 18 per cent. are literate. None of the lower Musalman classes have a proportion of even 5 per cent.

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

698. Considering how much higher a standard was imposed by the definition of literacy at this census, it was not to be expected that there should be any remarkable increase in the number of literates. There has, however, been an addition of 632,222, or 21½ per cent., in which all parts of the province share except Nadia and Midnapore. In the former there is a falling off of 2,448, or 2½ per cent., which, corresponds to the general loss of population. The change, however, must not be ascribed to this, or to a decline of literacy, but to the good work of the census staff. There was, as already stated, actually an increase in the number of literates aged 15 years or more, amounting to nearly 5 per cent., but this was wiped out by the large decrease among those under 15 years of age. The fact is simply that the enumerators very properly declined to enter as literate children who could not write and read a letter. In Midnapore where the number of literates has fallen by 30,876, or 10 per cent., five-sixths of the decrease has occurred among young persons under 15 years of age. Nearly the whole of the decrease is found in the Ghatal, Tamluk and Contai subdivisions, where the number of literates has fallen in every thana but Kedgeree and Nandigram, two adjoining thanas in the extreme south-east. In the Sadar subdivision there is a decline in three thanas, two of which (Debra and Garhbeta) adjoin the Ghatal subdivision; the third is Midnapore in the centre of the district, where, however, the decrease (346) is very small. Altogether, 15 out of 26 thanas show a decrease and, as they contain a population of Bengali Hindus and adjoin the districts of Hooghly, Howrah and the 24-Parganas, in which conditions are similar, and in which the number of literates has risen considerably, one would *a priori* expect an increase rather than a large decrease. On the other hand, it is in this area that educated and intelligent Bengali enumerators are most numerous and that the new definition of literacy would be understood and followed. We may safely infer, therefore, that the decrease is not real, but due simply to the care with which the instructions were followed. Even with this decrease, Midnapore stands fifth in order of literacy among the districts of Bengal, 9½ per cent. of the population being literate. Considering the fact there are 145,000 Animists (mostly Santals) in the district, who only contribute 551 literates, the present proportion of literates to the total population is remarkably high, and it is difficult to understand how in 1901 it could have been second in the list of literates, being surpassed only by Howrah. In this district, as well as in Nadia, the decrease is a testimony to the care with which the new definition of literacy was applied.

FEMALE EDUCATION.

699. The result of this, as of the last, census is to show that the advance of education among females is relatively more rapid than among males: the actual increase of female literates (90,342) is only a sixth of that returned for the stronger sex, but proportionately the growth (56 per cent.) has been thrice as great. The greatest advance has been made by Central Bengal, where the proportion of female literates has risen from 16 to 24 per mille. In West Bengal and East Bengal the gain represents 3 per mille, bringing up the ratio to 11 and 9 per mille respectively, while in the backward division of North Bengal it has risen from 3 to 5 per mille.

LITERACY IN ENGLISH.

700. The last decade has witnessed a further diffusion of English education in Bengal, for the number of persons returned as literate in English has increased by 181,569, or 57 per cent., bringing up the total to 498,136, of whom 39,555 are Europeans, Armenians or Anglo-Indians: considered in relation to the total number of literates, one in every seven of those able to read and write has a knowledge of English. The aggregate is made up of 469,654 males, or 2 per cent. of the male population, and 28,482 females, or 1 per mille of the female population. Among the former there has been an increase of 172,600, or 58 per cent., and among the latter of 8,969, or 46 per cent.: the high proportional figure in the latter case is of course due to the small number returned in 1901. The proportional growth is 2½ times as great as that for general literacy and is little short of remarkable, in view of the higher standard required for entries of literacy, but, as already stated, I am of opinion that the definition prescribed was not strictly followed in recording literacy in English. It seems, for instance, *primâ facie* improbable that one out of every 12 Hindu boys under 10 years, and one out of every six aged 10 to 15, who have learnt to read and write should be so precocious as to be able to write a letter to a friend in English and read the answer to it. Yet this is what the returns would lead us to believe.

Naturally those who have sufficient acquaintance with English to be able both to read and write it are found in commercial and industrial centres, No less than a quarter of the total number were enumerated in Calcutta, where one man in five and one woman in 18 knows English. One-fifth were enumerated in the metropolitan districts of the 24-Parganas, Hooghly and Howrah, among which Howrah is *facile princeps*, the ratio for males being 7 per cent. and for females 5 per mille. Next comes Darjeeling, where the presence of a European community is evidenced by the proportion for females being double as high as in Howrah.

The distribution by religion of those who are literate in English is naturally much the same as for general literacy. Excluding Europeans, the knowledge of English is most general among the Brahmos, of whom two-thirds are acquainted with it. They are followed by the Indian Christian community, whose converts are educated by European missionaries: the ratio among them is 9 per cent. The proportion among the Hindus is a little under 2 per cent., but it is thrice that returned for Buddhists and six times that returned for Musalmans (3 per mille). The order of precedence among different castes is different from that for general literacy. The first place is held by the Subarnabanik, to whom, however, the Baidya is very little inferior. Then come in order the Brahman, Kayasth, Gandhabanik and Agarwala.

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

GENERAL RESULTS.

701. From an educational point of view Bihar and Orissa lags far behind Bengal, for only 1½ millions, or 4 per cent. of the population, are literate. Of these, 1,434,000 are males and 76,000 are females, the male literates thus outnumbering the female literates by 19 to 1. Altogether 7·6 per cent., or one in every 13, of the males can read and write, but among the females only one in every 50. At each age period too the proportion of literates per mille is far lower than Bengal as shown in the marginal statement for literate males per mille. Persons aged 15 and over who have succeeded in learning to read and write number 1,288,000, or over four-fifths of the aggregate number of literates, but represent only 5½ per cent. of the total population at that age.

Age period.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.
0—10	21	9
10—15	136	66
15—20	189	103
20 and over ...	199	114

DISTRIBUTION BY LOCALITY.

702. Orissa is far more advanced than any other part of the Province, one out of every 16 of its inhabitants having at least the rudiments of learning. It it followed *longo intervallo* by South Bihar, where the literates constitute one-twentieth of the population. North Bihar is more backward than the South Gangetic districts,

the proportion of literates being under 4 per cent.; and the Bœotia of the Province is the Chota Nagpur Plateau, where only one of every 36 can read and write. Three districts stand in a class by themselves, viz., Patna and Balasore, which share the first place, 6·8 per cent. of their inhabitants being literate, and Cuttack, which is but little inferior with a ratio of 6·6 per cent. In only one other district, viz., Puri, is the proportion over 5 per cent. In the Feudatory States and in no less than six districts, viz., Champaran, Hazaribagh, Palamau, Singhbhum, Angul and Sambalpur, it falls below 3 per cent. The position of Champaran is noticeable, for it is far inferior to any other district of Bihar. The lowest place is held by Palamau, where the ratio is under 2 per cent. Among the denizens of cities one in every seven can read and write, the proportion being one in four among males and as low as one in 31 among females.

DISTRIBUTION BY RELIGION.

703. The returns for Hindus and Musalmans are very different from those for Bengal, for they are on exactly the same level from an educational point of view, the proportion of literates among both being 4 per cent. The latter figure is exactly the same as among the Musalmans of Bengal, and it is obvious therefore the followers of the Prophet are not more advanced in Bihar and Orissa, but that the Hindus there are far more backward than their co-religionists of Bengal. This is largely the result of the large number of uncivilised aboriginals in the Chota Nagpur Plateau, who have been absorbed into Hinduism. The Hindus of that tract number nearly 9 millions, or nearly three-tenths of the population of the Province, but they contribute under 300,000 literates, or one-fifth of the literate population.

From the marginal statement it will be seen that in the Province as a whole the males are, relatively, more, and the females less generally educated among the Hindus than among the Musalmans. It will also be seen that education is more widely diffused among the followers of the Prophet in every division except North Bihar, where, however, the Musalman community is strongest, numbering 2½ millions, or two-fifths of the Musalman population of the Province. If the education of Musalmans had proceeded as far in this division as it has elsewhere, the provincial average of literacy among them would be greater than among Hindus. Purnea is the only district in this division in which the proportion of literates among Musalmans does not fall below that for Hindus. Outside it there are only two districts (Balasore and the Sonthal Parganas) which return a higher ratio for Hindus than for Musalmans.

DIVISION.	PROPORTION OF LITERATES PER MILLE.			
	HINDUS.		MUSALMANS.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**81**	**3**	**79**	**5**
North Bihar	74	3	62	3
South Bihar	89	4	123	10
Orissa	127	4	139	9
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	63	3	86	6

Taking the figures for male literates only, we find that 6 per cent. of the Hindus in the Chota Nagpur Plateau are literate: in Palamau the average is half that figure. Owing partly to the low standard of Champaran, the proportion is only 7½ per cent. in North Bihar, whereas it is 9 per cent. in South Bihar. Relatively the greatest number of Hindu male literates, viz., 12·7 per cent., is found in Orissa, while it exceeds 13 per cent. in both Cuttack and Balasore. The only other districts in which more than 10 per cent. of the Hindus are literate are Patna (12) and Puri (11). The proportion of male literates to the male Muhammadan population exceeds 10 per cent. in no less than 11 districts as well as in the Feudatory States. In three of these districts, viz., Singhbhum, Angul and Sambalpur, it rises above 26 per cent., but the actual number is very small, and a large proportion are probably immigrant Musalman traders. Excluding these three districts, the most advanced Musalman community is found in Patna, where 17 per cent. of the males and 2 per cent. of the females can read and write, and then in Cuttack, where the corresponding ratios are 16 and 1, respectively. As regards natural divisions, Orissa and South Bihar have relatively the largest number of educated Musalmans, and North Bihar the least: the proportion of literates in the division last named is only half what it is in the two former.

As in Bengal, the small Brahmo community is the most educated next to the Europeans, two-thirds of their number being able to read and write. Next come the progressive Aryas, a new sect who give a leading place to education in their propaganda. Though the sect is of recent origin in Bihar, and although its ranks are mainly recruited from the lower castes, already one in every five can read and write ; it is noticeable that the proportion of female literates (4½ per cent.) is also unusually high. Among Indian Christians 8 per cent. are literate, which is only one-third of the figure returned for Bengal. The converts are, however, drawn from a different section of society, and are chiefly aboriginals. When it is considered that among their heathen brethren (the Animists) only one in every 200 is literate, and that a large proportion of them are young children, the extent of literacy among them must be regarded as striking testimony to the educational work of the missionaries.

LITERACY BY TRIBE AND CASTE.

704. The proportion of literates among Anglo-Indians, viz., 87 per cent., is a little higher than in Bengal where the poor Kintals of Calcutta lower the average. The most educated Indian caste is the writer caste of Kayasths, among whom one in every three can read and write. The second place is shared by Karans, the writer caste of Orissa, and those keen traders the Agarwalas, the proportion of literates among both being one in four. They are followed by the Saiyads, of whom 18 per cent. are literate, and the Brahmans (17 per cent.). The only other castes in which the ratio is 10 per cent. or more are the Baishnabs (12 per cent.), Babhans (10 per cent.) and Kalwars (10 per cent.) ; this proportion is, however, nearly reached by the Baniyas and Rajputs. The abysm of ignorance is found among the Animist races, among whom the average number of literates varies from 1 to 7 per mille. The latter figure is returned for the Hos, who may therefore be regarded as the least ignorant of the Animist tribes.

LITERACY IN ENGLISH.

705. The number of persons literate in English is only one-sixth of that returned for Bengal, aggregating 81,888, of whom all but 5,321 are males. The net increase since 1901 has been 21,094 or 37 per cent., to which females contribute only 1,722.* The figures appear more reliable than those for Bengal, for applying the same tests we find that (1) only one-twentieth of the literate population is literate in English, (2) only one out of every 44 Hindu boys under 10 who can read and write has a similar proficiency in English, and (3) the proportion of those aged 10 to 15 is only one in 23. Of the total number, 8,018 are Europeans, Anglo-Indians or Armenians, leaving an aggregate of only 73,870, viz., 71,794 males and 2,076 females, for the Indian population of the province. The figures are so small that there is no object in discussing the local variations in detail. Patna heads the list, 1 per cent. of its males having an acquaintance with English, but it owes its position mainly to the presence of a British regiment at Dinapore. Elsewhere the average is very low, and in those districts which rise above the ruck the higher proportion of literates can be attributed to Anglo-Indian colonies or to European missionaries, employés in coal mines, iron works and other industrial concerns. As in Bengal, the Brahmos have the most general acquaintance with English, and then the Aryas. The proportion among the Musalmans (3 per mille), low as it is, is higher than among Hindus (2 per mille), who include so many low-castes and semi-Hinduized aboriginals. The Kayasth is easily first among the individual castes. The second place is held by the Saiyads, and the third by the Karans of Orissa, followed closely by the merchant caste of Agarwalas.

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

706. Since 1901 the number of literates of both sexes has increased by nearly 110,000 or 8½ per cent., viz., 85,000 or 7 per cent. for males, and 25,000 or 55 per cent. for females.† The latter figure clearly demonstrates the rapid strides being made by female education, though the actual number of girls or women who have learnt to read and write is still small, amounting only to

* In calculating the increase, Sambalpur and the Feudatory States are omitted, as figures for 1901 are not available for them.

† In making this calculation, British territory only has been taken excluding Sambalpur. That district and the Feudatory States have had to be excluded, as owing to changes of area figures for 1901 are not available.

76,000. The proportional growth of female literates is nearly exactly the same as in Bengal, but in the case of males it is less than half what it is in that progressive Province.

There has been a decrease in the number of literates in five districts and eight Feudatory States. Nowhere is the decrease as great as in Orissa, where the three districts of Cuttack, Puri and Balasore have an aggregate loss of 47,000, the percentage of decrease being 14 per cent. in Cuttack, 17 per cent. in Balasore and 26 per cent. in Puri. The compilation for these three districts was most carefully checked, the work being done over again to make sure that there was no mistake, and the results worked out yet again by the tick system as well as by sorting. The decrease is simply due to the fact that in Orissa many more learn to read than to write. The population is largely composed of devout Vaishnavas, whose object is to learn enough to be able to read Vaishnava scriptures, the knowledge of writing and composition being a secondary consideration. It is common to find people who can read printed matter, especially sacred books such as the Bhagavat Gita, but cannot write more than their names or the letters of the alphabet. All of these are necessarily excluded from the returns by the more precise definition of literacy. The same phenomenon is noticeable in eight of the Orissa Feudatory States, viz., Baramba, Tigiria, Nayagarh, Ranpur, Baud, Patna, Bamra and Kalahandi. The decrease in Nayagarh is extremely large, the number of literates falling from 12,000 to under 5,000, but *a priori* the figure for 1901 is suspicious, for the percentage (8½ per cent.) of literates to the total population was thrice as high as the average for the Orissa States, and at this census no district in the whole of the province has such a high ratio.

There also has been a falling off of nearly 5 per cent. in Muzaffarpur, the greater part of the decrease occurring in the thana of Hajipur, in which, it may be noticed, the general population also declined by 5 per cent. The proportion of literates in this thana has fallen from 6 to 4½ per cent., but the latter ratio is well above the average for the district. In this thana too the figures were thoroughly checked, and the results verified by the tick system. The only other district in which there has been a loss of literates is Hazaribagh, where it amounts to 5½ per cent. This district is a backward one, where no considerable increase could be expected in face of the new definition, and it is noticeable that in the neighbouring district of Palamau the number of literates has risen by 66 only—an addition altogether incommensurate with the general growth of the population.

COMPARISON WITH OTHER PROVINCES.

707. The statement below has been prepared to show the extent of literacy in the two provinces dealt with in this report, compared with the other main provinces in India, and the rate of progress in each. Two age periods have been selected, viz., 5–15* and 15 and over, the former being the age period adopted by the Education Department as representing children of school-going age† : as explained in a former chapter, it includes all children 5 years old but under 15 years of age. The statement has unfortunately to be somewhat long, because in order to see what progress has been made, one has to consider not only the number of literates, but also the actual population from which they are drawn : for example, from the decrease of literates aged 5–15 in Bombay, one might assume that the education of the younger generation was declining instead of advancing, whereas it is really due to the loss of population of that age. The actual figures are, moreover, of interest as showing the numbers with which the Education Department in each province has to deal.

* In Table VIII statistics are given only for the age periods 0—10 and 10—15 and not for the period 5—15, but it may fairly be assumed that no children under 5 are literate (*i.e.*, able to write a letter to a friend and read the answer to it), the number of literates returned as aged 0—15 is therefore taken as identical with the number aged 5—15.

† The Education Department, instead of taking the census figures, calculates the number as representing 15 per cent. of the population. The basis of this calculation is fallacious, for the actual proportion is 27 per cent. for males and 25½ per cent. for females in Bengal, and 28 per cent. for males and 25 per cent. for females in Bihar and Orissa.

PROVINCE.		ALL AGES.			AGED 5—15			AGED 15 AND OVER.		
		Population.	Literates.	Per cent.	Population.	Literates.	Per cent.	Population.	Literates.	Per cent.
BENGAL	1911	46,305,642	3,575,231	7·7	12,216,153	592,799	4·9	27,510,601	2,982,432	10·8
	1901	42,884 311	2,943,009	6·9	11,309,733	546,280	4·8	25,536,135	2.396,729	9·4
Variation ...	*Actual* ...	*+3,421,331*	*+632,222*	...	*+906,420*	*+ 46,519*	...	*+1,974,466*	*+585,703*	...
	Proportional	*+ 8·0*	*+ 21·5*	...	*+ 8·0*	*+ 8·5*	...	*+ 7·7*	*+ 24·4*	...
BOMBAY	1911	27,084.317	1,860,493	6·9	6,151,583	284,586	4·6	17,013,033	1,575,907	9·3
	1901	25,468,309	1,626,683	6·4	6,780,472	308,975	4·55	15,660,356	1,317,708	8·4
Variation ...	*Actual* ...	*+1,616,108*	*+233·810*	...	*-628,889*	*- 24,389*	...	*+1,352,677*	*+258,199*	...
	Proportional	*+ 6·1*	*+ 14·4*	...	*- 9·3*	*- 7·9*	...	*+ 8·6*	*+ 19·6*	...
MADRAS	1911	41,870,160	3,130,250	7·5	10,373,491	441,462	4·3	25,899,033	2,688,788	10·4
	1901	38,623,066	2,436,743	6·3	10,191,369	340,438	3·3	23,203,145	2.096,305	9·0
Variation ...	*Actual* ...	*+3,247,094*	*+693,507*	...	*+182,122*	*+101,024*	...	*+2,695,888*	*+592,483*	...
	Proportional	*+ 8·5*	*+ 28·5*	...	*+ 1·8*	*+ 29·7*	...	*+ 11·2*	*+ 28·3*	...
UNITED PROVINCES	1911	48.014,080	1,636,052	3·4	11,824,626	260,414	2·2	30,365,373	1,375,638	4·5
	1901	48,493,879	1,494,717	3·1	11,861,670	194,605	1·6	30.478,548	1,300,112	4·3
Variation ...	*Actual* ...	*- 479,799*	*+ 141,335*	...	*- 37,044*	*+ 65,809*	...	*- 113,175*	*+ 75,526*	...
	Proportional	*- 0·9*	*+ 9·5*	...	*- 0·3*	*+ 33·8*	...	*- 0·3*	*+ 5·8*	...
BIHAR AND ORISSA*	1911	33,745,891	1,398,060	4·1	8,956,950	207,138	2·3	20,267,936	1,190,922	5·9
	1901	32,600,854	1,288,575	4·0	8,527,200	201,285	2·4	19,735,792	1,087,290	5·5
Variation ...	*Actual* ...	*+1,145,037*	*+109,485*	...	*+429,750*	*+ 5,853*	...	*+ 532,144*	*+103.632*	...
	Proportional	*+ 3·5*	*+ 8·5*	...	*+ 5·0*	*+ 2·9*	...	*+ 2·7*	*+ 9·5*	...

* The figures for Bihar and Orissa are exclusive of Sambalpur and the Orissa and Chota Nagpur States, as figures showing the number of literates in 1901 are not available.

708. In respect of literacy Bengal is superior to the other Provinces. Not only can it boast of a larger number of persons able to read and write, but the proportion of the latter to the whole population is higher than elsewhere. Next to it comes Madras, which is fast advancing to the same level, and then Bombay, which. however, contains only half as many literates. The proportional increase of literates aged 5—15 (8½ per cent.) since 1901 is a little in excess of the general growth of the population, but is much below that recorded for Madras and the United Provinces, the latter of which has a heavy leeway to make up. In Bengal, however, those who have actually learnt to read and write far outnumber those enumerated in either of these provinces; their number is 34 per cent. greater than in Madras, and is more than twice as great as it is in either Bombay or the United Provinces. The ratio of increase of literates aged 15 and over is greater than in any province except Madras. Considered in relation to the growth of population, it is even greater than in that Presidency, for it is 24·4 per cent. against 7·7 per cent. for the general population, the corresponding ratios in Madras being 28·3 per cent. and 11·2 per cent. The actual increase is also a little less than in Madras, but it exceeds by 148,000 that registered in Bombay, the United Provinces and Bihar and Orissa taken together.

709. Bihar and Orissa lags far behind Bengal, and the proportional growth of literates since 1901 is the smallest returned for any of the Provinces. In spite of this, the general average of literacy is higher than in the United Provinces. Among children aged 5—15 the progress of education during the last 10 years has been incommensurate with the growth of population, the increase of literates being barely 3 per cent., whereas the population of this age has had an addition of 5 per cent. Among literates aged 15 and over, however, there has been an advance of 9½ per cent. (compared with a growth of 2·7 per cent. in the general population) which is higher than the ratio (5·8 per cent.) returned for the United Provinces.

MISCELLANEOUS.

STATISTICS OF THE EDUCATION DEPARTMENT.

710. Statistics of institutions and pupils in each province according to the returns of the Education Department in 1891, 1901 and 1911 will be found in Subsidiary Table VII at the end of this chapter. In Bengal the

advance between 1891 and 1901 cannot be called rapid, the number of scholars rising by only 74,000 or 7 per cent., while the number of schools fell by 4,500; this, however, was not a real loss, as it was due to small, inefficient or ephemeral schools being closed down. The progress made during the last decade has been remarkable, there being an addition of nearly 4,000 schools and of 428,000 pupils: the proportional increase of the latter is no less than 38 per cent. The most noticeable feature in the returns is the advance made in female education, for girls' schools have been trebled in number and the students have multiplied over threefold: the actual number is still however, comparatively small, being 6,401 and 149,000 respectively. Primary education among boys has made the greatest strides; though the number of primary schools has decreased slightly, the number of pupils has risen by 200,000 or 26 per cent., and now aggregates over a million. High schools have 126,000 students on the rolls, the growth since 1901 being 33,000 or 35 per cent. The number (108,000) reading in Middle schools is less, but the increase in the decennium, viz., 51,000 or 89 per cent., has been greater. On the other hand, the popularity of Middle Vernacular schools is declining; they are now fewer by nearly 300 and have 12,000 fewer pupils than 10 years ago. Those who are sufficiently advanced for a collegiate education number 11,554 or 29 per cent. more than in 1901; of these, 9,304 attend Arts Colleges and 1,221 are students in Law Colleges.

The returns for Bihar and Orissa show much the same general features, there being a decrease of educational institutions between 1891 and 1901, but an addition of 6½ per cent. to the number receiving instruction. As in Bengal, the advance in the next decade was rapid, schools being more numerous at its close by nearly 4,000 and pupils by 237,000 or 50 per cent. There are now 27,000 colleges and schools with an attendance of 715,000, of whom 568,000 or four-fifths are pupils in primary schools. In this province also there has been a notable expansion of female education, the number of girls' schools rising since 1901 from 533 to 1,245, and of female scholars from 11,000 to 31,000. The number of students in High schools is 23,000 or a fifth of that in Bengal, while Middle English and Middle Vernacular schools taken together have only 24,833 pupils or two-thirds of the number found in the Bengal Middle Vernacular schools alone. Collegiate education is also on a far smaller scale, there being only 11 colleges with 1,311 students. It is noticeable that there is only one Law College with 11 students, while Bengal can boast of 11 such colleges with 1,221 students.

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS.

711. The statistics of the results of University examinations, which will be found in Subsidiary Table VIII, are of considerable interest. They show that between 1891 and 1901 there was a very large increase in the number both of candidates for different examinations and of those who satisfied the examiners. During the last decade, however, though there has been a moderate increase (9 per cent.) in the candidates for matriculation, *i.e.*, the Entrance examination, and a large increase (24 per cent.) in those appearing at the F.A. or Intermediate examination, there has been a relatively large decrease in the number of aspirants for the B.A. or B.Sc. and M.A. or M.Sc. degrees, and also of those examined in Medicine and Civil Engineering. The number of those who appeared at the Law examination, however, increased by over one-third, and they are now equal to two-thirds of the candidates for the B.A. or B.Sc. degree. I am not in a position to say how far these results are due to the revised University regulations. It is possible that prospective candidates for the degrees mentioned are deterred by the higher standard now demanded, but, on the other hand, it is noteworthy that, compared with 1901, the proportion of candidates that have succeeded in passing is higher in every case. In 1901 as many as 56 per cent. of the candidates passed the Entrance examination, but in no other examination did the proportion reach 43 per cent. In 1911, however, there was no examination which half or more of the candidates did not pass, and in the case of the Entrance examination the proportion rose to over 70 per cent. The increase in the ratio is especially great in the case of the B.A. or B.Sc. examination, which is now 61 per cent., or more than treble that of 1901.

STATISTICS OF BOOKS.

712. Subsidiary Table X, which has been compiled from the records of the Bengal Library, throws a certain amount of light on the literary activity of the people during the last

decade. Statistics of previous decades for each of the new provinces could not be obtained owing to the partition and re-partition of Bengal; but taking Bengal, Bihar and Orissa as a whole, we find that the number of uni-lingual books printed and published during the ten years ending in 1910 is 4,294 or 27 per cent. more than in the preceding decade. In Bengal, works in Bengali account for nearly two-thirds of the total number, while English books represent a fifth. In Bihar and Orissa, though the Oriyas constitute less than two-fifths of the population, the books written in Oriya represent over half of the total number, and those in Hindi and Urdu one-fourth. The study of Sanskrit is still largely in vogue, for it comes fifth in the list for the two provinces. The extent to which it is studied is more apparent from the returns of bilingual books, those published in Bengali and Sanskrit during the decade numbering 1,346, or nearly half the total number of bilingual works printed and published in Bengal. Bengali and English books come second with a total of 903. In addition to this, Sanskrit was combined with English in 198, and with Bengali and English in 256, books. In Bihar and Orissa again the study of Sanskrit led to the publication of 352 books in Sanskrit and Oriya, and of 90 in Sanskrit and Hindi.

Language.	1901-1911.			1891-1901.
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Total.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.
Bengali ...	10,535	63	10,598	9,331
English ...	3,019	209	3,228	2,580
Oriya	212	2,379	2,591	1,323
Hindi	501	941	1,442	968
Sanskrit ...	624	259	883	736
Musalman-Bengali	290	...	290	286
Urdu	151	108	259	258
Others	770	76	846	361
Total ...	*16,102*	*4,035*	*20,137*	*15,843*

713. Statistics of the number and circulation of newspapers and periodicals in each province during the years 1891, 1901 and 1911 will be found in Subsidiary Table IX at the end of this chapter. The statement of circulation must be received with some caution, and the figures regarded as an estimate only. It must also be borne in mind that the circulation of newspapers is not confined to subscribers. The dissemination of news is far wider than the figures would indicate, for it is the common practice for any one who happens to be literate in a village to read the newspaper to the assembled villagers and receive their plaudits, if nothingmore, for doing so. Of the newspapers published in Bengal, 66 with a circulation of 138,000, are written in Bengali. Their number has increased by 50 per cent. in the last 20 years, and their circulation has been doubled. Daily newspapers have not found much favour among Bengalis, and the great majority are weekly publications. There are 51 newspapers, written in English but owned, edited and read by Indians, all but eight of which are published weekly or monthly: their circulation is put down as 56,000. Monthly magazines are by far the most popular class of periodicals, accounting for four-fifths of the total number: there are 89 published in Bengali with 92,000 readers, and 46 published in English with 50,000 readers.

Newspapers and periodicals.

	Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.	
	Number.	Circulation.	Number.	Circulation.
Newspapers ...	127	214,180	28	13,577
Periodicals ...	172	170,830	16	7,700
Total ...	299	385,010	44	21,277

In Bihar and Orissa journalistic enterprise has not made much progress. The total number of newspapers is only 28, of which 9 are in English, 8 in Hindi and 6 in Oriya: their aggregate circulation is under 14,000. The number of newspapers has, however, been doubled in the last 10 years, and the circulation has gone up by 60 per cent. The circle of readers of periodicals is also small, and only 16 are published, all but one of which are monthly publications.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I—EDUCATION BY AGE, SEX AND RELIGION.

RELIGION.	NUMBER PER MILLE WHO ARE LITERATE.											NUMBER PER MILLE WHO ARE ILLITERATE.			NUMBER PER MILLE WHO ARE LITERATE IN ENGLISH.		
	All ages.			0—10		10—15.		15—20.		20 and over.							
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
BENGAL.																	
All religions ...	77	140	11	21	3	136	18	189	19	199	13	923	860	989	11	20	1
Hindu	118	210	20	39	6	223	32	280	34	276	22	882	790	980	18	35	1
Musalman	41	79	2	9	1	70	4	106	4	123	3	959	921	998	3	5	·1
Christian	466	521	402	165	153	488	500	585	508	664	493	534	479	598	361	410	304
European and other Christians.	*883*	*906*	*851*	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	*117*	*94*	*149*	*873*	*896*	*841*
Indian Christians ...	*243*	*286*	*196*	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	*757*	*714*	*804*	*87*	*113*	*58*
Brahmo	783	812	752	309	332	946	938	1,000	964	958	863	217	188	248	602	692	508
Buddhist	91	170	9	12	1	103	9	191	15	279	13	909	830	991	6	10	·4
Animist	5	9	·4	1	·2	7	·3	12	1	15	·4	995	991	1,000	·1	·1	·01
BIHAR AND ORISSA.																	
All religions ...	39	76	4	9	1	66	6	103	7	114	4	961	924	996	2	4	·2
Hindu	41	81	3	9	1	70	5	110	6	119	4	959	919	997	2	4	1
Musalman	41	79	5	10	2	68	8	110	9	122	6	959	921	995	3	6	·1
Christian	103	139	68	25	20	147	97	224	115	210	88	897	861	932	46	63	29
European and other Christians.	*845*	*857*	*833*	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	*155*	*143*	*172*	*825*	*838*	*807*
Indian Christians ...	*76*	*107*	*45*	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	*924*	*893*	*955*	*17*	*28*	*5*
Brahmo	634	635	633	280	332	638	939	737	706	782	712	366	365	367	474	503	315
Buddhist	72	127	5	...	...	79	...	128	...	182	6	928	873	995	10	14	5
Animist	5	10	1	1	·3	9	1	16	1	14	1	995	990	999	·1	·2	·004
Arya	197	344	46	97	22	359	103	447	81	431	44	803	656	954	31	61	...

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—EDUCATION BY AGE, SEX AND LOCALITY.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	NUMBER PER MILLE WHO ARE LITERATE.										
	ALL AGES.			0—9.		10—14		15—19.		20 AND OVER.	
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**60**	**112**	**8**	**16**	**2**	**104**	**12**	**153**	**14**	**162**	**9**
Bengal	**77**	**140**	**11**	**21**	**3**	**136**	**18**	**189**	**19**	**199**	**13**
WEST BENGAL	**102**	**191**	**11**	**36**	**4**	**190**	**17**	**256**	**19**	**254**	**12**
Burdwan	100	186	13	46	4	219	19	252	21	231	14
Birbhum	88	171	6	35	3	191	10	236	10	225	7
Bankura	94	184	7	34	3	186	9	256	13	251	8
Midnapore	94	181	7	20	2	136	9	243	12	260	8
Hooghly	111	199	21	42	7	232	30	266	32	248	23
Howrah	142	248	28	66	10	263	42	312	39	312	28
CENTRAL BENGAL	**109**	**183**	**24**	**34**	**8**	**171**	**36**	**228**	**39**	**245**	**28**
24-Parganas	124	216	17	43	5	214	26	272	27	237	20
Calcutta	321	396	164	153	78	444	273	470	260	419	166
Nadia	56	98	14	15	3	98	21	123	25	139	16
Murshidabad	58	103	9	16	3	106	14	147	14	157	10
Jessore	70	127	10	22	2	126	14	156	17	174	11
NORTH BENGAL	**53**	**98**	**5**	**14**	**2**	**90**	**9**	**127**	**8**	**146**	**6**
Rajshahi	46	86	5	9	1	70	9	110	9	133	6
Dinajpur	59	108	4	18	1	103	6	140	6	160	5
Jalpaiguri	56	99	4	15	2	85	6	118	7	141	5
Darjeeling	99	169	19	19	9	121	34	191	32	245	19
Rangpur	42	76	3	9	1	66	5	100	5	115	4
Bogra	59	111	5	17	3	116	11	146	5	170	5
Pabna	51	103	7	15	2	107	13	142	14	147	9
Malda	46	89	3	12	1	87	6	119	5	137	4
Cooch Behar	74	134	6	21	3	125	11	164	9	189	7
EAST BENGAL	**66**	**121**	**9**	**16**	**2**	**123**	**15**	**172**	**16**	**180**	**11**
Khulna	84	153	11	30	3	172	18	208	19	209	12
Dacca	75	134	16	21	4	149	27	205	29	192	20
Mymensingh	46	85	5	12	2	90	10	118	9	126	7
Faridpur	62	112	10	19	3	124	16	159	19	156	12
Backergunge	86	156	11	9	2	151	19	215	21	231	14
Tippera	71	132	8	17	2	127	13	188	13	198	9
Noakhali	62	118	6	12	2	96	10	172	9	202	7
Chittagong	67	133	7	17	3	108	10	175	11	222	9
Chittagong Hill Tracts	64	115	4	5	1	44	5	112	7	194	6
Hill Tippera	40	69	8	10	2	60	11	99	11	101	10
Bihar and Orissa ...	**39**	**76**	**4**	**9**	**1**	**66**	**6**	**103**	**7**	**114**	**4**
NORTH BIHAR	**37**	**72**	**3**	**10**	**1**	**66**	**5**	**98**	**6**	**105**	**4**
Saran	37	76	3	7	1	68	3	114	5	114	3
Champaran	26	51	2	5	1	43	4	65	5	74	2
Muzaffarpur	36	70	4	9	1	65	6	96	9	103	5
Darbhanga	41	81	3	11	2	75	6	111	6	118	3
Bhagalpur	40	78	3	14	2	76	6	107	6	110	4
Purnea	38	72	3	11	2	62	4	89	4	106	3
SOUTH BIHAR	**48**	**93**	**5**	**11**	**1**	**85**	**6**	**134**	**10**	**133**	**6**
Patna	68	126	9	17	3	117	14	181	18	171	10
Gay	43	84	4	9	1	75	4	122	7	122	5
Shahabad	46	92	4	11	1	91	5	138	8	129	5
Monghyr	40	77	4	8	1	66	5	106	8	115	4
ORISSA	**64**	**127**	**5**	**12**	**2**	**90**	**8**	**152**	**10**	**194**	**6**
Cuttack	66	133	5	14	2	93	7	163	10	203	6
Balasore	68	136	5	11	2	90	9	152	10	210	5
Puri	56	104	5	9	2	74	7	137	10	162	6
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU ...	**28**	**54**	**3**	**6**	**1**	**47**	**5**	**75**	**6**	**83**	**4**
Hazaribagh	23	43	3	6	2	36	5	62	6	67	4
Ranchi	31	57	7	7	2	51	12	81	11	91	7
Palamau	17	32	3	5	1	30	3	48	8	48	4
Manbhum	45	84	5	13	1	83	6	116	9	120	6
Singhbhum	27	51	4	7	1	45	5	73	6	79	5
Santhal Pargana	32	61	3	8	1	53	5	86	5	97	4
Angul	25	48	3	6	1	50	8	66	4	71	2
Sambalpur	28	55	2	2	3	50	4	81	5	82	2
Orissa Feudatory States	23	44	2	4	1	35	3	57	4	70	3
Chota Nagpur States	25	50	2	4	3	30	2	56	2	85	4
BENGAL—											
CITIES	291	372	134	136	63	407	233	452	220	400	133
BIHAR AND ORISSA—											
CITIES	147	251	32	39	14	234	54	379	63	315	33
SIKKIM	41	78	3	2	1	29	2	73	3	132	4

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—Education by Religion, Sex and Locality.

District and Natural Division.	Number per mille who are literate.									
	Hindu.		Muhammadan.		Animist.		Christian.		Buddhist.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**134**	**10**	**79**	**3**	**10**	**1**	**271**	**170**	**170**	**9**
Bengal	**210**	**20**	**79**	**2**	**9**	·4	**521**	**402**	**170**	**9**
WEST BENGAL	**206**	**12**	**149**	**7**	**9**	·4	**624**	**510**	**652**	**333**
Burdwan	198	13	144	6	3	1	664	569	857	...
Birbhum	195	7	139	4	11	1	325	259	...	...
Bankura	202	7	154	8	12	·3	460	376	...	...
Midnapore	198	6	138	8	8	·1	548	377	...	...
Hooghly	211	23	163	8	3	1	762	737	500	...
Howrah	268	24	166	10	13	3	753	691	692	500
CENTRAL BENGAL	**256**	**36**	**96**	**3**	**5**	·2	**617**	**537**	**560**	**291**
24-Parganas	251	23	153	4	9	...	396	248	735	182
Calcutta	442	150	222	37	...	...	822	774	545	296
Nadia	179	30	44	1	1	...	187	200	...	...
Murshidabad	160	16	62	2	3	...	743	730	...	...
Jessore	210	21	77	2	8	4	264	189	...	...
NORTH BENGAL	**132**	**9**	**78**	**2**	**7**	·2	**136**	**78**	**18**	·5
Rajshahi	174	21	62	1	5	...	337	288	444	...
Dinajpur	103	5	125	3	2	·01	140	59	...	...
Jalpaiguri	103	5	121	4	15	·3	198	73	127	4
Darjeeling	162	7	178	14	24	·2	702	468	134	4
Rangpur	109	7	58	1	3	·4	699	658	360	...
Bogra	178	16	97	2	3	·3	385	329	...	...
Pabna	231	25	58	2	18	...	622	505	200	...
Malda	114	5	71	2	3	·3	236	64	...	...
Cooch Behar	146	7	102	4	...	...	707	438	333	...
EAST BENGAL	**236**	**25**	**68**	**2**	**17**	**1**	**263**	**151**	**172**	**9**
Khulna	211	19	95	2	5	...	399	252	875	...
Dacca	263	40	62	2	23	...	170	89	388	...
Mymensingh	193	18	46	1	11	·2	332	186	423	...
Faridpur	232	25	48	1	...	...	244	123	...	...
Backergunge	289	32	99	2	...	...	265	175	341	29
Tippera	264	22	81	2	...	...	589	483	149	4
Noakhali	246	17	79	2	...	...	319	118	346	11
Chittagong	275	20	81	2	17	11	662	556	214	13
Chittagong Hill Tracts	154	4	107	1	24	2	378	195	138	5
Hill Tippera	76	10	56	3	...	...	413	254	44	1
Bihar and Orissa	**81**	**3**	**79**	**5**	**10**	**1**	**139**	**69**	**127**	**5**
NORTH BIHAR	**74**	**3**	**62**	**3**	**6**	·1	**490**	**329**	**778**	...
Saran	77	2	62	4	...	...	736	675	...	...
Champaran	52	2	39	2	...	...	290	99	...	...
Muzaffarpur	73	4	54	4	...	...	507	488	1,000	...
Darbhanga	84	3	55	3	...	...	730	531	...	...
Bhagalpur	79	3	73	6	6	·1	597	425	1,000	...
Purnea	72	3	72	2	7	·2	652	635	1,000	...
SOUTH BIHAR	**89**	**4**	**123**	**10**	**5**	...	**800**	**696**	**476**	...
Patna	119	7	174	20	...	...	893	817	1,000	...
Gaya	82	3	110	5	...	...	764	733	267	...
Shahabad	88	3	139	11	...	...	493	402	...	...
Monghyr	76	3	84	6	6	...	765	673	...	...
ORISSA	**127**	**4**	**139**	**9**	**6**	·2	**593**	**572**	**165**	...
Cuttack	131	4	159	9	...	...	678	656	78	...
Balasore	137	5	115	5	6	·2	529	540	...	...
Puri	103	4	116	12	...	...	525	427	217	...
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU ...	**63**	**3**	**86**	**6**	**10**	**1**	**105**	**39**	**98**	...
Hazaribagh	44	3	47	6	4	·3	509	371	...	...
Ranchi	83	5	146	11	13	2	93	25	1,000	...
Palamau	32	3	46	4	3	1	27	6	...	...
Manbhum	93	4	106	7	8	1	501	353	889	...
Singhbhum	86	6	263	22	15	·3	245	103	1,000	...
Santhal Parganas	94	4	75	2	11	·2	255	159	...	...
Angul	64	3	327	9	6	·1	813	810	...	...
Sambalpur	56	2	289	18	3	...	141	70	667	...
Orissa Feudatory States	49	2	185	8	3	·2	28	14	74	...
Chota Nagpur ditto	79	3	184	26	4	·1	750	100	...	...
BENGAL—										
Cities	424	134	207	31	41	...	820	772	561	290
BIHAR AND ORISSA—										
Cities	249	25	244	30	...	...	780	817	500	...
Sikkim	**83**	**2**	**632**	...	...	...	**581**	**208**	**61**	**1**

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—ENGLISH EDUCATION BY AGE, SEX AND LOCALITY.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	LITERATE IN ENGLISH PER 10,000.											
	1911.										1901.	
	0—9		10—14		15—19		20 AND OVER.		ALL AGES.		ALL AGES.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	*11*	*2*	*127*	*11*	*253*	*12*	*175*	*10*	*128*	*8*	*93*	*6*
Bengal	*18*	*4*	*206*	*18*	*385*	*18*	*265*	*16*	*197*	*13*	*136*	*9*
WEST BENGAL	*30*	*5*	*218*	*17*	*406*	*17*	*318*	*12*	*243*	*12*	*175*	*5*
Burdwan	29	5	308	14	522	18	363	16	290	14	207	11
Birbhum	11	1	182	2	328	4	188	3	152	2	94	1
Bankura	6	3	130	1	272	5	171	2	131	2	110	1
Midnapore	7	2	50	5	145	5	135	6	92	4	75	3
Hooghly	35	4	418	12	657	18	460	13	372	11	351	6
Howrah	145	32	686	111	979	85	835	49	667	54	389	20
CENTRAL BENGAL ...	*50*	*15*	*404*	*63*	*699*	*63*	*578*	*61*	*439*	*49*	*324*	*38*
24-Parganas	25	4	295	13	509	16	387	17	295	13	251	8
Calcutta	564	222	2,414	853	2,475	776	1,883	604	1,829	558	1,323	455
Nadia	8	1	159	4	349	8	263	5	187	4	167	3
Murshidabad	9	4	147	3	360	7	200	6	152	4	106	2
Jessore	13	1	183	3	307	4	193	3	155	3	94	1
NORTH BENGAL	*7*	*1*	*102*	*9*	*182*	*6*	*110*	*5*	*83*	*4*	*48*	*3*
Rajshahi	3	2	70	2	196	2	110	2	79	1	58	1
Dinajpur	4	1	64	2	95	2	73	1	52	1	29	1
Jalpaiguri	3	1	53	4	88	2	113	4	75	3	38	3
Darjeeling	85	55	377	212	363	150	364	93	306	101	130	63
Rangpur	2	3	56	3	109	4	72	3	52	2	30	2
Bogra	7	1	167	1	243	1	110	1	91	1	38	1
Pabna	11	2	214	3	411	5	199	4	161	3	93	2
Malda	2	...	54	3	133	1	79	1	56	1	33	...
Cooch Bihar	8	1	121	7	166	4	87	2	75	2	56	2
EAST BENGAL	*9*	*1*	*164*	*5*	*337*	*6*	*173*	*4*	*135*	*3*	*80*	*2*
Khulna	12	3	239	2	403	6	195	2	165	2	110	2
Dacca	19	1	267	13	611	14	303	9	233	8	148	3
Mymensingh	6	3	132	2	254	3	128	2	100	1	51	1
Faridpur	11	3	210	3	343	7	175	4	146	3	79	1
Backergunge	4	2	124	4	264	6	135	4	108	3	89	2
Tippera	7	1	137	4	300	3	134	3	110	3	55	1
Noakhali	4	1	93	1	256	3	127	2	91	1	39	...
Chittagong	11	2	132	9	308	9	225	8	148	6	83	4
Chittagong Hill Tracts ...	...	...	32	1	76	1	6	2	39	1	29	1
Hill Tippera	10	1	135	3	244	6	117	3	97	2	34	1
Bihar and Orissa ...	*3*	*1*	*32*	*3*	*74*	*4*	*59*	*4*	*47*	*3*	*34*	*2*
NORTH BIHAR	*3*	*5*	*29*	*1*	*61*	*2*	*46*	*2*	*33*	*1*	*26*	*1*
Saran	2	4	40	1	94	3	53	2	39	1	35	1
Champaran	1	2	16	1	42	1	32	1	22	1	23	1
Muzaffarpur	3	1	30	1	64	3	49	2	34	1	40	1
Darbhanga	3	1	27	1	45	2	44	2	30	2	15	1
Bhagalpur	5	1	43	3	93	2	65	3	47	2	24	1
Purnea	2	1	16	1	28	2	35	2	22	2	18	1
SOUTH BIHAR	*5*	*2*	*38*	*6*	*105*	*8*	*81*	*5*	*56*	*5*	*49*	*3*
Patna	11	4	81	20	207	21	135	11	102	11	94	9
Gaya	1	2	16	4	49	1	50	2	32	1	32	1
Shahabad	6	1	41	3	119	4	85	3	60	3	54	2
Monghyr	3	2	25	3	71	7	62	7	41	5	30	3
ORISSA	*4*	*1*	*42*	*4*	*101*	*5*	*71*	*3*	*52*	*3*	*38*	*2*
Cuttack	4	1	56	7	128	7	79	4	59	4	46	3
Balasore	3	1	32	2	73	4	67	3	46	2	31	1
Puri	4	2	23	1	74	4	60	4	42	3	31	1
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU	*2*	*1*	*29*	*2*	*63*	*4*	*56*	*4*	*36*	*3*	*29*	*2*
Hazaribagh	7	1	50	4	69	3	63	4	44	3	35	3
Ranchi	2	3	43	2	138	4	86	5	56	3	28	2
Palamau	2	3	24	1	37	6	43	9	27	5	17	...
Manbhum	4	1	47	3	85	7	107	13	68	7	43	1
Singhbhum	2	3	36	6	72	6	94	10	55	7	33	4
Sonthal Parganas ...	2	3	29	1	77	3	66	4	41	3	21	3
Angul	...	...	6	...	4	3	36	1	19	1	9	...
Sambalpur	1	1	24	1	52	3	39	2	27	2	...	...
Orissa Feudatory States ...	1	1	11	1	24	1	19	1	13	1	Not available.	
Chota Nagpur States ...	4	...	23	...	26	1	40	1	24	1		
SIKKIM	...	...	16	...	84	...	52	2	36	1	...	...

The figures for 1891 are not available.
In calculating for the province as a whole and for natural divisions, areas for which figures are not available have been left out of account.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—Progress of Education since 1881.

District and Natural Division.	Number of literate per mille.															
	All ages.								15—19.				20 and over.			
	Male.				Female.				Male.		Female.		Male.		Female.	
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1911.	1901.	1911.	1901.	1911.	1901.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	*112*	*104*	*108*	*89*	*8*	*5*	*4*	*3*	*153*	*140*	*14*	*9*	*162*	*146*	*9*	*6*
Bengal	*140*	*127*	*134*	*117*	*11*	*8*	*6*	*4*	*189*	*175*	*19*	*13*	*199*	*175*	*13*	*9*
WEST BENGAL	*191*	*188*	*200*	*172*	*11*	*8*	*5*	*3*	*256*	*249*	*19*	*13*	*254*	241	*12*	*9*
Burdwan	186	162	173	142	13	8	5	2	252	223	21	16	231	197	14	9
Birbhum	171	153	178	142	6	4	3	2	236	219	10	7	225	198	7	5
Bankura	184	183	185	167	7	5	4	2	256	248	13	10	251	241	8	6
Midnapore	181	205	194	175	7	7	4	2	243	257	12	10	260	273	8	8
Hooghly	199	197	243	205	21	14	9	4	266	257	32	22	248	240	23	16
Howrah	248	212	249	217	23	12	9	5	312	284	39	19	312	265	23	14
CENTRAL BENGAL	*183*	*162*	*156*	*140*	*24*	*16*	*14*	*7*	*228*	*216*	*39*	*30*	*245*	*209*	*28*	*18*
24-Parganas	216	202	210	191	17	13	19	5	272	269	27	21	287	258	20	14
Calcutta	396	316	325	311	164	115	90	66	470	425	260	204	419	323	166	108
Nadia	98	104	96	82	14	9	5	3	125	140	25	17	139	138	16	10
Murshidabad	108	106	103	83	9	6	4	2	147	152	14	10	157	152	10	7
Jessore	127	110	106	106	10	5	8	2	156	127	17	9	174	155	11	5
NORTH BENGAL	*98*	*84*	*88*	*76*	*5*	*3*	*2*	*2*	*127*	*110*	*8*	*5*	*146*	*122*	*6*	*4*
Rajshahi	86	80	79	67	5	4	3	3	110	107	9	5	133	118	6	4
Dinajpur	108	99	101	82	4	3	1	1	140	125	6	4	160	145	5	3
Jalpaiguri	99	70	89	57	4	4	3	1	118	86	7	6	141	99	5	4
Darjeeling	169	119	133	82	19	14	7	7	191	184	32	21	245	165	19	17
Rangpur	76	64	68	68	3	2	1	2	100	78	5	3	115	94	4	
Bogra	111	96	102	111	5	3	1	3	146	128	5	4	170	141	5	4
Pabna	102	91	93	83	7	4	2	2	142	127	14	7	147	134	9	5
Malda	89	74	79	68	3	2	2	...	119	104	5	4	137	107	4	3
Cooch Behar	134	107	106	80	6	4	3	2	164	134	9	7	189	152	7	5
EAST BENGAL	*121*	*108*	*118*	*103*	*9*	*6*	*4*	*3*	*172*	*153*	*16*	*11*	*180*	*157*	*11*	*8*
Khulna	153	124	115	102	11	8	4	2	208	165	19	13	209	170	12	10
Dacca	134	121	122	102	16	10	7	3	205	184	29	20	192	171	20	13
Mymensingh	85	69	79	67	5	4	3	2	118	94	9	6	126	104	7	5
Faridpur	112	97	109	95	10	6	5	2	159	137	19	13	156	136	12	7
Backergunge	156	147	151	118	11	9	5	3	215	210	21	14	231	200	14	10
Tippera	132	121	136	127	8	5	3	7	188	179	13	8	198	178	9	6
Noakhali	118	105	138	137	6	3	3	1	172	149	9	5	202	178	7	4
Chittagong	133	117	139	139	7	5	3	2	175	162	11	6	222	201	9	6
Chittagong Hill Tracts	115	79	...	...	4	3	...	...	112	80	7	3	194	130	6	4
Hill Tippera	69	41	...	...	8	2	...	...	99	53	11	3	101	62	10	2
Bihar and Orissa	*76*	*75*	*75*	*54*	*4*	*3*	*2*	*1*	*103*	*96*	*7*	*4*	*114*	*110*	*4*	*3*
NORTH BIHAR	*72*	*66*	*68*	*44*	*3*	*2*	*1*	*1*	*98*	*89*	*6*	*3*	*105*	*98*	*4*	*2*
Saran	76	73	69	47	3	2	2	2	114	89	5	3	114	118	3	3
Champaran	51	45	42	28	2	1	1	...	65	55	5	2	74	67	2	1
Muzaffarpur	70	78	91	46	4	3	1	1	96	100	9	5	103	115	5	4
Darbhanga	81	71	65	48	3	1	1	...	111	111	6	3	118	99	3	2
Bhagalpur	78	66	61	42	3	1	1	1	107	89	6	2	110	96	4	2
Purnea	72	57	66	48	3	1	...	2	89	72	4	3	106	81	3	1
SOUTH BIHAR	*93*	*82*	*85*	*62*	*5*	*3*	*2*	*4*	*134*	*106*	*10*	*5*	*133*	*116*	*6*	*4*
Patna	126	123	119	96	9	6	5	13	181	162	18	9	171	159	10	7
Gaya	84	72	76	59	4	2	1	1	122	91	7	3	122	100	5	3
Shahabad	92	86	74	54	4	3	2	1	138	106	8	5	129	121	5	4
Monghyr	77	58	74	43	4	2	2	1	106	79	8	4	115	80	4	2
ORISSA	*127*	*151*	*134*	*103*	*5*	*4*	*3*	*3*	*152*	*176*	*10*	*7*	*194*	*215*	*6*	*5*
Cuttack	133	150	144	98	5	5	3	2	163	183	10	7	203	219	6	5
Balasore	136	157	130	118	5	4	3	2	152	182	10	7	210	232	5	5
Puri	108	139	118	97	5	4	3	5	127	154	10	7	162	198	6	5
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU ...	*54*	*50*	*47*	*37*	*3*	*2*	*2*	*1*	*75*	*64*	*6*	*4*	*83*	*78*	*4*	*3*
Hazaribagh	43	52	57	31	3	2	2	1	62	77	6	3	67	78	4	2
Ranchi	57	51	36	30	7	5	3	2	81	70	11	8	91	86	7	5
Palamau	32	37			3	1			48	49	8	2	48	60	4	2
Manbhum	84	77	69	58	5	3	2	1	116	92	9	6	120	112	6	4
Singhbhum	51	48	52	41	4	3	4	1	73	58	6	4	79	73	5	3
Sonthal Parganas	61	47	37	33	3	2	1	2	86	66	5	4	97	71	4	2
Angul	48	39	35	37	3	1	...	...	66	47	4	2	71	59	2	1
Sambalpur	55	33	...	...	2	1	...	...	51	45	5	2	82	55	2	1
Orissa Feudatory States ...	44	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	57	...	4	...	70	...	3	...
Chota Nagpur States ...	50	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	56	...	2	...	85	...	4	...
SIKKIM	78	95	...	...	3	3	...	...	73	85	3	3	132	155	4	3

In calculating for the Province as a whole and for natural divisions, areas for which figures are not available have been left out of account.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—EDUCATION BY CASTE.

CASTE.	NUMBER PER 1,000 WHO ARE LITERATE.						NUMBER PER 10,000 LITERATE IN ENGLISH.					
	1911.			1901.			1911.			1901.		
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
BENGAL.												
HINDU.												
Agarwala	417	632	39	407	569	42	424	652	23	184	285	...
Bagdi	19	41	1	16	30	2	8	16	·4	5	9	...
Baidya	532	720	346	456	648	259	2,088	3,986	204	1,585	3,039	85
Baishnab	112	228	15	102	214	11	69	147	4	47	102	2
Barui	153	282	18	129	245	6	180	347	6	126	245	1
Bauri	10	20	·4	4	8	·3	3	5	1	·3	1	...
Bhuinmali	34	65	2	22	41	1	9	17	...	3	7	...
Brahman	399	644	113	358	639	56	1,090	1,990	41	819	1,569	11
Dhoba	55	103	3	55	103	3	28	53	·3	14	27	...
Gandhabanik	314	559	51	318	510	63	586	1,103	34	1,018	1,736	39
Garo	3	5	...	12	24	·5	...	...	...	...	...	...
Goala	77	135	6	63	130	4	65	116	2	39	81	1
Gurung	88	171	3	53	99	6	23	45	...	6	12	...
Jogi and Jugi	130	250	6	104	202	4	51	101	1	26	51	...
Kaibartta, Chasi	109	208	8	130	323	4	72	143	4	52	131	...
Kaibartta, Jalya	44	83	2	43	84	2	21	40	1	8	16	...
Kalu	107	205	6	103	204	4	31	59	1	31	62	1
Kamar	150	279	13	140	268	8	114	218	3	71	139	2
Kapali	60	116	3	...	...	...	26	51	1	...	...	...
Kayasth	347	569	134	309	538	79	980	1,866	50	759	1,475	43
Khambu and Jimdar	68	140	3	43	82	2	27	55	1	3	7	...
Koch	18	35	·2	...	...	...	1	2	...	...	...	...
Kumhar	80	152	5	66	125	4	57	110	2	27	53	...
Limbu	59	118	3	30	54	3	21	43	...	12	23	...
Malo	28	54	2	...	...	...	18	35	·1	...	...	...
Mangar	30	59	...	54	99	5	6	12	...	3	6	...
Muchi	12	23	·4	8	15	1	6	10	·1	1	2	...
Namasudra	49	95	2	33	64	1	22	44	·3	4	9	...
Napit	110	208	8	98	187	6	87	168	2	61	118	1
Newar	107	192	7	82	141	13	83	153	...	19	37	...
Patni	18	34	1	...	...	...	8	15	...	...	...	...
Pod	141	244	5	94	183	5	31	54	·1	15	29	...
Rajbansi	51	97	2	32	60	1	8	16	·1	3	6	·1
Sadgop	140	264	14	139	268	12	186	361	10	165	328	2
Subarna Banik	451	683	163	323	519	81	2,187	3,871	98	1,514	2,685	74
Sudra	113	222	12	102	209	9	83	172	1	61	129	1
Sunri	149	275	19	208	407	12	184	319	45	107	213	1
Sutradhar	86	161	7	62	116	5	65	127	1	54	102	2
Tanti	145	258	20	111	206	11	204	377	14	140	270	4
Teli and Tili	163	302	16	163	303	11	193	364	12	127	243	2
Tipara	7	11	·2	3	5	·3	·3	1	...	1	2	...
Tiyar	20	40	2	28	53	10	7	15	1	63	53	100
MUSALMAN.												
Dhobi	21	40	2	20	40	...	12	24	...	...	...	...
Hajjam	24	46	1	21	21	22	4	8	...	...	...	...
Jolaha	44	80	3	27	52	1	13	24	1	4	7	·4
Kulu	26	48	1	23	44	1	11	21	...	2	5	...
Naliya	8	14	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Saiyad	177	308	34	169	297	30	259	488	10	170	320	6
CHRISTIAN.												
Anglo-Indian	840	847	833	...	...	...	8,279	8,394	8,164	...	...	...
Indian Christian*	141	188	94	...	...	...	275	404	146	...	...	...
BUDDHIST.												
Bhotia	60	110	9	38	68	5	63	121	5	2	5	...
Chakma	53	100	1	45	83	2	18	35	...	11	21	...
Lepcha	29	58	1	29	52	5	19	37	...	6	12	1
Magh	110	211	13	87	173	8	50	101	1	24	51	...
Murmi	46	89	2	34	64	4	14	27	...	1	2	...
BIHAR AND ORISSA.												
HINDU.												
Agarwala	250	481	25	242	475	15	167	340	...	108	219	...
Babhan (Bhumihar Brahman)	102	187	14	88	166	9	16	31	·04	13	27	...
Baishnab	122	225	8	144	274	9	14	26	...	16	31	...
Baniya	97	191	5	89	180	2	20	39	1	17	22	...
Barai	19	37	1	21	45	·3	4	7	...	3	7	...
Barhi	21	43	11	23	46	1	5	10	·1	6	12	...
Bauri	3	6	·1	5	8	2	...	...	...	·1	·2	...
Bhuiya	8	16	1	5	9	·4	3	7	·3	·2	·4	...
Bhumij	12	22	1	7	15	1	2	4	·1	·1	·3	...
Brahman	168	317	18	158	336	7	81	156	6	49	105	1
Chamar	3	7	·3	3	6	·2	·3	1	...	·4	1	·02
Chasa	30	59	1	38	74	1	2	3	·02	2	3	...
Dhanuk	13	27	·4	10	20	1	1	2	...	1	2	...
Dhobi (Dhoba)	8	17	1	10	19	·4	1	2	·1	1	2	...
Dom	4	7	·3	3	7	·3	1	2	...	...	...	...

* The figures for Indian Christians relate only to East and North Bengal, and differ therefore from those in Sub-Table I which relate to the whole Province.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—EDUCATION BY CASTE—*concluded.*

CASTE.	NUMBER PER 1,000 WHO ARE LITERATE.						NUMBER PER 10,000 LITERATE IN ENGLISH.					
	1911.			1901.			1911.			1901.		
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
BIHAR AND ORISSA—*concluded.*												
HINDU—*concld.*												
Dosadh	4	7	·3	4	7	·2	·4	1	...	·4	1	·01
Gaura	14	27	1	23	46	1	1	3	...	2	4	...
Goala (Ahir)	12	24	1	9	18	·4	2	4	·1	1	2	·01
Gond	10	18	2	2	4	1	·1	·3	...	...	...	...
Hajjam	14	27	1	13	25	...	7	9	5	3	7	...
Hari	3	7	·1	7	14	·04	·2	·4	...	·2	·4	...
Ho	2	3	·2	2	4	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Kahar	17	34	2	14	30	1	7	15	·3	5	11	·2
Kalwar	100	201	2	101	208	2	20	40	1	15	32	...
Kamar	29	55	2	26	50	1	4	7	...	2	3	·1
Kandh	4	7	·3	5	10	1	·3	1	...	...	...	...
Kandu	20	40	1	25	52	1	3	5	·1	3	6	...
Karan	257	492	37	226	528	23	197	406	3	125	259	1
Kayasth	332	603	56	319	624	32	551	1,072	19	432	881	9
Kewat	17	35	7	20	41	...	1	3	...	1	1	...
Khandait	69	141	4	76	154	3	17	35	·2	6	13	...
Kolri	22	43	1	17	34	·4	3	5	·04	2	4	·01
Kumhar	13	26	1	16	31	1	3	6	·2	2	3	...
Kurmi	30	60	1	31	62	1	4	8	·1	3	6	·03
Lohar	14	27	1	11	22	1	3	5	·1	2	3	...
Mallah	4	9	·3	10	24	...	·2	·4	·1	1	2	...
Mal Paharia	7	14	1	1	3	...	·2	1	...	1	2	...
Munda	21	39	1	20	36	2	3	5	1	1	2	...
Musahar	1	2	·2	4	8	...	·3	1	...	·5	1	·04
Nuniya	9	20	·4	10	20	2	1	3	...	1	2	...
Pan	6	11	·2	6	12	...	1	2	...	...	...	...
Rajbansi	22	47	1	17	32	1	2	5	...	·4	1	...
Rajput (Chattri)	92	176	6	77	149	4	23	44	·3	16	31	·4
Rajwar	2	3	·1	2	4	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Rauniar	54	107	2	106	202	1	15	29	...	1	2	...
Santal	4	8	·4	3	6	·1	·4	1	...	·2	·4	...
Sonar	67	134	3	68	140	2	14	28	·1	13	17	...
Sunri	68	136	2	58	116	3	9	19	2	4	7	·3
Tanti	16	32	1	29	58	1	3	6	·1	2	5	·1
Teli	39	77	2	38	77	1	4	7	·2	2	4	...
MUSALMAN.												
Dhobi	4	7	·3	5	9	·4	2	4	...	·3	1	...
Dhunia	10	21	1	7	15	1	2	5	·1	...	...	...
Hajjam	18	36	1	21	45	1	5	11	...	4	9	...
Jolaha	20	41	2	24	48	2	7	14	2	13	27	·1
Kunjra	9	18	1	10	20	1	2	5	...	6	13	...
Saiyad	178	322	41	138	259	21	344	699	6	193	389	3
CHRISTIAN.												
Anglo-Indian	867	874	860	...	...	...	8,508	8,613	8,395	...	...	...
ANIMIST.												
Gond	2	4	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Ho	7	15	·3	7	14	...	3	6	...	1	3	...
Kandh	1	2	·1	18	36	1	...	...	...	...	...	...
Munda	5	10	1	7	13	...	2	3	...	·4	1	·1
Oraon	5	8	1	3	6	...	1	2	·2	·3	1	...
Pan	3	7	·2	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Santal	5	10	·1	4	7	·3	1	1	...	1	1	·2
Sauria Paharia (Male)	1	2	·1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VII.—Number of Institutions and Pupils according to the returns of the Education Department.*

Class of Institution.	1911.		1901.		1891.	
	Number of—		Number of—		Number of—	
	Institutions.	Scholars.	Institutions.	Scholars.	Institutions.	Scholars.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
BENGAL.						
PUBLIC INSTITUTIONS.						
Collegiate Education.						
Arts Colleges ... For boys ...	38	9,244	35	7,289	28	4,318
,, girls ...	3	60	2	45	2	19
Law ,, ...	11	1,221	13	760	6	903
Medical Colleges ...	1	629	1	569	1	197
Civil Engineering Colleges ...	1	328	1	271	1	271
Training Colleges ...	4	72	1	10	...	...
Total of Collegiate Education	***58***	***11,554***	***53***	***8,944***	***38***	***6,203***
School Education—General.						
High English Schools ... For boys ...	487	125,772	405	93,165	287	60,518
,, girls ...	18	1,495	5	523	...	...
Middle English Schools... For boys ...	1,122	107,657	775	56,940	675	48,583
,, girls ...	11	1,039	...	...	...	...
Middle Vernacular Schools For boys ...	541	34,335	854	46,481	943	52,796
,, girls ...	21	2,303	15	1,017	...	...
Primary Schools For boys ...	27,872	1,008,142	28,259	802,324	29,792	753,033
,, girls ...	6,096	139,180	2,091	44,041	...	...
Female Schools† ...	...	...	...	...	2,137	41,980
Total of School Education—General.	***36,163***	***1,419,923***	***32,404***	***1,044,491***	***33,834***	***956,883***
School Education—Special.						
Training Schools For masters ...	127	2,227	10	575	...	...
,, mistresses ...	8	128	8	445	...	...
Medical Schools ...	10	2,063	7	938	...	...
Engineering or Surveying Schools ...	1	311	1	109	...	...
Industrial School's ...	43	1,652	11	540	...	...
Commercial Schools ...	13	570	...	...	...	...
Madrasahs ...	393	15,376	23	2,692	...	...
Miscellaneous Schools ...	2,155	56,105	367	5,258	185	5,007
Total of School Education—Special.	***2,750***	***78,432***	***427***	***10,557***	***185***	***5,007***
Total of Public Institutions ...	***38,971***	***1,509,909***	***32,884***	***1,063,992***	***34,057***	***968,093***
PRIVATE INSTITUTIONS.						
Advanced, teaching Arabic or Persian ...	147	4,769	192	5,330	361	7,207
Advanced, teaching Sanskrit	147	915	540	4,035	804	7,068
Elementary, teaching vernacular only. For boys ...	135	3,058	529	7,041	1,176	8,456
,, girls ...	18	280	1	2	...	...
Elementary, teaching the Koran ... For boys ...	1,446	26,611	3,266	50,178	5,729	68,043
,, girls ...	194	2,167	253	1,821	...	...
Other schools not conforming to Departmental Standard. For boys ...	352	11,994	67	1,497	106	956
,, girls ...	37	2,114	...	...	...	...
Total of Private Institutions ...	***2,476***	***51,908***	***4,848***	***69,904***	***8,176***	***91,730***
GRAND TOTAL ...	***41,447***	***1,561,817***	***37,732***	***1,133,896***	***42,233***	***1,059,823***
BIHAR AND ORISSA.						
PUBLIC INSTITUTIONS.						
Collegiate Education.						
Arts Colleges ...	7	1,202	7	865	4	400
Law ,, ...	3	98	4	85	3	68
Training Colleges ...	1	11	...	...	...	...
Total of Collegiate Education	***11***	***1,311***	***11***	***950***	***7***	***468***

* Compiled for British territory.
† Details of female schools in 1891 are not available.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VII.—Number of Institutions and Pupils according to the returns of the Education Department*—*concluded.*

Class of Institution.	1911.		1901.		1891.	
	Number of—		Number of—		Number of—	
	Institutions.	Scholars.	Institutions.	Scholars.	Institutions.	Scholars.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
BIHAR AND ORISSA—*concluded.*						
PUBLIC INSTITUTIONS—*concluded.*						
SCHOOL EDUCATION—GENERAL.						
High English Schools ... For boys ...	91	22,328	87	18,060	68	14,901
,, girls ...	2	258	1	33	...	...
Middle English Schools ... ,, boys ...	182	14,854	151	9,118	136	8,544
,, girls ...	4	396	...	...	...	...
Middle Vernacular Schools ... ,, boys ...	136	8,967	153	7,817	159	8,113
,, girls ...	9	616	7	448	...	...
Primary Schools ... ,, boys ...	19,840	538,272	16,817	378,665	17,719	356,368
,, girls ...	1,171	29,724	506	10,838	...	...
Female Schools†	...	...	...	...	563	12,048
Total of School Education—General.	***21,435***	***615,415***	***17,722***	***424,979***	***18,645***	***399,774***
SCHOOL EDUCATION—SPECIAL.						
Training Schools ... For masters ...	118	1,923	8	200	...	...
,, mistresses	10	67	1	12	...	...
Medical Schools	2	223	2	246	...	...
Engineering or Surveying Schools ...	3	259	3	207	...	...
Industrial Schools	36	833	16	347	...	...
Commercial Schools	2	29	...	...	...	...
Madrasahs	7	630	5	375	...	...
Miscellaneous Schools	1,959	51,280	118	2,825	95	2,128
Total of School Education—Special.	***2,137***	***55,244***	***153***	***4,212***	***95***	***2,128***
Total of Public Institutions...	***23,583***	***671,970***	***17,886***	***430,141***	***18,747***	***402,370***
PRIVATE INSTITUTIONS.						
Advanced, teaching Arabic or Persian ...	473	5,919	992	10,317	934	9,548
Ditto Sanskrit	365	3,839	649	6,569	884	10,974
Elementary, teaching vernacular only. For boys ...	2,370	26,047	3,126	25,733	3,343	22,417
,, girls ...	16	391	15	425	...	...
Elementary, teaching the Koran ... ,, boys ...	245	3,130	371	4,122	239	2,297
,, girls ...	7	82	3	18	...	...
Other schools not conforming to Departmental Standard. ,, boys ...	166	3,648	49	869	157	1,541
,, girls ...	6	372	...	...	...	...
Total of Private Institutions...	***3,648***	***43,428***	***5,205***	***48,053***	***5,557***	***46,777***
GRAND TOTAL	***27,234***	***715,398***	***23,091***	***478,194***	***24,304***	***449,147***

* Compiled for British territory.
† Details of female schools in 1891 are not available.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VIII.—Main results of University Examinations.

Examination.	1911.			1901.			1891.			Variation per cent.			
										1901—1911.		1891—1901.	
	Candidates.	Passed.	Percentage of passed candidates.	Candidates.	Passed.	Percentage of passed candidates.	Candidates.	Passed.	Percentage of passed candidates.	Candidates.	Passed.	Candidates.	Passed.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.													
Matriculation (Entrance) ...	5,506	3,889	70·6	5,060	2,812	55·6	4,151	1,816	43·7	+ 8·8	+ 38·3	+ 21·9	+ 54·8
F. A. or Intermediate ...	4,071	2,098	51·5	3,286	1,039	31·6	1,929	693	35·9	+23·9	+101·9	+ 70·3	+ 49·9
B. A. or B. Sc.	1,119	679	60·7	1,688	311	18·4	807	231	28·6	-33·7	+118·3	+109·2	+ 34·6
Degrees in Arts, M.A. or M.Sc.	150	83	55·3	219	91	41·6	127	57	44·9	-31·5	- 8·8	+ 72·4	+ 59·6
Degrees in Medicine ...	423	231	54·6	506	214	42·3	107	69	64·5	16·4	+ 7·9	+372·9	+210·1
,, Law	766	396	51·7	553	160	28·9	203	128	63·1	+38·5	+147·5	+172·4	+ 25·0
,, Civil Engineering	48	25	52·1	62	19	30·6	24	9	37·5	-22·6	+ 31·6	+158·3	+111·1
Total ...	***12,083***	***7,401***	***61·3***	***11,374***	***4,646***	***40·8***	***7,348***	***3,003***	***40·9***	***+6·2***	***+59·3***	***+54·8***	***+54·7***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IX.—NUMBER AND CIRCULATION OF NEWSPAPERS, ETC.

LANGUAGE.	Class of Newspapers and Periodicals (Daily, Weekly, etc.).	1911.		1901.		1891.	
		Number.	Circulation.	Number.	Circulation.	Number.	Circulation.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
BENGAL.							
	NEWSPAPERS.						
BENGALI	Daily	2	3,500	3	2,500	6	4,300
	Weekly	59	133,000	44	115,300	30	53,300
	Thrice a month	1	200	1	250	...	...
	Fortnightly	2	600	5	1,750	6	3,400
	Monthly	2	600	5	1,600	...	...
	Total ...	***66***	***137,900***	***58***	***121,400***	***42***	***61,000***
ENGLISH	Daily	4	10,300	5	5,800	Not available.	
	Bi-weekly	1	2,000	1	1,000		
	Weekly	14	14,050	11	6,420		
	Fortnightly	3	3,400	1	150		
	Monthly	29	26,730	1	500		
	Total ...	***51***	***56,480***	***19***	***13,870***	...	...
HINDI	Weekly	7	17,900	2	13,000	6	9,600
	Monthly	1	500	...	...	2	3'0
	Total ...	***8***	***18,400***	***2***	***13,000***	***8***	***7,200***
PERSIAN	Weekly	1	1,000	1	1,000	1	250
URDU	Ditto	1	400	1	250	4	600
	Fortnightly	...	...	1	200	...	...
	Monthly	...	...	1	200	...	...
	Total ...	***1***	***400***	***3***	***650***	***4***	***600***
	Total of Newspapers.	***127***	***214,180***	***83***	***149,920***	***55***	***69,050***
	PERIODICALS.						
ASSAMESE ...	Monthly	2	930	...	...	2	1,200
	Quarterly	1	500	...	...	...	...
	Total ...	***3***	***1,430***	...	...	***2***	***1,200***
BENGALI	Weekly	...	...	1	1,000	1	1,000
	Fortnightly	...	...	2	1,600	...	...
	Bi-monthly	...	...	1	750	...	...
	Monthly	89	92,550	70	58,516	33	37,300
	Quarterly	2	1,000	1	750	...	...
	Total ...	***91***	***93,550***	***75***	***62,616***	***34***	***38,300***
ENGLISH	Bi-weekly	...	...	1	25	...	...
	Weekly	1	2,500	1	250	...	...
	Fortnightly	3	3,500	2	1,050	1	500
	Bi-monthly	1	1,000	...	...	...	...
	Monthly	46	50,150	22	15,175	5	3,175
	Quarterly	5	3,900	4	1,035	2	725
	Four-monthly	1	500	...	...	...	...
	Half-yearly	1	400	1	7,500	...	...
	Total ...	***58***	***61,950***	***31***	***25,035***	***8***	***4,400***
GARO	Monthly	1	750	1	750	...	...
HINDI	Ditto	1	450	2	1,400	1	500
SANSKRIT... ...	Ditto	1	500	1	250	1	250
ORIYA	Ditto	1	1,000	...	...	...	...
ARABIC AND BENGALI.	Ditto	...	...	1	1,000	...	...
BENGALI AND ENGLISH.	Ditto	3	2,200	1	150	2	800
	Bi-monthly	1	1,400	...	...	...	...
	Total ...	***4***	***3,600***	***1***	***150***	***2***	***800***
BENGALI AND SANSKRIT.	Bi-monthly	...	...	1	500	...	...
	Monthly	7	5,350	4	4,460	3	1,250
	Total ...	***7***	***6,350***	***5***	***4,960***	***3***	***1,250***
ENGLISH AND SANSKRIT.	Monthly...	...	...	1	1,000	...	...
HINDI AND MAITHILI.	Ditto	2	750	...	...	...	...
BENGALI, ENGLISH AND SANSKRIT.	Ditto	2	1,000	...	...	...	...
GUJARATI, HINDI, MARATHI, PUNJABI, TAMIL AND URIYA.	Ditto	1	500	...	...	...	...
	Total of Periodicals.	***172***	***170,830***	***118***	***97,161***	***51***	***46,700***
	GRAND TOTAL ...	***299***	***385,010***	***201***	***247,081***	***106***	***115,750***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IX.—NUMBER AND CIRCULATION OF NEWSPAPERS, ETC.—*concluded.*

LANGUAGE.	Class of Newspapers and Periodicals (Daily, Weekly, etc.).	1911.		1901.		1891.	
		Number.	Circulation.	Number.	Circulation.	Number.	Circulation.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
BIHAR AND ORISSA.							
	NEWSPAPERS.						
BENGALI ...	Weekly	3	1,300	1	600	...	...
ENGLISH ...	Bi-weekly	...	...	1	400	Not available.	
	Weekly	6	2,010	2	3,100		
	Fortnightly	...	...	1	500		
	Monthly	2	1,017	...	...		
	Four-monthly	1	500	...	...		
	Total ...	***9***	***3,527***	***4***	***4,000***		
HINDI	Weekly	5	2,300	1	500	2	1,700
	Fortnightly	1	1,250	1	500	...	...
	Monthly	2	500	1	500	1	200
	Total ...	***8***	***4,050***	***3***	***1,500***	***3***	***1,900***
URDU	Weekly	2	1,100	2	750	4	900
ORIYA	Ditto	6	3,600	4	1,600	4	1,050
	Monthly	...	...	...	...	6	1,000
	Total ...	***6***	***3,600***	***4***	***1,600***	***10***	***2,050***
	Total of Newspapers.	***28***	***13,577***	***14***	***8,450***	***17***	***4,850***
	PERIODICALS.						
BENGALI ...	Monthly		200	...	...	...	...
ENGLISH ...	Ditto	4	2,350	1	350	...	...
HINDI	Bi-monthly	...	...	...	...	1	250
	Monthly	5	2,500	2	450	4	1,250
	Quarterly	1	300	...	...	1	250
	Total ...	***6***	***2,800***	***2***	***450***	***6***	***1,750***
URDU	Monthly	...	...	1	500	...	...
ORIYA	Ditto	3	1,600	...	...	...	...
HINDI AND MAITHILI.	Ditto	1	500	...	...	...	...
HINDI AND SANSKRIT.	Ditto	1	250	...	...	...	...
	Total of Periodicals.	***16***	***7,700***	***4***	***1,300***	***6***	***1,750***
	GRAND TOTAL ...	***44***	***21,277***	***18***	***9,750***	***23***	***6,600***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE X.—Number of Books published in each Language.

Language.	Number of Books published in—										Total.
	1901.	1902.	1903.	1904.	1905.	1906.	1907.	1908.	1909.	1910.	1901—10.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12

BENGAL.

UNILINGUAL BOOKS.

Abor-Miri	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	2	...	3
Angami-Naga	...	...	...	...	1	1	...	1	...	1	4
Ao-Naga	...	...	...	2	...	1	...	2	1	...	...	8
Arabic	...	...	...	1	1	2	1	...	1	2	3	11
Armenian	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
Assamese	...	...	...	42	38	31	73	85	57	69	44	512
Bengali	...	...	...	938	954	843	1,022	901	976	1,140	1,530	10,535
Bhojpuri	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Bodo	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	1
English	...	...	...	253	255	209	319	259	303	339	416	3,019
French	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1	1	3
Garo	...	...	...	2	...	3	...	1	1	...	1	9
Hindi	...	...	...	36	40	39	66	48	68	68	70	501
Ho	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
Jamasari	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
Khasi	...	...	...	2	2	...	3	...	...	2	2	12
Latin	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
Lepcha	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	...	1	...	4
Lushai	...	...	...	...	1	1	2	1	...	1	3	9
Maithili	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
Manipuri	...	...	...	4	6	...	9	3	...	2	...	25
Mikir	...	...	...	...	1	3	1	54	...	...	...	59
Mundari	...	...	...	1	1	1	1	...	2	...	1	7
Musalmani-Bengali	...	...	...	64	50	27	49	16	17	9	11	20	27	290
Nagpuria	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	1	2	...	5
Nepali	...	...	...	1	1	...	1	1	...	2	10	3	2	21
Oraon (Kurukh)	...	...	...	1	...	1	...	...	1	...	...	...	1	4
Oriya	...	...	...	13	5	12	6	4	31	31	27	38	45	212
Paharia	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	1
Pali	...	...	...	1	1	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	4
Persian	...	...	...	1	5	1	2	3	4	3	4	4	7	34
Rungadania-Rabha	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Sanskrit	...	...	...	65	65	77	74	53	52	52	48	57	81	624
Santali	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	2	5
Sema-Naga	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	...	...	2
Tangkhul-Naga	...	...	...	1	...	1	...	...	...	3	1	1	2	9
Tibetan	...	...	...	...	1	...	2	...	...	2	1	2	3	11
Urdu	...	...	...	17	16	17	21	7	19	5	9	10	30	151
Total of Unilingual Books				*1,586*	*1,770*	*1,421*	*1,451*	*1,218*	*1,623*	*1,469*	*1,524*	*1,766*	*2,274*	*16,102*

BILINGUAL BOOKS.

Ao-Naga and English	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
Arabic and Assamese	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, Bengali	...	...	...	...	2	1	...	1	9	19	9	41
,, ,, English	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	3	5
,, ,, Musalman-Bengali	...	...	...	14	7	6	7	3	5	3	3	6	1	55
,, ,, Persian	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	2	1	...	5
,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	3	7	...	4	1	5	3	2	1	5	31
Assamese and English	...	...	...	1	2	2	...	4	2	3	3	2	6	25
,, ,, Sanskrit	...	...	...	1	1	2	1	...	...	...	2	5	...	12
Bengali and Burmese	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
,, ,, English	...	...	...	77	83	106	82	72	91	59	60	87	186	903
,, ,, Hindi	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	2	1	...	1	1	6
,, ,, Musalmani-Bengali	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	2
,, ,, Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	6	...	1	...	1	...	2	10
,, ,, Pali	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	...	1	1	1	1	6
,, ,, Persian	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	...	...	3
,, ,, Punjabi	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, Sanskrit	...	...	...	151	127	101	110	104	137	107	171	171	167	1,346
,, ,, Santali	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	3
,, ,, Traipuri	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	4	...	1	...	2	8
Burmese and Hindi	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
English and French	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, Hebrew	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
,, ,, Hindi	...	...	...	4	7	6	4	1	6	4	1	5	6	44
,, ,, Latin	...	...	...	2	1	...	...	...	1	...	1	1	...	6
,, ,, Manipuri	...	...	...	...	2	2	...	...	2	...	...	...	...	6
,, ,, Mundari	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	1	...	3
,, ,, Nepali	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	3	...	...	4
,, ,, Oriya	...	...	...	2	1	...	...	1	1	...	...	1	...	6
,, ,, Pali	...	...	...	1	...	...	3	6	...	...	...	1	...	11
,, ,, Persian	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	3	5
,, ,, Sanskrit	...	...	...	11	14	16	9	8	27	34	28	19	32	198
,, ,, Tibetan	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1	1	2	...	1	1	7
,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	2	4	5	...	1	3	1	...	3	4	23
Gujarati and Hindi	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	1
Hindi and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	2
,, ,, Prakrit	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, Sanskrit	...	...	...	1	3	2	4	6	5	2	2	6	6	37
,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	1	...	2	...	1	5
Marathi and Sanskrit	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	...	...	2
Musalmani-Bengali and Persian	...	...	...	1	...	1	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	3
,, ,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1	1	...	1	...	4

SUBSIDIARY TABLE X.—Number of Books published in each Language—*continued.*

Language.	Number of Books published in—										Total.
	1901.	1902.	1903.	1904.	1905.	1906.	1907.	1908.	1909.	1910.	1901—10.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
BENGAL—*concluded.*											
BILINGUAL BOOKS—*concluded.*											
Persian and Musalmani-Bengali	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, Turkish	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	2
,, ,, Urdu	...	3	...	2	...	1	...	3	3	2	13
Prakrit and Sanskrit	4	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	5
,, ,, Oriya	2	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2
Sanskrit and Tibetan	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	3	5
,, ,, Oriya	2	1	...	6	...	6	9	3	6	1	34
Telugu and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Total of Bilingual Books	***283***	***268***	***250***	***242***	***217***	***308***	***236***	***302***	***345***	***449***	***2,900***
TRILINGUAL BOOKS.											
Arabic, Bengali and Musalmani-Bengali	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
,, ,, ,, Persian	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
,, ,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	5	3	1	10
,, English and Persian	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	2
,, Musalmani-Bengali and Persian	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	...	...	...	2
,, Bengali and Urdu	...	1	1	1	...	1	3	...	1	...	8
Bengali, English and Hindi	1	...	1	...	1	...	1	...	1	...	5
,, ,, ,, Pali	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
,, ,, ,, Persian	1	2	1	...	...	...	...	1	1	2	8
,, ,, ,, Sanskrit	15	31	29	28	29	28	18	14	39	30	256
,, ,, ,, Traipuri	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	2
,, ,, ,, Urdu	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	3
,, ,, ,, Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
,, Hindi and Manipuri	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
,, ,, ,, Sanskrit	1	1	1	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	5
,, ,, ,, Oriya	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, Musalmani-Bengali and Urdu	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
,, Pali and Sanskrit	...	...	...	1	1	...	...	...	...	...	2
,, Sanskrit and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1	...	2
English Hindi and Nepali	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, ,, Sanskrit	2	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	3
,, ,, ,, Tibetan	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
,, ,, ,, Urdu	...	...	1	1	1	1	...	1	...	2	7
,, ,, ,, Oriya	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, Pali and Sanskrit	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, Persian and Urdu	...	...	...	3	...	...	...	...	...	...	3
,, Sanskrit and Tibetan	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1	2
Total of Trilingual Books	***22***	***36***	***36***	***36***	***33***	***25***	***25***	***26***	***51***	***42***	***332***
QUADRI LINGUAL BOOKS.											
Arabic, Bengali, English and Persian	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, English, Persian and Sanskrit	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Bengali, English, Hindi and Sanskrit	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	3
,, ,, Sanskrit and Urdu	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, Hindi, Urdu and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
Chinese, English, Manchu and Turki	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Total of Quadrilingual Books.	***2***	...	...	***1***	...	...	***1***	...	***2***	***2***	***6***
POLYLINGUAL BOOKS.											
Arabic, Assamese, Bengali, Burmese, English, Hindi and Latin.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
Arabic, Bengali, English, Hindi, Persian, Sanskrit, Oraon and Oriya.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
Arabic, Bengali, English, Hindi, Persian, Sanskrit and Urdu.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	2
Arabic, Bengali, English, Persian, Sanskrit, Urdu and Oriya.	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	1
Arabic, Bengali, English, Hindi, Persian, Sanskrit, Urdu and Oriya.	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
Arabic, Bengali, Hindi, Persian, Sanskrit and Urdu.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
Arabic, English, French, Latin, Persian, Sanskrit and Urdu.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
Arabic, English, Pali, Persian and Sanskrit.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
Assamese, Bengali, Cachari, Hindi, Kachá-Naga, Khasi, Kuki, Lushai, Manipuri, Mikir, Santali, Urdu and Oriya.	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
Bengali, Burmese, Chinese, English, Hindi, Tamil and Telugu.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
Bengali, Burmese, Chinese, English, Tamil and Telugu.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Bengali, Delhival, English, Hindi, Gujarati, Marathi and Telugu.	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
Bengali, English, Gujarati, Hindi, Marathi and Urdu.	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
Bengali, English, Hindi, Marathi, Persian and Urdu.	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Total of Polylingual Books	...	***1***	...	...	***1***	***1***	***2***			***2***	***15***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE X.—Number of Books published in each Language.

Language.	Number of books published in—										Total.
	1901.	1902.	1903.	1904.	1905.	1906.	1907.	1908.	1909.	1910.	1901-10.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
BIHAR AND ORISSA.											
UNILINGUAL BOOKS.											
Arabic	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	2
Bengali	5	2	3	5	...	3	2	4	24	15	63
English	33	22	17	12	20	21	16	26	27	15	209
Hindi	69	100	128	114	85	85	78	105	80	97	941
Khandh (Khond)	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Khasi	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	1
Maithili	2	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	2	7	13
Mundari	...	...	2	2	...	...	3	1	2	2	12
Nagpuria	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
Oraon	2	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	1	5
Oriya	140	157	173	195	181	245	312	296	320	360	2,379
Paharia	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
Persian	1	...	...	...	...	3	...	2	1	...	7
Sanskrit	25	12	23	23	28	20	29	30	31	39	259
Santali	4	2	2	...	1	3	6	4	7	4	33
Urdu	9	11	6	10	4	9	6	21	22	10	108
Total of Unilingual Books	***290***	***305***	***354***	***361***	***319***	***390***	***456***	***490***	***517***	***553***	***4,035***
BILINGUAL BOOKS.											
Arabic and Persian	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	2	...	...	4
,, ,, Urdu	3	1	...	3	...	4	5	...	11	...	30
Bengali and English	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1
,, ,, Sanskrit	...	...	3	...	1	...	1	...	1	2	8
,, ,, Santali	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
,, ,, Oriya	1	...	1	2	1	6	1	3	5	4	24
English and Hindi	5	1	1	2	...	1	1	2	3	1	17
,, ,, Kol	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, Sanskrit	1	...	...	...	1	3	...	1	...	...	6
English and Santali	...	1	1	1	2	1	...	...	1	...	7
,, ,, Urdu	1	...	...	...	4	...	3	1	...	...	9
,, ,, Oriya	...	2	2	1	...	1	...	1	3	4	14
Hindi and Persian	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
,, ,, Sanskrit	8	9	12	7	11	8	9	8	11	7	90
,, ,, Urdu	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	...	...	2
,, ,, Oriya	...	1	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1	3
Maithili and Sanskrit	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
Musalmani-Bengali and Persian	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
Persian and Urdu	1	...	...	...	1	...	2	2	...	...	6
Sanskrit and Oriya	25	15	26	23	24	59	44	53	58	45	352
Urdu and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1
Total of Bilingual Books	***45***	***30***	***49***	***39***	***45***	***65***	***69***	***75***	***96***	***66***	***579***
TRILINGUAL BOOKS.											
Arabic, English and Urdu	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	1
,, Persian and Urdu	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	2
Bengali, English and Sanskrit	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, ,, Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
,, Hindi and Sanskrit	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
,, ,, ,, Oriya	...	...	1	1	...	3	3	2	2	4	16
,, Sanskrit and Oriya	1	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	3	5	10
,, Urdu and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	2
English, Hindi and Sanskrit	...	1	...	...	...	2	...	3	1	...	7
,, ,, ,, Santali	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, ,, ,, Urdu	1	1	2	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	4
,, Persian and Urdu	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
,, Telugu and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1
Hindi, Maithili and Sanskrit	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	2	3
Total of Trilingual Books	***3***	***3***	***4***	***1***	...	***5***	***5***	***5***	***10***	***15***	***51***
QUADRILINGUAL BOOKS.											
Bengali, English, Hindi and Urdu	1	2	1	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	5
,, Hindi, Sanskrit and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	1	2
,, ,, Urdu and Oriya	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	1
English, Hindi, Persian and Urdu	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	1
Total of Quadrilingual Books.	1	2	1	2	...	...	1	1	...	1	9

CHAPTER IX.

LANGUAGE.

INTRODUCTORY.

714. At this census revised instructions were issued regarding the entry of language in the schedules. In 1901, it was laid down that the language to be entered was that ordinarily spoken by each person, but this led to some curious results, persons returning not their native language but that which they commonly used in intercourse with the outside world. One German missionary working among the Mundas, for instance, returned Mundari as his language, and another, whose converts consisted of Oraons, as Oraon, while some Frenchmen engaged in the silk industry entered English as the language which they ordinarily used. To prevent such anomalies, it was laid down at this census that the language to be returned was that which each person ordinarily spoke *in his own home:* in the case of infants and deaf-mutes * the language of the mother was to be entered. This change in the instructions has led to greater accuracy in the returns. It was realized that the native language was to be returned, and not that which an immigrant might use in his new environment. The increase, for example, in the number of Marwari speakers from 11,000 to 37,000 is only partly explicable by increased immigration, and is mainly due to the revised instructions. The same cause has led to considerable variations in the case of languages for which another character is used, such as Bengali in Purnea, which is commonly written in the Kaithi character: in this district the number of Bengali speakers has increased eight-fold. Similarly, in the Orissa Division, where the Musalmans speak Urdu but use the Oriya character for it, the number returned as speaking Hindi and Urdu has risen by nearly 60 per cent.

715. Statistics of the languages returned will be found in Imperial Table X, where they are arranged under three main headings, viz., languages of India, Asiatic and African languages foreign to India, and European languages. In Bengal the languages of India are grouped in four classes, viz., Aryan, Tibeto-Burman, Munda and Dravidian, a few entries being also placed under the heads Siamese-Chinese and Mon-Khmer. In Bihar and Orissa there are four groups, viz., Aryan, Munda, Dravidian and others. In this chapter the discussion of the figures will follow a scheme of classification drawn up by Sir G. Grierson, and prescribed by the Census Commissioner. At the end of the chapter three subsidiary tables are given as follows :—

Subsidiary Table I—Shows the distribution of the total population by language.

Subsidiary Table II—Shows for each district the number of persons speaking different languages per mille of the population.

Subsidiary Table III—Gives comparative figures for tribal languages, showing how many persons belong to the tribe and how many of them speak the tribal language.

THE NATURE OF THE RETURNS.

716. It was realized that it would be hopeless to expect the people themselves to return their languages with any philological exactitude. The linguistic and dialectic distinctions made by the linguistic survey are not recognized, and its terminology is more or less foreign to the people. A person speaking Bihari, for instance, does not call his language Bihari, but Hindi, and he does not recognize such names as Magahi, Bhojpuri and Maithili as designations for different dialects of that language. In these circumstances, it was not attempted to obtain a record of them. All that it was possible to do was to lay down that the name by which a language was commonly known should be entered in the schedules. Some people were not contented with this simple rule. The Tiyars in the Patna State, for instance, returned Bengali as their mother-tongue, though their language is indubitably Oriya and is known as such.

* In one case the language of a deaf-mute was returned as *Atpat*, an onomatopœic word describing the sounds he emitted.

URDU.

717. The Musalmans were strongly averse to their language being entered as Hindi, and were anxious to have it returned as Urdu. The Hindus were opposed to the entry of Urdu, and complaints were received that, in some cases, Hindu supervisors or enumerators changed or tried to change entries of of Urdu into Hindi. The question of the entry was, in fact, regarded as a question of religion. It was assumed that Hindus must speak Hindi and Musalmans Urdu, though the great majority speak neither one nor the other, but Bihari. The attitude of both shows strange ignorance of history, for Urdu largely owes its existence to the Hindus employed in the Mughal administration. "Urdu arose when the Hindus took to Persian education; if they had not been an apt medium for receiving and spreading the new dialect, Urdu would as little have formed itself during the reign of Shajahan as under the rule of the Pathans."* However this may be, the result of the agitation on the subject is that the number of persons recorded as speaking Urdu has jumped up from 89,677 to 542,059. Even in Bengal no less than 154,438 persons returned their language as Urdu, over two-fifths of the number being inhabitants of Midnapore.

ARABIC AND PERSIAN.

718. There was also a tendency to return Persian and Arabic as the language ordinarily spoken, though the number of persons born in Arabia or Persia, or who are the descendants of Persians and Arabians, is very small. In many cases it was found that Persian was used as an honorific designation for the language spoken by Musalmans, or as a name for some form of an Aryan language spoken by aboriginals, *e.g.*, it was returned as the language of some Santals and Koras who had left their homes and spoke a corrupt form of Bihari. Arabic was also put down as the language of Musalmans who knew the Koran, or of Biharis who were present in Bengal at the time of the census. Some Binds of Shahabad, who were enumerated in Khulna, were thus credited with a knowledge of Arabic, though one might as well expect Doms to speak Sanskrit. Arabic was also entered in Orissa for Tamil, this being a corruption of Arava, a name given to Tamil by speakers of Telugu. Inquiry was made in as many cases as possible regarding the actual language entered as Arabic and Persian, with especial success in Bihar and Orissa, where the real number was found to be only 55.

KOL AND KORA.

719. The greatest difficulty was caused by the language of various aboriginal races, such as Hos, Karmalis, Mundas, Oraons and Santals, being entered simply as Kol, Kolhe or Kolho. Kol, in one form or another, is used indiscriminately in many parts for Oraon, Mundari, Santali, Karmali (a dialect of Santali) and other non-Aryan tongues, and the discovery of the real language was no easy task. Such entries were checked as far as possible by reference to the entry of caste and birth-place, but in many cases the caste was also recorded as Kol, and the district of birth gave no clue as to the real race. In such cases local inquiries were made, and specimens of the language actually spoken were obtained. This difficulty was most felt in the 24 Orissa States, where there were over 117,000 entries of Kol or Kolho. The classification of these entries has given somewhat different results from those obtained in 1901, when 92,000 entries of Kol were treated as Ho (in addition to 29,000 actual entries of Ho), whereas all such entries in the five Feudatory States then attached to the Central Provinces were classified as Mundari. A similar difficulty was presented by entries of Kora, which is a generic name for earth-workers of any caste, and also of a separate tribe. The language returned as Kora varied greatly in different parts, being Santali in one place and Mundari in others, but Oraon in the great majority of cases.

THARS.

720. The Thars of Orissa States were a further source of perplexity. In some parts where an aboriginal tribe or caste speak an Aryan language, it does so with certain tribal peculiarities, and the language is not called Bengali, Oriya, Hindi, etc., but is referred to by the name of the tribe or caste concerned, the word Thar (*i.e.*, sign or symbol) being added. Common entires of this kind were Bindhani Thar, the language spoken by the Bindhanis or blacksmiths,

* H. Blochmann, *The Hindu Rajas under the Mughal Government*, Calcutta Review, Vol. LII, pp. 321 and 322.

and Kamari Thar spoken by the Kamars, both of which were found to be Hindi. The Thar does not, however, always denote an Aryan language : it is most commonly used as a suffix for non-Aryan languages, such as Koda Thar, Juang Thar, etc., Santali appeared as Santal Thar, Manjhi Thar, Majhiali Thar or Thar simply, while Bhumij was entered under numerous names, *e.g.*, Bhumij Thar, Bhumijali Thar, Tamaria or Tamria Thar, besides Tamaria Bhumij and Tamriali. Needless to say the most confusing entry was Thar simply, there being no clue to the actual language but the caste or locality.

721. In some cases, again, there is difficulty in classifying a dialect owing to the manner in which it varies in different localities, the admixture of words belonging to different languages and, occasionally, the character in which it is written. For instance, Kurmali is classified by Sir G. Grierson as a corrupt form of Magahi (Bihari), but it is written in the Bengali character and in some parts is said to be unmistakeably Bengali. Panch Pargania or Tamaria is also classified as Magahi, but is reported to vary from place to place according to the admixture of Bengali, Bihari and Oriya : elsewere, too, Tamaria is a name for Bhumij. In parts of Purnea, again, the language is a mixture of Bihari and Bengali, and Bihari fades imperceptibly into Bengali and *vice versa*. The character of the language in such cases will be referred to later in different sections of this chapter.

Lastly, there was the difficulty caused by misreadings or mis-spellings in the course of compilation. Much might be written on this subject, but such mistakes and their unravelling are merely curiosities of the census. To quote two small instances only, entries of two unknown languages were reported from one office, viz., Tipti and Boras. Reference to the entries of birth-place and caste at once solved the difficulty. The former was intended for Tibetan, the latter was a misreading of Oraon.

POLYGLOT DISTRICTS AND TOWNS.

722. Before proceeding to discuss the returns for different languages reference may be made to the polyglot population found in border districts. The frontier district of Darjeeling has the greatest diversity of tongues. As shown in the margin, there are no less than 13 languages, or groups of languages, each of which is spoken by over 1 per cent. of the population. Though Bengali comes second in the list, it is current as a vernacular only in a limited area, viz., the Tarai (Siliguri subdivision) ; in the rest of the district only 1,299 persons speak Bengali. In the border districts of Bihar and Orissa there are extraordinary local variations, which can best be realized by reference to the marginal statement. It may also be mentioned that, besides the languages entered in this statement for the Sonthal Parganas, Malto, a Dravidian language spoken by the Sauria Paharias (Maler), is the vernacular of 8½ per cent. of the population in the Rajmahal subdivision, of 5 per cent. in Godda, and of 6 per cent. in Pakaur.

LANGUAGE.	Percentage to total population.	LANGUAGE.	Percentage to total population.
Nepali (Khaskura) ...	21	Other Nepalese languages.	5
Bengali	17	Lepcha	4
Jimdar	14½	Bhotia	4
Murmi	10	Dravidian languages	3
Hindi	6½	Munda languages ...	2½
Limbu	5	English	1½
Mangar	4		

DISTRICT AND SUBDIVISION.	PERCENTAGE TO TOTAL POPULATION OF SPEAKERS OF—		
	Hindi and Urdu.	Bengali.	Santali.
Sonthal Parganas	***45***	***15***	***36***
Dumka	40	14	45
Deoghar	82	4	12
Rajmahal	39	13	36
Godda	57	3	33
Pakaur	11	30	51
Jamtara	26	34	39
Manbhum	***21***	***64***	***14***
Sadar	13	73	13
Dhanbaid	46	36	17
Purnea	***60***	***38***	...
Sadar	80	17	...
Kishanganj	3	97	...
Araria	99	1	...

DISTRICT.	PERCENTAGE TO TOTAL POPULATION OF SPEAKERS OF—		
	Bengali.	Ho.	Oriya.
Singhbhum ...	***16***	***37***	***18***
Dhalbhum	40	1	11
Remainder of district ...	1	58	22

In Singhbhum there are three main languages, viz., Bengali, Oriya and Ho. Ho is pre-eminently the language of the Kolhan, while Bengali is scarcely spoken outside Dhalbhum. Oriya, on the other hand, is mainly spoken in Porahat and Dhalbhum.

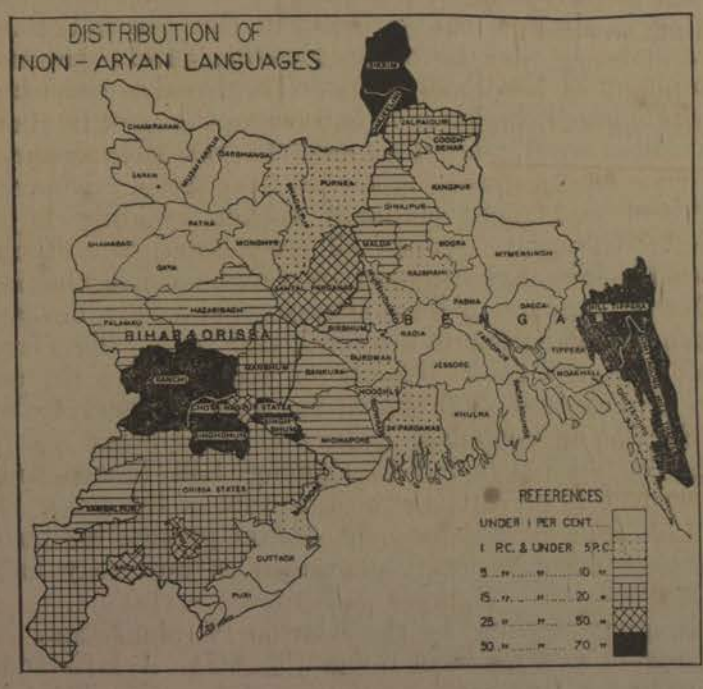
The industrial towns of Bengal, with their heterogeneous population of Bengalis and emigrants

from other parts of India, also have an astonishing variety of languages. No less than 50 different languages were returned in Calcutta, where 49 per cent. of the population speak Bengali, while Hindi or Urdu is the tongue of 41 per cent., Oriya of 4 per cent., English of 3 per cent. and Marwari of 1 per cent. Speakers of Hindi account for nearly half the population of Garden Reach, while in Howrah they outnumber those who speak Bengali by 4 per cent. In the mill towns of Bhatpara and Titagarh the predominance of Hindi is more marked; in the former there are four Hindi speakers to every Bengali, while in the latter Hindi is the language of three-fourths of the inhabitants. The population of Titagarh is particularly heterogeneous, for, in addition to Hindi, Bengali is spoken by 11 per cent., Telugu by 8½ per cent. and Oriya by 4 per cent.

GENERAL DISTRIBUTION OF LANGUAGES.

723. Statistics of the distribution of the main languages will be found in Subsidiary Table I in which they are classified according to Sir G. A. Grierson's scheme. The Indian languages belong to one or other of the four linguistic families shown in the margin. The Indo-European languages correspond with those described as Aryan languages in the last report, and consist mainly of Bengali, Bihari, Oriya and Naipali. The Austro-Asiatic family is represented by the Munda languages, while the Dravidian languages include Oraon, Malto, Kandh (Khond), Tamil and Telugu. The Tibeto-Chinese family comprises the Tibeto-Burman languages, which are subdivided into Tibeto-Himalayan languages (*e.g.*, Tibetan, Lepcha and Nepalese tribal languages) and Assam-Burmese languages, such as Bodo, Mech, Garo, Tipura and Burmese. The local limits of these four families are well defined. The languages of the Indo-European family are spoken throughout the plains, the Austro-Asiatic and Dravidian languages mainly in the Chota Nagpur Plateau and outlying districts. The area of the Tibeto-Chinese family consists of Sikkim and the north and south-east of Bengal, Tibeto-Himalyan languages being spoken in the former, and Assam-Burmese in the latter.

FAMILY.	BENGAL.		BIHAR AND ORISSA.	
	Number of speakers.	Ratio per mille.	Number of speakers.	Ratio per mille.
Indo-European ...	44,904,000	970	35,081,000	913
Austro-Asiatic ...	771,000	17	2,560,000	67
Dravidian ...	133,000	3	785,000	20
Tibeto-Chinese ...	446,000	10	125	...



724. All the languages classified under this head belong to the Sanskritic sub-branch of the Indian branch of the Aryan sub-family. The majority of the people speak languages of the Eastern group, which is represented by Bengali, Bihari, Oriya and Assamese. The first three have their home in the two provinces after which they are called, but Assamese is the language of immigrants, being returned only by 1,258 persons.

INDO-EUROPEAN FAMILY—EASTERN GROUP

725. Bengali is spoken by altogether 44,861,000 persons, of whom 42,566,000 are residents of Bengal. In the latter province it is the language of 92 per cent. of the population, and the number of its speakers has risen by 7 per cent. during the

BENGALI.

last ten years, which is 1 per cent. less than the rate of growth among the general population. In Bihar and Orissa it is spoken by 2,295,000 or 6 per cent. of the total population, the border districts of Purnea, the Sonthal Parganas, Manbhum and Singhbhum accounting for over nine-tenths of the total number. Since 1901 the aggregate in this province has risen by 736,000, but there would have been an increase of only 78,000 or 5 per cent. had it not been for the variations in Purnea, as shown in the margin. In a great part of that district it is difficult to say whether the language is Bengali or Bihari, for Bihar fades imperceptably into Bengali and *vice versâ*. In the main, however, it is Bengali with an admixture of Hindi, but it is written in Kaithi, the Bihari character, and not in Bengali. The paucity of the number returned as Bengali speakers in 1901 is due to the fact that the enumerators recorded this mixed dialect as Bengali on the strength of the written character, without regard to its philological nature. At this census, however, the character in use was not taken into consideration, but only the spoken language. It must not be imagined, therefore, that in Purnea Bihari is being replaced by Bengali. Sir G. A. Grierson estimated the number of Bengali speakers at 603,000, or nearly one-third of the population in 1901, and if that ratio is adopted, the Bengali-speaking population would be 663,000.

YEAR.	Hindi.	Bengali.
1901	1,773,455	91,877
1911	1,202,568	749,018
Variations ...	−570,887	+ 657,141

726. No attempt was made to collect statistics of dialects of Bengali, except Mal Paharia, and only three others appear in the retuns, viz., Chakma, Kharia Thar and Pahira Thar.

DIALECTS OF BENGALI.

Mal Paharia is, as the name implies, the vernacular of the Mal Paharias, nearly all of whom are found in the Sonthal Parganas. In that district no less than 34,414 persons, or nine-tenths of the total number of Mal Paharias, were returned as speaking this dialect. It is not a separate language, but merely a corrupt form of Bengali with here and there a Dravidian word, and it is said to resemble Kharia Thar. The Mal Paharias come of the same stock as the Maler or Sauria Paharias, but are a Hinduized and more civilized section residing in a different part of the district. They have cut off all connection with their congeners and have adopted the language of their more civilized neighbours. One group only retain the Malto language of their ancestors, and have not yet learnt the dialect used by the Mal Paharias of the south and west. They are found in Tappa Kunwarpal, a rugged tract difficult of access which lies on the boundary between the Sauria and Mal Paharias, and are said to be undistinguishable from the Saurias in language, habits and appearance.

MAL PAHARIA.

Chakma is a debased dialect spoken in the Chittagong Hill Tracts, and written in an alphabet akin to that of Burmese. In 1901 it was returned by 44,000 persons or one-third of the inhabitants of that district, but the number is now only half that figure.

CHAKMA.

Kharia Thar, or the language spoken by the Kharias of Manbhum, is treated as a patois of Bengali by Sir G. A. Grierson, whose classification has been followed. Though over four-sevenths of them are returned as Animists, they are said to have lost their distinctive language, unlike members of the tribe in adjoining areas. Pahira Thar is the vernacular of the Pahiras or Paharias, a small community found in the same locality as the Kharias, viz., along the Dalma range of hills in Manbhum. Little is known about them or their language. They are said to be cognate to the Kharias, and Sir G. A. Grierson states that their dialect is the same, being called Kharia Thar or Pahira (Paharia) Thar according to the speakers.

KHARIA THAR AND PAHIRA THAR.

727. Hindi and Urdu are spoken by altogether 26,850,000 persons, viz., 24,932,000 or two-thirds of the total population, in Bihar and Orissa, and 1,917,000 or 4 per cent. in Bengal. Since 1901 the number has decreased by 360,000 in the former province, but this does not represent a real loss. The change in the instructions about the entry of language has, as already shown, brought

HINDI AND URDU.

about a decrease of nearly 571,000 in Purnea. It has also been effectual in reducing the number of aboriginals returned as speaking Hindi instead of their tribal language. Not to multiply instances, the number of Santali speakers in the Sonthal Parganas has risen by 28,000, though the Santals themselves are reduced in numbers. In Bengal, the Hindi-speaking population has grown by 430,000 or 29 per cent., the result mainly of immigration from Bihar and Orissa : the males speaking Hindi outnumber the females by 2 to 1. Calcutta and the metropolitan districts of Howrah and the 24-Parganas, where the mill hands are recruited chiefly from up-country, contribute one-third of the increase. Between them they contain 731,000 speakers of Hindi or Urdu, or over one-third of the total number in Bengal. A large increase is also registered in North Bengal, where the speakers of Hindi are more numerous by 182,000 or 42 per cent., than they were 10 years ago. This division now contains nearly 600,000 persons with whom Hindi or Urdu is the mother-tongue.

Urdu, as stated above, represents, for the greater part, merely the language spoken by Musalmans. It is impossible to say what the real number of speakers of Urdu is, but it is certain that the majority of those who returned Urdu as their mother-tongue speak either Hindi in a more or less debased form, or pure and unadulterated Bihari. True Urdu is spoken by the higher classes of Musalmans and by immigrants from up-country. In Orissa also the local Musalmans, though far remote from their Urdu-speaking co-religionists, and surrounded by speakers of Oriya, have preserved a fairly pure, though not very grammatical. Urdu as the language of their home life. They are, however, unable to write it in its proper character, but use the Oriya script. The revised instructions have brought about a great increase in the returns for Urdu in the sea-board districts of this sub-province ; in Cuttack alone the number has risen from 1,459 to 52.600.

BIHARI.

728. Neither Urdu nor Hindi (without further specification) are recognized as languages in the prescribed scheme of classification, in which they are classified as Bihari, Eastern Hindi and Western Hindi. By far the most widely spoken of these languages is Bihari, the language of Bihar. It is not, however, confined to that sub-province, but also extends into Chota Nagpur and even into the Orissa States. It has three dialects, viz., Bhojpuri, Magahi and Maithili. Bhojpuri is so-called after the *argana* of Bhojpur in Shahabad and is *par excellence* the vernacular of Shahabad and the adjoining district of Saran. It extends on the west into the United Provinces and on the south into Ranchi, where Sir G. A. Grierson identifies it with the language called Nagpuria. In local estimation, however, Nagpuria should be classed as a separate dialect. It has, it is said, affinities to both Magahi and Bhojpuri, but the resemblance to the former is very much more marked. On the north, Bhojpuri is found in Champaran where there is a sub-dialect called Madhesi—literally the language of the middle land : the aboriginal Tharus also speak Bhojpuri, though some suppose that they have a distinct vernacular. Magahi or Magadhi derives its name from the ancient kingdom of Magadha, the nucleus of which consisted of the district of Patna and the north of Gaya. It is pre-eminently the vernacular of South Bihar, where it is current in the districts of Patna, Gaya and Monghyr. It spreads on the east into Malda, on the south and south-west into Hazaribagh and Palamau, and on the south-east into Manbhum, Singhbhum and the Chota Nagpur States. Maithili, the third of the dialects, is the language of the ancient kingdom of Mithila, the limits of which correspond to the modern Tirhut. It is now the vernacular of North Bihar, excluding the district of Champaran and Saran. South of the Ganges it is infected by Magahi, the result being a dialect called Chikka-Chikki, owing to the frequent use of the word *Chhik* in the conjugation of the verb substantive.

In the Linguistic Survey of India the number of speakers of Bihari in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa is estimated at 23,143,888, viz., Bhojpuri 6,991,972, Magahi 6,565,758 and Maithili 9,586,158.* An estimate based on the results of the present census is somewhat above this figure, the

* Linguistic Survey of India, Vol. V, Part II, pp. 14, 15, 32, 33, 44, 45, 187, 224, 278, 300, 311-14.

total for Bihari being estimated at 24,694,493, viz., Bhojpuri 7,095,023. Magahi 6,862,676 and Maithili 10,736, 794.*

BATHUDI.

729. Bathudi or Bathuri was returned as the language of 137 persons in the Orissa Feudatory States and Balasore. Specimens of the language were obtained, and it was found to be a patois of Hindi written in Oriya. The total number of Bathudis is 54,817, nearly all of whom were enumerated in the Orissa Feudatory States, mainly in Keonjhar and Mayurbhanj. There is unfortunately very little information regarding them or their origin. They are generally regarded as being of aboriginal descent, but according to a recent writer they were originally Buddhists with a rank equal to that of Brahmans, who sank to a low status on the destruction of Buddhism. Like Brahmans, they wear the sacred thread and observe *sraddha* on the eleventh day, but many of their observances are like those of aboriginals. In Mayurbhanj old buildings showing a high standard of civilization are attributed to them, and there are traditions of their having been a dominant race. Traces of Buddhistic worship are still found among them, Dharmaraj and Jagannath (who is regarded as an incarnation of Buddha) being two of their principal deities: it is noticeable also that formerly only Bathudis were allowed to officiate as priests in the worship of Dharma.† They say that their name was originally Batula or Bathula, but in Keonjhar they are known as Bahuri or Bauri, and it seems not impossible that they have had some connection with the Bauris of Orissa, who appear to be distinct from the Bauris of West Bengal.

KURMALI.

730. Kurmali is a corrupt form of Magahi, which, as the name implies, is the tongue of the aboriginal Kurmis of Chota Nagpur (not the Bihari cultivating caste of the same name). It was returned as the language of 211,411 persons in Manbhum, where the Kurmis number 291,729. It is not confined to them, however, but is spoken by many other castes. This patois is also known as Khotta or Khotta Bengali, and is written in the Bengali character. Locally it is regarded as a corrupt form of Bengali. It is reported that even in Ranchi, though Bihari words are used, the terminations are often Bengali. In Mayurbhanj it is usually called Kurmi Bengali or Kurmali Bengali, as well as simply Kurmi. With regard to its character, the late Maharaja of Mayurbhanj wrote as follows:—"The mother-tongue of the Kurmis of Mayurbhanj is Bengali, with the peculiar intonation belonging to them. These Kurmis have, as a rule, come from Midnapore and settled permanently in Mayurbhanj. Their dialect shows traces of Hindi and Oriya as well, but it cannot be called either." A corrupt form of Magahi is also spoken in thanas Gola and Kashmar, and in part of thana Ramgarh in the south-east of Hazaribagh. This patois, which is called Het Gola, contains Bengali words and phrases and locally is considered to be Bengali.

KURUMALI.

731. There were 3,038 entries of Kurumali in the schedules of the Orissa States, which have been classified as Hindi on the authority of the Linguistic Survey. "Kurumali",

* The basis of the calculation, which is the same as that adopted by Mr. Gait in 1901, is as follows:—

Magahi includes persons enumerated in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa who were born in (1) Patna and Gaya, (2) $\frac{1}{2}$ Hazaribagh, (3) $\frac{1}{2}$ Monghyr, (4) $\frac{2}{3}$ Malda and (5) $\frac{1}{15}$ Ranchi and Palamau; also $\frac{1}{5}$ of the persons speaking Hindi and Urdu in the Sonthal Parganas, 9,444 persons in the Chota Nagpur States and 7,320 in the Orissa Feudatory States.

Maithili includes persons enumerated in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa who were born in (1) Darbhanga and Bhagalpur, (2) $\frac{2}{3}$ Muzaffarpur (3) $\frac{1}{2}$ Monghyr and (4) $\frac{2}{3}$ Purnea; and also $\frac{1}{5}$ of the Hindu and Urdu speakers enumerated in the Sonthal Parganas.

Bhojpuri includes persons enumerated in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa who were born in (1) Champaran, Saran and Shahabad and (2) $\frac{1}{2}$ Palamau and Ranchi. It also includes 103,966 immigrants from the United Provinces to Bihar and Orissa comprising immigrants from the districts of the United Provinces where Bhojpuri is spoken, viz., the whole of the Gorakhpur Division, Benares, Ghazipur, Ballia, $\frac{2}{3}$ Mirzapur, $\frac{1}{2}$ Jaunpur and $\frac{2}{3}$ Fyzabad.

According to another method of calculation, the number of Bihari speakers may be estimated at 25,131,627. The basis of this latter estimate is as follows:—In Bihar and Orissa, excluding the districts of Cuttack, Puri and Balasore, the number of Bihari speakers is taken to be the number of those returned as speaking Hindi or Urdu, after deducting (1) those who speak Eastern Hindi (116,574 in Sambalpur and the Orissa States and 508,898 elsewhere), and (2) of immigrants from the Central Provinces and United Provinces, except those from Gorakhpur, Ballia, Benares, the Benares State, Ghazipur and Mirzapur who speak Bihari. In Malda those who returned Hindi and Urdu as their language are assumed to be Bihari speakers. Elsewhere the estimate of Sir G. A. Grierson has been adopted, adding an extra 10 per cent. for increased emigration.

† Nagendra Nath Basu, *Modern Buddhism in Orissa* (1911), pp. 15—36, 145.

writes Sir G. A. Grierson, "on examination, turns out to be another instance of Eastern Magahi. Here the corrupting element is more Oriya than Bengali, and, moreover, the specimens received being written in the Oriya character, they have necessarily acquired a further resemblance in orthography to that language, which probably does not properly belong to them. Instances of borrowing from Oriya abound, but even some of these are curious distortions. On the whole the dialect agrees very closely with the Kurmali Thar of Manbhum."*

PANCH PARGANIA OR TAMARIA.

732. Panch Pargania or Tamaria is a dialect spoken mainly in the five *parganas* of Tamar (whence the name Tamaria), Silli, Baranda, Rane and Bundu. According to the Linguistic Survey of India—"It closely resembles the Kurmali Thar of Manbhum. The principal apparent difference is the result of the characters employed in writing. In Manbhum the character adopted is the Bengali, and the language is looked at, so to speak, through Bengali spectacles. Hence words are spelled as a Bengali would spell them. In the five Parganas, on the other hand, the Kaithi alphabet is used, and the language is looked at through Hindi spectacles." According to the Deputy Commissioner of Ranchi (Mr. W. B. Thomson), "Panch Pargania or Tamaria is really a composite language formed of Bengali, Oriya and Bihari words and terminations. As spoken by some castes, it has a distinct resemblance to Oriya, and as spoken by others to Bengali, while as spoken by Kurmis and a few other castes who originally came from Bihar, it resembles Bihari. There is no valid reason why it should be classed as a dialect of Bihari rather than of Bengali or Oriya." Tamaria is also the name of a form of Bhumij spoken by the Tamarias, a section of the Bhumij tribe who were originally settled in the Tamar *pargana* of Ranchi. Those who returned Tamaria as their languages outside Ranchi have been treated, as in 1901, as speaking this Bhumij dialect, but it is quite possible that this classification is wrong, and that some of them really speak Tamaria Magahi and others Tamaria Bhumij.

ORIYA.

733. Oriya is returned for 7,820,000 persons in Bihar and Orissa, where it is the language of one-fifth of the population. The number returned as speaking Oriya in this province has risen by nearly two millions or 35 per cent. since 1901, but this is mainly due to the transfer of Sambalpur and five Oriya-speaking States from the Central Provinces. Owing to this transfer and to the addition of Gangpur and Bonai, the number of persons speaking Oriya has been nearly doubled in the Orissa States. Outside Orissa the language is practically only spoken in Singhbhum and the Chota Nagpur States. In Bengal there are 294,000 speakers of Oriya, of whom two-thirds are resident in Midnapore. Practically all the remainder are immigrants, there being only one female to every eight males. Midnapore is the only district in the Presidency where Oriya is a native language, and here it is almost confined to the south of the district bordering on Balasore. It is a curious mixture of Bengali and Oriya, but according to Sir G. A. Grierson it is Oriya in its essence. "It has put on strange clothes like Peter in the 'Tale of a Tub,' but the heart that beats under the strangely embroidered waistcoat is the same." Babu Monmohan Chakravarti informs me that it differs from the main Oriya language not only phonetically but also in grammar, and should be regarded as a distinct dialect of Oriya. The returns for the last three censuses show that this form of Oriya is being first replaced by Bengali, the number of Oriya speakers in Midnapore being 572,798 in 1891, but falling to 270,495 in 1901, and again to 181,801 in 1911. The greater part of the decrease has occurred in the south and south-east of the district, viz., in the three thanas of Dantan, Gopiballabhpur and Egra, where the aggregate has fallen from 255,800 to 171,031 since 1901. The speakers of Oriya now represent only one-third of the total population of these three thanas, whereas in 1901 they accounted for two-thirds of it. In Egra, Oriya has practically disappeared, the number being reduced from 57,292 to 160. On the other hand, there has been an increase of 40,000 in Ramnagar,

* Linguistic Survey of India, Volume V, Part II, pp. 166, 172,.

where the Oriya speakers now form two-thirds of the inhabitants instead of one-seventh as in 1901. These variations are due to the character of the language which is partly Bengali and partly Oriya, and to the instructions that the language ordinarily spoken in the home was to be entered. In the first three thanas the tendency of the people is obviously to regard their language as Bengali, and in the latter to look upon it as Oriya.

MEDIATE GROUP—EASTERN HINDI.

734. The Mediate group is represented by Eastern Hindi, which is the language of Oudh, Baghelkhand and Chhattisgarh. In the provinces dealt with in this report two dialects of Eastern Hindi are current in two widely separated areas. One dialect is known as Awadhi, literally the language of Oudh, which is spoken by Musalmans in five districts of Bihar. In Muzaffarpur this dialect is spoken by low caste Musalmans, the majority of whom belong to the Jolaha or weaver caste. It is hence known locally as Jolaha Boli. In Saran, Awadhi is not spoken by the lowest class of Musalmans, who use the local Bhojpuri, but by those of the middle class, and is known locally as Bihari Hindi. In Champaran, Awadhi is spoken by middle class Musalmans, and by people of the Tikulihar caste: the Awadhi spoken by the latter is locally known as Tikulihari, and that spoken by the middle class Musalmans is called Shekhai. On the south the dialect is current among the Musalmans of the districts of Gaya and Shahabad. "This Musalman dialect is an interesting survival of the influence of the former Muhammadan Court of Lucknow. It is frequently heard by Europeans in Bihar, as it is used as a kind of language of politeness by uneducated non-Musalmans of the same country, much as Urdu is used by their betters."* The total number of persons in the five districts above-mentioned with whom it is the common vernacular is estimated by Sir G. A. Grierson at 504,454. The number of persons speaking Awadhi outside this area is estimated by him at 111,358, viz., 3,214 in Bhagalpur, 1,230 in Orissa and 106,814 in Bengal.

LARIA OR CHHATTISGARHI.

735. Laria or Chhattisgarhi is a dialect of Eastern Hindi spoken in Sambalpur and the five States transferred from the Central Provinces, viz., Patna, Sonpur, Bamra, Rairakhol and Kalahandi. It is usually called Laria in this area, Laria meaning simply "eastern." It is thus equivalent to "the language of the east," just as Awadhi is sometimes called Purbi. Sir G. A. Grierson is of opinion that this dialect found its way through Jubbulpore and Mandla, being introduced in comparatively late times by the Aryans who first settled there. Thenceforward, owing to its geographical isolation, the dialect developed its own peculiarities. He estimates the number of Laria speakers in Sambalpur and the five neighbouring States at 176,643, and in the remaining Orissa States at 1,311. The number of persons returned as speaking Hindi or Urdu in the former group is 115,263 (70,650 in Sambalpur and 44,613 in the five States), and inquiry shows that their language is really Laria. Sir G. A. Grierson classes Binjhwari, Kalanga and Bhulia as broken dialects of Laria; but no distinction between them and Laria is recognized locally. They are regarded merely as the ordinary Laria spoken by members of the castes after whom they are named.

WESTERN GROUP.

736. The languages grouped under this head, and spoken in the two provinces dealt with in this report, are Western Hindi. Rajasthani, Gujarati, Panjabi and Banjari (one of the Bhil dialects), which are chiefly spoken by immigrants.

WESTERN HINDI.

Western Hindi is the designation of the modern Indo-Aryan vernacular of the Gangetic Doab and the country to its north. The principal dialect is Hindustani, whose home is the Upper Gangetic Doab in the country round Meerut, but which is commonly employed as a *lingua franca* throughout the north of India. The Persianized form of Hindustani is known as Urdu, and there is also a Hindi form of Hindustani which was invented by the teachers of the college at Fort William and owed its origin to the need of text-books for the college. "It was intended to be a Hindustani for the use of Hindus, and was derived from the indigenous Sanskrit. Owing to the popularity of the first book

* Linguistic Survey of India, Vol. VI, p. 9.

written in it, and to its supplying the need for a *lingua franca* which could be used by the strictest Hindus without their religious prejudices being offended, it became widely adopted and is now the recognized vehicle for writing prose by those inhabitants of Upper India who do not employ Urdu."

Urdu, as already stated, has been returned as a generic term for the language of Musalmans in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, and includes not only Urdu spoken by indigenous Musalmans and the Urdu immigrants from the north of India, but also Hindi and Bihari.

RAJASTHANI (MARWARI).

737. Rajasthani is a term applied to the language of Rajputana, and its most important dialect is Marwari. The latter is returned as the mother-tongue of 37,478 persons (19,145 in Bengal and 18,333* in Bihar and Orissa), all, needless to say, Marwari immigrants or their descendants. In Calcutta alone, where there is a wealthy and influential community of Marwari merchants, it is returned for 8,968 persons. There is a large increase over the figures of 1901 (10,625), which is partly due to greater immigration, for the number of persons born in Rajputana and enumerated in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa has risen from 40,572 to 51,747. The greater part of the increase however is to be attributed to the greater accuracy of enumeration resulting from the revised instructions about the entry of languages.

GUJARATI AND PANJABI.

738. Gujarati is shown as the speech of 7,382 or 3,014 more than in 1901. All of these are immigrants, except 282 persons in Midnapore called Siyalgirs, who speak a currupt form of Gujarati called Siyalgiri. They are a small community with criminal propensities, which are probably an hereditary legacy. They seem to have migrated to their present home about 150 years ago, and were probably camp-followers of the Marathas. Their vernacular, which is derived from a dialect closely related to Gujarati Bhili, shows that they came from Western India, probably from the border districts between Central India, Rajputana and Bombay, which are the habitat of Bhil tribes.

Panjabi appears in the returns as the language of 6,595 persons. These are immigrants from the Punjab, who come to Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, leaving their wives at home: there are approximately ten males among them to every female. Half of the total number were enumerated in Calcutta and the 24-Parganas.

BHIL LANGUAGES—BANJARI.

739. Banjari, or as it is sometimes called Labhani, is one of the Bhil dialects, which is spoken by the Banjaras, a well-known tribe of grain and salt carriers in Central India. At this census 6,804 Banjaras were enumerated in Sambalpur and the Orissa Feudatory States, but the number who returned Banjari as their language was only 5,747. They are not found outside this area, but apparently they formerly penetrated to Bihar, for there is a reference to them in the *Riyazu-s-Salatin*, in which it is stated that Ali Vardi Khan sent an expedition under a Rohilla Afghan named Abdul Karim Khan (who is described as the chief of the Afghans of Darbhanga) "against the Banjara tribe, who were a class of marauders and murderers, and who in the guise of traders and travellers used to plunder the imperial domains and treasures. Abdul Karim Khan, subduing the Banjara tribe, gained a large booty."

EASTERN PAHARI, NAIPALI OR KHASKURA.

740. Eastern Pahari is the name given in the Linguistic Survey to Naipali, or as it is sometimes called Khaskura, though this latter designation is not usually employed by the Nepalese themselves in this part of India. It is the *lingua franca* of the Nepalese, being the language of the Hindu castes and also a vernacular spoken by those tribes who have a tribal language of their own. They speak the latter among themselves, but Naipali in their intercourse with others. At this census it was returned

LOCALITY.	1911.	1901.	Increase per cent.
Darjeeling	56,768	45,320	25
Jalpaiguri	32,356	11,403	184
Sikkim	28,078	15,836	77

*Including 26 persons in Monghyr, whose language was entered as Jaipuri.

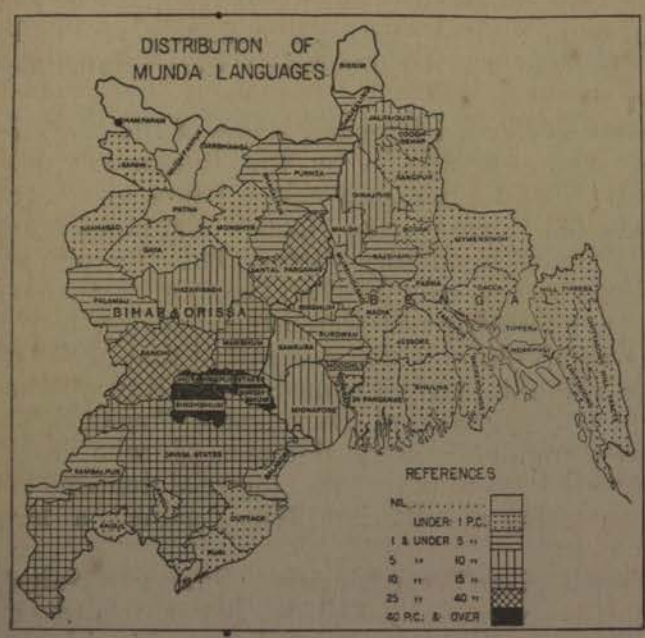
by 121,587 persons, viz., 90,844 in Bengal, 28,078 in Sikkim and 2,625 in Bihar and Orissa. The remarkable increase which, as shown in the margin, has taken place since 1901 in Jalpaiguri is due mainly to the fresh influx of immigrants from Nepal: the number of those born in Nepal and enumerated in the district has risen from 19,000 to 34,000. In Darjeeling some of the increase may perhaps be due to tribal languages being abandoned, but the greater part must be attributed to the change in the instructions about language, which made it clear to the enumerators that the mother-tongue was to be entered in the schedules. In Sikkim the growth must be ascribed largely to the present census having been more complete than its predecessors, as a result of which an addition of 49 per cent. in the general population of the State is now recorded: the proportion of Naipali speakers to the total population, viz., one-third, is the same as it was ten years ago. Two-thirds of the persons in Bihar and Orissa whose language was returned as Naipali are inhabitants of the frontier districts of Bhagalpur and Champaran. In Bhagalpur the number has risen from 523 to 1,395; the latter figure agrees very closely with that returned in 1891, viz., 1,171. In Champaran, on the other hand, the number has fallen from 7,231 to 515. The decrease is extraordinary, but I can offer no explanation for it.

741. The languages of the North-Western group are represented only by Sindhi and Kachchhi, which were returned for a small number of immigrants, viz., 113 speakers of Sindhi and 443 of Kachchhi. Marathi, which belongs to the Southern group, is more strongly represented, being returned by 3,756 persons.

North-Western and Southern Groups—Sindhi, Kachchhi and Marathi.

742. The Austro-Asiatic family is divided into two sub-families called Mon-Khmer and Munda. The former is represented by only 70 speakers of Khasi, whereas the latter has 3½ million speakers. The great majority speak the language designated Kherwari by Sir G. A. Grierson, to whom we owe the discovery that Santali, Mundari, Bhumij, Birhar, Koda, Ho, Turi, Asuri, Agaria and Korwa are not separate languages, but closely connected dialects of one and the same language. These dialects are spoken mainly in the Chota Nagpur Plateau and in a few outlying districts, as well as by emigrants to the tea gardens in Jalpaiguri and Darjeeling or to the Barind in Dinajpur and Malda. The other languages of this sub-family are Kharia and Juang, which are also current in the same area. In the Chota Nagpur Plateau the Munda languages are spoken by one-fifth of the total population, the highest proportion being reached in Singhbhum (60 per cent.), the home of the Hos. Then come the Sonthal Parganas (37 per cent.), which is one of the main centres of the Santals, and Ranchi (30 per cent.), where Mundas and Kharias are in greatest strength. Outside the Chota Nagpur Plateau the Munda languages are most commonly spoken in the adjoining district of Bankura (9 per cent.), where there is a strong Santal community, and in Dinajpur (7 per cent.), where the Santals are settling in the Barind.

Austro-Asiatic Family—Munda languages.



743. Santali is by far the most widely spoken of all these dialects, being the speech of over 2 millions of people. The actual increase since 1901 represents 18 per cent., whereas

Santali.

the Santal community has grown by 13 per cent. Under this head are classified Mahli and Karmali, which are dialects of the main language. Over one-third of the speakers of Santali (as distinct from Karmali and Malhi) are found in the Sonthal Parganas, while Manbhum and the Orissa Feudatory States each account for one-sixth of the total number: outside the Chota Nagpur Plateau over 156,000 are found in Midnapore, 114,000 in Dinajpur and nearly 100,000 in Bankura. There appear to be no signs of the Santals abandoning their language, for Santali has been returned by no less than 96 per cent. of the tribe.

KARMALI AND MAHLI.

The case is different with the speakers of Karmali, for though 21,842 persons returned their caste as Karmali in Bihar and Orissa, only one-third spoke that sub-dialect. The Karmalis are an aboriginal caste of iron-smelters and black-smiths found mainly in the Sonthal Parganas and Hazaribagh. Mahli also appears to be dying out, there being 25,000 speakers of it who represent under one-third of the tribe: 15,000 of these are inhabitants of the Sonthal Parganas.

MUNDARI.

744. Mundari is spoken by a little over half a million or one-fourth of the number that speak Santali. The greater number of persons whose speech is Mundari are found in Ranchi, where the total is 350,000; Singhbhum and the Orissa States account for another 100,000. Among the Mundas, as among the Santals, there appears to be no defection from the tribal language, which is spoken by 94 per cent. of the race. The number of Mundari speakers has increased by no less than 30 per cent. since 1901, owing mainly to the accession of Mundas caused by the transfer of Sambalpur and five Feudatory States from the Central Provinces. A part of the increase is also accounted for by a number of persons being classified as speakers of Mundari who were grouped with the Hos at the previous census.

HO.

745. Ho is far more centralized than Santali, being practically confined to Singhbhum, the two adjoining States of Kharsawan and Saraikela, and the Orissa States. Singhbhum alone contains two-thirds of the total number, while in the Orissa States they are mainly found in Keonjhar and Mayurbhanj, of which the border marches with Singhbhum. The Hos have retained their language to a remarkable degree, the actual number of speakers (420,000) falling short of the number belonging to the tribe by less than 2,000.

BHUMIJ.

746. The Bhumij, on the other hand, have to a very large extent given up their own language, only 35 per cent. of them speaking it. The number returning it as their mother-tongue has risen since 1901 by 19,000 or 20 per cent. in Bihar and Orissa, but has fallen by 3,000 or 13 per cent. in Bengal. The majority of the Bhumij in the latter province are inhabitants of Midnapore, where they have adopted the language of their Bengali neighbours: only one-third of them still speak their own language. In Bihar and Orissa the Bhumij are found in greatest strength in Manbhum, which contains 116,000 of them. Here less than 7,000 or 6 per cent. speak Bhumij, but this is an improvement on 1901, when barely 2 per cent. returned Bhumij as their language. Commenting on this result, Mr. Coupland, formerly Deputy Commissioner of Manbhum, writes:—"The small number of persons speaking Bhumij is perhaps partly accounted for by the fact that the Bhumij of Eastern Barabhum at any rate, and probably of a larger area, profess Bengali as their mother-tongue, though they speak freely with their Santal neighbours in so-called Santali, which a closer examination by an expert would probably show to be a survival of their own original dialect. The aspirations of the upper grades of Bhumij to take position as Rajputs and the general spread of Hindu religious ideas among them, no doubt, account largely for the extent to which they have given up their own language for Bengali.*" In Singhbhum the adoption of Bengali has not proceeded so far, for 35,000 out of 52,000 Bhumij returned their ancestral language as their mother-tongue.

* Manbhum District Gazetteer, pp. 72-73.

747. The most widely spoken of the other Kherwari dialects is Kora (or Koda or Kuda) which is returned as the speech of 24,000 persons. Considerable difficulty was experienced over the entries of Kora, especially in the Orissa States where it is called Kuda or Kura ; for, in addition to being the name of a tribe, it is used as a generic name for earth workers, who call their language as well as their caste Kora. In Sambalpur and some of the adjoining States, such as Rairakhol and Brama, the Kisans, who speak a corrupt form of Oraon, call themselves Kuda or Kura : in their case, therefore, the language returned as Kuda is Oraon. In Pal Lahara and Sonpur the Koda language is also corrupt Oraon : the speakers in the former calling themselves Kisan, or Koda, or Dhangar Koda. In Mayurbhanj however it is Mundari, and in Nilgiri it is reported to be really Santali, the speakers calling themselves Matia or Kuda. Special care was taken to classify the entries of Kuda or Koda in the Orissa States under their proper head both for caste and language ; but it is not certain that there has been the same accuracy in other places, where the Koras are immigrants among a foreign population, and it is consequently not so easy to obtain reliable information about them. The discrepancy between the number of Koras (95,480) and the number speaking the Kora dialect (24,035) is therefore probably not so great as would appear at first sight, as the name Kora is commonly used by various castes of earth-workers who do not belong to the Kora tribe or speak their language.

KORA, KODA OR KUDA.

748. The other Kherwar dialects are numerically insignificant, aggregating only 21,832, as shewn in the margin. Agaria has practically disappeared, for only four per mille of the tribe still speak it. Turi again is spoken by only one-tenth of the Turis, but Asuri and Birjia hold their own : Birjia is a sub-dialect of Asuri. Half the Birhors speak Birhar (or Birhor), while two-fifths of the Korwas are true to the speech of their forefathers. The decrease shown against the latter language is due to the transfer to the Central Provinces of Jashpur and other States in which the wilder Korwas live. Singli, which is shown separately, is said to be a form of Korwa. The revised instructions about the mother-tongue being spoken must be held responsible for the increase among the Turis, the whole of which has occurred in Ranchi and North Bengal, notably in the tea gardens of Jalpaiguri.

OTHER KHERWAR DIALECTS.

	1911.	1901.
Agaria	112	323
Asuri	4,006	3,126
Birhar	1,038	526
Birjia	1,323	1,377
Korwa	8,904	15,882
Singli	1,614	173
Turi	6,449	3,220

749. Juang is the language of the primitive tribe of the same name, so primitive, indeed, that they had no knowledge of the metals until the 19th century, while their women wore only leaves till 1871 when they were first clothed by order of the Government. They number 12,480, nearly all residents of the Orissa States, and Juang is spoken by 12,313.

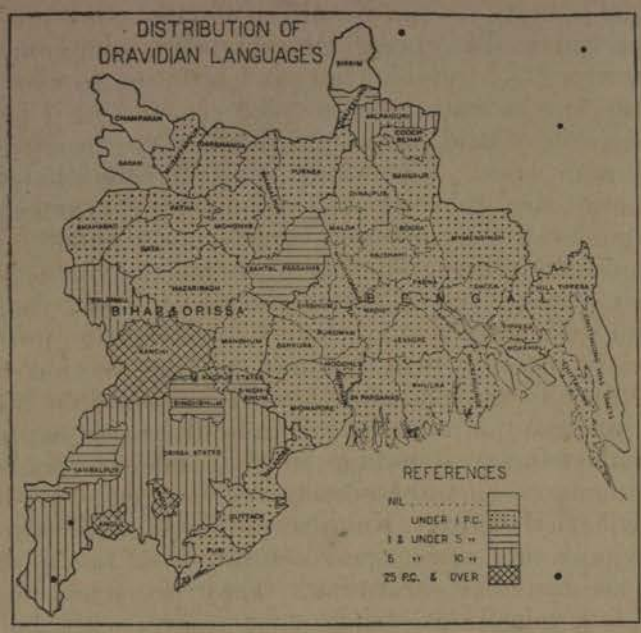
JUANG AND KHARIA.

Kharia is fairly widely diffused. It is spoken mainly in Ranchi and the Orissa States, but Kharia colonies are also found in Sambalpur and the tea gardens of Jalpaiguri. The number of persons speaking this language has risen by 34,000 or 43 per cent. since 1901, owing to the addition of Sambalpur and the adjoining Feudatory States.

750. The languages of the Dravidian family are spoken by 918,000 persons and belong for the most part to the Dravida group, which comprises the indigenous languages of Oraon, Malto and Malhar, and also Tamil, which is spoken by immigrants from Madras. Oraon is the language of 677,000 persons, of whom 559,000 were enumerated in Bihar and Orissa, and 117,000 in Bengal. In the former province the language is chiefly spoken in the Chota

DRAVIDIAN FAMILY—ORAON.

Nagpur Plateau, notably in Ranchi, which contains 358,000 Oraon speakers. The Oraons however are a pioneer race, who are found far afield. "Labour is the birthright of the pure Dravidian; whether hoeing tea in Assam, the Duars or Ceylon, cutting rice in the swamps of Eastern Bengal, or doing scavenger's work in the streets of Calcutta, Rangoon and Singapore, he is recognizable at a glance by his black skin, his squat figure and the negro-like proportions of his nose."* It is this pioneer spirit which accounts for their presence in districts so far from their homes as Purnea, the 24-Parganas, Rajshahi, Dinajpur and Jalpaiguri: over 58,000 speakers of Oraon were enumerated in the district last named, where they furnish a large proportion of the labour force on the tea gardens. The number speaking the language has risen by 24½ per cent. since 1901, and now constitutes nine-tenths of the tribe.



751. Kisan was returned as their language by 4,547 persons in Sambalpur and the Orissa States, and by 191 labourers in the tea gardens of Jalpaiguri. It was classified as Oraon, inquiry having shown that it was a corrupt form of that language. In Sambalpur and the Orissa States the Kisans, who are also called Kura or Kora, are very possibly an offshoot of the Oraons, early settlers in the country, whose language has been affected by intercourse with the Oriyas. They now form a distinct caste, and will neither marry with the Oraons nor eat rice in their houses.

KISAN.

752. Malto is the language of the Maler or Sauria Paharias, a Dravidian tribe of the Santal Parganas. Their total strength is 64,864, and the number returned as speaking Malto is 11 more. The difference is due to the fact that a certain number of Mal Paharias also returned their language as Malto. The results now obtained are somewhat different from those of 1901, when there were only 48,270 Maler or Sauria Paharias, but the language returns showed 60,777 speakers of Malto. The census of the Sauria Paharias in that year was however defective, and there appears to have been some confusion between Malto and the patois of Bengali spoken by the Mal Paharias.

MALTO, MALHAR AND TAMIL.

Malhar is the language of the small Malhar community found mainly in the Chota Nagpur Plateau. It was returned by only 236 persons. Tamil has 3,354 representatives among immigrants from Madras.

753. The Gond language is fast disappearing, as the Gonds have become Hinduized and adopted the Aryan languages of their neighbours. It now appears in the returns as the language of only 4,221 persons, though the Gonds themselves have a strength of 236,000: in other words, only one out of every 50 Gonds speaks his own language. Those who still retain it are practically confined to the Orissa States.

INTERMEDIATE LANGUAGES—
GOND

754. Two languages of the Andhra group of the Dravidian family are spoken in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, viz., Kandh (or Kui) and Telugu. Kandh is the language of the aboriginal Kandhs (who are generally called Khonds), while Kui is their own name for themselves. The number returned as speaking Kandh has risen since 1901 from 55,655 to 136,711, owing mainly

ANDHRA GROUP—
KANDH OR KUI.

* Imperial Gazetteer of India, Volume I, page 296.

to the transfer from the Central Provinces of the State of Kalahandi, in which there are 67,274 speakers of Kandh. This State, the State of Daspalla and the district of Angul are the chief centres of the Kandh language, and elsewhere it has fallen into desuetude. The marginal statement sufficiently illustrates the extent where it has fallen to which it has lost ground in some places, whereas it has more or less held its ground in the three localities first mentioned. The Kandhs of Angul are inhabitants of the Khondmals, one of the two subdivisions of that district, which is practically a reserve for them, so that they have maintained their tribal polity, their purity of race, their primitive religion and their tribal language more or less intact. In Kalahandi only one section of the Kandhs retains the language. They live in the almost inaccessible hill tracts of this State, and still practise the nomadic form of cultivation called *jhum*. They have different dialects corresponding to the dialects spoken in Gumsur and Kimedi, and in many cases interspersed with Telugu. These Kandhs call themselves Paharia or Dangria Kandhs, whereas the other Kandhs, who have settled down in the more open country and taken to regular cultivation, are known as Kachharia Kandhs. They are more and more assimilating Hindu customs, no longer eat, drink or intermarry with their brethren of the hills, and have dropped their own language and speak Oriya.*

District or State.	Number of—	
	Kandhs.	Kandh speakers.
Angul	52,934	51,053
Kalahandi ...	110,458	67,275
Daspalla ...	13,499	10,480
Patna	45,440	47
Baud	18,136	477
Bamra	7,333	46

755. The number of persons speaking Telugu was 18,680 in 1901, but has now risen to 31,463, of whom 10,683 were enumerated in Bengal and 20,780 in Bihar and Orissa. The increase is due simply to the greater influx of immigrants. In the 24-Parganas alone the number of Telugu speakers has risen from 294 to 5,154 owing to the attraction of labour to the mills: over 3,000 were operatives from Ganjam and Vizagapatam employed in the mills at Titagarh. The greater number of the Telugus in Bihar and Orissa were enumerated in the districts and States of Orissa, between which and the northern districts of Madras there is regular intercourse.

Telugu.

756. The languages belonging to the Tibeto-Chinese family, which are classified under the Tibeto-Burman sub-family, are spoken in Bengal by 446,000 persons or 1 per cent. of the total population. They are also spoken by 59,000 persons in Sikkim, where they constitute two-thirds of the population. The languages of this family in Sikkim and the British districts of Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri belong to the Tibeto-Himalayan branch, and are spoken by the Bhotias, Lepchas and Nepalese hill races.

Tibeto-Chinese Family.

This branch is divided into three groups, of which the first is the Tibetan group, under which four languages are classified, viz., the Bhotia of Tibet, Sharpa Bhotia, the Bhotia of Sikkim (or Denjongke) and the Bhotia of Bhutan (Lhoke). The names show that the Bhotia languages differ according as they are spoken in Tibet, Sikkim, Bhutan and Eastern Nepal, Sharpa being a name meaning "eastern" which is applied to those Bhotias who have migrated from Tibet and settled in the east of Nepal. The total number of persons speaking Bhotia languages at this census is 26,494, of whom 12,433 were enumerated in Sikkim and nearly all the remainder in Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri. The aggregate has increased by 4,000 since 1901, the result of increased immigration. The number speaking each language is—Sharpa Bhotia 5,795, Bhotia of Sikkim 11,562, Bhotia of Bhutan 3,993 and Bhotia of Tibet 5,144. The last heading also includes all entries of Bhotia in which there was no specification of country, and in which reference to the entry of caste or tribe gave no clue to their character.

Tibeto-Himalayan branch.
Tibetan Group—
Bhotia.

757. The group mentioned in the margin includes Lepcha and the languages of several Nepalese tribes or castes, viz., Gurung, Murmi, Sunuwar, Mangar and Newari, besides Toto. The comparative statement in the

Non-pronominalized Himalayan Group.

* L. E. B. Cobden-Ramsay, Orissa States Gazetteer, p. 200.

margin shows the number of persons speaking each of these languages at this and the last census. It is said that when a Nepali knows Naipali as well as his tribal language, he prefers to return the former. On the other hand, the revised instructions about the entry of language should *à priori* have resulted, as elsewhere, in a larger number of persons returning the tribal language. It is impossible to say how much effect those two factors had, and whether one counter-balanced or outweighed the other; but I am inclined to believe that the tendency to return Naipali was only slightly checked by the orders on the subject. It is noticeable that there is a substantial increase only among the Murmis, while the number speaking Lepcha has risen slightly, the increase being commensurate with the growth of the Lepcha race. Mangar is stationary, but Newari, Sunuwari and Gurung have lost ground. The decrease in the number of Gurung speakers is especially noticeable. In 1901 barely two-fifths of them were faithful to their mother-tongue, but the proportion is now reduced to one-sixteenth, and in Sikkim only 22 out of 6,000 returned Gurung as their language. The returns for this language would in any case be small, as the Gurungs of Eastern Nepal, and their brethren in Sikkim and Darjeeling, do not speak the language of the tribe to anything like the same extent as the Gurungs of Western Nepal. But the number is decreasing so rapidly, that it appears only a matter of time before it is abandoned altogether.

LANGUAGE.	1911.	1901.
Gurung	1,052	6,142
Lepcha	20,606	19,274
Mangar	16,573	16,661
Manjhi	736	902
Murmi	35,954	32,062
Newari	6,986	7,491
Sunuwari	4,464	5,006
Toto	256	170

758. All the languages of this group that appear in the returns belong to the Eastern sub-group, viz., Dhimal, Thami, Limbu and the Kiranti languages, *i.e.*, Yakha, Khambu and Jimdar, all of which are spoken in Sikkim, Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri.

PRONOMINALIZED HIMALAYAN GROUP.

EASTERN SUB-GROUP.

Jimdar is by far the most widely spoken of all these languages, being the mother-tongue of 55,063 persons, of whom 39,260 were enumerated in Bengal (the great majority in Darjeeling) and 15,803 in Sikkim. It has been returned almost universally by the Jimdars, there being only 4,164 who disclaimed the language. There were a few entries of Dungmali, Tulung, Lohorong, Chaurasya and Kulung, which are treated in the Linguistic Survey as dialects of Jimdar. The names, however, are only designations of Jimdar septs, and the return of caste was in most cases Jimdar. Khambu has lost popularity as a name, and was returned by only 850 persons. As will be shown in Chapter XI, there is reason to believe that the Khambus and Jimdars are of the same stock, Khambu being originally a tribal name and the Jimdars a Hinduized section of the tribe.

JIMDAR AND KHAMBU.

The Limbus returned Limbu as their language to the number of 22,389 out of a total of 25,466. The number of speakers is only 354 more than it was 10 years ago, whereas the Limbus have added over 2,000 to their numbers. Yakha is the mother-language of the small Yakha community, who are closely allied to the Jimdars; it was returned by 1,335 persons or 26 more than the actual number of Yakhas. The difference is probably due to some Yakhas being returned as Indian Christians without specifying their caste. Dhimal and Thami are numerically insignificant, being spoken only by 444 and 292 persons, respectively.

LIMBU, YAKHA, DHIMAL AND THAMI.

759. The second branch of the Tibeto-Chinese family is designated Assam-Burmese, and consists of the Bodo and Burma groups, the languages appertaining to which are spoken by 279,000 persons in the south-east of Bengal, chiefly in the Chittagong Hill Tracts and Hill Tippera. The number of their speakers has increased by 32,500 or 13 per cent. since 1901.

ASSAM-BURMESE BRANCH.

The most important language of the Bodo group is Tipura or Mrung, which is the mother-tongue of the Tipuras or Tiparas, a Mongolian race who appear to be identical with the Mrungs of Arakan. Three-fourths of them

BODO GROUP—
TIPURA OR MRUNG.

are found in Hill Tippera, and nearly all the remainder in the Chittagong Hill Tracts, there being only small colonies in the adjoining districts of Tippera and Chittagong. The number of persons speaking Tipura (126,269) has risen by 24 per cent. during the last 10 years, owing to the growth of the tribe: only 3,756 failed to return Tipura as their language.

GARO.

760. The Garo language is spoken by 38,773 persons, of whom 33,351 were enumerated in Mymensingh and 3,048 in Jalpaiguri. The home of the language is the Garo Hills, by which Mymensingh is bounded on the north. During the last 10 years the number of speakers has not altogether kept pace with the growth of the tribe, and the proportion of those who returned Garo as their mother-tongue to the number whose caste was entered as Garo has consequently fallen from 94 per cent. to 90 per cent.

KOCH.

761. The Koches of Bengal have with few exceptions abandoned their own language and speak Bengali. According to Sir G. A. Grierson—"There can be little doubt that the original Koches were the same as the Bodos. 'Koch,' 'Mech' and 'Bara' or 'Bodo' all connoted the same tribe, or, at most, different septs of the same tribe. This is well shown by the traditional origin of the Koch Kings from a Mech father and Koch mothers. In Assam the name 'Koch' is no longer that of a tribe, but rather that of a Hindu caste, into which all converts from the different tribes—Kachari, Garo, Lalung, Mikir, etc.—are admitted on conversion. The case is very much the same in Bengal. The name 'Koch,' in fact, everywhere connotes a Hinduised Bodo who has abandoned his ancestral religion for Hinduism and the ancestral Bodo language for Bengali or Assamese. There is, however, in Dacca, the Garo Hills and Goalpara a small body of people who are known as Koch or Pani Koch, who still speak a language belonging to the Bodo group, and are either animistic or nominal Hindus."* In Dacca 3,525 Koches entered their language as Koch, and 3,001 more are returned for Mymensingh. In the latter district Koch is spoken by a small community called Koch Mande, living in the Madhupur Jungle, who are either a remnant of the Koch tribe or Garos with a slight veneer of Hinduism. The total number claiming to speak Koch has been reduced by half since 1901, though those who returned themselves as Koch by caste have an addition of 82 per cent.

	Number of Koches.	Number speaking Koch.
1901	70,375	12,622
1911	128,436	6,598

BODO, MECH OR PLAINS KACHARI.

762. The aggregate returned under this head is 21,726, while the number of the tribes or castes with whom it is a mother-tongue is 22,540, viz., 1,810 Kacharis and 20,730 Meches. The head-quarters of the language is the three central districts of Assam Valley, viz., Darrang, Nowgong and Kamrup, and in Bengal it is practically confined to Jalpaiguri with its population of 20,173 Meches. The language has remained stationary since the last census, though the Meches have lost nearly 4,000, probably because on becoming Hinduised they have adopted some other name to conceal their origin.

RABHA.

Rabha is a language spoken by the Rabhas of Assam, where it is fast dying out. It was returned by only 704 persons in Jalpaiguri and Dacca.

KUKI-CHIN GROUP.

763. The Kuki-Chin group is represented by six different languages, but by only 31,769 speakers. All are numerically insignificant, except Manipuri and Kuki. Manipuri is spoken almost to a man by the Manipuris of Hill Tippera, who on absorption into Hinduism have adopted the name of Kshattriya. Kuki is a term applied promiscuously to the hill races who do not understand Bengali in Hill Tippera and the Chittagong Hill Tracts, where also the speakers of the other languages are found.

Sub-group.	Language.	Number.
Meithei	Manipuri ...	16,613
Old Kuki ...	Hallam ...	2,941
	Rangkol ...	556
Central Chin ...	Lushai ...	581
Southern Chin ...	Khami	1,050
	Khweymi or Kumi	
	Khyang ...	501
Unclassed ...	Kuki ...	9,527

BURMESE GROUP.

764. The last of the groups of the Assam-Burmese branch is the Burma group, which is represented in Bengal by Burmese and the allied language of Mru. The latter is returned by 11,284 persons, of whom all but 214 were enumerated in the Chittagong Hill Tracts. Burmese is more widely spoken, being returned by

*Linguistic Survey of India, Vol. III, Part II, p. 95.

42,346 persons in that district, by 21,194 in Chittagong, by 8,701 in Backergunge and by 1,610 in Hill Tippera. The total number of persons speaking it in Bengal is 74,158, of whom the great majority are indigenous, for only 2,600 persons born in Burma were present in Bengal at the time of the census. Those who speak it are mainly Maghs, who use a dialect current in Arakan and hence known as Arakanese. No less than 65,869 persons returned their language simply as Magh, as shown in the marginal statement, which also gives the number of Maghs in each district. The difference in the figures is due to the fact that the Maghs are a mixed race, some aboriginals of the country, as in the Chittagong Hill Tracts, others later immigrants from Arakan, and others again of mixed birth. In Chittagong, for instance, there are three sections. One is an off-shoot of the Maghs of the Hill Tracts, who are called Jhumia Maghs from their nomadic system of cultivation: they speak Burmese and write it in a corrupt Burmese character. The Roang Maghs, who are found in the Cox's Bazar subdivision, are the descendants of Arakanese immigrants. The earliest were refugees who fled to Chittagong at the close of the 18th century after the invasion and conquest of Arakan by the Burmese. A later body sought British protection shortly before the first Burmese war in 1824. The name Raong is merely a corruption of Rakhaing, the indigenous name for Arakan. Their language and their names are Burmese; their religion is Buddhism; they do not, as a rule, understand Bengali, and never speak it among themselves. Both the Jhumia and the Raong Maghs probably belong to the same original stock, but the former, having long been settled in Chittagong and the hill country to the east, regard themselves as autocthonous, while the latter belong to a more recent stream of immigrants from Arakan. The physical characteristics of both are unmistakeably Mongolian. Their stature is low, the face broad and flat, the cheek-bones high and wide, the nose flat and bridgeless, and the eyes small with eyelids obliquely set. The Rajbansi or Barua Maghs are the offspring of Bengali women by Burmese men or, more generally, of Arakanese mothers by Bengali fathers. They have intermarried for generations with Bengalis, speak only Bengali, and are in fact Bengalis in all but their religion, which is Buddhism.

DISTRICT.	Number of Maghs.	Magh speakers.
Chittagong Hill Tracts.	46,238	42,344
Chittagong ...	68,913	20,947
Hill Tippera ...	1,930	1,610
Backergunge ...	8,819	903
Noakhali	426	36
Dacca	35	22
Tippera	1,578	6
Mymensingh ...	4	1

765. There is a tendency among educated Indian gentlemen who have made a study of languages to reject the distinctions recognized by the Linguistic Survey. Objections are chiefly raised to the differentiation of dialects and sub-dialects, on the ground that they are based on variations in vocabulary rather than in grammar. The dialects, and even more the sub-dialects, are, it is stated, in some cases nothing but variants of the main language as spoken by different classes, castes or tribes, or in different localities. The general opinion is that the variations must be very marked, and that they must include changes in grammatical form, before they have a right to be classed as dialects. The language of the villager differs from that of the townsman, the patois of the ignorant peasant from the pure diction of the educated scholar, and there are also variations in different parts of the country; but mere provincialisms or differences of pronounciation or vocabulary are, it is urged, not a sufficient criterion for demarcation into dialects or sub-dialects. On this point I may be permitted to quote from a report by Babu Manmatha Nath Sen, District Census Officer at Sambalpur, and afterwards Deputy Superintendent of Census in charge of the Central Office at Cuttack, whose remarks refer primarily to the treatment of Binjhwari, Kalanga and Bhulia as dialects of Chhattishgarhi or Laria in the Linguistic Survey. It should be added, however, that though classed as dialects in the Survey, it is stated that they are "rather jargons than dialects, and that the correctness of

DIALECTS.

the Chhattisgarhi depends a great deal on the personal equation of the speakers." Apart from this question, his note is of interest as throwing light on the mutual intelligibility of dialects, and also on their local and social distribution in an area where numerous different languages are current.

"Bhulia, Binjhwari or Binjhali and Kalanga have been shewn separately as forms of Laria or Chhattishgarhi. But they are nothing more than Laria or Chhattisgarhi, intermixed to a more or less extent with Oriya and other neighbouring languages. The castes speaking Laria, in some cases, differ slightly in their dialect: for instance, Laria spoken by a Mali will slightly differ from that spoken by a Teli, and both from Laria as spoken in Chhattisgarh; but a little investigation shows that the differences in these cases, as well as in the case of Bhulia, Binjhwari, etc., are dependent on the degree to which the speakers have been exposed to the influence of Oriya or other languages, and are not such as to entitle them to separate entry in a family of languages. If they are to be shewn separately, Oriya as spoken in Sambalpur should also be shown separately, as Sambalpuri Oriya also differs, to the same extent, if not more, from the pure form of the tongue as spoken in the heart of Orissa.

"While in Sambalpur I collected specimens of Laria spoken by several castes and compared them, so as to ascertain how far the form of speech differed on account of the difference in caste, and found that each differed from the other to some extent. A careful observer, when once versed in these differences, can at once detect the caste. The difference between these forms of speech are however not greater than the difference in Oriya as spoken by a man of Cuttack. There is a good deal of difference in the pronunciation and vocabulary of the Cuttack Oriya and Sambalpuri Oriya, the latter having absorbed many Hindi words. There are also differences in minor points of grammatical structure, *e.g.*, a Sambalpuri will place a negative before the verb and in Cuttack after it. The verbs, too, take more shortened forms in Sambalpuri Oriya than in Cuttack Oriya, *e.g.*, where a man of Cuttack will say *karuchanti*, the Sambalpur man will say *karuchan* and, in a more vulgar form of speech, *karsan*. Still a Sambalpuri will make himself intelligible to a Cuttack man. The difference in the pronunciation of the common people even in Cuttack and Puri is so marked, that one can at once detect it. There are also diversities—though of a minor nature—in the speech of people living in urban and rural areas, and in the language of men and women in the same area. To quote examples, the townsmen of Cuttack will pronounce *r* in place of *l*, saying *hara* instead of *hala* (plough). Again, a man of Sambalpur or Cuttack will use the word *karuchhi* for 'am doing,' while a woman of Sambalpur will say *karsin* and a woman of Cuttack *karuchi*."

As regards other languages and dialects, it may be pointed out that the difference between Chhattisgarhi and the other two dialects of Eastern Hindi, Bagheli and Awadhi is not great. For instance, *is*, the termination of the past tense (*e.g.*, *kahis*, he said; *maris*, he struck), which is what everybody notices in Chhattisgarhi, is "the typical shibboleth" of a speaker of Eastern Hindi, and is commonly heard in Calcutta among servants belonging to Oudh. Sir G. A. Grierson is, indeed, of opinion that if a Chhattisgarhi speaker was set down in Oudh, he would find himself at home with the language of the locality in a week.

BILINGUAL RACES.

766. Instances of tribes being bilingual are frequent. The Nepalese tribes, some of which are crystallizing into castes, are generally bilingual, speaking Naipali (or Khaskura), the *lingua franca* of the Nepalese, in their intercourse with others, but using only the tribal language among themselves. To this rule the Gurungs are a notable exception, only one in every sixteen speaking the Gurung tongue. In Western Nepal, it is true, the Gurungs are acquainted with the tribal language, but in Darjeeling and Sikkim the Gurungs are immigrants from Eastern Nepal, where the great majority speak only Khaskura. The Nepalese castes, as distinct from tribes, have no language, however, but Naipali:

curiously enough, the language as spoken by the Kamis, a low blacksmith caste, is regarded as a well of Naipali pure and undefiled. The Munda and Dravidian races are also more or less bilingual in districts where they live side by side with Hindus speaking Aryan languages. This is particularly the case in border districts, such as Manbhum. There, writes Mr. H. Coupland, formerly Deputy Commissioner, "the members of the aboriginal tribes are to a large extent polyglot, speaking Bengali or Hindi, usually the former, in addition to their own dialect even where, as in the case of the Santals, they are a sufficiently numerous community to force a knowledge of their own language on their neighbours, and on the courts and offices with whom they come into contact." The same phenomenon is observable in Sambalpur and the eastern States of Orissa. Some races, such as the Mundas and Oraons, stick tenaciously to their language, but in speaking with their Hindu neighbours use the vernacular current in the district or State. For this feature the prescription of an Aryan language as the language of the Courts is partly responsible, but even more the necessities of commercial and social life in areas where there is a mixed population.

DISPLACEMENT OF NON-ARYAN LANGUAGES.

767. In the Bengal Census Report of 1901 it was stated: "The gradual disappearance of the non-Aryan dialects is only a matter of time. Even now it is only in the remoter tracts, and in the less accessible and inhospitable hills, that they still flourish. The process of absorption will doubtless go on with increasing rapidity, as communications begin to improve and intercourse with the outside world becomes more and more continuous." From the preceding account it will have been seen that this process is going on among some of the Nepalese tribes, notably the Newars, Sunuwars and Gurungs, but that others, such as the Jimdars and Murmis, and also the Lepchas, show no tendency to give up their language in favour of the *lingua franca* of Naipali. In the Chota Nagpur Plateau some races, such as the Gonds and Bhumij, have practically abandoned their language, and the Kandhs appear to have followed their example in tracts where they have come into contact with communities speaking Aryan languages. On the other hand, they show no inclination to do so in localities where they are more or less in isolation, such as Angul and the hill tracts of the Kalahandi State. On the whole, however, the figures of this census show no signs of the non-Aryan language falling into desuetude in the Chota Nagpur Plateau, even though that tract is being largely opened up and its people brought into contact with Aryan-speaking races. Even among the Bhumij of Bihar and Orissa, among whom one might expect the process to be accelerated, the proportion of persons speaking Bhumij has increased from 35 to 39 per cent. The marginal figures for five of the chief tribes having Munda or Dravidian languages or dialects, and numbering in all 4 millions, indicate that so far from deserting their own language, they are clinging to it. There is in all cases an increase in the relative number of those retaining their forefathers' speech, which is largely, no doubt, due to the revised instructions regarding the entry of language. Even after allowing for this, the increased proportion is very noticeable when it is remembered that these races are spreading over the country away from their native homes, where they are more likely to adopt the language of Aryan communities or to enter the latter in the schedules because they have to speak it to the people round them: about one-third of the Santals, over one-third of the Oraons and one-eighth of the Mundas were enumerated in Bengal.

TRIBE.	PERCENTAGE SPEAKING TRIBAL LANGUAGE.	
	1911.	1901.
Ho	99½	95
Kharia	76	69
Munda	94	92
Santal	99	94
Oraon	90	88

RELIGION AND LANGUAGE.

768. At the same time, there can be no doubt that absorption into Hinduism often leads to partial defection from the tribal language. The figures in the

margin give, for 16 Munda and Dravidian tribes in Bihar and Orissa, a comparative statement of the number of persons returned as Hindus and Animists that speak the tribal language. While religion appears to make little difference in some cases, *e.g.*, among Santals and Hos, probably because their Hinduization is only skin-deep, it does make a great difference in the case of others, such as Bhumij, Birhors, Kandhs, Karmalis, Kharias, Korwas, Mundas, Oraons and Turis, among whom the proportion is much higher among Animists than among Hindus.

Tribe.	Hindu.		Animist.	
	X.	XIII.	X.	XIII.
	Number speaking tribal language.	Total number.	Number speaking tribal language.	Total number.
Asuri	205	333	2,727	3,099
Bhumij	99,739	266,025	5,831	6,647
Birhor	462	1,387	551	953
Gond	3,994	209,815	218	25,856
Ho...	57,991	60,406	357,481	358,815
Juang	1,175	1,310	11,138	11,530
Kandh (Khond) ...	13,430	135,834	123,276	167,049
Karmali	2,711	16,341	4,414	5,501
Kharia	21,823	37,887	56,699	67,585
Kora	3,741	41,568	336	7,415
Korwa	3,602	7,300	5,106	6,931
Mundari	71,883	88,840	318,885	321,600
Oraon	41,853	52,482	413,144	422,191
Santal	252,614	271,280	1,127,964	1,128,170
Sauria Paharia or Maler.	5,709	5,517	57,162	57,279
Turi	1,283	44,513	1,415	2,886

The extent to which the aboriginals adopt the garb of Hinduism, and with it the language of the Hindus, depends a good deal on their relative strength in areas where there is a mixed population. The Gonds, for instance, were a dominant race, who became feudal lords of the Brahmans and other Hindu castes. The subject races raised no objection to the Gonds entering the fold of Hinduism, and as the Gonds gradually absorbed the religion and customs of the Hindus, Oriya displaced Gondi. The position of the aboriginals and the Hindus is now reversed. The caste system is rigid, and the aboriginals being in a minority are regarded as pariahs: they are contemptuously referred to as among the unclean helot races, *e.g.*, 'Ganda, Ghasi, Kol, Kharia.' There is no inclination on the part of the Oriya Hindus to welcome them in their circle, and the aboriginals are forced to live in their own settlements and be content with their own society. In such circumstances, they naturally cling to their own language and their distinctive customs. It is only in the neighbourhood of towns, where they come into close contact with the Hindus, that Oriya displaces the non-Aryan tongue. On the other hand, where the aboriginals form a majority and are landed proprietors, as in Ranchi, they are not regarded with contempt. A minority can with difficulty ostracize a majority, and consequently it is easy to obtain admission in the ranks of Hindus, and thereby win the respectability attaching to the religion of a more civilized community.

Toponomy.

769. In many parts there are traces in the local toponomy of the influence of languages which are no longer spoken by the people. Legends of the presence, or even the rule, of the races that spoke such languages persist, and tradition ascribes various remains to them. This is especially the case with districts adjoining or near to the Chota Nagpur Plateau, such as Gaya and Shahabad. In the former the remains of rude forts in the south of the district are ascribed to the Kols: even at the foot of Pretsila, a sacred hill near the town of Gaya, rude stone circles are said to be their work. Shahabad, according to local tradition, was held by Cheros who were eventually conquered by Savars or Suirs, a generic name for hill races; while the traditions of the Oraons relate that they held the fort of Rohtasgarh till ousted by the Hindus. In these two districts several names of places or rivers may be identified with Kolarian or Dravidian names, though they are often so corrupted or transformed that their origin is not apparent. Many more have disappeared altogether owing to their displacement by Aryan names. Even in Ranchi, with its large Munda population, Mundari names are apt to disappear, as Aryan names with the same meaning are adopted in their place, *e.g.*, the Bihari name for "the village of the fig-tree" is substituted for the Mundari designation. The old names have been kept in the settlement records, but whether that will preserve them in popular parlance is doubtful.

770. To give a few instances of Kolarian and Dravidian names in localities on the southern fringe of the Chota Nagpur Plateau, where Bihari is now the

universal language, a person travelling along the Grand Trunk Road to Gaya, halts at the dâk bungalow of Dumri in Hazaribagh close to the border of the district: this means the village of the fig-tree, *dumbari* being the Dravidian designation for a fig-tree. Further along, in the district of Gaya, he comes to the picturesque village of Kahudag, which is a Kolarian name, *dag* being a corruption of *da'a* meaning water. The river Damodar has the same derivation, being a duplication of *da'a* (water) and *odâr* (water). Another march further up the Grand Trunk Road is the village of Sherghati, which now bears a Hinduistic name but contains an old fort said to have been built by the Kol Rajas. In this district there are several other places of which the names are undoubtedly Kolarian, *e.g.*, the *pargana* of Kutumba and the village of Pachamba in the south-east of the Nawada subdivision; the ending *amba* is frequently found in Oraon village names, its meaning being a spring of water. Pachamba means an old spring; Kutumba is very possibly a corruption of Kitamba meaning the foul spring.* There are similar traces of Dravidian names in Orissa. To mention one common instance, *pada* (not the Bengali *pāra*) is a non-Aryan word meaning village, which is found as the termination of many place names, *e.g.*, Kenduapada in Balasore, Baripada in Mayurbhanj, Chatrapada in Cuttack, etc. Further inland, in Sambalpur and the adjoining Feudatory States, there are many place names of non-Aryan origin; of which Mr. B. C. Mazumdar has given the following account:—"We meet with a large number of such geographical names, as Bāh-Mundā, Mundāmahal, Munder, Utu (ātā)-birā, Kulhā-birā, and many other names of Mundari origin; and also many such geographical names of other non-Aryan origin, as Gujā (meaning hill, the name of a particular hill about 10 miles north-west of Sambalpur), Sir-Gujā (the name of a State to the west of Lohardaga), Bheren (the name of a river as well as of a zamindari in Sambalpur), Sir-Girdā (the name of a village), Jhār-Sir-Girdā (Jharsuguda railway station), Loi-Ra, Loi-Sing and so forth. The Kandh name Jorr for a river has been retained even in the name of the river Katjorri which is far away from Sambalpur and flows past Cuttack. Many old geographical names have been Hinduised, but in many cases the history of the names have not been obliterated....According to the mythology of the Gonds, their principal god Lingo had his seat on the west in the Central Provinces. Wherever the Gonds moved and made their colony, they consecrated a hill in the name of Lingo and named the hill as Bāro-pāhār. Thus it is that we have got a Bāro-pāhār range in Bargarh subdivision of the district of Sambalpur. The Gonds invariably named some hills and forests in their new settlement after the sacred geographical names of their old home."†

771. To turn to a different locality, the names of places, hills, rivers, etc., in the Darjeeling district frequently furnish evidence of the presence of the Lepchas or Bhotias, though they are greatly corrupted by the Nepalese, who are almost as bad linguists as the English. Other names have been transformed by the Bengalis, *e.g.*, Mahanadi is a corruption of Mahaldi, a Lepcha name meaning the winding river. In some cases the original name has been almost or altogether lost. The name Jaldhaka, for example, is now commonly used instead of Dichhu, which is merely a word of dual origin meaning water; *di* is a Bodo, and *chhu* a Bhotia word for water. It is possible that the root of the name Tista is also *di*, but Hindu scholars have derived it from *trisrota*, *i.e.*, three currents. The Bhotia name for this latter river is Tsang-chhu or the pure water, while the Lepchas call it the Rangnyung or the great straight-going water.

* F. Hahn, *Dravidian and Kolarian Place Names*, Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal, Part III, 1903.

† B. C. Mazumdar, *Sonpur in the Sambalpur Tract* (1911), pp. 18—20.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—DISTRIBUTION OF TOTAL POPULATION BY LANGUAGE (ACCORDING TO CENSUS).

LANGUAGE.	BENGAL.				BIHAR AND ORISSA.			
	Total number of speakers 000's omitted.		Number per mille of population of Province (1911).	Where chiefly spoken.	Total number of speakers 000's omitted.		Number per mille of population of Province (1911).	Where chiefly spoken.
	1911.	1901.			1911.	1901.		
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
I. LANGUAGES OF INDIA ...	***46,253***	***42,834***	***998·8***	.....	***38,426***	***35,540***	***999·7***	
A. INDO-EUROPEAN FAMILY ...	***44,904***	***41,768***	***969·8***	.....	***35,081***	***32,734***	***912·7***	
Aryan sub-family—								
Indian Branch—								
Sanskritic sub-Branch—								
1. Eastern Group—								
Hindi and Urdu*	1,917	1,487	41·4	Whole Province.	24,933	25,293	648·7	Bihar and Chota Nagpur
Bengali	42,566	39,874	919·3	Whole Province.	2,295	1,559	59·7	Purnea and Manbhum.
Oriya	294	341	6·4	Midnapore.	7,820	5,862	203·5	Orissa.
2. Northern Group—								
Naipali (Khaskura)	91	57	1·9	Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri.	3	8	·07	Bihar and Chota Nagpur
3. Western Group—								
Marwari (Rajasthani) ...	19	2	·4	Whole Province.	18	9	·5	Whole Province.
Others	*17*	*7*	*·4*	.....	*12*		*·3*	
B. AUSTRO-ASIATIC FAMILY ...	***771***	***671***	***16·6***	.....	***2,559***	***2,210***	***66·6***	
Munda sub-family—								
Mundari	50	32	1	North Bengal.	475	371	12·4	Chota Nagpur Plateau.
Santali	665	491	14·4	West and North Bengal.	1,419	1,270	36·9	Chota Nagpur Plateau.
Bhumij	21	24	·5	West and North Bengal.	106	87	2·7	Singbhum and Orissa States.
Ho	4	·3	·08	Dinajpur and Jalpaiguri.	417	367	10·8	Singbhum and Orissa States
Kharia	6	·4	·1	Jalpaiguri.	107	75	2·8	Ranchi and Orissa States.
Others	*25*	*19*	*·5*	.....	*35*	*40*	*·9*	
C. DRAVIDIAN FAMILY	***133***	***88***	***2·8***	.....	***785***	***595***	***20·4***	
1. Dravida Group—								
Oraon or Kurukh	117	82	2·5	North Bengal.	559	461	14·5	Chota Nagpur Plateau.
Malto	2	1	·04	Murshidabad.	63	60	1·6	Santhal Parganas.
2. Andhra Group—								
Kandh or Kui	...	...	...	.....	137	55	3·6	Angul and Orissa States.
Others	*14*	*5*	*·3*	.....	*26*	*19*	*·7*	
D TIBETO-CHINESE FAMILY ...	***446***	***407***	***9·6***	.....	*·1*	*·5*	***·003***	
Tibeto-Burman sub-family—								
Tibeto-Himalayan Branch—								
1. Tibetan Group—								
Bhotia	14	14	·3	Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri.	·07	·05	·002	North Bihar.
2. Non-pronominalized Himalayan Group—								
Murmi	29	27	·6	Darjeeling.	...	...	...	
Mangar	14	14	·3	Darjeeling.	·02	·2	·0007	North Bihar.
3. Pronominalized Himalayan Group—								
Jimdar	39	34	·8	Darjeeling.	...	...	...	
Limbu	14	16	·3	Darjeeling.	...	...	...	
(*b*) Assam-Burmese Branch—								
1. Bodo Group—								
Bodo Mech or Plains Kachari.	22	21	·5	Jalpaiguri.	...	...	...	
Garo	39	36	·8	Mymensingh.	...	...	...	
Tipura or Mrung ...	126	102	2·7	Hill Tippera.	...	...	...	
2. Burma Group—								
Burmese	74	64	1·6	Chittagong and Chittagong Hill Tracts.	·01	·08	·0003	South Bihar.
Others	*75*	*79*	*1·6*	.....	*·01*	*·002*	*·0003*	
E. OTHER LANGUAGES	·01	...	·003	.....	2	...	·006	
II. LANGUAGES FOREIGN TO INDIA.	***52***	***50***	***1·2***	.....	***10***	***9***	***·3***	

* The great majority of those returned as Hindi and Urdu really speak Bihari. The estimate of the number of Bihari speakers given in the Linguistic Survey of India is 23,143,888, of whom 6,991,972 speak Bhojpuri, 6,565,758 Magahi, and 9,586,158 Maithili. According to the estimate given in the preceding Chapter it is 24,694,493, or, if a different method of calculation is adopted, 25,131,627.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II—DISTRIBUTION BY LANGUAGE OF THE POPULATION OF EACH DISTRICT.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	NUMBER PER 10,000 OF POPULATION SPEAKING					
	Bengali.	Hindi and Urdu.	Tibeto Burman languages.	Munda languages.	Dravidian languages.	Other languages.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
BENGAL	**9,192·36**	**414·07**	**96·27**	**166·44**	**28·67**	**102·19**
WEST BENGAL	**8,750·40**	**458·02**	**·02**	**519·45**	**13·53**	**258·58**
Burdwan	9,026·80	456·08	·04	474·28	2·08	40·72
Birbhum	9,016·29	309·11	...	660·04	8·24	6·32
Bankura	9,071·67	40·74	...	882·38	·23	4·98
Midnapore	8,286·19	396·04	...	641·16	15·44	661·17
Hooghly	9,198·57	479·50	·04	208·78	32·56	80·55
Howrah	8,518·68	1,272·89	·07	10·69	25·80	171·87
CENTRAL BENGAL	**8,853·52**	**910·19**	**·32**	**39·92**	**32·69**	**163·36**
24-Parganas	8,693·77	997·33	·008	67·02	66·90	174·98
Calcutta	4,904·40	4,106·19	2·81	1·15	33·30	952·15
Nadia	9,861·62	108·80	·006	·63	16·37	12·58
Murshidabad	9,108·59	738·45	·01	114·14	31·28	7·53
Jessore	9,960·62	32·20	·006	·38	1·14	5·66
NORTH BENGAL	**8,811·12**	**571·68**	**149·28**	**275·23**	**87·28**	**105·41**
Rajshahi	9,544·38	203·66	·15	155·58	82·28	8·95
Dinajpur	8,731·95	447·73	·84	735·76	78·10	5·62
Jalpaiguri	6,760·01	1,227·76	372·38	541·24	647·29	451·12
Darjeeling	1,731·69	656·67	4,718·01	266·16	295·73	2,336·74
Rangpur	9,590·37	344·01	1·16	45·34	2·16	16·96
Bogra	9,587·13	331·06	...	73·35	3·40	5·06
Pabna	9,751·03	170·61	·03	67·29	·81	10·18
Malda	7,169·53	2,175·36	...	640·66	10·46	3·99
Cooch Behar	9,592·01	359·68	16·17	3·90	·11	28·13
EAST BENGAL	**9,747·88**	**95·01**	**149·93**	**1·73**	**·64**	**4·81**
Khulna	9,957·76	27·01	...	8·88	·01	6·34
Dacca	9,800·43	173·71	18·60	·47	·10	6·69
Mymensingh	9,728·92	187·70	80·44	·11	·06	2·77
Faridpur	9,938·20	58·61	·03	·01	·05	3·10
Backergunge	9,938·73	21·66	35·90	·02	·0082	3·69
Tippera	9,950·34	41·22	6·11	...	·12	2·21
Noakhali	9,993·85	5·09	·34	...	...	·72
Chittagong	9,792·82	39·60	152·64	3·12	2·67	9·15
Chittagong Hill Tracts	4,259·44	4·29	5,672·69	48·43	...	15·15
Hill Tippera	4,261·87	273·68	5,349·52	29·14	31·05	54·74

DISTRICTS.	NUMBER PER 10,000 POPULATION SPEAKING					
	Hindi and Urdu.	Oriya.	Bengali.	Munda languages.	Dravidian languages.	Other languages.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
BIHAR AND ORISSA	**6,486·83**	**2,034·66**	**597·09**	**665·93**	**204·26**	**11·23**
NORTH BIHAR	**9,411·03**	**·04**	**535·65**	**34·81**	**10·07**	**8·40**
Saran	9,996·15	·03	1·94	·009	...	1·88
Champaran	9,986·70	·01	3·82	...	...	9·47
Muzaffarpur	9,993·61	·02	2·58	...	·007	3·84
Darbhanga	9,992·27	·01	2·97	...	·07	4·68
Bhagalpur	9,831·74	·06	16·93	117·59	10·20	23·48
Purnea	6,044·16	·11	3,764·60	120·25	60·28	10·60
SOUTH BIHAR	**9,955·21**	**·19**	**9·26**	**22·67**	**2·06**	**10·71**
Patna	9,969·77	·02	13·43	...	·04	16·74
Gaya	9,988·98	...	6·33	·51	·16	4·02
Shahabad	9,982·74	·71	5·40	·03	8·37	2·75
Monghyr	9,885·93	·07	12·47	81·66	·0094	19·87
ORISSA	**286·42**	**9,563·23**	**85·81**	**28·30**	**30·68**	**5·56**
Cuttack	307·82	9,596·37	63·11	·36	25·97	6·37
Balasore	303·26	9,346·41	178·40	111·55	16·86	3·52
Puri	224·95	9,677·32	37·11	·02	54·63	5·97
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU	**3,076·42**	**3,082·18**	**1,209·01**	**2,004·55**	**611·13**	**16·71**
Hazaribagh	9,177·09	·65	60·76	740·91	11·28	9·21
Ranchi	4,283·01	47·42	86·57	2,994·06	2,579·99	8·95
Palamau	9,290·96	·09	3·97	138·01	564·47	2·50
Manbhum	2,117·95	12·15	6,354·05	1,486·90	13·72	15·23
Singhbhum	494·29	1,794·27	1,563·72	6,003·77	114·03	29·92
Sonthal Parganas	4,451·80	·75	1,456·83	3,720·12	354·85	15·65
Angul	22·36	7,320·96	7·72	21·30	2,623·35	4·31
Sambalpur	949·35	8,341·68	13·11	199·88	437·24	58·74
Orissa States	293·64	7,564·03	214·11	1,397·08	515·18	15·90
Chota Nagpur States	635·33	2,896·68	1,859·05	4,539·07	58·33	11·57

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—Comparison of Caste and Language Tables.

Language.	Strength of tribe (Table XIII).	Number speaking tribal languages (Table X).
1	2	3
I—ARYAN SUB-FAMILY—		
1. BANJARI—		
Bihar and Orissa	6,826	5,747
II—TIBETO-BURMAN SUB-FAMILY—		
1. TOTAL BHOTIA—		
Bengal	16,936	13,984
Sikkim	12,414	12,433
TOTAL	***29,350***	***26,417***
(a) SHARPA BHOTIA—		
Bengal	5,329	4,217
Sikkim	1,548	1,578
TOTAL	***6,877***	***5,795***
(b) BHOTIA OF SIKKIM—		
Bengal	1,234	1,151
Sikkim	10,251	10,411
TOTAL	***11,485***	***11,562***
(c) BHOTIA OF BHUTAN—		
Bengal	5,150	3,989
Sikkim	189	4
TOTAL	***5,339***	***3,993***
(d) BHOTIA (TIBETAN OR UNSPECIFIED)—		
Bengal	5,223	4,627
Sikkim	426	440
TOTAL	***5,649***	***5,067***
2. BODO, MECH OR PLAINS KACHARI—		
Bengal	22,540	21,726
3. GARO—		
Bengal	43,001	38,773
4. GURUNG—		
Bengal	10,961	1,030
Sikkim	6,058	22
TOTAL	***17,019***	***1,052***
5. JIMDAR—		
Bengal	43,290	39,260
Sikkim	15,814	15,803
TOTAL	***59,104***	***55,063***
6. KHAMBU—		
Bengal	1,811	823
Sikkim	67	27
TOTAL	***1,878***	***850***
7. KHAMTI—		
Bengal	1,461	1,050
8. KHYANG—		
Bengal	791	501
9. KOCH—		
Bengal	125,046	6,598
10. KUKI—		
Bengal	5,563	9,527
II—TIBETO-BURMAN SUB-FAMILY—concluded.		
11. KUKI (HALLAM)—		
Bengal	5,611	2,941
12. LEPCHA—		
Bengal	11,083*	11,328
Sikkim	9,233	9,278
TOTAL	***20,316***	***20,606***
13. LIMBU—		
Bengal	16,878	13,944
Sikkim	8,584	8,445
TOTAL	***25,462***	***22,389***
14. LUSHEI—		
Bengal	59	581
15. MANGAR—		
Bengal	21,516	13,521
Sikkim	3,182	3,026
Bihar and Orissa	874	26
TOTAL	***25,572***	***16,573***
16. †MANIPURI—		
Bengal	16,419	16,613
17. MRU (MURUNG)—		
Bengal	13,391	11,284
18. MURMI—		
Bengal	30,900	28,599
Sikkim	7,446	7,355
TOTAL	***38,346***	***35,954***
19. NEWARI—		
Bengal	9,602	5,599
Sikkim	2,947	1,270
Bihar and Orissa	157	11
TOTAL	***12,706***	***6,880***
20. SUNUWAR—		
Bengal	4,323	3,556
Sikkim	984	908
TOTAL	***5,307***	***4,464***
21. TIPURA (TIPARA)—		
Bengal	130,025	126,269
22. TOTO—		
Bengal	235	256
23. YAKHA—		
Bengal	1,283	1,311
Sikkim	26	24
TOTAL	***1,309***	***1,335***
III—MUNDA SUB-FAMILY—		
1. ‡AGARIA—		
Bihar and Orissa	3,039	112
2. ASURI—		
Bengal	1,100	790
Bihar and Orissa	3,716	3,216
TOTAL	***4,816***	***4,006***

The figures in columns 2 and 5 include not only Hindus, Animists and Buddhists, but also Christians.

* There were also 1,598 persons in Darjeeling returned as Indian Christians, without specification of caste or race, whose language was entered as Lepcha.

† The Manipuris were returned as Kshattriyas by caste.

‡ Agaria is spoken by a hill tribe in Chota Nagpur. There is also a cultivating caste of the same name in Orissa, the members of which speak Oriya; the figures for the latter caste are excluded.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—Comparison of Caste and Language Tables—*concluded.*

Language.	Strength of tribe (Table XIII).	Number speaking tribal languages (Table X).	Language.	Strength of tribe (Table XIII).	Number speaking tribal languages (Table X).
1	2	3	4	5	6
III—MUNDA SUB-FAMILY—concld.					
3. BHUMIJ—			12. SANTALI—		
Bengal	90,282	21,263	Bengal ... ... Total ...	685,385	664,459
Bihar and Orissa	272,694	105,866	Mahli ...	*15,965*	*3,200*
TOTAL	***362,976***	***127,129***			
4. BIRHAR—			Bihar and Orissa ... Total ...	1,493,331	1,419,357
Bihar and Orissa	2,340	1,013	Karmali ...	*21,842*	*7,125*
5. BIRJIA—			Mahli ...	*64,159*	*22,069*
Bihar and Orissa	1,415	1,323	TOTAL	***2178,716***	***2,083,816***
6. HO—			13. TURI—		
Bengal	1,349	3,530	Bengal	17,666	3,748
Bihar and Orissa	420,422	416,456	Bihar and Orissa	47,429	2,701
TOTAL	***421,771***	***419,986***	TOTAL	***65,095***	***6,449***
7. JUANG—			***IV—DRAVIDIAN FAMILY—***		
Bihar and Orissa	12,840	12,313	1. GOND—		
8. KHARIA—			Bihar and Orissa	235,690	4,212
Bengal	16,105	6,437	2. KANDH—		
Bihar and Orissa	133,872	107,190	Bihar and Orissa	302,883	136,711
TOTAL	***149,977***	***113,627***	3. MALTO (Sauria Paharia)—		
9 KORA—			Bengal	1,661	1,668
Bengal	46,497	19,958	Bihar and Orissa	63,203	63,207
Bihar and Orissa	48,983	4,077	TOTAL	***64,864***	***64,875***
TOTAL	***95,480***	***24,035***	4. ORAON—		
10. KORWA—			Bengal	165,337	117,256
Bihar and Orissa	14,231	8,717	Bihar and Orissa	587,411	559,495
11 MUNDARI—			TOTAL	***750,048***	***676,751***
Bengal	67,252	50,298			
Bihar and Orissa	490,948	475,416			
TOTAL	***558,200***	***525,714***			

The figures in columns 2 and 5 include not only Hindus, Animists and Buddhists but also Christians.

Chapter X.

INFIRMITIES.

772. As at previous censuses, four infirmities have been recorded, viz., insanity, deaf-mutism from birth, total blindness and leprosy. The statistics compiled from the returns will be found in Imperial Tables XII and XII-A, the former of which shows the ages of afflicted persons and also their distribution according to locality, while the latter furnishes information regarding the infirmities from which different castes and tribes suffer. At the end of this chapter the following four subsidiary tables are given.

INTRODUCTORY.

Subsidiary Table I shows the number of persons afflicted in each district per 100,000 of the population at each of the last four censuses.

Subsidiary Table II shows the distribution of infirmities by age per 10,000 of each sex.

Subsidiary Table III shows the number afflicted per 100,000 at each age period and the number of females afflicted per 1,000 males.

Subsidiary Table IV gives the same information as Subsidiary Table III for each of the castes for which figures were compiled.

773. The instructions to the enumerators regarding the record of infirmities were that only persons who were blind of both eyes, or insane, or suffering from corrosive leprosy, or deaf and dumb from birth were to be entered in the schedules, and that those who were blind of one eye, or suffering from white leprosy only, or who had become deaf and dumb after birth were to be excluded. All possible care was taken to see that the instructions were followed, but it must be admitted that the results are not altogether complete and accurate, chiefly because the census staff consists of an improvised agency without medical knowledge. In the returns for insanity, persons who are not insane but merely weak-minded are entered, as well as those who are idiots or who suffer from violent forms of mental derangement. The deaf-mutes should be confined to those who have been deaf and dumb since their birth, but there is a tendency to enter persons who are only mute or only deaf, and among the latter to include elderly persons suffering from senile deafness. The blind similarly include those who are not totally blind, but whose sight has become impaired with old age: to a small extent also those persons who have lost the sight of one eye are apt to be entered as blind.

INSTRUCTIONS REGARDING THE RECORD OF INFIRMITIES.

Apart from errors made by the enumerators, there can be no doubt that the returns are not complete, owing to the deliberate concealment of facts by members of families in which there are persons suffering from one or other of the infirmities in question. This part of the census work is regarded, especially by the better classes, as an unfair inquisition. They are by no means inclined to give the enumerator an insight into their family troubles, and their reluctance is all the greater in the case of their women, more particularly daughters of marriageable age. It is for this reason largely that males suffering from infirmities outnumber the females by three to two. On this and other accounts the statistics of infirmities are, next to the returns for age, the least satisfactory of those obtained by the census.

774. The total number of persons in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa suffering from each infirmity, as recorded at each of the last four censuses, is noted in the margin. It will be observed that whereas there was a general and steady decline for every infirmity between 1881 and 1901, the last decade has witnessed an increase in all cases except that of leprosy. The decrease in the first 20 years was not peculiar to Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, but common throughout

VARIATIONS.

Infirmity.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
Insane	24,530	22,941	25,628	30,675
Deaf-mutes	59,843	53,154	70,165	85,495
Blind	73,998	70,859	73,480	97,350
Lepers	35,320	37,377	46,390	56,523
Total ...	*193,691*	*184,331*	*215,663*	*270,043*

India, and was attributed to the higher standard attained at each successive census, *i.e.*, to the exclusion from the returns of persons whose infirmities did not fall within the scope of the definitions given in the instructions to the census staff. The variations since 1901 will be discussed, later in this chapter, in the sections dealing with each infirmity. Here it will be sufficient to state that the increase is all the more noticeable, in view of the greater accuracy of enumeration. *A priori*, the exclusion of erroneous entries should have resulted in a decrease, but on the other hand some increase was to be expected on the present occasion, owing to the improvement in the process of tabulation resulting from the use of special slips for infirmities. These two factors may be taken as counterbalancing one another and the figures may be accepted as representing the actual variations during the last ten years. At the same time, it must be remembered that the increase in the number of afflicted persons has been only 5 per cent., whereas the increase in the population has been 7 per cent.

DISTRIBUTION.

775. The marginal figures show the number of afflicted persons, and their proportion per 100,000 of the population, in each of the two provinces dealt with in this report.[1] Insanity is much more prevalent in Bengal, the number of insane persons being both actually and relatively four times as great as in Bihar and Orissa.[1] Blindness however, is far commoner in the latter province, as is only natural considering its hot dry climate. There is not much difference in the figures for lepers and deaf-mutes, but relatively Bihar and Orissa suffers most.

INFIRMITY.	BENGAL.		BIHAR AND ORISSA.	
	Number.	Proportion.	Number.	Proportion.
Insane	19,978	43	4,552	12
Deaf-mutes	32,125	69	27,718	72
Blind	32,747	71	41,251	107
Lepers	17,489	38	17,835	46
Total ...	*101,681*	*220*	*91,152*	*237*

AGE RETURNS.

776. Diagrams showing the age distribution of afflicted persons of both sexes are given later in this chapter for each infirmity. Here it may be stated, in order to avoid repetition later, that they have one common feature.[1] The number of children under 10 years of age is small in all cases, because parents are naturally reluctant to recognize the existence of infirmities in their children or to acknowledge that they are afflicted so long as there is any real prospect or imaginary hope of recovery. The returns for children consequently cannot be said to represent the facts completely.

RACE AND CASTE.

777. A note of warning must also be sounded regarding the statistics of infirmities by race, nationality, tribe or caste given in Subsidiary Table IV. Proportional figures are given in this table, and sometimes they yield extraordinary results if the actual figures are not referred to. It will be seen, for instance, that in Bengal the highest incidence of insanity among females (347 per 100,000) is found among the Chasas, a respectable caste of Oriya cultivators, but actually only one female of that caste was returned as insane. The relative figures for the caste in Bengal, also show an extraordinarily high incidence both of blindness and leprosy, but the figures are worked out from only 19 blind persons and 15 lepers, who were presumably emigrants from their homes. Very different results are apparent in the returns for Bihar and Orissa, where the total number of Chasas dealt with was over 800,000. In other cases too it will be seen that the proportion is very much higher for castes enumerated away from their homes. For instance, the figures for the Dhanuks, a Bihari caste, are very much higher in Bengal than in Bihar and Orissa, and the same is the case with the Rajwars, a caste found mainly in South Bihar and Chota Nagpur. In view of these circumstances, abnormal figures for castes outside the province of origin will not be taken into account in the subsequent sections dealing with the distribution of infirmities by castes.

In Bengal those who returned themselves as Kaibarttas without further specification appear to suffer most from different infirmities. The incidence of

[1] The details in the statement do not agree with the total, owing to the former including, and the latter excluding, double infirmities.

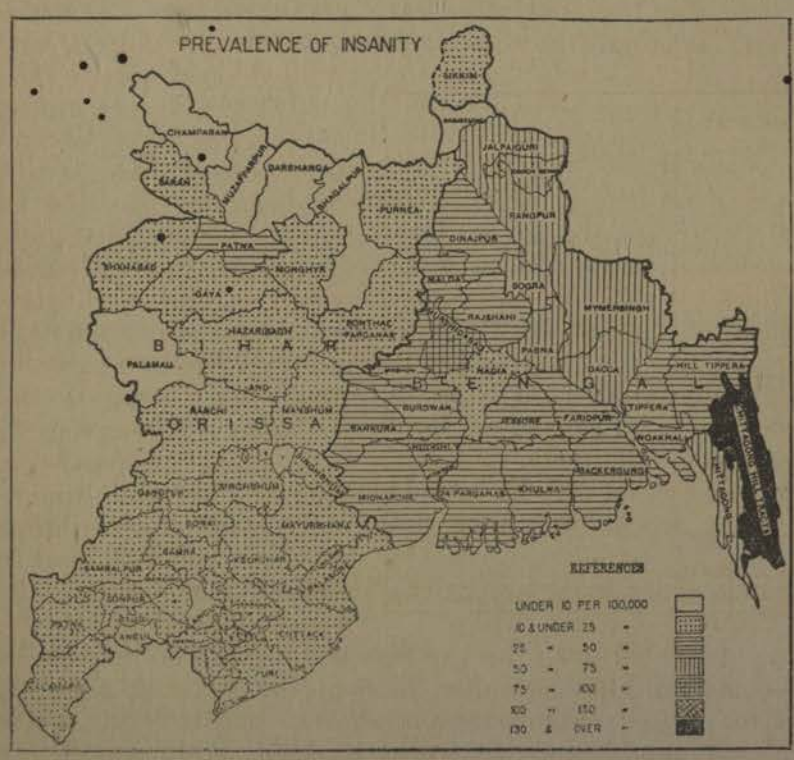
infirmities is very much lower among the Jaliya Kaibarttas, who are mostly fishermen, and the Chasi Kaibarttas or Mahishyas who are mostly cultivators. In Bihar and Orissa those unfortunate persons who have lost caste, and bear the generic name of Ajat, appear to be the most afflicted. A high general incidence (except for insanity) is also found among the Saraks, a small caste, mostly weavers by occupation, who are descendants of the early Jains and still have a vegetarian diet.

INSANITY.

779. In Bengal every district and State except Darjeeling and Nadia has a ratio of over 25 insane persons per 100,000 of the population, but in no part of Bihar and Orissa does the proportion rise to that figure except in Patna, where there is a central lunatic asylum. In five districts, moreover, viz., Champaran, Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga and Bhagalpur (which form a solid block in the north of the province), Palamau and Angul, as well as in the Chota Nagpur States, the proportion falls below 10 per 100,000.

DISTRIBUTION OF INSANITY.

In Bengal insanity is most prevalent on the eastern side of the Bhagirathi, and the greatest incidence is found in North Bengal and East Bengal. The highest district ratio is returned by the Chittagong Hill Tracts (157 per 100,000) and then by Cooch Behar (71), Jalpaiguri (71), and Chittagong (68). The high ratio of Murshidabad (75). is simply due to its containing a central lunatic asylum : excluding the inmates drawn from outside districts, the ratio is one of the lowest in Bengal. The reasons for the high incidence in these districts are obscure. It is noticeable, however, that Chittagong and the Chittagong Hill Tracts adjoin Burma, where insanity is very common, and that a considerable portion of the population have a Burmese strain. The Maghs, who are descended from Burmese either in the immediate or remote past, have an unusually large proportion of insane persons (8 per 10,000). It is difficult to draw any inferences regarding Cooch Behar and Jalpaiguri. There is very little insanity in Darjeeling and Sikkim to the north, and it is not specially prevalent in Rangpur and Dinajpur to the south. Nor can it be said to be due to the constitution of the population, as the Mongolian element is far stronger in Darjeeling and Sikkim. and the proportion of insane persons among the Koches of Bengal is unusually small. On the other hand, it is fairly high among the Meches, a distinctively Mongolian race, and among the Rajbansis, who are believed to be allied to the Koches, if not of the same descent. In Bihar and Orissa the local variations are comparatively small. Insanity is most prevalent in Orissa, and then in South Bihar, while it is least common in North Bihar. Outside Orissa the worst districts are Ranchi, Manbhum, Singhbhum and Sambalpur.

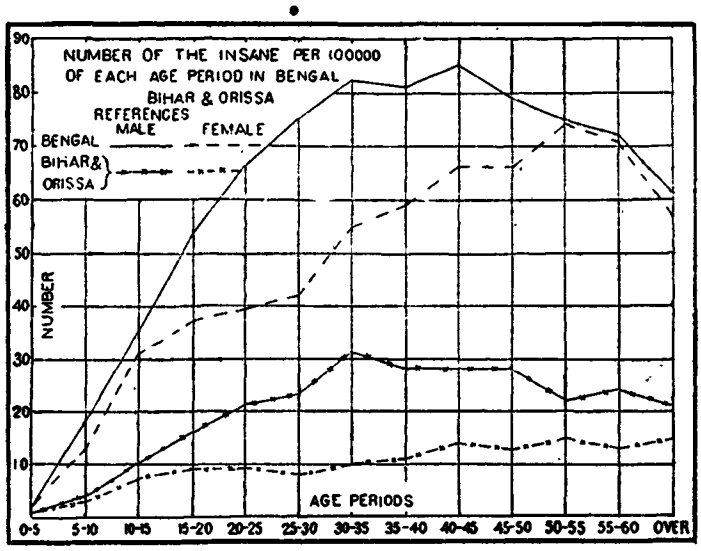


VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

780. Between 1891 and 1901 the number of insane persons in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, according to the census returns, decreased by 10 per cent., but the present census shows an increase of 7 per cent. The general population, however, has grown at the same rate, so that proportionately the number of insane persons is the same as in 1901, viz., 35 per 100,000 among males and 23 per 100,000 among females. In Bengal the ratio for males is exactly the same as it was in 1901, but among females it has risen by 1 per 100,000. In Bihar and Orissa, however, there has been a decrease of 1 per 100,000 both among the male and female population. The decrease here may be ascribed, in part at least, to more accurate enumeration. It is noticeable that the proportion of children below 10 years of age to the total number is 5 per cent. in this province and 6 per cent. in Bengal, whereas in 1901 it was 7 per cent. in the two Provinces taken together: the difference is probably due to a smaller number of the congenitally weak-minded being included in the returns. In Bengal there are marked local variations. There has been a considerable decrease in the number of insane persons in West Bengal, but elsewhere there is an increase. In Central Bengal the rise is due to the concentration of lunatics since 1901 in the central lunatic asylum at Berhampore in the Murshidabad district. If this district is left out of account, the number of insane persons in Central Bengal is stationary.

INSANITY BY AGE.

781. The marginal diagram shows the number of insane persons of both sexes per 100,000 of the population. The number is small in early youth, because insanity is an infirmity of maturity. It is naturally not so common among children, with undeveloped minds and sheltered lives, as among adults who have to face the wear-and-tear of life. Among males the rise is most marked from 25 to 35 years of age, the period when mental equilibrium is most affected by passion, domestic trouble and the struggle for existence. Between 35 and 45 the proportion in Bengal remains practically stationary and then steadily declines, but in Bihar and Orissa the decrease begins at 35, though there is no heavy drop till 50. In the case of females the increase is more gradual, the period at which the number increases most being 25 to 45, *i.e.*, the child-bearing age. Briefly, the diagram shows that in both sexes insanity is a disease of early manhood or womanhood and of middle age.



DISTRIBUTION AMONG THE SEXES.

782. In Bihar and Orissa there are 2 insane males to every insane female. There is far less disparity between the sexes in Bengal, where the numbers are 3 to 2. The proportion of females to males is lowest in West Bengal (1 to 2) and highest in North Bengal (4 to 5): the proportion in East Bengal is nearly as high as in the latter division. The age statistics further show that at every age period insanity is relatively more common among females in Bengal than in Bihar and Orissa. Among young children aged 0—5 in the former Province, there are 110 insane girls to every 100 insane boys: the proportion falls to under 70 between 5 and 15 years of age and then rises to 75 at 15—20. After 20, it gradually sinks until there are 65 females to every 100 males at the age period of 45 to 50, after which the disparity between the sexes almost disappears. The proportion of females in Bihar and Orissa is far smaller, for, except among women over 50 years of age, it is always below 60. Both the census returns and the returns of admission to lunatic asylums show that insanity among women is less common than in European countries.

According to the late Major Robertson Milne, I.M.S., Superintendent of Central Lunatic Asylum at Berhampore, "Were it not for the *pardah* system, it is highly probable that the numbers of the women patients would be very much increased. But even taking that into consideration, and as the result of private inquiries, the fact remains that the women of India are less liable to mental disorders than are their European sisters."*

DISTRIBUTION BY RACE AND CASTE.

783. In considering the returns of insanity by race and caste, the figures for males only will be taken into account (except for Europeans and Anglo-Indians), the returns for females being not altogether reliable. At the head of the list stand the Kaibarttas of Bengal other than Chasi or Jaliya with a proportion of 244 per 100,000, and then the poor outcastes of Bihar and Orissa known as Ajat (231). The Bengal Baniya comes third, and next to him the Anglo-Indian, with a ratio of 160 for males and 181 for females. Insanity among the Europeans is far less common, the proportions being 96 and 147 respectively. Both among Anglo-Indians and Europeans the females appear to be more liable to loss of reason than males: the explanation in the case of Europeans is undoubtedly that the men are a picked race, many of whom have to pass a medical examination before coming to this country, and that women transplanted to India are more easily affected by the trials of a monotonous life in a tropical climate and an uncongenial environment. The only other castes in which the proportion is over 100 per 100,000 are the Baidyas and Bhumij of Bengal.

LUNATIC ASYLUMS.

784. The number of persons confined in lunatic asylums at the time of the census was 1,241 (1,019 males and 222 females), or 298 more than in 1901. There are three lunatic asylums in Bengal, situated at Bhawanipore (in Calcutta), Berhampore and Dacca: the former is intended for Europeans and Anglo-Indians only, and the two latter for Indians. In Bihar and Orissa there is only one asylum situated at Patna (Bankipore). The number of insane persons in these asylums is comparatively small. Not only is the accommodation limited, but under the law in force in India only criminals, or persons who are declared dangerous to themselves or to others, or who are wandering about without proper guardianship and unable to take care of themselves, can be sent to asylums. The majority of lunatics are kept by their friends, and it is only when they have committed crimes, or have become homeless vagabonds, or dangerous to the public, that they can be confined in a lunatic asylum.

About two-fifths of the inmates are criminal lunatics, who have been admitted under one or other of the sections of the law relating to lunatics. The first class includes those persons who, being accused of having committed a crime, are found, after due observation by a medical officer, to be of unsound mind, and consequently incapable of making a defence; in other words, they are held to be unable to understand the nature of the proceedings against them and to be unfit for trial. Their cases are then remanded under section 466 of the Criminal Procedure Code for the orders of Government, which authorizes the detention of the accused in an asylum until he is declared fit to stand his trial, or until further orders. The second class includes those who, having been tried for their crimes and found guilty, are declared to have been insane at the time of the crime and unable to realize the nature of their act, or that it was wrong or contrary to law. They are then acquitted on the ground of insanity, and the case is referred to Government, which may direct their confinement in an asylum or some other suitable place of custody. A lunatic may, in such cases, be made over to the care and custody of a friend or relative on the latter giving security. The accommodation in the asylums being limited, the policy is to restrict admissions to lunatics (1) who are dangerous, (2) who are absolutely incapable and have no one to look after them, and (3) whose criminal propensities are a real nuisance to society. Increased strictness has eliminated the less serious cases of lunacy, and the inmates are, to a very large extent, hopeless cases.†

* *Clinical Report on the Berhampore Asylum for 1909*, Indian Medical Gazette, May, 1910.

† Resolution on the Triennial Report on Lunatic Asylums in Bengal (1909—11).

TYPES OF INSANITY.

785. A considerable proportion of the lunatics admitted to the asylums suffer from "Toxic (hemp-drug) Insanity," due to indulgence in *ganja* (*Cannabis sativa* v. *Indica*), which is smoked with tobacco: of 103 male patients admitted into the Berhampore Asylum in 1909, insanity could be definitely ascribed to previous indulgence in *ganja* in no less than 32 cases.* Insanity of this kind always takes the form of a state of mental exaltation, accompanying or succeeding which there is a certain degree of mental enfeeblement. The cases may be classified under four heads as follows :—

(1) *Ganja* intoxication.—This is a mild state of mania, lasting from a few hours to a few days, which may be recognized by two symptoms. There is, first, a tendency to talkativeness of a foolish, delusional, and often incoherent character, and, secondly, a tendency to the performance of mischievous or indecent acts. The condition it induces is, however, different from that produced by alcohol, for the gait of the *ganja* inebriate is but slightly ataxic, and his movements and actions exhibit a purposiveness not seen in the alcoholic drunkard. These cases of *ganja* intoxication are comparatively rarely seen in the asylums.

(2) Acute *ganja* mania.—This is an acute state of mental exaltation and confusion, characterized by fleeting delusions of grandeur, and often also of persecution, by restlessness, and sometimes by indecency and destructiveness: sleeplessness is another prominent feature. The patient grimaces, gesticulates, is noisy, garrulous and forgetful of time and place; he neither knows nor cares where he is, how long he has been there, or whence he has come. These cases have a duration of about fourteen days to two months. Improvement is gradual as a rule, but sometimes recovery is extraordinarily abrupt. The recovery is, however, rarely complete, and generally the patient is left with some degree of weak-mindedness.

(3) Chronic *ganja* mania.—The symptoms are identical with those of acute mania, with which indeed this type of insanity commences. The patient lapses into a state of mild sub-acute mania, of which the salient features are extreme irritability and a tendency to garrulousness, which is often abusive. He suffers from fleeting delusions of exaltation and a poor memory of time and place. This condition may continue for many years, and terminates generally in weak-mindedness, very rarely in complete dementia.

(4) Weak-mindedness.—This is the insanity resulting from constant indulgence in *ganja* to excess, which has been described by Dr. Warnock of the Cairo Asylum under the name of *Cannabina Mania*. Irritability, an extremely defective memory for place and time, foolish but mild delusions of grandeur (which are never fixed but vary from day to day or week to week), a tendency to loquacity and indolence are the main features of this type. As in all varieties of hemp-drug mental disorders, general sensibility is diminished. Many of the persons suffering from this form of *ganja* insanity are either *sadhus* or their disciples: it is this diminished sensibility which enables *fakirs* and *sadhus* to undergo such painful ordeals as lying on beds of nails, etc. In India it might be termed "Sadhuistic insanity," for it is the insanity with which many of its religious ascetics are afflicted.

786. The second main type of insanity is "Toxic (alcoholic) insanity," which is due to excessive indulgence in alcohol. There is reason to believe that alcohol, as a causative factor in the production of mental disorder, is becoming of increasing importance, owing to a growth of intemperance among the lower castes. The latter formerly had bouts of drunkenness on days of festival, but now their bouts are not confined to feasts and festivals. The third type is "Epileptic insanity," which need not be described, and the fourth is "General paralysis of the insane." The latter is so far a comparatively rare disease among natives of India, though lamentably frequent in Europe: Colonel G. F. A. Harris, I.M.S., C.S.I., Inspector-General of Civil Hospitals, Bengal, states that in 30 years he has only seen three genuine cases in India, the subjects being a Hindu, an Afghan and an Armenian.† The fifth type is "Systematised delusional insanity (Paranoia)," which is

* The proportion in 1911 was 38 per cent.

† Annual Returns of the Lunatic Asylums in Bengal for 1910.

also rare. Lunatics suffering from this form of insanity have strong delusions of persecution and inflated ideas of their dignity. Such cases are very intractable and rarely recover. The sixth type is "Homicidal melancholia," *i.e.*, melancholia of a homicidal character, and the seventh type is "Phthisical insanity." Beggars are specially liable to the latter. As long as they can get enough to keep them in fair health, they do not, as a rule, suffer mentally, provided they do not indulge in drugs. But should they be afflicted by tuberculosis, the progressive asthenia of that complaint makes them less able to follow their calling. This preys on their minds, and they suffer from an irritable melancholia. Tuberculosis, it may be added, is four times commoner in the insane than in the sane, and is fostered by their associations and habits.*

BELIEFS ABOUT INSANITY.

787. The educated classes believe that insanity is due to mental disorder, for which various things may be responsible, such as family bereavements, financial losses, disappointment in love, religious fanaticism, the immoderate use of intoxicating liquor or drugs, especially *ganja*, etc. It is commonly attributed to excessive indulgence in sexual passion, and also to abstinence from sexual intercourse when maturity has been obtained. This latter belief often leads to unfortunate results. When a youth is seen to be in danger of becoming insane, the consummation of the marriage which he contracted as a boy is hurried on as a means of saving him. His tottering reason is only too often overthrown and hopeless lunacy ensues. The power of drugs to produce insanity is firmly believed in, and it is generally agreed that it is frequently caused by love philtres given by neglected wives in the hope of winning or regaining their husband's love.

788. The lower classes have a curious medley of ideas on the subject. Physically, insanity is thought to be due to an excess of bile in the system or to worms in the head. Ultimately it is due to the anger of the gods or evil spirits. Neglect of the worship of the gods, or the curse of a *yogi*, *sadhu* or other holy man, may produce it; it is specially liable to attack those who practise Tantric arts but fail to control the spirits they evoke, and devotees of Kali who gaze upon frightful spectres, while worshipping at the dead of night at a burning ghât or sitting on dead bodies. Generally, however, it is attributed to demoniacal possession. The evil spirit may be moved by motives of passion as well of vindictiveness. *e.g.*, a male spirit may take possession of a girl of prepossessing appearance, while female spirits enter into handsome young men. The spirit which is most commonly thought to produce madness is Brahmadaitya, the spirit of Brahman who has died an unnatural death, *e.g.*, by murder or suicide. This spirit dwells in *pipal* trees: to spit on the root of a pipal tree in which Brahmadaitya resides, or to make water in its shade, is fatal to the reason. Another curious belief is that persons with yellow moustaches or with tapering heads are apt to become insane.

BELIEFS OF ABORIGINALS.

789. The beliefs of the aboriginal races are similarly primitive. The Hos believe that insanity is caused either by excess of bile, or by the wrath of a *bonga* or evil spirit at some insult or injury, *e.g.*, when money is buried by a man and removed by some one else after his death (the idea being that they are the property of the *bonga*), or when the *bonga's* residence (a tree, river or hill) is desecrated by a man easing himself or making water. The cutting of trees in a sacred grove (*jahira*) also amounts to desecration and produces insanity, but this belief is not much of a deterrent when the supply of wood for domestic purposes is disappearing. The Bhumij believe that insanity is the result of the possession of evil spirits (*bhuts*) or of the evil eye of witches. If an exorcist or witch-doctor fails to effect a cure, it is believed that it is a disease due to a disordered brain or the consequence of some sin committed by the lunatic. It may, for instance, be caused by disrespect to the family *bhut*, failure to subscribe for the worship of the village deity, or desecration of the sacred grove; or it may be the result of a man having fallen a victim to some powerful evil spirit, whom he tried to exorcise. The Santals similarly believe that insanity is due to possession by

* Major C. J. Robertson-Milne, I.M.S., *Clinical Report on the Berhampore Asylum for the year 1909*, Indian Medical Gazette, Vol. XLV, No. 5, May 1910.

bongas or evil spirits, either because of the enmity of a witch who has control over a *bonga*, or because a *bonga* has fallen in love with a human being. In the former case the *bonga* is supposed to work the wicked will of the witch as a reward for her allowing herself to be seduced by him. In the latter case, the *liaison* with the *bonga* may go on without any evil consequence, but on the other hand it may end in insanity and death. The belief among the Kandhs (Khonds) is similar to that of the Hos. According to them, a mild attack of insanity is caused by an excess of bile in the system, while a severe form is attributed to obsession by either the Earth goddess or the Hill god.

BELIEFS OF THE HILL RACES.

790. The Nepalese attribute insanity to the following causes—(1) The direct or indirect influence of evil spirits who desire their victims to become their slaves after death; (2) the effects of poisonous herbs, roots or fruits administered in food or in drink, by enemies; (3) the curse of an elderly man laid on a younger member of the same or of a different family; (4) accidental injuries to the head; and (5) mental trouble due to anxiety, grief, disappointment, excessive sexual indulgence and immoderate drinking. The Lepchas and Bhotias also attribute insanity to the black magic of sorcerers, such as Paharia Bijuas, Dhamis or Jhankins, Limbu Yabus and Lepcha Phön-böns, who use their evil craft at the instigation of some enemy. Sometimes it is believed to be the result of the wrath of an unappeased family deity or the evil influence of a malignant spirit called Gyalpo. Insanity in a male is attributed to a Gyalpo, but insanity or idiocy in a woman to a female water sprite called Men-wö. The learned believe it to be a family taint, due to mysterious causes, *e.g.*, the intermarriage of close relations.*

BELIEFS REGARDING HEREDITY.

791. Insanity is believed to be hereditary, but it is recognized that it may skip a generation. It is thought that it is more easily transmitted through the mother, there being a saying that madness is due to a mother and ignorance to a father. Among the aboriginals, however, there appears to be no fixed idea about insanity being hereditary, but rather that when it persists in a family, it is due to the continued anger of an evil spirit. Thus, among the Bhumij, the recurrence of insanity in a family is attributed to their having erected their homestead, or reclaimed some land, in an enchanted place or having used timber from the sacred grove for the rafters of a house. The Santals again have no idea of causative connection, except in so far as they believe that the same family is persecuted by the same *bonga*. The Hos think that insanity cannot be transmitted, the idea being that it is the result of a personal offence or neglect. A son who does not take the precaution of appeasing the angry *bonga* that has afflicted his father with insanity, may also be attacked after his father's death, but this is only another expression of the same idea. The Kandhs (Khonds) consider that mild insanity can be transmitted from father to son, as the latter inherits the tendency to accumulation of bile. If, however, insanity appears in an acute form, it is believed that a deity has not been properly appeased by the father's sacrifices and still hungers for fresh victims.

METHODS OF TREATMENT.

292. Madness being due to possession by an evil spirit, every attempt is made to appease or exorcise it. In Midnapore, for instance, when a man is first attacked, exorcists (*ojhas* or *gunias*) are called in. They hold smoking chillies to the nostrils of the patient, chant *mantras*, addressing the spirit in filthy and obscene language, all with the idea of driving it away. When these means prove futile, they prescribe a diet calculated to force the spirit to leave his victim in fear of losing his caste, for Brahmadaitya is the spirit of a high-caste Brahman.† The unfortunate patient has therefore to consume soup made of toads, fæcal matter, etc. When these abominable nostrums fail, the use of medicated oils and of indigenous herbs and drugs is resorted to. Among the Santals there are elaborate ceremonies for exorcism, which proceeds by regular steps. The

* I am indebted for the above account to the Maharaj Kumar of Sikkim.

† Insulting forms of worship are not unknown. "Usually the object of the worshipper is to propitiate the deity he is addressing, but occasionally his aim seems to be to inspire disgust. Thus, in the worship of Alaksmi, the officiating Brahman offers jute leaves, not flowers, with his left, or impure, hand. The idea seems to be that the goddess will be annoyed at this treatment, and will in consequence depart elsewhere. (*Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal*, Part III, 1903, p. 31.)

first thing the *Ojha* does is to find out by divination whether he can effect a cure or not. He applies a little oil to two *sal* leaves, and rubs them together on the ground, muttering an incantation the while. By looking at the impressions formed on the leaves, he professes to know whether he will be able to do anything or not. He then proceeds to find out the *bonga's* name, how he is to be appeased, etc., and names the articles required, *e.g.*, animals for sacrifice, a nail of iron or copper, partly straight and partly twisted, etc. As soon as the patient's family have got them together, they ask him to appoint a day for his final work. On the day fixed the lunatic is made to touch the sacrificial animals, and the *Ojha* makes passes round him, at the same time repeating certain incantations. Next, the *Ojha* and some of the villagers take the animals outside the village boundary, where they sacrifice and eat them. When they have finished their meal, they return to the house, where the *Ojha* prepares medicine, which the patient takes. Then the whole company drink up the beer, which has been brewed for the occasion. The medicine is repeated at intervals. The family wait a year and if in the meantime the patient recovers, they give the *Ojha* his fees; if there is no cure, he gets nothing. The *Ojha* is more fortunate than other practitioners, as he is allowed a year for his cure to work. Less formal methods are employed by the Bhumij. The exorcist smears a leaf with oil, looks into it and then declares the patient to be possessed by a certain spirit. He then performs a ceremony of exorcism, which consists of incantations appropriate to the spirit concerned, after which a black goat (or sometimes a lamb), 2 or 3 cocks, a girdle, a garland, a small basket and a looking-glass are offered for the propitiation of the evil spirit. Among the Khonds the earth goddess demands the sacrifice of a pig, the hill god of a goat; if these prove ineffectual, the mad man is left to his fate.

793. Among Bengalis offerings are made to Kali on the day of the new moon in the hope of effecting a cure. The most popular of her shrines is that at Tirol in the Arambagh subdivision of the Hooghly district. Insane persons are taken and *puias* performed, after which the priests give an iron bracelet (*bala*) for the lunatic to wear. Great is the fame of Kali's bracelet. "I had," writes a correspondent, "occasion to pass through this village about two years ago, and the villagers extolled its virtues to such an extent that I could hardly believe them. They told me that not only Hindus, but people of other nationalities, and even Europeans, resort to the village for the cure of insane: that however turbulent or boisterous the mad person may be, he becomes as quiet as a lamb when he comes within the precincts of the village. Such is the influence of the goddess." It is not absolutely necessary that the insane person should be taken to Tirol. The consecrated *bala* can be brought from it by a member of the family, and the priests will also send one by parcel post, if ordered. The bracelet is worn for life, or is sent back to the temple if a cure is effected, in which case thank-offerings are made. Flowers taken from Kali's shrine are also efficacious if put in a small metal casket and worn as an amulet. Amulets called *kabaj*, *i.e.*, charms written or carved on the leaves of the *bhuria* plant, are worn with the same idea, and in the case of Musalmans, texts from the Koran.

In Bihar alms are given away in the hope of procuring the favour of the gods. The colour of the articles distributed varies according to the god propitiated. If Saturn's goodwill is to be won, everything must be of a reddish colour, such as red cloth, red wheat and red *gur*; if Saturn, they must all be black, *e.g.*, black cloth, black iron, black *til*, black *urid*, etc. Here too the bracelet of "Pagla Kali" is held in repute.

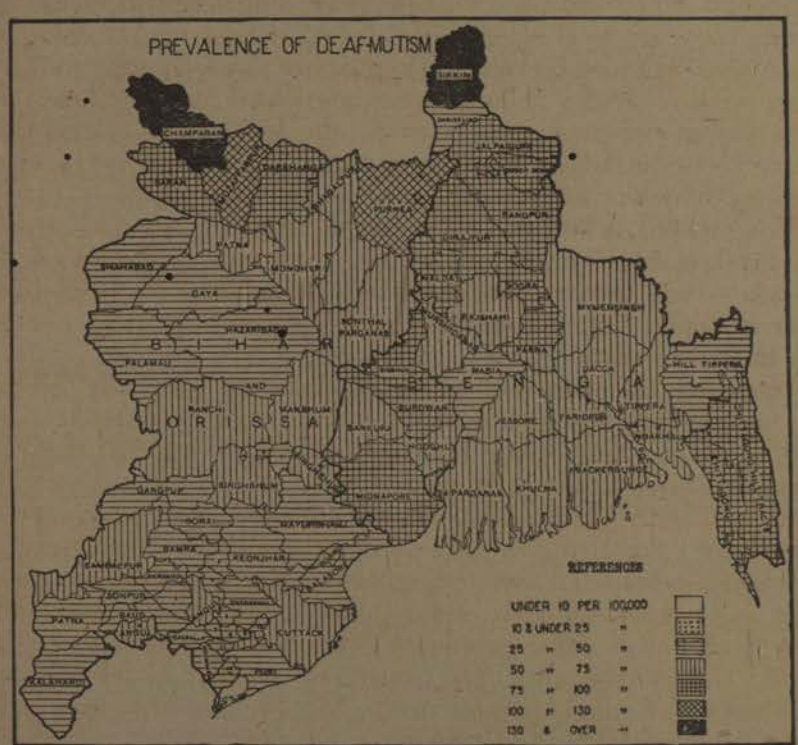
794. The medical treatment of the insane is designed with an eye to its cooling effects on the brain and nervous system. Ordinarily, a lunatic person's head is shaved to admit of a free application of medicinal oils, which are specially prepared by Kavirajes to keep the head cool. In acute stages he is made to drink the milk of green cocoanuts, which have been buried for 24 hours in soft silt at the bottom of old tanks. He is also made to bathe once a day, if not oftener, in old tanks choked with weeds and vegetable matter, the water of which is considered cooler than that of fresh water tanks. Sometimes, too, the mud taken from these putrid tanks is plastered on its head, or aloe pulp is mixed with water and applied in the form of an

emulsion. Cool drinks are given and a simple diet of pot-herbs. A favourite remedy is soup made from a particular kind of frog (called *sona bang* or the golden frog) and soup prepared from a vegetable known as *susuni sak*. The juice or sap of palm leaves and various roots, plants or trees, such as plantains and fig trees, is also administered. If violent, he is confined in a dark room, and either bound hand and foot or has a heavy clog of wood fastened to his ankle. Altogether, the lunatic's life in Bengal is not a happy one.

DEAF-MUTISM.

795. Deaf-mutism is most prevalent in Sikkim, North Bihar and North Bengal. Sikkim is by far the most affected area, 27 per 10,000 of its population being deaf-mutes, while Champaran is far ahead of any other district, with a ratio of 17 per 10,000. The average is only about half this latter figure in the other districts in which the infirmity is prevalent, viz., Saran, Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga, Purnea, Malda, Dinajpur, Jalpaiguri and the State of Cooch Behar. All these districts and States lie to the north of the Ganges and are watered by Himalayan rivers: in all of them deaf-mutism is associated with cretinism and goitre.* In adjoining districts also the number of deaf-mutes is well above the average. In the Siliguri subdivision of Darjeeling they represent 10 per 10,000 of the population and in Rangpur 8 per 10,000: in the latter district over 5,000 cases of goitre are treated annually, but even this figure gives no indication of the extent to which the disease prevails.†

LOCAL DISTRIBUTION.



796. In Champaran the area most affected is the south-western portion of the Motihari subdivision, which comprises the thanas of Motihari, Kesaria, Madhubani and Gobindganj. In these four thanas the ratio varies from 21 to 35 per 10,000, the latter figure being reached in the Motihari thana, which is watered by the Dhanauti. The affliction is not so prevalent in the north of the district, and is least common in the south-west, *i.e.*, in the Adapur and Dhaka thanas, the ratio falling to 6 per 10,000 in Adapur. The area of greatest incidence nearly exactly corresponds with the limits of the Majhawa *pargana*, which has a sinister reputation in Bihar. It is regarded as a home of idiots—to ask a man if he comes from Majhawa is tantamount to calling him an idiot, and deaf-mutes are known locally as Majhawa *bagar*. In the district, generally, the physique of the people is below that of the average Bihari. "In nearly every village there are a certain number of people who look miserable specimens of humanity, and in the district, as a whole, the proportion

* Goitre is also common in Bhutan, and cretinism is found there. Captain Kennedy, I.M.S., who accompanied the Political Officer in Sikkim on a mission to Bhutan in 1909-10, writes that, out of 202 cases treated by him, one in four had goitre, and there were two cretins. Goitre in Purnea, a centre of deaf-mutism, was noticed as early as 1788 A.D., when the author of the Riyazu-s-Salatin wrote: "Tumours of the throat, in men and women generally, as well as in wild beasts and birds, are common." This is not an exaggerated statement, as dogs, horses and fowls often have thyroid swellings in this and other districts.

† Rangpur District Gazetteer, p. 52.

of chronic invalids strikes one as unusually large. An unsightly form of goitre is very prevalent and the number of cretins is remarkable." * Deaf-mutism is specially prevalent near the Dhanauti, a tortuous river with an unhealthy neighbourhood. Formerly there were flourishing villages along its banks, but gradually the river-bed became silted up. Fever of a malignant type broke out and the population was decimated.†

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

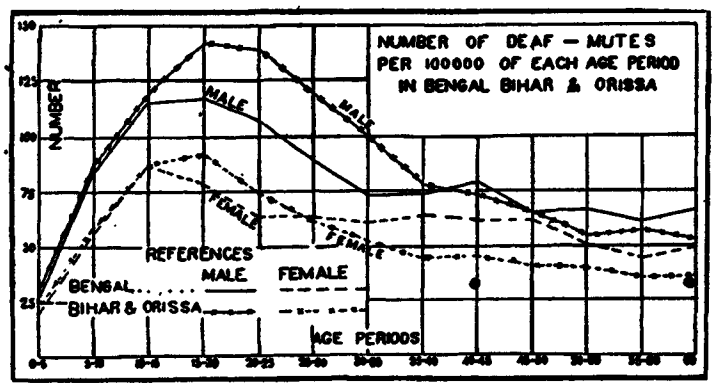
797. Since 1901 the number of deaf-mutes in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa has increased by 6,689 or 13 per cent., while in Sikkim it has risen by 7½ per cent. In Bengal, Bihar and Orissa the increase occurs both among those aged 20 and over, and also among those who are under 20 years of age, the latter being persons born during the decade or under ten years of age at the last census. Very little, if any, of the increase can be due to persons suffering only from senile deafness being returned under this head, for the number of deaf mutes aged 50 and over is only 167 or 4 per cent. more than in 1901. In that year they represented 8 per cent. of the total number, but now the proportion, though the same in Bengal, has fallen to 7 per cent. in Bihar and Orissa.

CENSUS.	UNDER 20 YEARS.		20 AND OVER	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1911	17,837	11,712	18,275	12,019
1901	16,868	10,628	15,641	10,017
Increase	969	1,084	2,634	2,002

798. The local variations are of a curious character. In the area of greatest prevalence there have been decreases in the extreme east in Champaran and Saran, but in nearly all the other districts there have been increases, viz., in Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga, Purnea, Malda and Dinajpur. On the other hand, there have been decreases in Bhagalpur, Darjeeling, Jalpaiguri and Cooch Behar. The decline in Cooch Behar and Jalpaiguri is small, but in Bhagalpur and Darjeeling it is so remarkable that it must probably be ascribed to insufficient enumeration: in the latter district it is noticeable that no deaf-mutes are found in two out of five thanas, and that the returns for all infirmities are far below those of 1901. In Saran the falling off is small, but it is considerable in Champaran, where every other infirmity has also lost ground except insanity. Both these districts suffered from famine in 1897, the former in a minor and the latter in a major degree; and the decrease might be attributed to its effects in thinning out these unfortunate persons who are largely dependent on charity. On the other hand, both Muzaffarpur and Darbhanga exhibit increases, though they were also famine-stricken in 1897 and have since suffered, the former from scarcity and the latter from two famines. Elsewhere there have been considerable increases in Cuttack, the Orissa States, Midnapore, the 24-Parganas, Faridpur, Bogra, Tippera and Chittagong.

DEAF-MUTISM BY AGE AND PROPORTION OF THE SEXES.

799. From the marginal diagram it will be seen that the number of deaf-mutes of either sex rises till the age period 10 to 15 in Bengal, and 15 to 20 in Bihar and Orissa, and then drops steadily. The explanation is that deaf-mutism is a congenital affection and that deaf-mutes generally are short-lived. At the same time, the paucity of deaf-mutes over the age of 40 to 45 is evidence of the comparative accuracy of the returns, persons afflicted with the deafness of old age being excluded from the schedules. As in other countries, there is a marked disproportion of the sexes, males being largely in excess. They preponderate most in Bengal, where there are approximately 8 males to every 6 females, the proportion in Bihar and Orissa



* Champaran Famine Report of 1897.
† Champaran District Gazetteer, p. 59.

being 9 to 6. In this latter Province there are 64 female deaf-mutes, and in Bengal there are 68, to every 100 males suffering from this affliction.

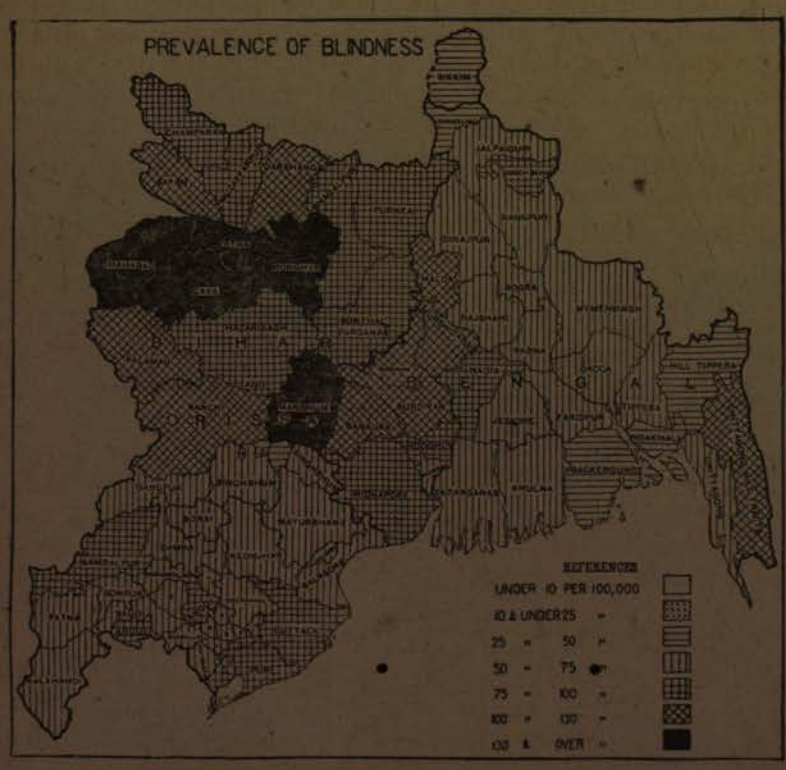
DEAF-MUTISM BY CASTE AND RACE.

800. Proportionately more deaf-mutes are found among the outcastes called Ajat than among any other caste or race, the ratio being as high as 1,755 per 100,000 among males and 1,444 among females. The distribution of Ajat deaf-mutes is, however, very local, five-sevenths being found in Champaran and the remainder in Muzaffarpur. The Kaibarttas of Bengal also have an unusually large number of deaf-mutes, and they are followed *longo intervallo* by the Nau-Muslim or converts to Islam in Bihar and Orissa: the actual number of deaf-mutes among the latter is however only 23. No other race or caste in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa is on the same plane, but high ratios are returned for the Saraks (all in Manbhum), Haris and Bhats in Bihar and Orissa and for the Baniyas in Bengal. Deaf-mutism is very common among the castes or races resident in Sikkim, as is natural, for its prevalence is a matter of locality rather than of race. Even here, however, there are considerable variations. The Murmi heads the list, closely followed by the Brahman, while high figures are also returned for the Lepcha and Khas or Chettri. The Bhotia and Khambu (Jimdar) are far less frequently born without speech and hearing, and in this respect are better off than the Bengal Baniya or the Haris and Bhats of Bihar and Orissa. Figures which have been specially prepared to show the distribution of deaf-mutism among the castes of Champaran also indicate that it cannot be correlated with caste or race. The Ajat heads the list, one out of eight being deaf-mute. High proportions are also returned, in a descending scale, for the Bablians, Tambulis, Baishnabs, Nats, Kasarwanis and Bhars, who have very different modes of life. The infirmity is least common in such widely different castes as the Atiths, Doms, Halalkhors, Kayasths, Kewats, Musahars, Tharus, Saiyads and Musalman Dhobis, in all of which the proportion falls below 1 per 1,000.

BLINDNESS.

LOCAL DISTRIBUTION.

801. The distribution of blindness is what one would naturally expect, for it is least common in areas where the climate is humid and the country green, and most common in districts with an arid soil and a hot dry climate, where the eyes are affected by the fierce glare of the sun and, in the hot weather, by clouds of dust driven before a scorching wind. Nowhere is it so prevalent as in South Bihar, where these latter conditions prevail: then comes, *longo intervallo*, North Bihar. West Bengal, Orissa and the Chota Nagpur Plateau occupy an intermediate position, and at the bottom of the list stand North, Central and East Bengal. The four worst districts are Patna, Gaya, Shahabad,



Monghyr (which make up the natural division of South Bihar) and Manbhum, in all of which the proportion of blind persons is 130 or more per 100,000 of the population.

CATARACT OPERATIONS.

802. The returns of successful operations for cataract during the last decade (1901 to 1910) also afford testimony to the extent to which Bihar suffers from diseases of the eye. Altogether 37,326 such operations were performed (compared with 15,987 in the previous decade), of which 12,419 or one-third took place in South Bihar and 6,238 or one-sixth in North Bihar: in other words, Bihar accounts for half the total number in the two Provinces. The returns for individual districts also show very much the same local distribution of blindness as the census returns: conditions in Calcutta are of course exceptional, and there is consequently little correspondence between the medical and census statistics. In no other district than those shown in the margin were there as many as 1,000 successful operations in the 10 years, while in Orissa the aggregate was below that number. The Oriya, unlike the Bihari, dreads the surgeon's knife and will rather be blind than face an operation.

DISTRICT.	Number of operations	Number of blind per 100,000.
Calcutta	8,320	73
Patna	4,071	179
Gaya	3,997	161
Shahabad	3,406	192
Saran	2,233	116
Murshidabad	1,717	111
24-Parganas	1,556	52
Champaran	1,363	81
Muzaffarpur	1,021	80

803. Blindness is chiefly due to neglected inflammation of the eyes, combined with poorness of constitution and the application of caustic remedies. Cases in which senile decay causes cataract and various forms of ulceration, especially of the cornea, are very common. These, though easily amenable to treatment in their earlier stages, are often not submitted for treatment at the hospitals, until vision has been hopelessly destroyed, and it is too late for any treatment to be of use. Ophthalmia is specially common during the months of April and May, when the hot west winds, loaded with dust, are blowing. It is often only a mild form of conjunctivitis, but among the poor it takes the form of purulent ophthalmia, resulting in total destruction of the eye, or in the formation of permanent opacities of the cornea.

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

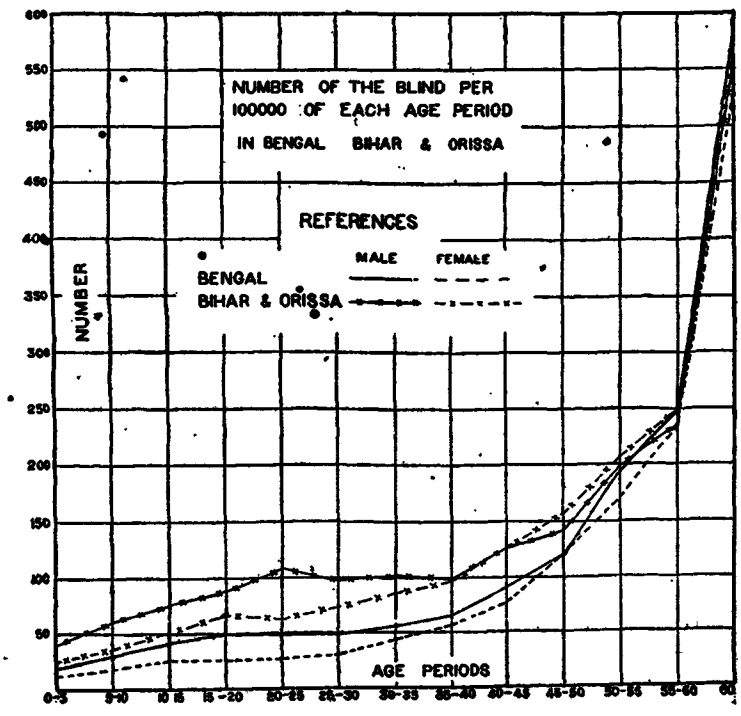
804. The number of blind persons in the two Provinces has risen by 3,139 or by 4 per cent. since 1901. As shown in the margin, the increase is common to both sexes, and has occurred at all ages, except among females aged 50 and over. The increase is all the more noticeable because of the largely enhanced number of successful operations for cataract—the aggregate during the decade was actually more than half the total number of blind persons enumerated in 1901—and *primâ facie* the restoration of sight to such a large proportion should have had some effect in diminishing the blind population. On the other hand, the proportional growth of blind persons falls short of the general growth of population. Compared with 1901, blindness is relatively less prevalent among both sexes in all parts of the two Provinces, except (1) Central Bengal, where the proportion is the same, (2) Orissa, where the proportion of blind females has risen by 6 and of males by 10 per 100,000, (3) South Bihar, where there is a rise of 9 and 11 respectively, and (4) East Bengal, where the proportion for blind males has risen by 2 per 100,000.

CENSUS.	UNDER 50 YEARS.		50 YEARS AND OVER.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1911	24,052	17,427	15,317	17,202
1901	22,823	16,141	14,660	17,235
Variation ...	+ 1,229	+ 1,286	+ 657	- 33

805. The age distribution of the blind is apparent from the diagram, in the next paragraph which mainly serves to illustrate the well known fact that blindness is a senile affection. The number rises very slowly till the age of 45 to 50 is reached, after which it mounts rapidly. One point is of interest, viz., that in Bengal the proportion of blind women is always a little less than that of blind men, whereas in Bihar and Orissa the ratio among females above 40 or 45 years of age is consistently higher than among males. The explanation of this fact is given below. Blindness is more common among males than among females, probably because males, living a more exposed life, are more liable to have their sight impaired. The medical returns also show that cataract is more frequent among men, or at any rate that men have recourse more freely to the surgeon for relief; in 16,500 successful operations the proportion of males to females was 3 to 2.

DISTRIBUTION BY AGE.

806. The Bengali woman is far less subject to eye diseases than her sister in Bihar and Orissa. Among the blind population of the latter Provinces males outnumber females by 23 per cent., whereas in Bengal the excess is under 3 per cent. Among young children under 10 years of age the proportion of the sexes is very nearly the same in both Provinces, but once childhood is passed, the female of Bihar and Orissa begins to suffer much more than the Bengali woman. From 20 to 40 years of age blindness among the former becomes more and more common, and from 40 and over there are more blind women than men. In Bengal, too, there is the same upward rise, but even at 60 years of age and over the proportion of blind women to blind men is only two-thirds. The greater liability to blindness among women in Bihar and Orissa is probably due to the conditions of their life. Their physical surroundings (*e.g.*, a dry climate, an arid country and a fierce glare) are more trying to the sight than in Bengal. The structure of the Bihari houses, with their thick mud walls, has also an injurious effect. They are neither so spacious or well-ventilated as the Bengali homesteads, where bamboo walls allow of a more thorough perflation of air. As the Bihari women progress in years, the accumulative effect of a life spent in small, dark, smoky rooms tells on them more and more.



807. The Kaibarttas of Bengal, other than Chasi and Jaliya Kaibarttas, show the greatest liability to blindness, and then the Saraks in both Provinces, the Bhats and Halalkhors in Bihar and Orissa, and the Rajwars in Bengal. The aboriginal races do not suffer in any marked degree. Among the Hos blindness is almost unknown, while the Kandhs (Khonds) and Santals are far less liable to loss of sight than the Mundas and Oraons. Castes such as the Karans, Kayasths, and Baidyas are also not specially afflicted, though a tendency to blindness might *a priori* be expected because of their literary habits, the strain on the eyes caused by study, and a poor physique. The Bauris again, who form a large proportion of the mining population, where coal dust might affect the eyesight, are more immune than the Bagdis, whose habits,

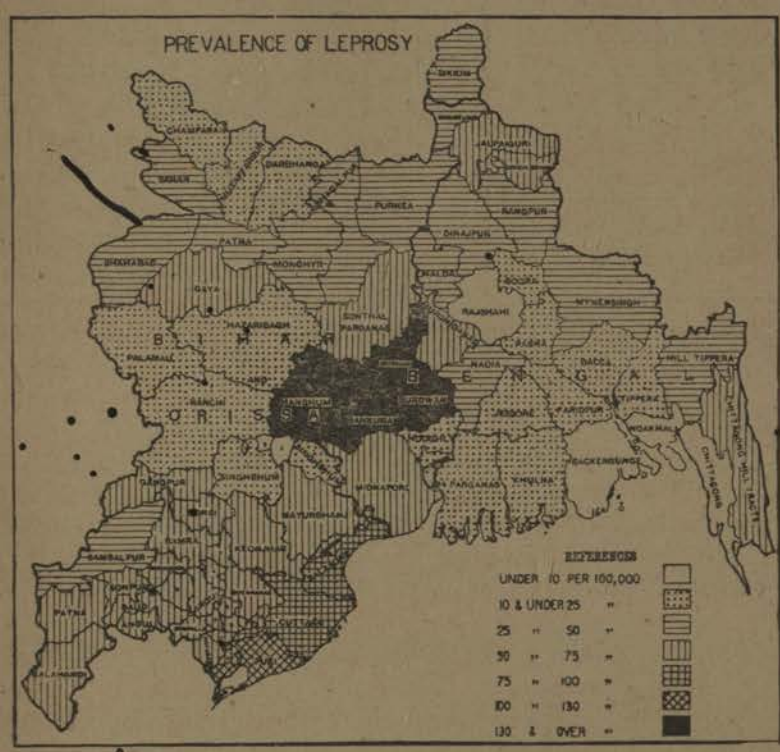
BLINDNESS BY CASTE AND RACE.

food and manner of life are otherwise much the same. For these and other variations among the 165 different castes for which statistics have been compiled, I can offer no explanation.

LEPROSY.

DISTRIBUTION OF LEPROSY.

808. Leprosy is unusually prevalent in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa owing to two leper centres, viz., the four inland districts of Bankura, Burdwan, Birbhum and Manbhum, and the three seaboard districts of Cuttack, Balasore, and Puri, which between them contain 12,605 lepers or over one-third of the total number. The disease is most rife in the four districts first named, where there is an average of 16 lepers per 10,000 of the population. The greatest intensity is reached in Bankura with a ratio of 23 per 10,000: this district is, indeed, the blackest leper spot in the whole of India. In the Orissa districts the proportion is 10 per 10,000, and the disease is evenly diffused through all the three districts. Elsewhere it is most common in the Sonthal Parganas (which adjoins the leper districts of Birbhum, Burdwan and Manbhum) and in the district of Gaya: the number of lepers in the latter district is slightly swollen by immigrants, the town of Gaya being a sacred place of pilgrimage to which lepers are attracted in the hope of charity from pilgrims.*



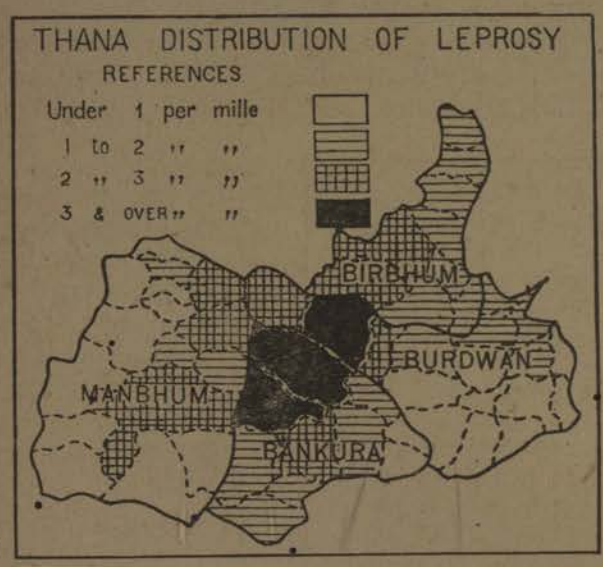
There is a definite geographical distribution of leprosy. The lower delta, included in Central and East Bengal, which has a humid climate and a soil composed mainly of recent alluvium, is most immune. The whole of the north of the two Provinces is also in a favourable position, though there are two exceptions, viz., the State of Cooch Behar and the district of Jalpaiguri in the submontane country known as the Tarai. South Bihar and the Chota Nagpur Plateau, with a drier climate, are more exposed to the ravages of the disease, while it is rife in the country to the south and south-east of the Plateau.

809. The reason for its excessive prevalence in the three seaboard districts of Orissa and the four inland districts on the fringe of the Chota Nagpur Plateau are unknown. They are inhabited by different races and their physical configuration varies widely. The inhabitants of the former are mainly orthodox Hindus: the latter contain a population, in which an aboriginal element is fairly strong. The seaboard districts consist of three distinct tracts, viz., a maritime fringe, a central zone of alluvium, and an upland and somewhat sterile strip of submontane country. The inland

* At the time of the census plague was raging in Gaya town, and foreign-born lepers avoided the place. In Puri town out of 113 lepers, more than half came from outside the district, some hailing from such distant places as Bundelkhand and Gwalior.

districts are partly lateritic uplands and partly an alluvial delta, and, as will be shown in next paragraph, it is in the lateritic area that the disease is most prevalent. It is least prevalent in the seaboard districts at the north-east of Bay of Bengal (viz., Backergunge, Noakhali and Chittagong) and in Rajshahi, in all of which the proportion of lepers is under 10 per 100,000 of the population.

810. In Bankura the highest incidence is found in the rolling upland country to the north-west, where lepers represent 4 to 5 per mille of the population. Every other part of the district in which there is lateritic soil has a ratio of 1 to 3 per mille, whereas it falls below 1 per mille in the alluvial country in the extreme east (thanas Kotalpur and Indas). In Manbhum leprosy is most frequent in the border thanas adjoining the west of Bankura and having the same physical aspects. In Burdwan the proportion is 3 per mille in the Asansol subdivision, where the soil is lateritic, and does not exceed 2 per mille in the alluvial area. In Birbhum the proportion is 2 to 3 per mille in the Suri and Dubrajpur thanas to the south-west, where the country is similar to the Asansol subdivision, and it is under 2 per mille throughout the rest of the district, which is partly alluvial. The marginal map will show how the disease concentrates in, and radiates from, a strip of land lying partly in Burdwan and partly in Bankura.



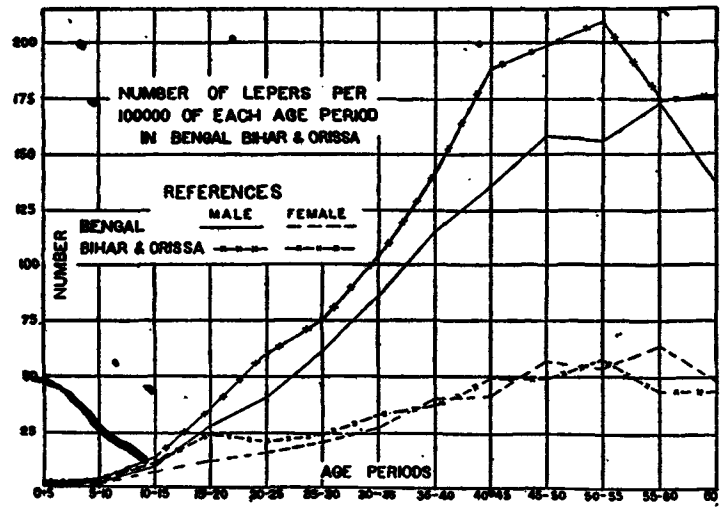
811. Since 1901 there has been a general decline of leprosy throughout both Provinces. The number of lepers has fallen by $5\frac{1}{2}$ per cent., and their proportion per 100,000 of the population from 72 to 62 in the case of males and from 23 to 21 in the case of females. In the two leper centres the decrease is specially noticeable, for there has been an improvement in all the three Orissa districts and also in Burdwan, Birbhum and Bankura. The sole exception is Manbhum, in which there has been a slight increase of 63 lepers or 3 per cent., which is, however, far below the growth of the general population (19 per cent). Increases are recorded for Gaya and the Orissa States, but these are not of much importance. In the latter the present census was more complete than its predecessor, while the severe epidemic of plague which raged in Gaya in 1901 either killed off or drove out of the district a number of its leper population. Plague being also present in the town at this census, it was partially evacuated, but the inhabitants merely moved out to the villages and did not leave the district.

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

812. The decline in the number of lepers may be due to several causes. Part of it may, with some reason, be ascribed to the stress of hard times, especially in Bihar and Orissa. The Province had a series of lean years, scarcity prevailing in several districts in one year or another. Those unfortunate persons who depend on charity are among the first to feel the pinch, for the stream of private benevolence dries up in hard times, and the margin between sufficiency and privation, narrow at all times, disappears. The old naturally die off first, and it is significant that there has been a decrease of 10 per cent. in the number of lepers aged 50 and over. Such an explanation would be less applicable to Bengal where the people's prosperity was scarcely checked by the pressure of high prices. The decrease may also be due, to a small degree, to more accurate diagnosis of cases of leprosy, complaints such as leucoderma and secondary syphilis being excluded from the returns. Even, however, allowing for this, the decrease has been so general and so continuous during the last 30 years, that there is justification for the belief that leprosy is gradually and slowly becoming less common.

LEPROSY BY AGE.

813. The age distribution of lepers is very different from that of other infirmities. Both among males and females the period of greatest incidence is from 20 to 60, the rise being steady and continuous, though more pronounced among males, for whom the returns are more complete. The same characteristic was noticed by Mr. Gait in 1901, whose remarks on the subject may be quoted. "A leper's life is a comparatively short one. According to one of the most reliable estimates (that of Daniellsen and Boeck), the average duration of life from the date of attack is only 9½ years for tuberculated and 18½ years in the case of anæsthetic leprosy. It follows that the steady proportion of lepers between the ages of 20 and 60 indicates a marked rise in the liability to infection between those ages."



PROPORTION OF THE SEXES.

814. Both in Bengal and in Bihar and Orissa there are approximately 3 male lepers to every female leper. The proportion of the sexes at different age periods, however, differs considerably, and specially at the first period (0—5). Among young children of this age there are 117 females to every 100 males in Bihar and Orissa, but less than half that number in Bengal. In both Provinces the proportion gradually and steadily falls until the age of 45—50, when the proportion is almost the same, there being 28 female lepers in Bengal, and 25 in Bihar and Orissa, to every 100 male lepers. After the age of 50, however, there is a rise in the relative number of females: the proportion for elderly female lepers in both Provinces is very nearly the same as for females in their full maturity, *i.e.*, between 25 and 30 years of age.

LEPROSY BY CASTE AND RACE.

815. The castes that appear to be most affected by leprosy are the small Sarak community in Bengal and then the Hajjams and Indian Christians. The high figure in the last case is explicable by the fact that a number of them are inmates of leper asylums, where they have been converted to Christianity: it is not likely that it implies any special liability to the disease. Both Bagdis and Bauris suffer to a marked degree, but with them leprosy is probably a matter of locality rather than of race or manner of life, for they form a considerable proportion of the population of the leprous districts. Other castes of Bengal in which leprosy is especially common are (in a descending scale) the Lohar, Kaibartta, Mali and Khaira. In Bihar and Orissa the most afflicted are the Mayra, Sarak and Kalu: their local distribution is, however, limited, for all the lepers among the Mayras and Kalus were enumerated in the Sonthal Parganas and Manbhum, and the Sarak lepers in Manbhum only.

816. In order to ascertain whether any castes are specially liable to the disease in the leper area, *i.e.*, the districts of Burdwan, Birbhum, Bankura and Manbhum, statistics have been prepared of the castes in those four districts, among which there are 100 or more lepers, or which have an aggregate strength of over 50,000. The result is shown in the margin. The highest incidence is found among the Rajputs and then among the Bauris, while the Bhumij, Kayasth, Kora, Kurmi, Mal and Santal

Caste.	Number of lepers.	Proportion per 100,000.	Caste.	Number of lepers.	Proportion per 100,000.
1. Bagdi	612	158	14. Kayasth ...	50	72
2. Baishnab ...	132	175	15. Kora ...	82	63
3. Bauri	1,219	331	16. Kumhar ...	78	112
4. Bhuiya ...	64	102	17. Kurmi ...	261	80
5. Bhumij ...	99	67	18. Mal ...	54	80
6. Brahman ...	354	113	19. Napit ...	88	149
7. Chasi Kaibartta...	87	168	20. Rajput ...	206	353
8. Dom	251	215	21. Sadgop ...	326	138
9. Gandabanik ...	106	203	22. Santal ...	238	85
10. Goala ...	419	222	23. Sunri ...	268	288
11. Hari ...	116	162	24. Tanti ...	74	102
12. Kalu ...	228	282	25. Teli and Tili ...	291	228
13. Kamar ...	123	144	26. Sheikh ...	590	106

suffer the least. Of the latter all but the Kayasths have a strong aboriginal strain, but so also has the Bauri. It is not apparent why the Rajputs should have proportionately four times as many lepers as the Kayasths, or why the latter should be more immune than the Brahmans. The Bauris and Bagdis, again, have very much the same occupations, customs and manner of life, but leprosy is twice as frequent among the former as among the latter.

LEPER ASYLUMS.

817. The law relating to leprosy, which is in force in both Provinces, is the Lepers Act (III of 1898), an Act applicable to all India, which was introduced in 1901 in place of the Bengal Lepers Act of 1895. This Act provides for the establishment of asylums to which lepers may be sent from specified areas, for the arrest of pauper lepers found wandering in such areas, and for their detention in an asylum. It also empowers the Local Government to prohibit lepers from engaging in certain trades or occupations likely to endanger the public health. The asylums established under it are the Albert Victor Leper Asylum at Gobra near Calcutta and the asylums at Purulia in Manbhum, Raniganj in Burdwan, Bhagalpur and Muzaffarpur. The asylum at Gobra is a Government institution managed by a Board appointed by Government; the rest are under the management of the Mission to Lepers in India and the East, assisted by contributions from Government. Under section 9 of the Act notifications have been issued prohibiting lepers in certain localities from following certain trades or occupations connected with the bodily requirements of human beings, or from doing certain acts likely to endanger public health. The localities in question are the districts of Burdwan, Birbhum and Manbhum, the Muzaffarpur thana (excluding two outposts), the towns of Calcutta, Cossipur-Chitpur, Manicktollah. Tollygunge, Garden Reach, Howrah, Krishnagar, Bhagalpur, the South Suburban Municipality and Fort William. These have also been specified as local areas from which lepers may be sent to specified asylums.

818. The Albert Victor Leper Asylum at Gobra was declared to be an asylum under the Lepers Act in 1901 : the areas from which lepers may be sent to it are Fort William, Calcutta, the Suburban Municipalities and the Krishnagar Municipality. The Purulia Leper Asylum is the largest asylum in the two Provinces, containing accommodation for over 600 lepers. It was established in 1887, and in 1902 was declared to be an asylum to which lepers might be sent from the district of Manbhum. From the outset the working of this asylum has been in the hands of the German Evangelical Lutheran Mission : its popularity is such that most of the inmates go there of their own free will, and the number sent under the Act is generally very small. A large majority of the inmates, however, are such as could legally be sent there, and in consideration of this fact, and of the good work done by it, Government gives the asylum an annual capitation grant, which is at present fixed at Rs. 12,000 a year. The Raniganj Leper Asylum, established in 1893, was declared to be an asylum under the Act in 1907 : the local areas from which lepers may be sent to it are the districts of Burdwan and Birbhum. It contains about 200 lepers, and receives annually from Government a capitation grant calculated at the rate of Re. 1-8 a month for each inmate that is a leper within the meaning of the Act. The Bhagalpur Leper Asylum was established in 1890 and was brought under the operation of the Act in 1908. The town of Bhagalpur is the local area from which lepers under the Act may be sent to it. Government contributes a capitation grant at the usual rate of Re. 1-8 per head a month. The Muzaffarpur Leper Asylum was declared an asylum under the Act in 1909, and the Muzaffarpur thana (excluding the independent outposts of Minapore and Sakra) was specified as the local area from which lepers might be sent to it. A capitation grant at the usual rate is made from Provincial revenues.

819. There are also asylums at Asansol, Bankura and Lohardaga, belonging to the Mission to Lepers in India and the East, which have not been brought under the operation of the Lepers Act, but are assisted by Government contributions. The Lohardaga Asylum is the oldest in the two Provinces, having been started in 1884 at the instance of the Revd. F. Hahn of Gossner's German (Evangelical Lutheran) Mission. That at Asansol was

started about six years later, and that at Bankura in 1902. The Rajkumari Leper Asylum at Deoghar, the Puri Leper Asylum (started in 1905) and the Sambalpur Leper Asylum are private institutions maintained from subscriptions. There is also an asylum in the State of Mayurbhanj, which was opened in 1907. It is subsidized by the Maharaja and is visited by members of an Australian Mission called the Mayurbhanj State Mission. Altogether 1,227 lepers (811 males and 416 females) were enumerated in the different asylums.

From the preceding account it will be seen that all the asylums in the two Provinces except that at Gobra are maintained either by the Mission to Lepers in India and the East or depend upon private charity. Government, however, makes considerable grants for their upkeep, and in the decade 1901-1910 contributed Rs. 1,29,052 (Rs. 24,250 as building grants and Rs. 1,04,802 as annual subventions), while local bodies subscribed over Rs. 4,000.

THE WORK IN THE ASYLUMS.

820. The work in the Mission asylums is partly evangelistic, for it is desired to make converts, and partly philanthropic, as the lepers are given shelter, clothed and fed. It is also to a large extent medical, but as it has not yet been established that there is any effective cure for this mysterious disease, the treatment is of a comparatively simple character, and is applied with the object of giving relief, rather than with a hope of actual cure. The most important part of the work is preventive, the worst and most dangerous cases being segregated, while special efforts are made to save the untainted children of leprous parents from contagion. It is recognized that the disease being not hereditary but contagious, the best chance of successful work lies in separating children from diseased parents and protecting them from contamination.

CAUSATION OF LEPROSY.

821. The most recent authoritative pronouncement regarding the causation of leprosy is that of the Conference of Leprologists presided over by Professor Virchow, which was held at Berlin in 1897. The conclusions arrived at by this body of experts were briefly that :—(1) The disease is communicated by the bacillus, but its conditions of life and methods of penetrating the human organism are unknown. Probably it obtains entrance through the mouth or the mucous membrane. (2) It is certain that mankind alone is liable to the bacillus. (3) Leprosy is contagious, but not hereditary. (4) The disease has hitherto resisted all efforts to cure it. A similar Conference held at Bergen in 1909 confirmed these views.

Mr. Jonathan Hutchinson, F.R.S., has advanced another theory, viz., that leprosy is due to eating badly cured fish. His views are—(1) the leprosy is caused by a bacillus, which gains access to the body through the stomach, and not by the breath or by the skin. (2) That in the great majority of cases in which grown-up persons become lepers, the bacillus enters the stomach in connection with badly cured fish, eaten in a state of partial decomposition and not sufficiently cooked. (3) That the bacillus is not present in any other form of fish-food. (4) That it is but very seldom that the bacillus is present even in such fish, and that it is especially likely to be found in fish which has been imported from a distance. (5) That a very small quantity of tainted fish may suffice to introduce the bacillus, and that a long period is necessary before its results will be observed.

822. Mr. Hutchinson's theory is not confirmed by the results of the census over the areas where leprosy is most prevalent. In Bankura, in particular, which is the worst leper centre in either Province, the consumption of badly cured fish is extremely rare. On the other hand, it is common among the Nepalese races, who fulfil the conditions necessary according to Mr. Hutchison, for (1) the fish they eat is badly cured, (2) it is eaten very largely, (3) it is in a state of partial decomposition and (4) it is imported from distant places. In every bazar frequented by the Nepalese such badly cured fish may be seen. Its condition will be sufficiently described by a quotation from Mr. Inglis, an old planter of North Bihar. "Large quantities of dried fish are sent to Nepal, and exchanged for rice and other grains, or horns, hides and blankets. The fish-drying is done very simply in the sun.

It is generally left till it is half putrid and taints the air for miles. The sweltering, half-rotting mass, packed in filthy bags, and slung on ponies or bullocks, is sent over the frontier to some village bazar in Nepal. The track of a consignment of this horrible filth can be recognized from very far away. The perfume hovers on the road, and as you are riding up and get the first sniff of the putrid odour, you know at once that the Nepalese market is being recruited by a fresh accession of very stale fish. If the taste is at all equal to the smell, the rankest witches' broth ever brewed in a reeking cauldron would probably be preferable."* The localities where the Nepalese are found in greatest strength have little leprosy, viz., Darjeeling, where the proportion of male lepers per 100,000 is 45, and, Sikkim, where it falls to 16. The figures for Nepalese castes, moreover, show that the incidence of leprosy is very low; out of 35,000 persons belonging to different Nepalese castes in Sikkim only 6 are lepers.

NEW METHODS OF TREATMENT.

823. Experiments with Deycke's Nastin treatment of leprosy were made in 1909-10 by Major Anderson, I.M.S., Civil Surgeon of Manbhum, in the Purulia Leper Asylum, and the results were so far encouraging as to lead to their continuance. Nastin is the name given by Professor Deycke and Dr. Reschad, two physicians in the Imperial Ottoman Service, to a fatty substance extracted from 14 days old pure cultures of a species of streptothrix (*S. Leproides*), which is found in cases of leprosy to be associated with the true bacillus of leprosy. Drs. Deycke and Reschad hold that the leprosy bacilli contain a fatty substance similar to, or biologically related to, Nastin, which not only prevents these bacilli themselves from being attacked and destroyed by the human phagocites, but by its action on the healthy human tissues, renders the latter favourable for subsequent invasion by the leprosy bacillus. Though Nastin does not act directly on the leprosy bacilli, it immunizes the healthy tissues against the action of this fat, so that the healthy phagocites of the tissues can attack and destroy the leprosy bacilli. The Nastin injection, in brief, produces an immunization against the fatty substance with which the bacilli are impregnated and on which is dependent their comparative unassailability. Professor Deycke holds that Nastin injection will exercise no curative influence in the severest and most advanced cases of leprosy, especially if accompanied with complications of the internal organs: such cases are quite incurable by any known treatment. In cases of somewhat less severity cure is rare, but with careful dosing the condition may be prevented from getting worse. In cases of medium severity, or in light cases, the leprous processes can, in most cases, be arrested, and generally a more or less important retrogression of the leprous symptoms may ensue. "In the majority of cases," wrote Professor Deycke in 1909, "irrespective, of course, of the most severe and hopelessly advanced forms, it will be possible to arrest the process; in many cases there will be obtained a distinct improvement, which is evidenced in a particularly pronounced manner by increase in strength and general health, and unmistakeable retrogression of the leprous symptoms."

An account of other methods of treatment will be found in the *Indian Medical Gazette* for July 1911 and July 1912. Reference to them is not required in this report, because they have not, so far as the writer is aware, been applied in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.

* J. Inglis, Sport and Work on the Nepal Frontier, p. 218.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I—NUMBER OF PERSONS AFFLICTED PER 100,000 OF THE POPULATION AT EACH OF THE LAST FOUR CENSUSES.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	INSANE.								DEAF-MUTES.								BLIND.								LEPERS.							
	Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	**35**	**35**	**42**	**54**	**23**	**23**	**28**	**36**	**85**	**82**	**119**	**155**	**56**	**52**	**72**	**95**	**92**	**95**	**101**	**138**	**82**	**85**	**97**	**146**	**62**	**72**	**94**	**124**	**21**	**23**	**31**	**41**
BENGAL	**50**	**50**	**58**	**74**	**36**	**35**	**44**	**53**	**81**	**72**	**102**	**126**	**58**	**49**	**68**	**84**	**78**	**80**	**84**	**119**	**63**	**67**	**75**	**113**	**56**	**69**	**104**	**141**	**19**	**23**	**36**	**51**
WEST BENGAL	**36**	**41**	**44**	**60**	**19**	**20**	**24**	**34**	**88**	**70**	**106**	**140**	**60**	**47**	**73**	**96**	**96**	**104**	**94**	**136**	**92**	**100**	**97**	**150**	**137**	**168**	**244**	**287**	**57**	**64**	**90**	**107**
Burdwan[*]	33	43	38	61	18	20	23	41	90	81	104	144	61	54	77	108	108	123	104	165	107	121	110	186	200	239	313	444	80	88	122	159
Birbhum	38	43	53	60	21	22	32	35	88	83	127	150	70	67	107	107	110	102	135	125	101	118	147	121	241	321	522	485	88	109	190	182
Bankura*	49	42	53	66	21	22	30	28	86	79	141	176	62	58	103	125	107	121	134	152	123	134	155	179	314	367	515	540	153	168	218	214
Midnapore	31	36	35	47	20	19	18	24	95	59	99	121	60	31	53	74	93	97	70	117	86	87	68	129	80	91	122	134	29	31	36	52
Hooghly	40	43	50	84	19	21	26	46	80	66	80	140	56	48	62	97	90	93	83	147	75	78	82	163	37	55	115	179	10	14	25	49
Howrah	37	48	55	62	18	25	28	36	79	72	107	132	51	45	67	90	61	88	70	120	52	67	59	120	18	23	47	82	4	6	14	31
CENTRAL BENGAL	**50**	**43**	**51**	**66**	**29**	**28**	**36**	**45**	**61**	**54**	**95**	**105**	**48**	**40**	**60**	**69**	**76**	**76**	**86**	**119**	**68**	**68**	**69**	**112**	**38**	**46**	**78**	**111**	**12**	**14**	**23**	**38**
24-Parganas	40	41	64	80	33	38	46	54	63	57	127	119	47	40	77	74	57	60	84	116	47	47	56	107	15	18	50	72	5	5	18	30
Calcutta[†]	39	60	71	42	33	49	49	42	28	38	24	45	35	44	42	42	63	71	38	101	92	105	60	173	32	32	26	63	26	22	25	37
Nadia	32	33	47	64	16	18	27	38	59	48	91	105	39	28	52	68	90	72	104	119	76	57	77	106	50	49	119	150	14	17	29	42
Murshidabad†	116	58	31	78	34	27	25	30	70	62	79	123	59	42	53	82	114	115	111	159	109	114	98	157	90	119	129	194	24	33	38	63
Jessore	39	36	46	50	31	31	38	40	75	60	108	97	52	46	62	59	72	76	78	101	49	54	56	78	22	32	65	65	5	7	15	16
NORTH BENGAL	**57**	**65**	**71**	**92**	**46**	**53**	**55**	**71**	**94**	**97**	**119**	**165**	**70**	**67**	**83**	**108**	**74**	**82**	**82**	**120**	**64**	**71**	**83**	**118**	**50**	**63**	**88**	**147**	**14**	**18**	**29**	**50**
Rajshahi	48	54	54	60	38	48	50	49	70	62	84	81	58	49	60	61	63	79	82	98	61	80	87	89	7	15	30	55	6	10	17	37
Dinajpur	53	62	74	90	43	51	56	67	102	91	105	149	68	64	73	104	79	75	77	117	69	76	81	123	42	56	61	104	13	15	30	42
Jalpaiguri	77	84	98	113	64	56	82	96	101	135	97	182	53	83	79	107	72	65	54	105	57	57	58	107	89	110	139	185	29	33	53	69
Darjeeling	8	21	33	32	6	15	26	27	49	152	196	162	28	124	152	157	27	53	76	71	23	46	79	95	45	43	93	156	14	27	49	68
Rangpur	59	83	62	123	51	75	48	100	95	100	97	227	68	66	58	144	69	86	66	132	55	66	54	129	73	94	107	231	17	24	27	64
Bogra	66	54	99	77	62	52	80	64	93	60	116	116	75	44	107	70	74	76	89	80	53	52	100	78	30	38	81	105	6	11	25	29
Pabna	60	58	68	84	44	41	50	53	94	111	138	187	75	76	94	127	78	90	85	136	63	65	73	107	29	46	62	100	8	11	21	30
Maida	36	32	47	64	24	26	34	53	107	93	141	113	80	67	111	88	102	100	126	155	107	99	136	160	55	54	93	110	15	16	25	37
Cooch Behar	79	100	119	132	63	75	90	85	113	135	200	228	71	86	109	124	88	93	113	139	71	89	133	186	98	125	205	307	25	37	60	112

In the calculations for each Province and natural Division, those areas for which figures are not available have been left out of account.

* There are leper asylums at Purulia (Manbhum), Gobra (Calcutta), Deoghar (Sonthal Parganas), Lohardaga (Ranchi), Raniganj and Asansol (Burdwan), Bankura, Bhagalpur, Sambalpur, Muzaffarpur and Puri. Excluding the inmates who were born outside the districts in which these asylums are situated, the proportion of lepers per 100,000 persons of each sex is:—Manbhum males 157, females 105; Calcutta males 18, females 20; Sonthal Parganas males 97, females 47; Ranchi males 13, females 10; Burdwan males 183, females 72; Bankura males 313, females 153; Bhagalpur males 49, females 16; Sambalpur males 60, females 34; Muzaffarpur males 42, females 4; and Puri males 174, females 57.

† There are lunatic asylums at Bhawanipur (Calcutta), Berhampur (Murshidabad), Dacca and Patna. Excluding the inmates who were born outside the districts in which these asylums are situated, the proportion of lunatics per 100,000 persons of each sex is—Calcutta, males 36, females 29; Murshidabad, males 37, females 18; Dacca, males 58, females 39; and Patna, males 16, females 8.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I—NUMBER OF PERSONS AFFLICTED PER 100,000 OF THE POPULATION AT EACH OF THE LAST FOUR CENSUSES—*continued*.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	INSANE.								DEAF-MUTES.								BLIND.								LEPERS.							
	Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33
BENGAL—concluded.																																
EAST BENGAL	*53*	*47*	*62*	*74*	*40*	*36*	*51*	*56*	*78*	*66*	*94*	*104*	*54*	*45*	*60*	*69*	*72*	*70*	*81*	*110*	*48*	*49*	*63*	*90*	*31*	*35*	*59*	*74*	*7*	*8*	*19*	*27*
Khulna	48	44	45	58	44	38	48	56	85	62	80	92	60	43	59	65	67	58	44	81	44	37	31	60	14	12	18	38	5	5	8	14
Dacca†	71	66	79	85	41	40	47	55	76	74	36	101	55	55	23	73	79	79	73	118	59	61	52	101	33	39	57	83	9	12	14	31
Mymensingh	60	56	67	74	42	42	53	46	82	80	123	111	64	58	90	72	78	86	97	104	54	63	89	90	67	84	124	129	13	15	40	39
Faridpur	45	27	51	66	32	22	41	49	73	34	78	85	51	21	47	47	75	53	74	101	44	31	47	67	16	17	44	63	4	4	11	17
Backergunge	37	39	56	63	31	35	53	60	62	57	92	84	38	38	52	53	60	65	88	105	33	35	47	68	7	9	21	33	3	4	8	17
Tippera	35	25	44	67	31	19	45	54	74	55	107	112	48	29	57	67	66	51	94	138	46	34	73	127	26	22	59	69	8	5	18	30
Noakhali	28	34	47	78	31	30	56	67	88	82	113	124	49	49	63	68	56	71	82	113	38	50	67	107	5	9	20	34	1	2	8	18
Chittagong	79	77	82	104	59	56	64	84	99	83	116	143	57	53	82	108	85	79	71	117	56	57	63	109	12	18	35	61	3	4	13	28
Chittagong Hill Tracts	137	120	164	...	181	134	174	...	83	64	85	...	77	65	84	...	117	120	127	...	96	97	184	...	76	74	77	...	28	22	38	...
Hill Tippera	44	58	95	...	56	39	45	...	48	48	163	...	39	44	86	...	50	40	153	...	40	58	76	...	52	37	67	...	14	14	33	...
BIHAR AND ORISSA	*16*	*17*	*20*	*29*	*8*	*9*	*10*	*16*	*90*	*95*	*139*	*192*	*55*	*56*	*78*	*109*	*111*	*112*	*122*	*160*	*104*	*104*	*123*	*184*	*71*	*76*	*82*	*103*	*23*	*24*	*26*	*29*
NORTH BIHAR	*12*	*13*	*19*	*33*	*6*	*6*	*8*	*18*	*132*	*150*	*210*	*264*	*80*	*85*	*116*	*145*	*102*	*105*	*121*	*146*	*84*	*86*	*112*	*152*	*48*	*47*	*65*	*76*	*9*	*10*	*12*	*17*
Saran	16	16	22	23	7	8	7	10	127	135	195	188	70	67	129	96	132	127	178	163	103	100	148	162	64	49	85	98	9	7	10	15
Champaran	9	9	21	56	4	6	7	32	208	275	434	567	130	173	235	337	83	94	114	156	78	86	103	173	37	33	53	62	5	4	10	10
Muzaffarpur[c]	9	10	15	22	3	3	6	10	144	145	156	225	81	78	77	119	92	102	105	140	69	68	97	138	43	47	52	54	4	10	5	8
Darbhanga	11	9	12	25	5	5	5	16	121	117	155	179	70	62	70	82	118	101	98	114	91	81	83	97	40	33	41	46	6	4	7	9
Bhagalpur[c]	10	13	16	29	6	7	6	16	66	127	180	225	43	73	99	134	91	112	137	160	77	96	128	173	50	56	70	75	17	16	22	26
Purnea	18	25	29	53	13	13	20	34	139	130	189	283	95	84	130	174	88	96	93	160	84	86	115	188	56	70	94	78	17	21	28	28
SOUTH BIHAR	*20*	*17*	*21*	*22*	*9*	*8*	*9*	*13*	*67*	*63*	*91*	*175*	*40*	*35*	*50*	*103*	*171*	*162*	*170*	*248*	*162*	*151*	*175*	*301*	*74*	*77*	*95*	*132*	*13*	*12*	*20*	*25*
Patna†	38	38	40	36	14	12	12	23	64	61	62	227	42	34	37	151	186	187	173	310	172	194	181	427	64	77	69	132	11	9	10	23
Gaya	13	12	18	17	9	6	8	12	57	49	104	183	37	26	56	108	163	145	152	248	159	138	161	300	105	102	127	163	19	16	27	30
Shahabad	16	12	28	22	7	5	8	10	59	54	136	121	30	27	42	66	196	181	329	285	187	159	198	311	52	57	130	140	8	9	13	27
Monghyr	17	13	14	16	7	7	9	7	86	88	110	172	48	51	65	92	144	141	161	155	138	130	159	179	68	73	103	90	12	13	27	18

In the calculations for each Province and Natural Division, those areas for which figures are not available, have been left out of account.

[c] There are leper asylums at Purulia (Manbhum), Gobra (Calcutta), Deoghar (Santhal Parganas). Lohardaga (Ranchi). Raniganj and Asansol (Burdwan). Bankura, Bhagalpur, Sambalpur, Muzaffarpur and Puri. Excluding the inmates who were born outside the districts in which these asylums are situated, the proportion of lepers per 100,000 persons of each sex is:—Manbhum males 157 females 105; Calcutta males 18, females 20; Santhal Parganas males 97, females 47; Ranchi males 13, females 10; Burdwan males 183, females 72; Bankura males 313, females 153; Bhagalpur males 49, females 16; Sambalpur males 60, females 34; Muzaffarpur males 42, females 4 and Puri males 174, females 57.

† There are lunatic asylums at Bhawanipur (Calcutta), Berhampore (Murshidabad). Dacca and Patna. Excluding the inmates who were born outside the districts in which the asylums are situated, the proportion of lunatics per 100,000 persons of each sex is:—Calcutta, males 36, females 29; Murshidabad males 37, females 18; Dacca males 58, females 39; Patna males 16, females 18.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I—NUMBER OF PERSONS AFFLICTED PER 100,000 OF THE POPULATION AT EACH OF THE LAST FOUR CENSUSES—*concluded.*

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	INSANE.								DEAF-MUTES.								BLIND.								LEPERS.							
	Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33
ORISSA	*24*	*27*	*27*	*34*	*10*	*12*	*12*	*16*	*72*	*64*	*116*	*126*	*33*	*29*	*59*	*70*	*92*	*82*	*89*	*106*	*69*	*63*	*93*	*128*	*159*	*170*	*168*	*190*	*48*	*49*	*59*	*61*
Cuttack	23	27	23	31	10	12	9	15	87	59	115	116	39	29	62	64	107	97	89	108	80	73	95	139	148	153	128	171	43	44	48	57
Balasore	23	24	24	28	11	13	10	15	65	86	109	176	30	38	57	101	63	45	62	84	56	44	60	107	159	187	185	214	45	53	59	64
Puri[a]	27	28	41	47	8	14	19	21	51	50	124	95	23	21	53	50	94	89	117	124	61	63	119	128	180	185	229	204	60	58	82	75
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU	*15*	*18*	*17*	*23*	*9*	*11*	*11*	*15*	*63*	*60*	*65*	*92*	*44*	*43*	*40*	*59*	*91*	*97*	*88*	*107*	*102*	*109*	*101*	*131*	*66*	*75*	*51*	*69*	*37*	*40*	*41*	*38*
Hazaribagh	11	13	12	18	8	8	6	13	62	54	73	105	35	40	46	60	100	94	85	116	93	90	100	145	16	15	20	26	7	9	13	15
Ranchi[a]	20	21	25	20	14	17	16	16	55	60	77	81	47	55	51	58	100	122	148	122	109	141	148	152	13	35	37	40	10	13	20	26
Palamau	10	12			5	13			49	63			41	50			95	140			115	145			13	23			14	18		
Manbhum[a]	19	24	27	32	13	14	16	16	86	83	90	103	60	48	52	62	150	148	146	137	212	205	190	180	158	186	107	160	106	120	139	87
Singhbhum	14	19	17	27	11	16	24	24	82	66	85	67	59	52	60	55	55	67	74	70	63	81	89	81	30	47	48	52	17	32	24	44
Sonthal Parganas[a]	14	17	12	23	7	11	8	13	72	82	49	91	50	59	28	57	88	103	42	76	97	123	46	84	100	122	57	69	47	50	25	32
Angul	4	16	23	45	3	3	8	22	69	66	101	165	40	39	44	85	96	96	123	154	90	95	127	136	84	77	73	163	35	39	38	78
Sambalpur[a]	19	16	...	...	8	6	...	...	63	57	...	...	50	41	...	...	83	79	...	...	113	84	...	...	60	37	...	...	34	29	...	...
Orissa Feudatory States	15	18	...	...	7	9	...	...	51	40	...	...	33	26	...	...	69	65	...	...	67	65	...	...	64	64	...	...	36	32	...	...
Chota Nagpur States	8	10	...	...	3	7	...	...	45	63	...	...	35	36	...	...	39	80	...	...	37	67	...	...	12	23	...	...	3	17	...	...
SIKKIM	*13*	*46*	...	...	*7*	*32*	...	...	*297*	*355*	...	...	*233*	*385*	...	...	*36*	*71*	...	...	*21*	*57*	...	...	*16*	*55*	...	...	*40*	*25*	...	...

In the calculations for each Province and Natural Division, those areas for which figures are not available have been left out of account.

[a] There are leper asylums at Purulia (Manbhum), Gobra (Calcutta), Deoghar (Sonthal Parganas), Lohardaga (Ranchi), Raniganj and Asansol (Burdwan), Bankura, Bhagalpur, Sambalpur, Muzaffarpur and Puri. Excluding the inmates who were born outside the districts in which these asylums are situated, the proportion of lepers per 100,000 persons of each sex is :—Manbhum males 157, females 105; Calcutta males 18, females 20; Sonthal Parganas males 97, females 47; Ranchi males 18, females 10; Burdwan males 183, females 72; Bankura males 313, females 153; Bhagalpur males 49, females 16; Sambalpur males 60, females 34; Muzaffarpur males 42, females 4 and Puri males 174, females 57.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II. PART I.—DISTRIBUTION OF THE INFIRM BY AGE PER 10,000 OF EACH SEX.

AGE.	INSANE.								DEAF-MUTES.							
	Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.																
Total ...	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*
0— 5	65	116	166	183	98	152	150	249	432	458	389	459	517	536	467	553
5—10	530	575	518	677	554	658	538	594	1,569	1,616	1,349	1,190	1,569	1,658	1,310	1,128
10—15	815	872	748	811	860	975	733	696	1,670	1,729	1,233	1,161	1,524	1,597	1,039	988
15—20	909	930	827	857	1,015	982	822	810	1,268	1,385	965	849	1,325	1,358	937	764
20—25	1,006	996	924	2,116	1,029	988	890	1,740	1,074	972	850	1,628	1,098	991	820	1,475
25—30	1,358	1,313	1,249		1,090	974	1,014		1,100	1,008	871		1,028	878	843	
30—35	1,350	1,238	1,256	2,152	1,103	1,060	1,064	1,861	813	807	823	1,502	774	798	814	1,318
35—40	1,084	1,055	1,034		857	848	954		586	519	656		532	484	595	
40—45	978	946	1,065	1,490	959	1,006	1,014	1,574	514	489	690	1,178	520	502	673	1,176
45—50	594	564	598		565	575	668		283	282	422		296	291	428	
50—55	530	583	622	862	752	641	766	1,165	262	277	552	879	305	330	561	988
55—60	244	246	328		309	281	358		119	114	278		118	128	320	
60 and over	537	566	665	852	819	860	1,009	1,311	310	344	922	1,154	394	449	1,193	1.610

AGE.	BLIND.								LEPERS.							
	Male.				Female.				Male.				Female.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.																
Total ...	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*	*10,000*
0— 5	404	379	421	406	304	271	275	257	32	29	48	63	80	87	83	122
5—10	727	705	712	707	485	433	402	388	78	83	98	146	167	170	187	257
10—15	735	748	708	592	445	449	386	297	224	250	256	271	435	450	379	386
15—20	590	628	572	475	445	441	401	293	427	411	415	440	704	700	579	612
20—25	592	574	532	1,029	452	451	375	764	598	571	525	1,444	783	756	643	1,560
25—30	667	666	582		558	495	458		979	965	909		995	978	899	
30—35	663	638	627	1,113	602	582	565	914	1,212	1,182	1,184	2,470	1,117	1,053	1,138	2,032
35—40	556	543	548		520	492	484		1,331	1,272	1,254		1,034	908	1,028	
40—45	657	685	704	1,144	669	706	737	1,074	1,463	1,502	1,454	2,368	1,204	1,249	1,317	1,922
45—50	518	523	502		552	517	528		1,044	1,028	1,025		833	797	835	
50—55	776	783	766	1,184	877	910	910	1,384	1,059	1,144	1,085	1,533	1,034	1,049	1,000	1,474
55—60	444	452	505		495	543	594		474	487	512		439	463	518	
60 and over	2,671	2,676	2,821	3,350	3,596	3,710	3,885	4,629	1,079	1,076	1,230	1,266	1,175	1,340	1,394	1,635

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II—PART II.—DISTRIBUTION OF THE INFIRM BY AGE PER 10,000 OF EACH SEX, 1911.

AGE.	INSANE.				DEAF-MUTES.				BLIND.				LEPERS.			
	Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.		Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.		Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.		Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
Total ...	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***	***10,000***
0— 5	61	100	80	90	417	483	449	558	319	266	479	331	38	66	27	93
5—10	555	568	427	483	1,579	1,566	1,558	1,572	574	434	862	521	75	132	80	200
10—15	831	847	754	863	1,696	1,464	1,642	1,596	614	389	842	483	205	389	243	477
15—20	934	1,041	807	882	1,265	1,385	1,272	1,254	538	391	636	483	444	630	411	775
20—25	1,024	1,031	937	1,017	1,032	1,055	1,121	1,151	476	387	696	497	564	783	613	784
25—30	1,386	1,112	1,247	979	1,046	1,021	1,160	1,036	558	443	764	639	1,030	1,033	929	959
30—35	1,292	1,112	1,584	1,056	728	753	909	800	559	480	755	688	1,227	1,021	1,197	1,208
35—40	1,075	856	1,120	863	613	569	556	487	540	453	570	567	1,383	1,090	1,279	981
40—45	969	947	1,010	1,017	557	550	466	483	666	613	649	709	1,395	1,153	1,530	1,252
45—50	578	562	657	580	298	322	268	264	569	569	472	541	1,049	908	1,039	762
50—55	532	753	523	747	291	317	228	290	881	972	683	811	994	1,050	1,123	1,019
55—60	241	309	257	309	127	118	109	118	531	570	367	442	521	528	427	355
60 and over	522	762	597	1,114	351	397	262	391	3,175	4,033	2,225	3,288	1,055	1,217	1,102	1,135

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000 OF EACH AGE PERIOD AND NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.

BENGAL

AGE.	NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000—								NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.			
	Insane.		*Deaf-mutes.*		*Blind.*		*Lepers.*					
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Insane.	Deaf-mutes.	Blind.	Lepers.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
All ages	***50***	***36***	***81***	***58***	***78***	***63***	***56***	***19***	***671***	***676***	***773***	***320***
0— 5	2	2	25	19	18	11	2	1	1,096	783	642	560
5—10	18	13	83	57	29	18	3	2	687	671	584	560
10—15	35	31	115	86	40	25	10	7	695	584	490	609
15—20	54	37	117	79	48	25	25	12	743	740	562	454
20—25	66	39	106	64	47	26	41	16	676	691	629	429
25—30	75	42	90	63	46	30	61	21	535	660	614	321
30—35	82	55	74	60	55	42	86	27	578	698	654	266
35—40	81	59	74	63	63	56	115	40	535	627	648	252
40—45	85	66	79	62	90	76	136	42	656	668	711	265
45—50	79	66	65	61	119	120	158	57	653	730	773	277
50—55	75	74	66	50	192	170	156	54	950	737	852	338
55—60	72	71	61	44	246	234	173	64	861	827	831	325
60 and over	61	57	66	48	572	533	137	45	979	764	982	369

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

All ages	***16***	***8***	***90***	***55***	***111***	***104***	***71***	***23***	***518***	***636***	***974***	***338***
0— 5	1	1	30	22	40	25	1	2	583	791	672	1,167
5—10	4	3	88	58	60	36	4	3	586	642	589	841
10—15	10	7	119	87	75	50	14	11	593	618	560	664
15—20	16	9	142	92	88	67	36	24	566	627	740	637
20—25	21	9	139	74	107	61	60	21	562	653	695	432
25—30	23	8	119	61	97	72	75	24	406	568	815	349
30—35	31	10	99	52	101	85	103	33	545	760	888	341
35—40	28	11	78	44	93	97	141	37	399	557	969	259
40—45	28	14	73	45	125	123	188	49	521	639	1,063	376
45—50	28	13	65	41	141	157	193	49	457	629	1,116	248
50—55	22	15	54	39	198	207	208	57	739	806	1,155	307
55—60	24	13	57	33	235	249	174	44	623	686	1,172	281
60 and over	21	15	53	36	556	569	176	43	966	946	1,440	343

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000 PERSONS OF EACH CASTE, AND NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.

HINDUS, ANIMISTS AND CHRISTIANS.

CASTE, TRIBE OR RACE.	Locality.	NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000.								NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.			
		INSANE.		DEAF-MUTES.		BLIND.		LEPERS.		Insane.	Deaf-mutes.	Blind.	Lepers.
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.				
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
AGARIA	Bihar and Orissa	37	36	119	73	82	95	37	73	1,000	625	1,182	2,000
AGARWALA	Bihar and Orissa	19	14	68	35	105	69	37	...	666	454	388	...
AJAT	Bihar and Orissa	231	38	1,755	1,444	139	368	277	76	200	1,000	5,000	333
AMAT	Bihar and Orissa	6	9	140	81	104	53	55	16	1,500	604	531	294
ANGLO-INDIAN... ...	Bengal	160	181	43	11	85	149	21	...	1,133	250	1,750	...
ATITH	Bihar and Orissa	12	4	127	43	94	115	98	32	333	387	1,391	375
BABHAN	Bihar and Orissa	12	3	74	32	89	62	31	3	253	423	666	61
BAGDI	Bihar and Orissa	11	11	159	89	193	268	296	167	1,000	571	1,411	577
	Bengal	32	18	73	54	99	86	153	49	560	750	960	327
BAIDYA	Bengal	104	47	45	34	97	66	32	9	457	750	674	286
BAISHNAB	Bihar and Orissa	39	19	109	59	179	193	154	64	437	488	975	375
	Bengal	98	58	80	50	153	129	121	46	669	760	1,020	422
BANIYA	Bihar and Orissa	52	15	159	80	215	188	95	41	250	518	966	439
	Bengal	210	163	262	433	228	650	123	135	500	1,067	1,846	714
BARAI	Bihar and Orissa	12	14	145	67	179	149	150	32	1,125	473	892	218
BARHI	Bihar and Orissa	13	7	90	54	127	130	35	10	571	633	1,095	290
BARNAWAR	Bihar and Orissa	25	12	95	107	123	143	111	36	500	4,500	1,090	333
BARUI	Bengal	54	26	89	54	56	45	22	1	480	554	685	50
BAURI	Bihar and Orissa	16	10	52	46	138	148	272	144	652	894	1,090	540
	Bengal	20	22	53	46	102	173	395	237	1,133	890	1,733	619
BEDEA	Bihar and Orissa	23	14	138	107	54	128	15	...	666	833	2,571	...
BELDAR	Bihar and Orissa	11	2	57	40	88	145	77	7	200	720	1,641	88
BHANDARI	Bihar and Orissa	21	7	86	58	94	95	136	28	333	714	1,095	215
BHAR	Bihar and Orissa	...	...	93	147	27	204	34	19	...	1,643	8,000	600
BHAT	Bihar and Orissa	40	...	224	83	295	110	112	...	...	429	432	...
BHOGTA	Bihar and Orissa	10	5	41	23	69	89	8	5	500	562	1,296	666
BHUINMALI	Bengal	60	34	86	61	84	76	34	7	560	694	886	214
BHUIYA	Bihar and Orissa	12	9	45	45	110	123	78	39	769	1,061	1,162	438
	Bengal	16	6	37	22	39	41	227	60	333	714	591	224
BHULIA	Bihar and Orissa	6	6	70	24	41	59	70	30	1,000	333	1,428	416
BHUMIJ	Bihar and Orissa	8	9	57	44	84	106	77	48	1,181	851	1,372	690
	Bengal	111	16	54	45	61	57	134	93	149	870	962	631
BIND	Bihar and Orissa	10	3	76	46	119	134	35	10	333	687	1,290	318
BINJHAL	Bihar and Orissa	13	3	29	25	46	69	63	19	250	888	1,571	316
BRAHMAN	Bihar and Orissa	30	9	102	44	125	73	82	23	307	434	597	278
	Bengal	93	41	66	49	82	54	43	16	388	636	579	237
CHAIN	Bihar and Orissa	19	...	84	48	159	102	51	24	...	800	680	500
CHAMAR	Bihar and Orissa	10	7	94	60	110	109	49	12	769	702	1,122	268
	Bengal	46	48	134	156	121	210	133	66	600	872	1,000	287

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000 PERSONS OF EACH CASTE, AND NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES—*continued*.

HINDUS, ANIMISTS AND CHRISTIANS—*contd.*

CASTE, TRIBE OR RACE.	LOCALITY.	NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000.								NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.			
		INSANE.		DEAF-MUTE.		BLIND.		LEPERS.		Insane.	Deaf-mute.	Blind.	Lepers.
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.				
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
CHASA	Bihar and Orissa	18	8	57	30	78	59	129	36	493	549	777	292
	Bengal	130	347	777	347	1,884	2,083	1,884	694	1,000	167	462	194
CHIK	Bihar and Orissa	19	19	96	94	109	132	13	13	1,000	1,000	1,235	1,000
DHANUK	Bihar and Orissa	9	6	96	52	126	117	59	12	720	592	1,017	224
	Bengal	163	67	138	99	190	265	109	33	333	600	1,143	290
DHOBA	Bihar and Orissa	19	12	97	65	113	126	64	30	706	702	1,173	379
	Bengal	37	27	103	53	78	57	43	12	682	475	684	235
DOM	Bihar and Orissa	15	7	71	45	95	79	120	35	500	647	858	301
	Bengal	1	29	150	105	119	148	200	113	600	781	1,265	547
DOSADH	Bihar and Orissa	12	5	95	72	169	139	67	9	500	820	897	153
	Bengal	34	22	24	22	153	122	43	11	286	400	544	111
DUMAL	Bihar and Orissa	18	3	48	41	79	94	109	44	167	875	1,231	417
EUROPEAN AND ALLIED RACES.	Bengal	96	147	20	40	20	80	14	...	750	1,000	2,000	...
GANDA	Bihar and Orissa	5	7	37	26	48	52	22	16	2,400	718	1,120	739
GANDHABANIK ...	Bihar and Orissa	8	9	50	52	185	158	76	77	1,000	1,000	727	1,000
	Bengal	72	10	67	68	81	77	129	30	139	1,000	958	234
GANGAI	Bihar and Orissa	13	...	96	48	71	89	75	92	...	565	1,412	333
GANGAUTA	Bihar and Orissa	33	7	81	72	147	142	71	7	231	969	1,002	107
GARERI	Bihar and Orissa	16	17	81	33	115	85	23	6	1,143	444	804	300
GARO	Bengal	51	37	78	33	161	155	60	42	727	411	943	692
GAURA	Bihar and Orissa	12	11	67	43	94	88	92	32	952	681	994	371
GHASI	Bihar and Orissa	23	14	139	70	141	120	23	25	625	543	896	1,125
GOALA OR AHIR ...	Bihar and Orissa	10	5	96	55	112	111	44	10	531	578	995	226
	Bengal	38	34	71	63	82	91	92	62	729	727	904	948
GOKHA	Bihar and Orissa	9	17	65	29	48	21	148	58	2,000	467	455	412
GOLA	Bihar and Orissa	25	18	50	20	65	58	137	36	714	571	889	263
GOND	Bihar and Orissa	19	10	73	39	81	77	63	34	545	824	968	541
GONR	Bihar and Orissa	...	3	...	83	3	56	...	6	...	...	19,000	...
GONRHI	Bihar and Orissa	8	9	78	22	111	75	65	4	1,300	308	714	73
GOSAIN	Bihar and Orissa	56	8	64	50	161	215	56	8	143	750	1,300	143
GURIA	Bihar and Orissa	17	7	98	45	132	108	196	32	417	486	872	281
HAJJAM	Bihar and Orissa	22	8	116	76	167	157	59	14	381	691	993	250
HALALKHOR	Bihar and Orissa	11	11	22	64	359	181	65	21	1,000	2,000	515	333
HALWAI	Bihar and Orissa	24	17	122	50	123	97	41	7	706	419	793	172
HARI	Bihar and Orissa	41	26	242	167	159	176	133	62	667	718	1,151	467
	Bengal	38	33	100	96	104	90	127	38	794	932	837	294
HO	Bihar and Orissa	1	1	5	7	2	1	3	...	500	1,400	400	...
INDIAN CHRISTIAN ...	Bihar and Orissa	16	1	43	25	74	79	190	192	56	825	949	1,038
	Bengal	53	30	60	47	66	70	634	321	522	731	737	472
JOGI AND JUGI ...	Bihar and Orissa	23	45	194	195	158	307	119	6	2,000	1,000	1,929	48
	Bengal	58	38	89	48	70	54	27	7	641	548	726	259

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000 PERSONS OF EACH CASTE, AND NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES—*continued.*

HINDUS, ANIMISTS AND CHRISTIANS—*contd.*

CASTE, TRIBE OR RACE.	LOCALITY.	NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000.								NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES			
		INSANE.		DEAF-MUTE.		BLIND.		LEPERS.		Insane.	Deaf-mute.	Blind.	Lepers.
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.				
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
KAHAR	Bihar and Orissa	16	11	103	64	201	209	106	20	769	689	1,183	218
	Bengal	19	42	57	96	81	146	47	55	1,125	792	853	550
KAIBARTTA (Total) ...	Bihar and Orissa	11	19	143	70	76	70	54	25	1,500	500	916	480
	Bengal	35	22	67	42	75	62	39	11	611	613	821	272
KAIBARTTA (Chasi) ...	Bihar and Orissa	7	...	29	...	7	...	7	...	...	...	...	...
	Bengal	29	18	58	36	62	37	36	10	587	614	900	269
KAIBARTTA (Jaliya) ...	Bihar and Orissa	...	...	44	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
	Bengal	54	37	77	50	101	71	31	10	655	637	678	327
KAIBARTTA (Unspecified)	Bihar and Orissa	27	29	202	107	116	107	79	39	1,800	541	943	500
	Bengal	244	193	698	431	888	495	387	92	724	566	529	217
KALU	Bihar and Orissa	22	14	134	109	259	299	308	127	600	800	1,138	406
	Bengal	61	33	104	96	136	124	233	109	470	914	894	461
KALWAR	Bihar and Orissa	24	10	117	62	95	70	47	5	429	548	753	119
KAMAR	Bihar and Orissa	19	9	112	65	117	112	72	27	477	598	996	385
	Bengal	48	31	70	57	92	66	62	26	591	750	666	388
KANDH	Bihar and Orissa	12	5	36	21	49	61	85	39	444	623	1,288	494
KANDRA OR KADMA ...	Bihar and Orissa	15	7	64	19	81	37	148	42	545	313	492	306
	Bengal	...	27	183	60	97	81	81	27	...	323	833	333
KANDU	Bihar and Orissa	14	7	125	74	144	140	63	8	500	630	1,046	130
KAPALI	Bengal	42	37	78	54	81	58	21	8	848	661	687	333
KARAN	Bihar and Orissa	38	8	58	14	56	39	118	25	222	268	750	226
	Bengal	45	11	112	39	101	58	63	31	250	353	555	479
KARMALI	Bihar and Orissa	18	...	72	19	72	65	9	9	...	250	875	1,000
KASARWANI	Bihar and Orissa	43	7	144	71	100	114	29	14	167	500	1,286	500
KASERA	Bihar and Orissa	7	7	40	40	87	20	47	7	1,000	1,000	231	143
KAYASTH	Bihar and Orissa	42	16	107	43	139	75	40	5	365	382	514	127
	bengal	93	46	73	50	88	61	22	11	471	651	658	454
KEWAT	Bihar and Orissa	22	6	78	50	126	105	89	39	318	690	891	462
	Bengal	24	13	68	31	80	140	216	77	333	666	1,571	316
KHAIRA	Bihar and Orissa	20	...	39	123	59	176	69	95	...	3,250	3,000	1,429
	Bengal	20	5	55	43	119	138	353	220	250	818	1,208	648
KHANDAIT	Bihar and Orissa	22	7	77	28	99	73	130	39	354	406	810	331
	Bengal	14	102	7	267	7	425	7	374	2,000	15,000	16,500	14,500
KHARIA	Bihar and Orissa	27	11	64	63	116	99	135	26	429	1,020	883	700
KHARWAR	Bihar and Orissa	14	9	31	34	71	108	14	11	667	1,184	1,567	833
KHATWE	Bihar and Orissa	7	...	96	55	110	106	56	13	...	642	1,066	258
KHETAURI	Bihar and Orissa	8	...	76	35	114	77	91	14	...	500	733	167
KISAN	Bihar and Orissa	16	10	70	61	106	82	16	20	667	923	842	133
KOCH	Bengal	13	16	27	18	116	116	239	10	1,250	647	987	400
KOIRI	Bihar and Orissa	15	7	166	100	132	129	47	8	384	614	999	175
KOLTA	Bihar and Orissa	3	6	13	46	20	69	10	16	2,000	3,125	3,583	1,667
KORA	Bihar and Orissa	5	10	39	14	140	62	24	10	2,000	375	448	400
	Bengal	59	44	69	58	103	146	133	63	750	666	1,429	481

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000 PERSONS OF EACH CASTE, AND NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES—*continued.*

HINDUS, ANIMISTS AND CHRISTIANS—*continued.*

CASTE, TRIBE OR RACE.	LOCALITY.	NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000.								NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.			
		INSANE.		DEAF-MUTE.		BLIND.		LEPERS.		Insane.	Deaf-mute.	Blind.	Lepers.
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.				
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
KUMHAR	Bihar and Orissa	11	9	99	72	105	144	62	23	786	728	1,375 719	373
	Bengal	54	28	81	63	93	71	59	20	493	729		326
KURMI	Bihar and Orissa	15	6	96	58	143	150	61	17	412	616	1,061	287
	Bengal	29	23	137	68	195	217	111	88	636	398	1,033	631
LOHAR	Bengal	40	18	75	30	86	121	421	206	428	389	805	465
MAGH	Bengal	81	86	57	52	86	56	21	9	1,098	944	1,077	461
MAHLI	Bihar and Orissa	6	...	47	78	41	44	28	50	...	1,667		1,778
MAHURI	Bihar and Orissa	81	7	144	64	108	222	45	93	111	563	2,333	2,600
MAL	Bihar and Orissa	...	24	8	65	75	73	183	178	...	800	1,000 336	1,000
	Bengal	22	2	92	19	144	55	158	93	111	216		609
MALI	Bihar and Orissa	7	10	73	43	83	137	70	39	1,400	588	1,655 1,111	551
	Bengal	22	65	132	117	99	129	386	...	2,400	710		...
MALLAH	Bihar and Orissa	5	4	107	76	109	97	54	40	889	802	1,005 2,500	220
	Bengal	84	133	137	309	84	442	158	508	500	1,077		1,533
MALO	Bengal	35	33	40	37	85	64	39	9	909	882	722	220
MAL PAHARIA ...	Bihar and Orissa	5	...	5	46	5	56	5	5	...	9,000	11,000	1,000
MAYRA	Bihar and Orissa	43	26	188	95	179	276	284	164	600	500	1,524	422
	Bengal	54	25	75	37	75	49	87	76	391	656	562	757
MECH	Bengal	65	82	112	205	47	72	233	41	1,142	1,666	1,400	160
MUCHI	Bihar and Orissa	32	...	63	39	128	96	146	96	...	600	750	632
	Bengal	19	17	45	29	34	41	15	1	894	739	1,035	270
MUNDA	Bihar and Orissa	22	34	99	74	147	133	58	33	1,125	812	942	596
	Bengal	17	6	51	40	34	40	43	25	333	722	1,083	500
MUSAHAR	Bihar and Orissa		5	49	36	86	87	84	43	895	735	1,038	517
NAMASUDRA	Bengal	48	36	86	53	71	51	29	8	729	604	706	265
NAPIT	Bihar and Orissa	23	17	91	79	137	187	74	108	750	875	1,375	1,461
	Bengal	32	34	90	58	83	67	41	20	622	613	763	468
NUNIYA	Bihar and Orissa	11	3	79	38	122	105	60	9	513	815	962	167
ORAON	Bihar and Orissa	18	13	63	47	139	148	16	11	825	813	1,155	703
	Bengal	15	13	56	43	67	63	18	7	769	660	800	313
PAN	Bihar and Orissa	11	5	68	31	82	79	94	32	462	474	295	369
PASI	Bihar and Orissa	12	8	61	35	105	152	74	15	667	565	1,443	196
PATNI	Bengal	15	23	18	30	40	38	76	8	1,500	1,600	909	95
PATRA	Bihar and Orissa	28	10	80	41	80	71	91	41	400	571	1,000	500
PATWA	Bihar and Orissa	48	...	132	35	96	164	36	...	...	273	1,750	...
POD	Bengal	42	36	54	38	33	38	14	5	812	687	692	308
RAJBANSI	Bihar and Orissa	32	20	104	68	106	112	85	23	556	593	950	230
	Bengal	65	47	86	50	73	64	80	21	675	584	816	244
RAJPUT	Bihar and Orissa	20	4	99	43	108	73	62	7	214	421	650	113
	Bengal	91	57	107	128	104	171	243	146	364	692	952	344
RAJU	Bihar and Orissa	19	15	91	50	42	62	160	35	800	542	1,455	214
RAJWAR	Bihar and Orissa	9	12	49	42	143	162	140	33	1,333	875	1,135	386
	Bengal	141	134	347	269	358	281	499	208	846	688	697	370

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV TO CHAPTER X.—NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000 PERSONS OF EACH CASTE, AND NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES—*continued.*

HINDUS, ANIMISTS AND CHRISTIANS—*concluded.*

CASTE, TRIBE OR RACE.	LOCALITY.	NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000.								NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.			
		INSANE.		DEAF-MUTES.		BLIND.		LEPERS.		Insane.	Deaf-mutes.	Blind.	Lepers.
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.				
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
RAUNIAR	Bihar and Orissa	29	10	78	53	124	41	45	22	333	667	333	474
SADGOP	Bihar and Orissa	31	36	39	36	85	118	131	64	1,000	800	1,182	412
	Bengal	50	18	91	40	95	51	163	24	353	437	525	148
SAHAR	Bihar and Orissa	6	4	48	23	92	93	136	95	667	523	1,082	746
SANNYASI	Bihar and Orissa	9	...	94	56	113	28	47	9	...	600	250	200
SANTAL	Bihar and Orissa	9	6	42	33	37	48	41	22	689	802	1,310	543
	Bengal	15	9	39	35	41	44	58	34	580	878	1,038	582
SARAK	Bihar and Orissa	67	28	323	113	390	480	349	113	400	333	1,172	308
	Bengal	51	...	51	100	307	50	1,073	400	...	2,000	166	381
SAVAR	Bihar and Orissa	15	8	15	54	74	46	245	54	500	3,500	600	212
SHAGIRDPESHA ...	Bihar and Orissa	20	4	133	73	103	69	128	38	250	704	857	385
SOKIAR	Bihar and Orissa	...	13	45	13	100	93	45	...	...	333	1,000	...
SONAR	Bihar and Orissa	27	8	91	60	113	108	53	7	321	674	975	125
SUBARNABANIK ...	Bihar and Orissa	81	41	121	104	172	218	212	52	500	833	1,235	238
	Bengal	87	30	129	47	99	64	35	25	324	345	619	666
SUDH	Bihar and Orissa	13	...	33	7	108	37	90	27	...	231	357	314
SUDRA	Bengal	69	44	69	32	85	49	30	6	694	510	633	238
SUNRI	Bihar and Orissa	17	1	95	63	154	136	94	55	762	678	1,041	605
	Bengal	67	27	88	57	79	99	240	115	385	640	1,196	460
SUTRADHAR	Bengal	61	37	54	45	93	75	52	26	571	780	753	458
TAMBULI	Bihar and Orissa	30	15	142	45	142	165	137	30	500	321	1,181	222
	Bengal	71	21	63	67	109	97	50	59	294	1,067	885	1,167
TANTI	Bihar and Orissa	11	7	102	55	125	111	90	38	750	594	986	473
	Bengal	48	21	103	50	91	92	59	27	395	440	916	420
TELI AND TILI ...	Bihar and Orissa	24	7	85	57	123	113	63	29	309	700	952	295
	Bengal	57	34	79	62	86	79	125	57	552	725	836	419
THARU	Bihar and Orissa	11	17	51	64	45	29	17	12	1,500	1,200	625	666
THATHERA	Bihar and Orissa	23	...	78	36	163	87	31	15	...	500	571	500
TIPARA	Bengal	36	45	29	19	42	36	29	14	1,208	632	821	474
TIYAR	Bihar and Orissa	21	6	59	28	155	141	59	28	333	529	1,000	529
	Bengal	37	30	74	49	65	69	39	10	800	650	1,057	262
TURI	Bihar and Orissa	...	8	9	25	41	25	5	62	...	11,500	2,555	15,000

MUSALMANS.

DARZI	Bihar and Orissa	11	15	97	62	108	139	34	15	1,500	706	1,421	500
DHOBI	Bihar and Orissa	4	...	46	4	25	8	46	...	...	90	333	...
DHUNIA	Bihar and Orissa	7	6	141	99	139	115	70	6	1,000	804	946	90
FAKIR	Bihar and Orissa	9	26	123	97	169	120	55	9	3,000	850	763	166
JOLAHA	Bihar and Orissa	14	10	119	79	144	131	61	16	800	748	1,022	295
	Bengal	26	21	59	38	42	61	19	11	700	555	1,067	483
KALAL	Bihar and Orissa	6	10	137	35	84	55	30	20	2,000	304	785	800
KULU	Bengal	34	14	55	45	55	36	12	4	375	769	615	333
KASSAB	Bihar and Orissa	...	...	73	95	29	54	73	...	...	1,400	2,000	...

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000 PERSONS OF EACH CASTE, AND NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES—*concluded.*

MUSALMANS—*concluded.*

CASTE, TRIBE OR RACE.	LOCALITY.	NUMBER AFFLICTED PER 100,000.								NUMBER OF FEMALES AFFLICTED PER 1,000 MALES.			
		INSANE.		DEAF-MUTES.		BLIND.		LEPERS.					
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Insane.	Deaf-mutes.	Blind.	Lepers.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
KUNJRA	Bihar and Orissa	8	10	113	60	114	117	45	10	1,428	594	1,137	250
MALLIK	Bihar and Orissa	21	36	158	71	211	293	243	151	2,000	533	1,640	739
NAU MUSLIM	Bihar and Orissa	...	100	463	797	199	299	66	...	...	2,285	2,000	...
NIKARI	Bengal	47	65	124	47	77	77	29	65	1,385	381	1,000	2,200
PATHAN	Bihar and Orissa	21	8	109	68	128	104	74	27	409	672	875	392
	Bengal	45	14	91	60	90	92	111	31	232	507	790	213
SAIYAD	Bihar and Orissa	54	6	128	103	115	116	56	25	125	842	885	320
	Bengal	45	28	63	74	69	65	32	9	529	1,000	808	250
SHEIKH	Bihar and Orissa	19	15	132	98	114	102	68	18	817	766	928	258
	Bengal	38	24	75	55	84	72	50	11	582	686	795	211
SIKKIM.													
BHOTIA	Sikkim	...	17	202	284	47	67	47	84	...	1,308	1,333	1,667
BRAHMAN	*id*	69	36	451	179	174	...	...	...	500	385	..	...
KHAMBU	*id*	25	13	164	76	38	25	...	...	500	462	667	...
KHAS	*id*	31	...	336	409	...	...	31	...	...	1,091	...	...
LEPCHA	*id*	...	...	384	367	21	46	21	161	...	941	2,000	7,000
MURMI	*id*	...	...	459	241	27	...	27	54	...	529	...	2,000

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CHAPTER XI.

CASTE.

INTRODUCTORY.

824. At the last census statistics of all castes and tribes were compiled, but it was realized that the compilation of figures for a great number of minor groups, each of which formed an infinitesimal fraction of the population, involved an expenditure of time and labour which was incommensurate with the value of the results. At this census it was laid down by the Government of India that the caste table should give statistics only for the more important castes and for any others which Local Governments for special reasons might wish to include. At the same time it was stated that any Local Government might, if it wished, order a complete table to be prepared. The then Government of Bengal availed itself of the discretionary powers allowed to it, and decided that figures should be compiled only for castes or tribes which in 1901 numbered 50,000 or more, for other castes or tribes that accounted for 25,000 or more in any single district, and for any other castes, tribes and races that were of local importance or of special ethnological interest. The castes coming under the last category were selected in consultation with the District Officers. Table XIII therefore gives statistics only of selected castes and tribes for Bihar and Orissa and in Bengal for the Burdwan and Presidency Divisions, the district of Darjeeling and the State of Cooch Behar, all of which were under the Bengal Government at the time of the census. Altogether 205 castes and tribes are entered in the table for Bihar and Orissa besides European and allied races. In Eastern Bengal statistics were compiled for all castes and tribes but not for European races : over 450 groups with a strength varying from 1 to 22,000,000 will be found in the table for this sub-province, but half of them have under 1,000 representatives. It is to be regretted that when the trouble was taken to record the numerical strength of such a large number of communities, it was not decided to compile statistics for such races as the English Irish, Scotch and other European nationalities.

CASTE CLAIMS.

825. No part of the census aroused so much excitement as the return of castes. There was a general idea in Bengal that the object of the census is not to show the number of persons belonging to each caste, but to fix the relative status of different castes and to deal with questions of social superiority. Some frankly regarded the census as an opportunity that might fairly be taken to obliterate caste distinctions. The feeling on the subject was very largely the result of castes having been classified in the last census report in order of social precedence. This "warrant of precedence" gave rise to considerable agitation at the time and proved a legacy of trouble. The agitation was renewed when the census operations of 1911 were instituted. Hundreds of petitions were received from different castes—their weight alone amounts to 1½ maunds —requesting that they might be known by new names, be placed higher in the order of precedence, be recognized as Kshattriyas, Vaisyas, etc. Many castes were aggrieved at the position assigned them, and complained that it lowered them in public estimation. The Subarnabaniks, in particular, were offended at being placed low down in the list, whereas in 1891 they were grouped with other Bania castes among Vaisyas. Others thought it a suitable opportunity to advance new claims. It was impossible to comply with these requests, as it was decided from the outset that there should be no classification of castes by status.

METHODS PURSUED.

826. The methods pursued by the castes who desire to attain a higher status follow a more or less stereotyped plan. One of the first steps is to obtain favourable *vyavashthas* or rulings from complaisant Pandits. These refer to the present occupations and manner of life of the caste, and quote verses from ancient works to show that they are like those of the *varna* from which the caste claims to be an offshoot. Other Hindus do not care what rulings the Pandits give, provided that their own status is not affected. Their treatment of the

aspirant caste remains the same, and they rarely pay attention to the rulings. Recently, however, a body known as the Samaj Raksha Sabha of Benares took disciplinary measures against certain Pandits who had pronounced in favour of a section of a Bengali caste that claimed to be Vaisyas. The Sabha found that their *vyavashtha* was wrong and compelled all but one of the Pandits to withdraw it and to return the money they had received. The Pandit who refused to recant or refund the money was punished by being deprived of the services of his priest.

The ruling of the Pandits is also frequently reinforced by pointing out the similarity of the present caste name to the historic name of some respectable but extinct tribe or caste. This argument is usually based on some phonetic similarity, *e.g.*, Pod and Pundra. But there is little or no attempt to prove historical connection, or to show that the modern and archaic names are, or ever have been, colloquial equivalents.

827. Another expedient is to adopt an entirely new name which points to a respectable origin. As a case in point may be mentioned Mahishya, a designation recently assumed by the Chasi Kaibarttas, a cultivating community, in order to distinguish themselves from the Jaliya Kaibarttas, who follow what Hindus regard as a degrading occupation, viz., fishing. Mahishya is a name derived from *mahisha* (meaning a buffalo), which was given to a mixed caste by the Sanskrit law-givers, and was probably applied to a caste or tribe of cattle-keepers and graziers : it is mentioned in the *Gautama Dharma Sutra* (a work not later than 300 B.C.), in which a Mahishya is described as born of a Vaisya woman by a Kshattriya father. More frequently, however, ambitious castes, strive to attain greater respectability not by adopting a new name but by calling themselves Kshattriyas or Vaisyas (two of the old *varnas* or "estates" of Manu's days) or their fallen descendants (Bratya). The next step is to enter the name in registered deeds and to cite that fact as a proof that it is their proper designation. This is an easy enough matter. One low caste man who claimed a magniloquent new title for his caste, went so far as to declare : "In respect of caste we may designate ourselves as we like in documents that may be presented for registration."*

Recently two new and ingenious expedients have been adopted by the low Bengali castes. The first is to declare that their ancestors were Buddhists and were degraded by the victorious Brahmans, or by King Ballal Sen, when Brahmanical supremacy was re-established. The second is to allege that originally they were not Bengalis, but immigrants from up-country, whose original status was not recognized in the country of their adoption.

828. The following is a list of the names, other than those generally recognized, that were claimed at this census.

NEW NAMES.

The list is divided, for facility of reference, into castes that wished to have themselves returned as (A) Brahmans, (B) Kshattriyas, (C) Vaisyas and (D) under other names.

Caste.	Locality.	Name claimed.
	A.	
Babhan ...	... Bihar	... Brahman.
Belwar ...	... Saran	... Brahman.
Namasudra	... Bengal	... Namasudra-Brahman.
	B.	
Hadi ...	... Mymensingh	... Haijay Kshattriya.
Koch ...	... Mymensingh	... Koch Kshattriya.
Kurmi ...	... Bihar	... Kurmi Kshattriya.
Malo (Jhalo and Malo)	Bengal	... (1) Bratya Kshattriya. (2) Jhalo Bratya Kshattriya and Malo Bratya Kshattriya.

* Under section 58 of the Indian Registration Act the signature and "addition" of every person admitting execution has to be endorsed on a registered document, and "addition" includes caste. The endorsement is usually made by a rubber stamp in a prescribed form. The party admitting execution signs his name, but the blanks on the form, including the entry of caste, are filled in by the registering officer, who has to ascertain his caste from the man himself. The officer is in a difficult position if the man will not state his real caste, but gives some new fangled name.

Caste.	Locality.	Name claimed.
		(3) Jhalla Kshattriya and Malla Kshattriya.
		(4) Jhalo (Bratya Kshattriya) and Malo (Bratya Kshattriya).
		(5) Jhalla-Barman or Jhalo-Barma and Malla Barman or Malo Barma.
Napit	East Bengal ...	(1) Kshattriya.
		(2) Paramanik or Sila Das.
		(3) Kayasth or Parashab.
Pod	Bengal ...	(1) Bratya Kshattriya.
		(2) Pundra Kshattriya.
Pundari	Bengal ...	Pundra Kshattriya.
Rajbansi ...	Eastern Bengal ...	(1) Kshattriya.
		(2) Rajbansi Kshattriya.
		(3) Kshattriya Rajbansi.
		(4) Bratya Kshattriya.
		(5) Patit Kshattriya.
		(6) Bhanga Kshattriya.
Rajbansi ...	Cooch-Behar ...	(1) Kshattriya Rajbansi.
		(2) Rajbansi Kshattriya.
	Purnea ...	Bhanga Kshattriya.
	C.	
Barui	Bengal ...	Vaisya Barujibi or Barujibi.
Gandhabanil ...	East Bengal ...	Vaisya Gandhabanik.
Gaura	Cuttack ...	Vaisya Gop.
Goala	Bengal ...	Vaisya Ballabh Gop.
Haladhar ...	Central Bengal ...	Vaisya.
Karmakar ...	Bengal ...	Karmakar Vaisya or Karmakriti.
Sadgop ...	Bengal ...	Vaisya Sadgop.
	East Bengal ...	(1) Vaisya Gop.
		(2) Purba Bangia Satgop.
Shaha	Bengal ...	(1) Vaisya.
		(2) Vaisya Shaha.
		(3) Sadhubanik or Sahabanik.
Subarnabanik ...	Bengal ...	Vaisya.
Sutradhar ...	Bengal ...	Vaisya Sutradhar.
Tambuli ...	Howrah ...	Tambuli Vaisya.
Tili	East Bengal ...	Vaisya.
	D.	
Baishnab ...	Bengal ...	Brahma Baishnab.
Bhuinmali ...	East Bengal ...	Bhumi Das.
Chasadhoba ...	Bengal ...	Satchasi.
Doai	Dacca ...	Sudra or Patikar.
Gangai (Ganesh) ...	Purnea and North Bengal.	Tantubai.
Jogi or Jugi ...	Bengal ...	Yogi.
Jolahas ...	Bengal ...	Sheikh.
Kalu	Bengal ...	Taili.
Kumhar (Kumbhakar)	Mymensingh ...	Rudra Pal.
Shagirdpesha ...	Midnapore ...	Madhyasreni Kayasth.
Sonar	Gaya ...	Kanaujia Chhattri.

THE MODERN CASTE AND THE *Varna*.

829. In Manu's days Hindu society was divided into four *varnas*, or classes, or as it might also be translated "the four estates." There is a general desire among the low castes of Bengal to merge the modern caste in the ancient class by calling themselves Kshattriyas or Vaisyas, two of those *varnas*. These ambitious castes point to present practices as though they are proof of origin, oblivious of the fact that argument as to origin cannot be drawn from present modern usage and that practices change from day to day. They imagine that by using the old name, they will have the respectability attaching to it, though the Hindu community is very conservative and does not overlook centuries of tradition

and practice. The castes that aspire to be recognized as Kshattriyas or Vaisyas obtain however a certain amount of support from Pandits. Instead of recognizing that a caste which used to be of poor repute has risen in the social scale, the Pandits overcome the difficulty by the pleasing fiction that they never were that humble caste. They overlook questions of origin and descent, as well as the views of their predecessors and of the main body of Hindus, and consider avocation only. They compare, for instance, the present occupation of the caste and that of the old *varna*, and if it is the same, identify the caste with the *varna*. Thus, according to Manu, the Chandals were a degraded race, whose principal occupation was that of burning the dead and hanging criminals ; they were vagrants who kept dogs and asses, and were clothed in rags stripped from the dead. No Namasudra (a new name for the Chandal) at the present day does any of these things, and therefore, some Pandits rule that they are not Chandals. Other castes, who have given up their traditional occupations and are engaged in trade, claim to be Vaisyas. The Pandit's argument in such cases is briefly.—"These men are traders. The Vaisyas were traders. Therefore, these men are Vaisyas." The following extract from a resolution passed in June 1912 by the Executive Committee of the Vanga Dharma Mandal (the Bengal branch of the Bharat Dharma Mahamandal) illustrates the standpoint adopted :—"In view of the opinions expressed by Pandits and leading members of the Bengali Hindu Society, and by the special officer deputed by the Vanga Dharma Mandal in this behalf to make local enquiries, the Vanga Dharma Mandal is of opinion that the Rarhi and Varendra Sahas of Eastern Bengal, as represented by the Eastern Bengal and Sylhet Vaisya Samity, whose manners and customs substantially resemble those of the upper classes of Hindu society, and whose callings and professions do not differ from those of the Vaisyas, are a distinct caste from the Sunri Sahas, and that their claim to be classed as Vaisyas may be conceded as being not inconsistent with the principles and practices enjoined by the Sastras."

QUESTIONS OF NOMENCLATURE.

830. To the claims of those that desired to be returned as Kshattriyas or Vaisyas, the answer had to be that the census is designed to obtain a record of castes, at present existing, under the names by which they were generally known and not of the *varnas* that existed centuries ago.* The census record has nothing to do with their origin, and it does not matter whether they are descendants or modern representatives of the ancient Vaisyas, Kshattriyas, etc., or not. If their claims were entertained, we should revert to prehistoric times, in which Hindu society was divided between four estates. There would be no record of their numbers, no clue to their progress or decay, no statistics throwing light on their occupations, social practices, etc. Such claims, moreover, are sometimes made only by a handful of educated or half-educated men, who put themselves forward as spokesmen for the whole caste. The main body may be ignorant of their representation, or careless of the result, while their pretensions may be scouted by the general Hindu community. It is significant also that, in some cases, the caste itself is divided in opinion, one section claiming that it is Vaisya and another that it is Kshattriya. The most interesting feature of the agitation is perhaps that the low castes still apparently look to the Census Superintendent as having the power of the old Hindu Kings to raise and lower castes—forgetful that the admission of their claims might result in a state of affairs resembling that called *varnasankara*, or confusion of classes, which was so sternly denounced by the early Hindu sages.

831. The case of those castes who discard the name borne by their ancestors and arrogate a new designation is different. In their case the new name is recognized by the census authorities, if it generally applied to them by the

* The Indian Association submitted a memorial on this subject representing that Government should "allow individuals and communities to return themselves as they desire to be known and called". The Government of Bengal replied, viz., that their request appeared "to violate the principal object for which the census is conducted, to obtain a record of existing facts, and *inter alia* to obtain statistics of the numbers of persons belonging to the different castes now recognized. This object would have been defeated if the members of the various castes had been permitted to adopt new caste designations at their own discretion and to have such designations returned in the schedules. The only possible principle to adopt is that castes should be entered by the names by which they are generally known ; to admit other names would cause endless confusion and would, in many cases, lead to friction between rival communities belonging to the same caste ".

Hindu community at large and is not used by any other caste. In this way, the Chandals have been allowed to be returned as Namasudras, that term being recognized by the Hindus generally and applying exclusively to them. Similarly, the Chasi Kaibarttas are allowed to return themselves as Mahishya, for, though that name has been adopted by the Chasi Kaibarttas in recent times, it has won general recognition and is exclusively applied to the Chasi Kaibarttas. Ten years ago this innovation was resented by conservative Hindus in some places—in Nadia the higher castes went so far as to refuse to take water from the Chasi Kaibarttas—but it is now generally tolerated. On the other hand, it was not possible to concede the request of the Chasadhobas, who are very anxious to change their name and be called Satchasi in order to falsify the tradition that they were Dhobas or washermen who took to cultivation. Their occupation is cultivation, and they have no connection with the Dhobas, but they consider that the name casts a slur upon them. Inquiry, however, showed that they are not usually known as Satchasi, and that this is also a designation of Sadgop. The Chasadhobas themselves also admitted that, much to their disgust, another community assumed the same name. Their representations bore fruit, however, for the various names used by them were carefully traced out and a more accurate return of their numbers was obtained. The name Chasadhoba was returned by some, but others preferred the new designation of Satchasi. Elsewhere, *e.g.*, in Murshidabad, some called themselves Chasati and others Haliarai or Haladhar. The net result was that their number in the returns for West and Central Bengal was doubled.

CLAIMS TO THE NAME OF BRAHMAN.

BABHANS.

832. Only three castes claimed to have themselves entered in the schedules as Brahmans, viz., the Babhans, Belwars and Namasudras. The Babhans are a large and influential caste in Bihar, who say that they are and always have been Brahmans, and now differ from those who are universally recognized as such in having taken to cultivation and given up the principal functions connected with priesthood, viz., officiating as priests in religious ceremonies, teaching the Vedas, and receiving alms. They claim that, even at the present day, Maithil Brahmans who take to non-priestly occupations such as cultivation and secede from their own community are admitted among them. They also contend that many of their ceremonies are performed in the same manner and style, and with the same *mantras* as those of Brahmans.*

833. It appears very probable that the Babhans were originally Brahmans, and that their degradation from the status of Brahmans dates back to the downfall of Buddhism. Babhan is merely the Pali form of Brahman and is found in Asoka's pillar inscriptions as a corruption of Brahman—in one place in connection with the Sramanas or Buddhist monks.† It is most probable that they were Brahmans who under the Buddhist regime took to cultivation and landholding, and that the orthodox Hindu Brahmans refused to recognize them when they regained their ascendancy. There is, however, as pointed out in the last census report, no doubt that at the present day they are regarded as a community distinct from Brahmans. It is the irony of fate that in Bihar their Brahmanical status is no longer conceded, whereas in Orissa the Mastan, who were also Buddhistic Brahmans, are still recognized as Brahmans, though they follow non-Brahmanical occupations; in fact, their devotion to cultivation has earned them the name of Balaram-gotri, the plough being a distinctive weapon of the god Balaram. The better classes among the Babhans generally call themselves Bhumihar Brahmans, *i.e.*, landholding Brahmans, and this title is obtaining recognition in Tirhut. Elsewhere they are still commonly known as Babhans or simply as Bhuinhars: Bhumihar is only a Sanskritized form of Bhuinhar. The name Bhumihar Brahman has been recognized by Government, and they are now returned as Babhan (Bhumihar Brahman). It was, however, impossible to grant their request to be recorded simply as Brahmans, both because it would have given them a name and status not recognized by their co-religionists, and also because, in the returns, they would have been merged in the main

* It is reported that in Purnea there have been a few cases of Babhans marrying Maithil Brahman girls, but none of Maithil Brahmans taking wives from among the Babhans.

† *Babhan*, by Mahamahopadhya Hara Prasad Sastri, Journal of the Asiatic Society, Bengal, Vol. LXXI, Part I, pp. 61-62.

body of Brahmans and all record of them as a community would have been lost.

BELWARS.

The Belwars, who are found in Saran and Champaran, also claim to be Brahmans. They are a small but wealthy community whose chief occupation is trade in cattle and grain. It is reported that they were originally Sanadh Brahmans, and that their present name is a corruption of Bailwar, meaning a dealer in oxen. They are now no longer recognized as Brahmans, but wear the sacred thread and receive salutations as if they were.

NAMASUDRAS.

834. The only other caste that ventured to ask that it might be returned as Brahman was the Namasudra of Bengal. This request can scarcely be characterized as other than extraordinary. A generation ago a man of this community, when asked his caste, invariably replied Chandal or Chang or Charal, and they were generally known as Chandals in Hindu society. As they advanced in wealth and education, they began to adopt the more pleasing designation of Namasudra. On account of the ill-feeling and resentment which the name Chandal aroused, they were entered in the census tables of 1891 as Namasudra or Chandal, and in those of 1901 as Namasudra (Chandal). Hitherto they have been quite content to be called Namasudras, but at this census they went further. Not only did they represent that the suffix Chandal should be dropped—a prayer which was granted—but also that they should be enumerated as Namasudra Brahmans. In support of this claim they went so far as to declare that they are of Brahman descent and that their social customs and rites are similar to those of Vedic Brahmans. "We can," they said, "firmly lay hold on Brahmanical origin and can claim to be recognized by the Government as such." Thus do the pretensions of the low castes grow.

CLAIMS TO KSHATTRIYA STATUS.

835. A most persistent agitation was carried on by the Rajbansis of Northern Bengal with the object of being recognized as Kshattriyas by descent. They desired not only to be recorded separately from the Koch, but also to be distinguished by the name of Kshattriya. The former request was granted without hesitation, as there is no doubt that at the present day, irrespective of any question of origin, the Rajbansi and Koch are separate castes. It was, however, obviously out of the question to allow them to be returned by the generic and archaic name of Kshattriya. One section of the Pods was also extremely anxious to be known as Bratya Kshattriya. This is a progressive section which lives by cultivation unlike the other Pods, whose occupation is fishing. By the adoption of the new name they desire to emphasize their separation from the latter, fishing being generally looked upon as being as disreputable as cultivation is respectable. Another name which they claim is Padmaraj.

CLAIMS TO VAISYA STATUS.

836. The most interesting of the claims to Vaisya status was that set up by the Shahas of Bengal. In 1901 they were grouped with Sunris under the head Sunri or Shaha, the name Shaha being taken as synonymous with Sunri. At this census one progressive section aspired to a separate record of their community and to recognition as Vaisyas, as they disclaim all connection with the Sunris, and have nothing to do with the manufacture and sale of liquor, the traditional occupation of the Sunris, but are engaged in trade, money-lending and zamindari. Their claim to be Vaisyas has been recognized by certain Hindu authorities, but it was obviously impossible to allow the use of that generic term, and in any case the question of status was beyond the scope of the census. In view, however, of their feeling about the term Sunri, a separate entry has been made for Shahas in the caste table. At the same time, it must be must be admitted that this heading is by no means a satisfactory one, as the Bengali Sunris from whom they wish to be disassociated, also use the same name.* In Calcutta the members of this community returned their caste as Sadhubanik—a new and distinctive name used exclusively by them, which means simply a trader and is therefore an appropriate designation.

* Over 300,000 persons have been returned as Shahas, and there is a corresponding reduction in the number of Sunris.

CLAIMS OF MUSALMANS.

837. The ambition of numerous functional Musalman groups is to be known as Sheikhs. Practically all those of low degree, such as Nikaris or fishermen, Jolahas or weavers, Kulus or oil-pressers, Napits or barbers, etc., have this aspiration, though the better class Musalmans would not recognize them, nor would they recognize each other, as such. The Jolahas were insistent that they should not be returned by that name owing to its unfortunate connotation: the name is of Persian origin and means a weaver, but has come to be used proverbially for a fool. In view of their strong feeling on the subject it was laid down that they might return themselves as Momin or Nurbaf, two common synonyms, or as Sheikh Momin. They were not, however, content with this, but begged to be returned as Sheikhs. This was not allowed except in Eastern Bengal where the late Government gave even more that was asked for and issued orders that "in the case of Jolahas, Kulus, etc., if a person returns himself as such, the name of the caste should be entered. If, however, he does not so return himself, even though the enumerator considers him to be Jolah, Kulu, etc., the entry should be Sheikh, Pathan, etc., as in the case of other Muhammadans." Elsewhere in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa only those persons who are recognized as Sheikhs or Pathans were returned under those designations. The Jolahas of Eastern Bengal took full advantage of the boon granted by the local Government, the result being that the census returns show a decrease in their number from 310,000 to 110,000 in the districts under its administration. It is thus impossible to ascertain the growth of this well recognized community or to see how far its members are deserting the traditional occupation of weaving. The Nasyas of North Bengal also took the opportunity to call themselves Sheikh, their number falling from 199,727 to 1,816. In Jalpaiguri there were 63,884 Nasyas in 1901, but now there are only 36, while in Pabna the figure is reduced from 93,155 to 231.

INITIATION INTO CASTE.

HINDUS.

838. There are, writes Mr. W. Crooke in *Northern India*, two special rites to be performed after the birth of a child—"one to provide the baby with a name, the second to introduce it formally into the circle of its caste. . . When the name has been bestowed, the next rite is a species of initiation, by which the baby becomes duly introduced into the caste circle of its parents. Up to this time the child is hardly regarded as possessing a sentient soul, and he is subject to no restrictions in regard to food or drink. When he is once initiated, his real life as a Hindu begins. This rite assumes various forms. It is sometimes repesented by the solemn feeding of the child on sacred rice and other substances, each of which is supposed to impart some special quality. This is usually combined with a general feast to the members of the commensal circle, from which important results are believed to follow. The boy being now free to eat and drink within his group, and strictly forbidden to share in the food of those who are strangers to it, becomes united to his clansmen by an indissoluble bond. In popular opinion taboo, or impurity from outside, is usually communicated through food, and no one eating with his clansmen is likely to practise magical arts to their detriment by means of the common meal. . . This rite of initiation is performed for boys alone. A girl, in the Hindu view, needs no initiation in childhood. This is deferred until by virtue of the marriage rite she is severed from her own relations and is formally introduced into a new circle of kindred, that of her husband*." In another work, Mr. Crooke says—"When a child is dressed in a more or less imperfect way, the inference is that he or she has been initiated into caste, up to which time a Hindu thinks that children have no souls, and that it does

* *Northern India* (London, 1907), page 200.

not matter what they eat, or whether they do or do not observe the rules of ceremonial purity.*"

839. These ideas are not held by the Hindus of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. Children have souls both before and after birth. Birth and death are but changes of its garment. The soul enters the fœtus in the fifth month of pregnancy, and the cry of the new born infant is the wail of the soul on finding itself caught in the meshes of Maya or illusion. So far from having no soul, a young child has more of the divine nature than an adult. The idea is strikingly like that expressed by Wordsworth in *Intimations of Immortality*—

> "Not in entire forgetfulness
> And not in utter nakedness,
> But trailing clouds of glory, do we come.
> From God who is our home :
> Heaven lies about us in our infancy".

The same spirit permeates popular sayings, such as "The Deity is the infants' play-fellow," "Touch not an infant with your foot, for it is the Deity," etc. "The higher spiritual views among Hindus," writes a Hindu correspondent, "is that little children possess more of the Divinity in their constitution than adults, and that, consequently, they are above those artificial restrictions which govern men as members of society." The belief that an infant can commit no sin is partly due to this idea, and partly also to the common-sense principle that there can be no sin without knowledge of good and evil, or, at least, a consciousness of the categorical imperative. In practice, it finds expression in the fact that, while a child is of tender years, it is free from caste restrictions. Sanction for this is found in a saying attributed to the sage Angira, viz., "A child under five years of age can commit no fault and is liable to no *prayaschitta*. A child above five and below eleven years of age can have *prayaschitta* performed by a Guru or a friend." This idea is carried so far that young children are allowed to mix and even eat with children of other castes, but care is taken that they do not eat with children of low castes from whom water cannot be taken, and in no case are they allowed to eat forbidden food such as beef and pork.

THE TWICE-BORN.

840. Among Brahmans and other twice-born castes, such as Rajputs and Babhans, the initiation of boys into caste is marked by Upanayan, *i.e.*, the ceremony of investiture with the sacred thread, which should be performed at the eighth year of his age for a Brahman and the eleventh for a Kshattriya. This is, in fact, his second birth. According to one of the sacred texts, until it takes place, a child born of Brahman parents is no better than a Sudra, *i.e.*, he is not bound by the restrictions placed on Brahmans. Investiture with the sacred thread confers on him the full rights and privileges of his caste. He can repeat the sacred *gayatri* or Vedic prayer to the Sun-god, study the Vedas, participate in worship and be married. The ceremony of tonsure (Churakaran) and ear boring (Karnaveda) are now generally performed on the same day as Upanayan and form an integral part of it. According to Mr. Crooke, "Ceremonial tonsure finally rids him of any of the pollution acquired at birth which may still cling to him. His ears are then bored to receive the rings, which through life will guard him against the effects of taboo impersonated in the demons and evil spirits which ever beset his path. These preliminary rites of purification, directed against spiritual rather than physical pollution, prepare him for the final ceremony of initiation. This consists in the girding of the boy with sacred cord, which marks his status as one of the twice-born castes. This constitutes, as it were, a sacred circle which envelops his body, and within which no evil influence from abroad can penetrate. The thread itself is valueless as a protective until it has been sanctified by the blessing of Brahmans and the recital of texts from the sacred books. From this time the boy's spiritual life begins.†

* *Things Indian*, page 98. It must not be imagined that Mr. Crooke means to imply that clothing has anything to do with initiation. When a boy is old enough to be bound by caste rules, he will naturally be clothed in the interests of decency. I venture to proffer these remarks, as Mr. Crooke's words are generally taken by Bengali Hindus as meaning that initiation depends on clothing.

† *Northern India*, p. 201.

841. Upanayan is appropriately called Bratbandhan, *i.e.*, the ceremony which binds a child by caste restrictions. Some Brahmans in Tirhut, the old conservative and orthodox country of Mithila, are so strict, that they will not eat boiled rice touched by a boy before Upanayan or by a girl before her marriage. The children are, they say, still Sudras. The same belief appears to be responsible for a curious practice among the Maithil Brahmans, viz., that on the eve of Upanayan, the child takes rice cooked by servants of, *e.g.*, the Dhanuk or Kahar caste. This signifies that, before his second birth, a Brahman can take food touched by the lower castes and is apparently meant to mark the fact that he does so for the last time. Females, however, do not attain their full rights and privileges till they are *eyo*, *i.e.*, married, and retain them only while they remain in the married state. A widow has not the right to offer cooked food to the gods, or assist in other social and religious ceremonies, which are confined to married women.

OTHER CASTES.

842. There is considerable difference of opinion regarding the ceremony which marks the admission of low caste children to the caste circle with all its rights and liabilities. A few hold with Mr. Crooke that it is symbolized by the Annaprasan ceremony, at which a child is given a little sanctified rice. This rite, which is common both to high and low castes, is accompanied by a common meal among the caste members present; but the view that it marks the child's right to eat and drink with his caste fellows appears fantastic, for the ceremony is performed between the fifth and eighth month, when a baby cannot eat with others but is dependent on its mother or wet-nurse. Even among Brahmans, motherless children continue to be suckled by wet-nurses of other castes after Annaprasan. The great majority are of opinion that Annaprasan has no such special meaning, and that the real rite of initiation takes place when a child has sufficient intelligence to understand what it may or may not do. Some consider that this essential ceremony is Karnaveda or ear boring, others that it is Churakaran or tonsure, and others again that it is marriage.

MARRIAGE AND KARNAVEDA.

843. Marriage, it is said, is the Sudra's only *sanskara*. Among the low castes marriage seems to be regarded as making a distinct advance in social life. After it, water can be taken from the hands of those who are *jalacharanya*; and it is generally recognized that once a boy is married he is no longer free to do what he likes. As marriages take place among them at an early age—usually at about the age of five—that year may be taken as the period when caste restrictions begin to be enforced. Few people now have an idea of what the real meaning of the Karnaveda ceremony is, but there seems to be a belief in some parts that boring of the ears is a protection against the influence of evil spirits. It should be performed when a child is under 5 or 6 years of age, for the sensible reason that the lobe of the ear is then soft enough to be pierced without much pain. The ceremony is, to some extent, falling into disuse in Bengal, where some castes, such as the Kayasths and Sadgops, are beginning to have the ears merely touched with some sharp instrument at the time of marriage. Karnaveda is, in fact, coming to be regarded merely as a preliminary to marriage, so much so that some hold that a boy cannot be married till it has been performed. As regards the Oriya castes one correspondent (Babu Durga Prasad Misra, Deputy Magistrate, Sambalpur) writes: "Among the low classes and other non-Brahmans it is not certain whether Karnaveda or marriage gives a boy or girl his or her caste rights. In many cases a marraige does so, and in many others Karnaveda. After Karnaveda non-Brahmans are entitled to cremation; but water from them is not acceptable for the worship of the *Pitris* though it is available for the worship of the gods. For instance, a Thanapati by caste performs *puias* in a temple before his marriage, but cannot perform *sraddha* until married. So it may be said that a non-Brahman is half initiated into the caste by the Karnaveda and completely initiated by marriage."

CHURAKARAN.

844. There is no such doubt about the meaning of Churakaran, the ceremony at which the head is shaved clean except for one tuft of hair. "The only general test of caste initiation amongst the majority of the Hindus," writes the District Census Officer of the 24-Parganas (Babu Sukumar Haldar), "is the ceremony of Churakaran. It is this ceremony that makes a boy

a full-fledged Hindu. It has some resemblance to the Christian ceremony of confirmation or admission to full communion. The *choti*, *chura*, *chaitan*, *sikka* or *tikki* (queue) is regarded all over India as the distinctive mark of the Hindu. It has been generally discarded by educated Bengalis, but the only Hindus who are entitled to shave their heads completely are the Sannyasis (religious devotees), who are regarded as being outside the pale of civic society. A man who abandons the world, and becomes a Sannyasi, is socially dead, and his relatives take possession of his earthly goods. He is no longer subject to any caste restrictions. The higher Hindu thought regards caste restrictions as merely mundane, and treats the Sannyasi as more akin to God than the mere member of society." The same idea is prevalent in Bihar where the ceremony is commonly known as Mundan. The inner meaning of the rite is, however, often lost sight of. Some even think that it simply is a hygienic practice, or that its object is to keep the head cool.

845. The great majority of Hindus have no conception of the reason for these or other ceremonies. They are gone through as a matter of course, and not with the idea that they mark the introduction of a boy into the caste circle. They merely consider that when a boy is old enough to understand his duties and obligations, he is bound by them. The ceremonies have no special meaning to them, but are merely matter of immemorial custom. It must further be added that it is difficult, if not impossible, to distinguish between the initiation of a Hindu into caste as a social system and his initiation into spiritual life. Churakaran, in particular, is a purifying ceremony. Nails are cut and the hair regularly shaved at the end of *asauch* (a period of impurity), and also when a pious Brahman is to engage in sacrifice (*vaina*). The belief still lingers that natal hair has dangerous potentialities. Should a mother have to cut off her baby's hair without the proper ceremony, it is carefully preserved in the belief that otherwise evil may befall him.

ABORIGINAL RACES.

846. Among the aboriginal races the Santals have a ceremony (described below) by which those born into the tribe are solemnly recognized as its members. This ceremony appears to be unknown among other races, but the Hos have a observance by which a child is made a member of the family. After the child has been named, he is given a thread to wear round the waist, this being an article always worn by a Ho. The parents and relatives then cleanse themselves and offer rice-beer and rice, cooked in new pots, to their ancestors. This offering is intended to propitiate the spirits of the dead and prevent them from molesting the child. Cooked rice and rice-beer are then consumed by the parents, their relatives and any others who may choose to partake of them. After this the parents are regarded as having been entirely purified, while the child has been made a member of the family. This ceremony, however, is regarded as chiefly one of purification, and its omission would not involve the permanent exclusion of the child from the Ho tribe. It enables the parents to eat and drink again with their relatives and neighbours, and protects the child from the machinations of evil spirits. Among the Kandhs also the child and its parents go through a ceremony of purification. The cooking pots are renewed and the members of the family are again allowed to draw water from the village spring. The child is brought out of the house and formally presented to the village people. Among the Oraons there is no regular system of initiation, but when a boy is 6 or 7 years old, *i.e.*, old enough to enter the *dhumkuria* or common dormitory, the elder boys burn five deep marks on the lower part of his arm. This is the mark by which after death he will be recognized as an Oraon by other Oraon spirits.*

SANTALS.

847. The Santals have a solemn ceremony, called Chacho Chhatiar, by which the Santal is formally recognized as a member of the community. There is no age fixed for the ceremony, but it must precede marriage. If it has not been performed, a Santal can neither be married nor cremated, but has to be buried. It takes

* The Revd. P. Dehon, *Religion and Customs of the Oraons*, Memoirs of the Asiatic Society of Bengal, No. 9, Vol. I, 1907.

place in the presence of the assembled villagers, and its main features are as follows. The Naeke or village priest, who performs the public sacrifices to the Santal gods, the Manjhi or village headman, and other village officials, their wives, and every other woman present are anointed. Liquor (*handi*) is served to all present, each receiving four leaf cups for each of the children to be introduced into their society. A Guru, *i.e.*, an old Santal versed in the tribal folk-lore and legends, starts the *binti*, *i.e.*, a recitation, which begins with the creation of the earth and relates the history of the Santals and their wanderings. This ended, the Guru asks the assembled people to admit the boy to brotherhood saying—"We implore you to let us stay with you, to brew and drink beer, to fetch water, to pin leaves together on the day of marriage, the day of Chhatiar, the day of cremation." The ceremony is concluded by further drinking and singing of songs. The people are thus asked to recognize the boy as having a right to participate at the three great social functions of the Santals, and they acknowledge his rights by drinking *handi*, the Santal mode of ratification.

CASTE RESTRICTIONS.

848. In the days of Manu the restrictions with regard to occupations were very rigid and the penalties for transgressions severe. Manu declares (Chapter X, Verses 92, 96 & 97)—"A Brahman falls at once through selling meat, lac and salt; he becomes a Sudra in the course of three days through selling milk...If a low-born man should, through greed, live by the occupations of the exalted, the king should banish him at once, after depriving him of his property....Better one's own duties incomplete than those of another well performed; for he who lives by the duties of another falls from caste at once." In other words, banishment, accompanied by confiscation of property, was the punishment for encroachment by a man of low caste upon the monopoly of one of higher caste. Again, Manu lays down (Chapter X, verse 418) that the king should compel the Vaisya and the Sudra to follow each his own occupation, for "by departing from their own occupations, these two would cause the universe to shake." The rules regarding eating with persons of other castes were not nearly so strict. A learned twice-born man was not to eat the cooked food of Sudras who did not perform *sraddhas*, but if he was without means of subsistence, he might take raw food in quantity sufficient to last him for one night. The punishments were also light, *e. g.*, a fast for three days if the offence was unintentional, and a simple penance if it was intentional. "For devouring the food of those whose food one ought not to eat, and food left by a woman or Sudra, and such flesh as ought not to be eaten, one should drink water and barley for seven nights." The marriage restrictions were equally lax, for a twice-born man could, with impunity, marry into a lower caste.

849. In modern times the restrictions regarding occupations have been considerably relaxed, for no caste punishes a man who trespasses upon the preserves of the higher castes. A man can also adopt the occupations of lower castes, unless they are regarded as degraded or revolting, such as selling cowhides. In Bengal, some Brahmans have become physicians, shopkeepers and even liquor vendors. Brahmans, Baidyas and Kayasthas have joined and started boot and leather manufacturing concerns without any notice of their conduct being taken by the Hindu community. A striking proof of the extent to which conditions have changed afforded by the remarks of a speaker at the Samaj Raksha Sabha of Benares, of which the following report recently appeared in one of the newspapers.* "In the present condition of their society, when they saw the names of Brahmans and even Pandits in the list of shareholders of the Great Eastern Hotel Company, when they remembered that even well-known Brahmans took active part in tanneries, wine shops, and other business, and the speaker himself was director of a company of publishers of Sanskrit books (each of which was sinful according to strict Hindus),

* *Statesman*, 1st May 1912.

the Raja said they had no right to hate Shahas for keeping wine shops. When they, Brahmans, intruded on the trades and the occupations of the people of lower caste, they had no moral right to protest against their coming up to them and shaking hands with them."

With these remarks may be compared those of a Hindu correspondent describing the changes he had witnessed in his own lifetime: "Thirty years ago, one rarely heard of a Vaidic Brahman being engaged otherwise than in acting as Guru to his disciples or as a teacher in Sanskrit *tols:* at the present day, there are vakils, pleaders and clerks galore among them. One could hardly point out a Grahacharjya that had any other occupation than the preparation of the Hindu almanac or casting horoscopes: many Government servants in high appointments are now found in their ranks. Similarly there are scores of Bhat and Agradani Brahmans who disdain to attend *sraddhas* and similar ceremonies for the sake of gifts, but find employment in trade or in public and private offices. Numbers of Barna Bipras are influential traders and public servants; hundreds of Rarhi and Barendra Brahmans are employed by trading and other firms. But though modern education has loosened, it has failed to break down altogether the strong barrier that centuries of orthodoxy built up. The wealth of the Brahman or Kayasth trader or merchant is still a matter for scorn in centres of rural orthodoxy: and it is doubtful if this feeling does not, even to this day, retard the flow of capital into industrial and commercial channels." At the other end of the scale we find the Namasudras, who are by tradition cultivators and boatmen, engaging in a number of other occupations, *e.g.*, as clerks, traders, shopkeepers, goldsmiths, oil-pressers, braziers, blacksmiths and carpenters: one member of the Namasudra caste even holds the appointment of a Deputy Magistrate.

850. As regards commensality, the upper classes in Bengal, whose ideas have been liberalized by Western education, ignore all but extreme cases. They rarely punish a member, who takes prohibited food, provided he does so privately. Even cases of open violation of traditional rules are treated leniently. Gentlemen returning from England are now taken back into society after a simple penance and sometimes without it. As regards marriage, the upper classes were formerly far stricter than the lower classes, but now an opposite current has set in and marriages between endogamous sub-castes, widow marriages and adult marriages are taking place among the higher castes of Bengal in increasing numbers. An account of various other restrictions is given in paragraphs 579—584 (pages 367-368) of the last Bengal Census Report, from which it will be seen how greatly standards differ. Instances of the practical working of different restrictions will also be found in the section of this Chapter dealing with caste government.

851. The Nepalese castes are the least fettered, especially in regard to occupations. They are tribal and not functional castes, and a man may adopt nearly any occupation. A Brahman will work as a syce—I have had one myself—or garden cooly, a Chhetri as a khitmatgar, a Jimdar as a cook, etc. None of the high castes, however, will work as a blacksmith, tailor or tanner, these and a few other occupations being regarded as degrading. They have also far greater freedom in eating and drinking together. Respectable castes, such as Jimdar, Newar, Gurung, Mangar and Sunuwar, can eat and drink together until they are married, and marriage takes place later than among the Hindus of the plains, being deferred till 12, 15, or even 25 years of age. Even after marriage they can eat anything together except pulse and flour made of millets.

CASTE GOVERNMENT.

852. "We have," observes a recent writer on India and its problems, "destroyed in Indian social life all those courts of arbitration, and all those offices, which had, as one of their functions, the settlement of personal disputes. We have thus driven the people to the pleader and the barrister and the law courts."[*] The writer appears to overlook the vitality of caste

[*] J. Ramsay Macdonald, *The Awakening of India*, London, 1910, p. 115.

polity and the important part played by caste tribunals. It is their function to adjudicate upon questions affecting the purity and solidarity of the caste; they are the medium through which the unwritten law of the community is brought into action. They take cognizance of offences against that law, and their jurisdiction has a wide range extending over matters domestic, moral, social, and, in some cases also, professional, civil and criminal.

CONTROL OF CASTES BY HINDU KINGS.

853. The early records of India show that the authority of the caste to make and maintain its own laws was recognized, and that it was the duty of the king with his Brahman counsellors to enforce its regulations. According to Gautama (*circa* 500 B. C.), the laws of castes and families, when not opposed to sacred texts, were authoritative. "The king shall protect the castes and orders, in accordance with justice, and those who leave the path of duty he shall lead back to it." Manu again says—"A king shall enforce his own law only after a careful examination of the laws of castes and families." The king was not, however, to act entirely on his own responsibility, but in co-operation with, and on the advice of, Brahmans. Vasishta affirms that the three lower *varnas* were to live according to the teaching of the Brahman: the latter had to declare their duties, and the king had to govern them accordingly. The king's duty was to pay attention to all the laws of castes (*jati*) and families, to make the four *varnas* fulfil their duties and to punish those who failed to do so. The parts allotted to the Brahman and to the king in the enforcement of caste rules are explained by Apastamba, who says that, if those who have broken caste rules fail to perform the penance prescribed by their spiritual guide, he shall take them before the king. The king shall "send them to his domestic priest, who should be learned in the law and the science of government. He shall order them to perform the proper penances if they are Brahmans, and reduce them to reason by forcible means, excepting corporal punishment and servitude. In the case of other castes, the king, after having examined their actions, may punish them even by death."*

BALLAL SEN.

854. Ballal Sen, King of Bengal in the 12th century A. D., seems to have gone further, and to have laid down an elaborate code of caste rules. He further fixed the position of different castes, elevating some and degrading others. According to the *Vallala Charita*, he made, or at any rate declared, the Kaibarttas a clean caste, from whom Brahmans might take water, and he also raised the status of the Kansaris and Malis. He is further credited in the same work with degrading the Sonar Banias, declaring them to be an unclean caste, whom no Brahman could teach, or officiate for, without himself being degraded. Ballal Sen is, however, chiefly remembered as the father of Kulinism. He laid down rules for determining the precedence of the family within the caste, and hypergamy was the direct result of Kulinism. From hypergamy again arose the practice of polygamy among the Kulin Brahmans of Bengal. While a Kulin could marry as many wives as he liked, the Bangsaj or the Srotriya had often the greatest difficulty in securing even one.

THE MUGHAL GOVERNMENT AND CASTE.

855. I have been unable to find any record of the Mughal Government exercising active control over caste matters, but from the following extract from the proceedings of the President and Council, dated the 16th August 1679, it appears that it reserved to itself the right to sanction restoration to caste:—"The peculiar punishment of forfeiting caste, to which the Hindus are liable, is often inflicted from private pique and personal resentment amongst themselves, and requires to be restrained to those occasions only where there may be a regular process and clear proofs of the offence before the Brahmans, who are their natural judges. But, when any man has naturally forefeited his caste, you are to observe that he cannot be restored to it *without the sanction of Government, which was a political supremacy reserved to themselves by the Muhammadans* † and which as it publicly asserts the subordination of Hindus, who are so considerable a majority of subjects, ought

* A. M. T. Jackson, *Note on the History of the Hindu Caste System*, J.A.S.B., July 1907.
† The italics are mine.